

Combating Targeted Disinformation Campaigns

A whole-of-society issue

Part Two

August 2021

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United States

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Acknowledgments

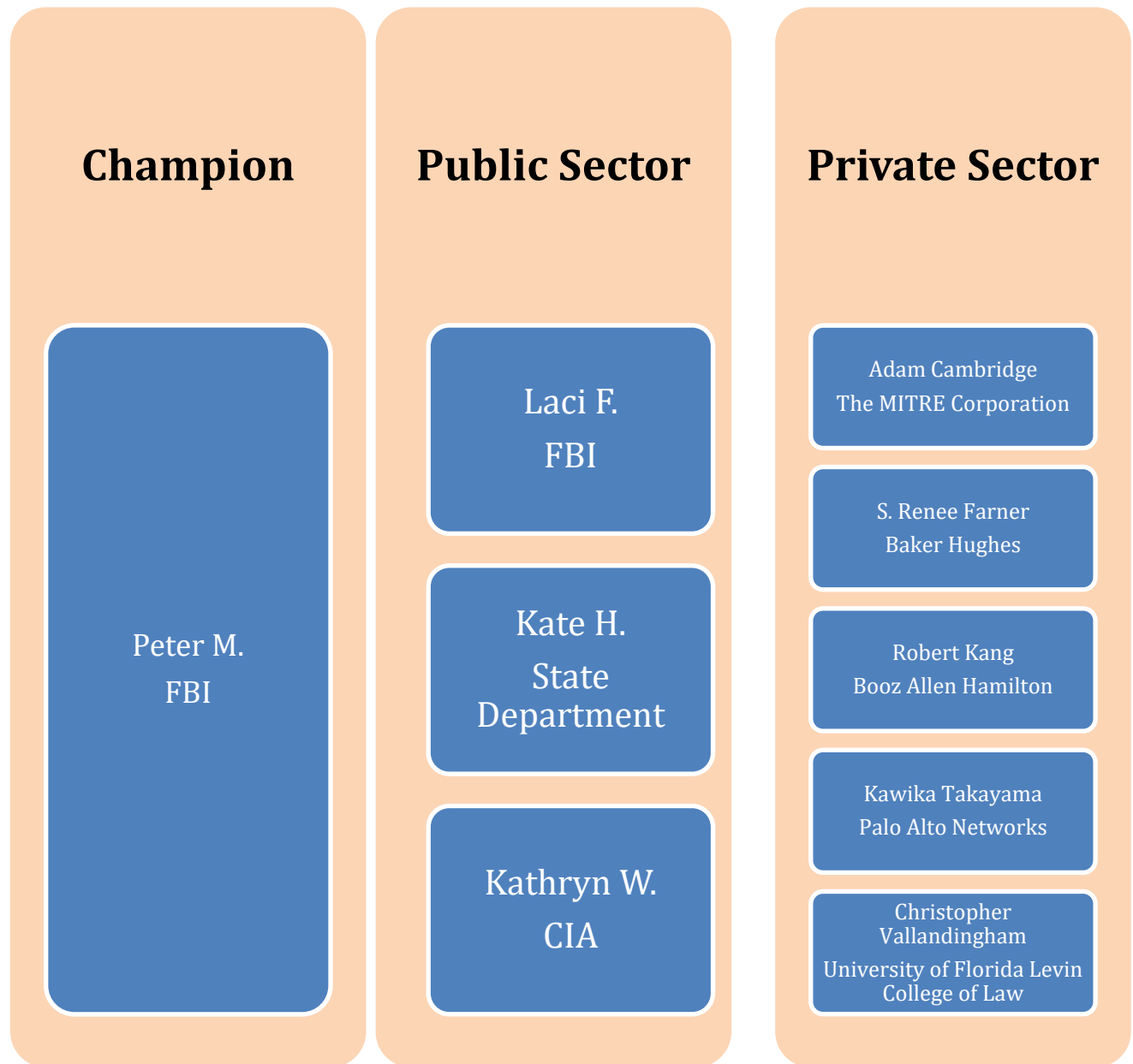
We would like to thank all who contributed to this research amid the unprecedented challenge of the COVID-19 pandemic. This project would not be possible without the assistance of the Office of the Director of National Intelligence and the Department of Homeland Security, who provided us the opportunity to work together on a very important and pressing topic.

We are grateful to the individuals from academia, private sector companies, and think tanks who joined us in our weekly teleconferences to lend their insights on the vexing topic of disinformation campaigns. Their input provided invaluable guidance on lines of inquiry and potential criteria for evaluating the effectiveness of different approaches to countering disinformation campaigns.

We would like to extend a special thank you to Peter M., Team Champion, whose patience and wisdom help guidance us through both years of our project.

We would like to acknowledge the Team members listed below for their contributions on this project and report. We are deeply indebted to Peter Thielen from Booz Allen Hamilton for helping the team to develop a graphic on how to spot dis/misinformation and bringing our vision to fruition and Hale Vallandingham for her assistance with graphics and formatting.

Team Members



Scope

This paper was produced by the Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns team under the auspices of the Public-Private Analytic Exchange Program – an initiative of the Office of Director of National Intelligence and managed by the Department of Homeland Security. The paper was based on open-source research and interviews with subject matter experts. All judgments and assessments are based solely on unclassified sources, are the product of joint private sector and U.S. government efforts, and do not necessarily represent the judgments and assessments of the employers of the Team members.

Offensive and defensive cyber operations conducted by the U.S. government against foreign threat actors are beyond the scope of this paper.

Executive Summary

Recent events have demonstrated that targeted disinformation campaigns can have consequences that impact the lives and safety of information consumers. On social media platforms and in messaging apps, disinformation spread like a virus, infecting information consumers with contempt for democratic norms and intolerance of the views and actions of others. These events have highlighted the deep political and social divisions within the United States. Disinformation helped to ignite long-simmering anger, frustration, and resentment, resulting, at times, in acts of violence and other unlawful behavior.

All information consumers are vulnerable to being deceived by imposters, charlatans, hucksters, con men, and self-proclaimed experts. But ideological rigidity and intolerance of opposing views make information consumers especially vulnerable to such deception. In polarized environments, threat



Figure 1 Disinformation (obtained from [Defense.Info](https://www.defenseinfo.org/)).

actors find ample opportunity to spread disinformation. Their voices are amplified by disgruntled audiences willing and sometimes eager to spread messages of discord.

In 2019, the Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns team submitted the first of a two-part report on targeted disinformation campaigns.¹ In the first report, we provided

¹ 2019 Public-Private Analytic Exchange Program, Department of Homeland Security, *Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns: A whole-of-society issue*, PDF file, October 2019, https://www.dhs.gov/sites/default/files/publications/ia/ia_combatting-targeted-disinformation-campaigns.pdf (Accessed August 24, 2021).

a broad overview of targeted disinformation campaigns, described how disinformation enters the information ecosystem, how threat actors exploit modern technology, and how information consumers wittingly or unwittingly contribute to the spread of disinformation. We then suggested ways to counter these campaigns. We concluded that, to combat these campaigns, a comprehensive solution involving many sectors of society and lines of efforts was required.

In our second paper, we expand on two themes explored in the first paper: 1) how to stem the supply of disinformation; and 2) how to reduce the demand for disinformation. In this paper, we recommend approaches that impact both supply and demand.



None of these approaches are new; nor are they decisive by themselves. When combined and implemented consistently, the sum is greater than the parts.

Disinformation should not be viewed as a problem to be solved, but as a condition to be treated. There is no cure. However, preventative and alleviatory measures can be taken.

Recommendations

Source attribution

- Identification of sources of disinformation, when feasible. We believe that threat actors should not be permitted to hide behind the veil of anonymity and identifying them by name gives information consumers important information as they evaluate the truthfulness of the information.

Exposure of imposters

- Exposure of imposters who use false persona and fake credentials to dupe information consumers online. If possible, we believe that uncovering imposters should be done without revealing personally identifiable information about the person.

User control over content

- Greater control by information consumers over the sources of information that appear in their content feeds on social media platforms. We believe that giving information consumers greater control may help to limit the creation of echo chambers.

Fact checking

- Access to content alerts which identify information that is factually incorrect, fraudulent, misleading, or satirical. We believe that such alerts should be politically neutral and based on clear definitions of the categories used.

Psychology of disinformation

- Making information consumers aware of how they process online information and how their online activities facilitate disinformation campaigns will help them make better decisions regarding this information.

Media literacy

- Information consumers who understand how to evaluate the impact of social media and other modern forms of communication on their ability to assess the trustworthiness of information will be more resilient to disinformation.

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1. Disinformation Campaigns Are National Security Threats



Disinformation campaigns are threats to national security because they have a corrosive impact on democratic institutions and civil society in the United States.

A healthy democracy depends on well-informed citizens, the competition of ideas, and the willingness to compromise. Disinformation campaigns undermine all three.

Disinformation campaigns have contributed measurably to divisions within U.S. society. Threat actors take advantage of these divisions and harness the power of social media platforms to spread disinformation to large audiences. At times, these disinformation campaigns influence the real-world behavior of information consumers. For example,



Figure 3 Jimmy Margulies via AP (from [ABC news](#)).

disinformation about the 2020 presidential elections impacted the lead-up to the events of January 6, 2021 in Washington, D.C. Furthermore, disinformation about the COVID-19 vaccination program has undermined efforts to curb the virus and its variants. Disinformation also weakens international alliances and undermines U.S. attempts to project soft power abroad.



Figure 4 Divided country (obtained from [News Bharati](#)).

The launch of Sputnik I in 1957 sent shockwaves through the U.S. government. Fearing that the Soviet Union was surpassing the United States in technological and military prowess, the U.S. government responded by investing heavily in human capital and the development of technology. Experts identified weaknesses in educational

institutions from primary to graduate levels, insufficient investment in basic and applied research, and governmental bureaucracies ill-adapted to guide the changes deemed necessary to respond to the threat. Major sectors of society contributed to a whole-of-society response to the perceived threat. A similar response is needed today for disinformation campaigns. However, the divisions in our society hinder such a coordinated response.

Perhaps because the disinformation crisis has descended upon us so suddenly, and because it reinforces our increasing political polarization, we've tended to regard it as inevitable and unavoidable—a fact of digital life. But we do have options, and if we come together to exercise them, we could make a meaningful difference.

Glenn Gerstell, former NSA General Counsel



In Finland, information literacy forms part of the national curriculum for primary and secondary schools. In math courses, instructors show students how statistics can be manipulated for the purposes of misleading others. In art classes, students learn how images can be altered to change their meaning. In language classes, students are exposed to different ways words can be used to mislead. And finally, students learn in history classes about past propaganda campaigns.



In Malaysia, the Communication and Multimedia Ministry launched an information verification portal called "sebenarnya.my." The public can use this portal to request that the Ministry verify information found online.



Germany introduced the "Act to Improve Enforcement of the Law in Social Networks" in 2017. This bill requires social media companies with over two million users in Germany to enforce 21 statutes in the German criminal code related to hate speech on their platforms. Platforms must review and delete unlawful content within 24 hours of receiving a complaint or be fined up to 50 million EUR.

Efforts of other countries: Finland ²; Malaysia³; Germany⁴

² Jon Henley, "How Finland Starts Its Fight against Fake News in Primary Schools," *The Guardian*, last modified January 29, 2020, <https://www.theguardian.com/world/2020/jan/28/fact-from-fiction-finlands-new-lessons-in-combating-fake-news> (accessed August 24, 2021).

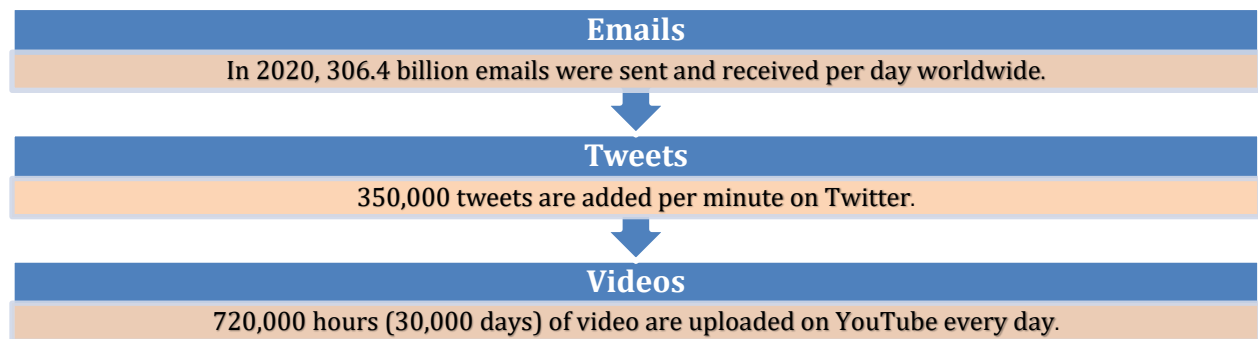
³ Fairuz Mohd Shahar, "Communications Ministry launches sebenarnya.my to quash fake news, information", *New Straits Times*, last modified March 14, 2017, <https://www.nst.com.my/news/2017/03/220604/communications-ministry-launches-sebenarnyamy-quash-fake-news-information> (accessed August 24, 2021).

⁴ Nina Jankowicz and Shannon Pierson, "Freedom and Fakes: A Comparative Exploration of Countering Disinformation and Protecting Free Expression", PDF file, Wilson Center, December 2020, <https://acrosskarman.wilsoncenter.org/sites/default/files/media/uploads/documents/WWICS%20STIP%20Freedom%20and%20Fakes%20A%20Comparative%20Exploration%20of%20Countering%20Disinformation%20and%20Protecting%20Free%20Expression.pdf> (accessed August 24, 2021).

2. Reducing the Supply of Disinformation



Methods exist which can help slow, but not eliminate, the supply of disinformation. The challenge is breathtaking. The global information ecosystem enables the creation and distribution of information on an enormous scale.



The global dissemination of information: Emails;⁵ Tweets;⁶ YouTube.⁷

In this section, we conclude that technological and non-technological solutions exist that can reduce the likelihood that disinformation will course through the information ecosystem and negatively impact the target audience. These methods include source attribution, fact-checking, and greater user control over algorithms used by social media platforms.

⁵Joseph Johnson, “Number of sent and received e-mails per day worldwide from 2017 to 2025”, last modified April 7, 2021, <https://www.statista.com/statistics/456500/daily-number-of-e-mails-worldwide> (accessed August 24, 2021).

⁶ “Twitter Usage Statistics,” <https://www.internetlivestats.com/twitter-statistics>. (accessed August 24, 2021).

⁷ Maryam Mohsin, “10 YouTube Stats Every Marketer Should Know in 2021” (Infographic), last modified January 25, 2021, <https://www.oberlo.com/blog/youtube-statistics> (accessed August 24, 2021).

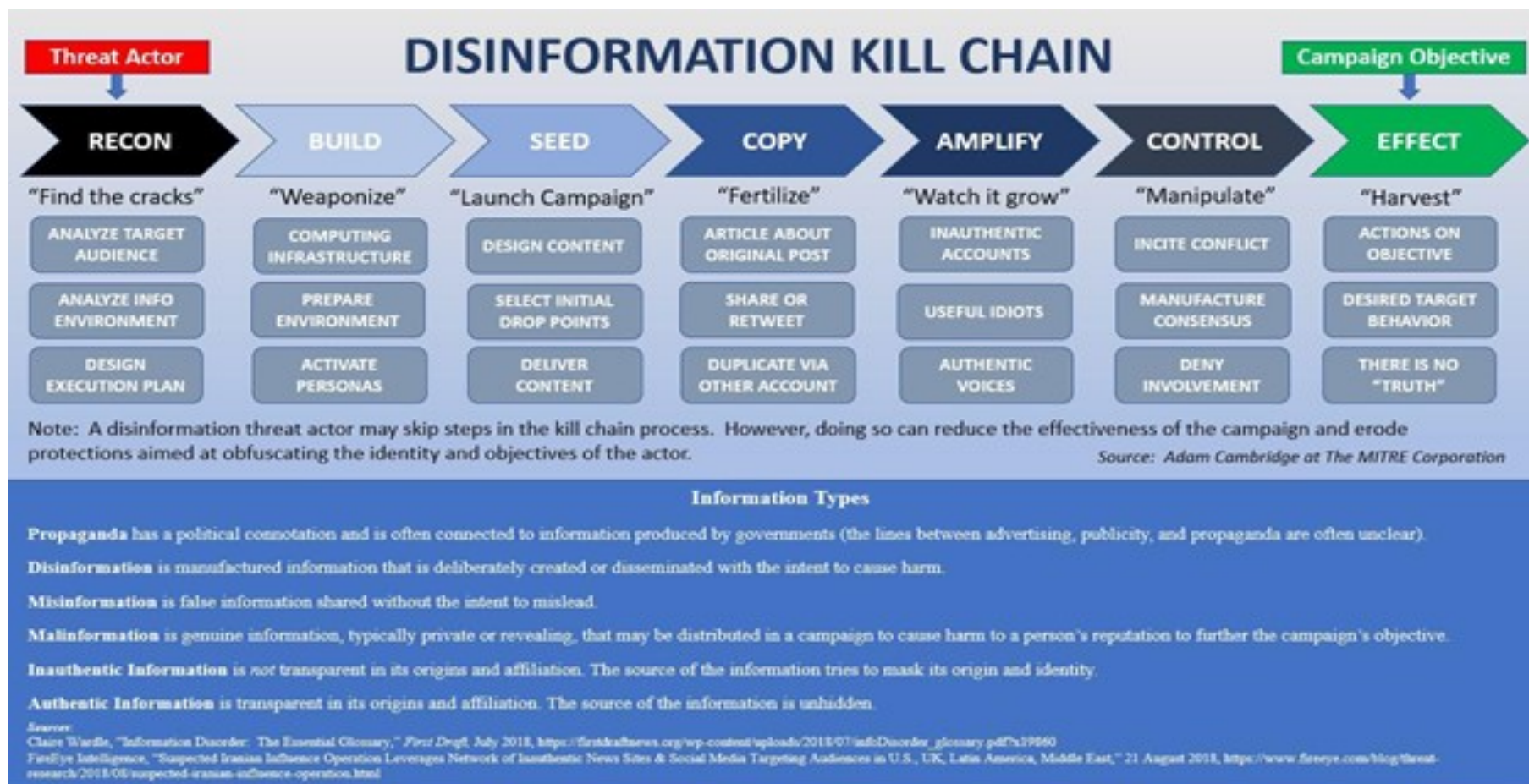


Figure 5 Source: The MITRE Corporation.

2.1. Source Attribution and Anonymity



Providing information about the threat actors responsible for disinformation campaigns can help slow the spread of disinformation since the source of information influences how information consumers evaluate the truthfulness of the information and the decision to later share the information. This method is called source attribution. Source attribution can be conducted in a manner that safeguards the constitutional and statutory rights of U.S. citizens to privacy and the freedom of speech.

In the United States, anonymity has long been considered a necessary component of the freedom of speech. However, anonymity on the Internet is a mixed bag. It not only promotes the discussion of sensitive topics, but also facilitates uncivil behavior and the spread of disinformation. In the next two sections, we consider source attribution of both foreign and domestic threat actors.

2.1.1. Identifying Foreign Actors



“Naming and shaming” is an approach to countering disinformation in which threat actors behind disinformation campaigns are publicly identified. When threat actors use fake personas to deceive, information consumers may decide to disregard the threat actor and the disinformation associated with that threat actor when the deception is uncovered. Once a threat actor is publicly identified, they will be shamed into altering course.

Our deeply-felt national scruples about misidentifying a fake account or inadvertently silencing someone, however briefly, create a welcoming environment for malign groups who masquerade as Americans or who game algorithms....When tech platforms or regulators strive to take meaningful action to suppress abuse of their platforms and our American polity, there are waves of outrage over censorship. We have conversations about whether or not bots have the right to free speech, we respect the privacy of fake people..

New Knowledge, *The Tactics & Tropes of the Internet Research Agency*

Private companies have publicly attributed malicious cyber incidents to foreign state actors.⁸ The benefits of doing so are usually short-lived since the threat actor will likely change tactics in response. These companies have stated several reasons for engaging in this activity, including supporting internal government discussions by allowing employees not possessing the appropriate security clearances to view information that would likely be classified if provided by the federal government, providing corroborating information for other information gathered by the federal government, and underscoring to the public the reach of the cyber incident.⁹

One method of disseminating this information is through source alerts. Researchers at Harvard University tested whether source alerts help to reduce the likelihood that

⁸ Sasha Romanosky and Benjamin Boudreaux, "Private Sector Attribution of Cyber Incidents: Benefits and Risks to the U.S. Government", PDF file, Rand, January 2019, https://www.cs.dartmouth.edu/~ccpalmer/teaching/cs55/Resources/Papers/RAND_WR1267.pdf (accessed August 24, 2021).

⁹ Ibid., 17-20.

information consumers will believe or share political messages. Limiting the study to foreign sources of information and two social media platforms (Twitter and Facebook), the researchers explored whether general (“foreign government”) and specific (“Russian government”) source alerts did have such an effect.¹⁰ In assessing how the participants in the study viewed the truthfulness of the information, the researchers found that the effects were more significant for specific source



Figure 6 State-affiliated media account labels (obtained from [Twitter](#))

alerts than for general ones. Exposure to specific source alerts reduced the probability that the participants would find the disinformation truthful. General and specific source alerts reduced the tendency to “like” or share the disinformation on Twitter only.

FireEye, CrowdStrike, Dell SecureWorks, and Cisco Talos have publicly identified foreign threat actors.¹¹ In recent years, both Facebook and Twitter have increased the use of specific source alerts and have tied disinformation campaigns to foreign actors such as the Iran Broadcasting Company and the Royal Thai Military.¹²

¹⁰ Jason Roos Arnold et al., “Source alerts can reduce the harms of foreign disinformation”, PDF file, *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*, May 2021, https://misinforeview.hks.harvard.edu/wp-content/uploads/2021/05/arnold_source_alerts_foreign_disinformation_20210510.pdf (accessed August 24, 2021).

¹¹ Romanosky and Boudreaux, “Private Sector Attribution of Cyber Incidents: Benefits and Risks to the U.S. Government.” 6.

¹² Josh A. Goldstein and Shelby Grossman, “How disinformation evolved in 2020”, Tech Stream, Brookings, last modified January 4, 2021, <https://www.brookings.edu/techstream/how-disinformation-evolved-in-2020> (accessed August 24, 2021).



Developed by OpenAI, GPT-3 uses neural networks and machine learning to generate automated text in response to prompts from humans. These texts are difficult to differentiate from those written by humans.

Figure 7 OpenAI, GPT-3.

There are risks associated with source attribution. Such source attribution invites blowback from these threat actors and may undermine ongoing federal law enforcement, intelligence, and diplomatic efforts.

The evidence that such naming “shames” foreign actors into modifying their behavior is thin.¹³ However, identifying specific foreign threat actors behind disinformation campaigns gives information consumers the opportunity to evaluate the information with this source attribution in mind and therefore we recommend such attribution when circumstances allow.

❖ Recommendation 1: Identify Foreign Sources of Disinformation

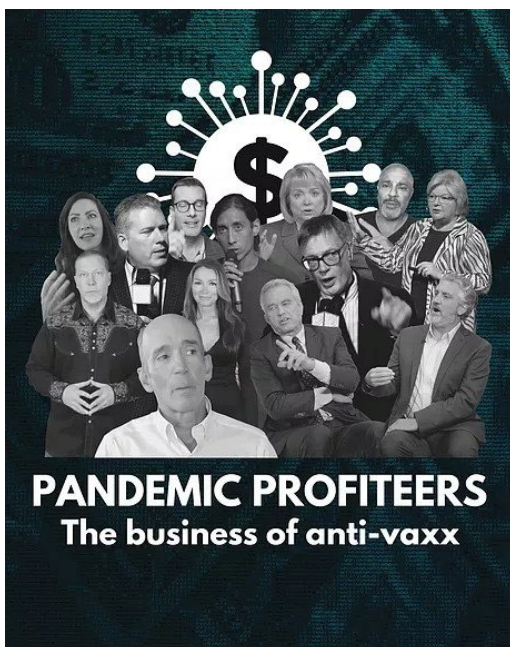
2.1.2. Identifying Domestic Actors



Since the 2016 U.S. presidential election and the emergence of the COVID-19 pandemic, the focus on disinformation campaigns has shifted from foreign

¹³ Jack Snyder, “Backlash against naming and shaming: The politics of status and emotion”, *The British Journal of Politics and International Relations* 22, no 4 (2020): 644-653.

threat actors to domestic ones.¹⁴ On balance, disinformation campaigns originating from domestic actors are more enduring and damaging than those originating from foreign actors.¹⁵ But, when domestic actors are involved, even if co-opted by foreign actors, the factors that bear on the decision to identify domestic actors differ in important ways from those that apply to foreign actors.



CCDH
Center for Countering Digital Hate

counterhate.com

Figure 8 *Pandemic Profiteers*, [Center for Countering Digital Hate](#).

Both private and public entities have legal obligations to protect information they collect about information consumers. This obligation depends on the type of information collected and how it was collected. Private entities generally have no legal obligation to protect information about information consumers with whom they have no fiduciary relationship, provided the information was gathered through licit means. Therefore, these private entities are free to publish this information when it suits their purpose. For example, in a report published in March 2021, the Center for Countering Digital Hate named twelve

information consumers responsible for 73% of anti-COVID-19 vaccine content online.¹⁶

¹⁴ Larry Luxner, “Ahead of the 2020 US elections, the disinformation threat is more domestic than foreign”, Atlantic Council, last modified September 23, 2020, <https://www.atlanticcouncil.org/blogs/new-atlanticist/ahead-of-the-2020-us-elections-the-disinformation-threat-is-more-domestic-than-foreign> (accessed August 24, 2021).

¹⁵ Richard Stengel, “Domestic Disinformation Is a Greater Menace Than Foreign Disinformation”, *Time*, last modified June 26, 2020, <https://time.com/5860215/domestic-disinformation-growing-menace-america> (accessed August 24, 2021).

¹⁶ Center for Countering Digital Hate, “The Disinformation Dozen: Why Platforms Must Act on Twelve Leading Online Anti-Vaxxers”, PDF file, March 24, 2021, https://252f2edd-1c8b-49f5-9bb2-cb57bb47e4ba.filesusr.com/ugd/f4d9b9_b7cedc0553604720b7137f8663366ee5.pdf. (accessed August 24, 2021).

The report included the name, photo, and screenshots of posts on Facebook and Twitter of each individual. The New York Times later published a more detailed article on the person listed in the report as the greatest offender.¹⁷

Whether the identification of domestic threat actors by private entities helps to stem the spread of disinformation is unclear. While naming and shaming may be superficially appealing as a method of exacting a price from those who peddle in disinformation, such naming and shaming might make matters worse by provoking a fierce backlash from those sympathetic to the views of the information consumers identified. In the end, this further entrenches both sides in their respective ideological positions.¹⁸ Since polarization is a primary reason for the success of disinformation campaigns, attempting to counter these campaigns with methods which may generate even more polarization seems questionable. Also, revealing the identities of domestic threat actors and other personally identifiable information can render these information consumers vulnerable to harassment or more egregious forms of retaliation.¹⁹ We do not condone harassment and vigilantism as means of responding to domestic threat actors.

Absent suspicion of criminal activity or a legitimate government purpose pursuant to clear legal authority, government monitoring of the opinions and activities of U.S. persons is problematic. Although federal and state law penalize false statements in judicial proceedings and official documents and information consumers may be liable for words

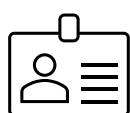
¹⁷ Sheera Frankel, "The Most Influential Spreader of Coronavirus Misinformation Online", *N.Y. Times*, last modified July 24, 2021, <https://www.nytimes.com/2021/07/24/technology/joseph-mercola-coronavirus-misinformation-online.html> (accessed July 30, 2021).

¹⁸ Ibid.

¹⁹ Kim Zetter, "Cyberbullying Suicide Stokes the Internet Rage Machine", *Wired*, last modified November 21, 2007, <https://www.wired.com/2007/11/cyberbullying-suicide-stokes-the-internet-fury-machine> (accessed August 24, 2021).

that incite violence, defraud, or defame, disinformation, much less misinformation, is not illegal in most cases.

2.1.3. Uncovering Imposters



An alternative to naming specific domestic threat actors is to alert information consumers to those threat actors who assume fake persona or claim to have credentials which they do not have. The status of the threat actor plays an important role in influencing the perceived trustworthiness of that threat actor.²⁰ Someone who claims to be an epidemiologist will likely be viewed as more reliable on the topic of coronaviruses than a person who claims to be a bus driver.

Information consumers who assume fake personas or claim fake credentials to deceive others for illegitimate purposes have no moral or legal standing for protection for their fraud, which is a form of disinformation. Revealing that credentials are fake can be accomplished without identifying the threat actor by name or by other information which can be tied to a specific person.



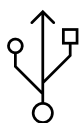
Figure 9 Fake identities, (obtained from [Wonder How To](#)).

²⁰ Edward L. Glaeser, “Measuring Trust”, PDF file, *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, (August 2000): 811-846. https://scholar.harvard.edu/files/laibson/files/measuring_trust.pdf (accessed August 24, 2021).

Threat actors who spread disinformation often seem to act with impunity, facing few negative consequences for the harm that they cause. In some circles, their disinformation may enhance their status and generate lucrative opportunities for them due to the attention that they draw. Legal actions against threat actors are available, but limited in number, and invariably costly and time-consuming. In a deeply divided society, shunning and ostracism no longer have the practical import they may have had in earlier generations. The lack of perceived consequences encourages threat actors to continue their activities. We acknowledge the challenges in today's environment and believe that punitive measures are less effective than measures which provide information about the threat actors upon which information consumers can make better informed decisions.

❖ Recommendation 2: Uncover Imposters

2.2. Social Media Algorithms & Fact-Checking

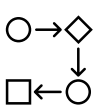


Challenging disinformation by fact-checking the information and making the results of this fact-checking publicly available is an important method of combatting disinformation campaigns. Disinformation which spreads unchecked through the information ecosystem will ultimately end up in the content feeds of social media platforms. Algorithms determine much of the content which ends up in these feeds. By allowing information consumers more control over these algorithms and the sources which these algorithms utilize, information consumers may have a greater ability to exclude known sources of disinformation.



Figure 10 Misinformation, (obtained from [Agility PR Solutions](#)).

2.2.1. Social Media Algorithms



Social media companies use algorithms to sort, index, prioritize, and sometimes suppress the content generated by users of their platforms. These companies can manipulate these algorithms to enhance the profitability of their platforms by attempting to keep users engaged on their platforms as much as possible through attention-grabbing features such as likes, comments, streaks, and recommended posts and people to follow. User activities are recorded, quantified, and used to tailor the user's experience while on the social media platform. On the one hand, algorithms simply give

the user more of what the user's activity on the platform seems to indicate the user wants. On the other hand, these same algorithms potentially create polarizing echo chambers by excluding contrary views.

In April 2021, the United States House of Representatives Subcommittee on Privacy, Technology, and the Law, a subcommittee of the Committee on the Judiciary, met to discuss the impact of algorithms.²¹ Several panelists warned of the dangers of algorithms and broadly echoed the sentiments of others who claim that algorithms affect how we see the world²², erode our ability to freely make choices²³, inherently create polarization²⁴, and create dangerous feedback loops²⁵. The panelists offered solutions ranging from robust federal oversight to a new digital infrastructure which avoids the many problems created by social media platforms in their current forms.

Algorithms influence decision-making in many sectors of society from determining insurance rates to assessing the volatility of stock prices on Wall Street. Algorithms require data to function, which comes in the form of user input on social media platforms.

²¹ *Algorithms and amplification: How Social Media Platforms' Design Choices Shape Our Discourse and Our Minds*, 117th Congress, Subcommittee on Privacy, Technology, and the Law, Committee on the Judiciary, U.S. Senate, April 27, 2021, <https://www.judiciary.senate.gov/meetings/algorithms-and-amplification-how-social-media-platforms-design-choices-shape-our-discourse-and-our-minds> (accessed August 24, 2021).

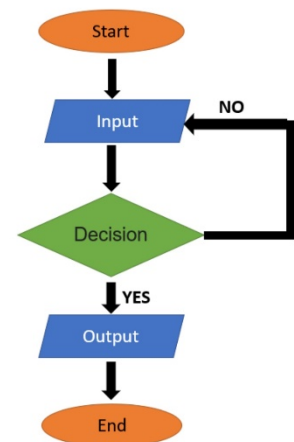
²² Joanna Stern, "Social-Media Algorithms Rule How We See the World. Good Luck Trying to Stop Them," *Wall Street Journal*, last modified January 17, 2021, <https://www.wsj.com/articles/social-media-algorithms-rule-how-we-see-the-world-good-luck-trying-to-stop-them-11610884800> (accessed August 2, 2021).

²³ Lewis Mitchell and James Bagrow, "Do social media algorithms erode our ability to makes decision freely? The jury is out", last modified October 11, 2020, <https://theconversation.com/do-social-media-algorithms-erode-our-ability-to-make-decisions-freely-the-jury-is-out-140729> (accessed August 3, 2021).

²⁴ Charles Johnston, "How Social Media Platforms Inherently Create Polarization", *Psychology Today*, last modified November 29, 2020, <https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/cultural-psychiatry/202011/how-social-media-algorithms-inherently-create-polarization> (accessed August 3, 2021).

²⁵ Ben Dickson, "What makes AI algorithms dangerous?", *TechTalks*, last modified June 10, 2020, <https://bdtechtalks.com/2020/06/10/ai-weapons-of-math-destruction> (accessed August 3, 2021).

Input into algorithms helps to determine the output of these algorithms. Social media platforms ultimately determine what content the algorithms feed into the content streams of users. By providing control of the data that the algorithm uses, platforms may help to ensure users have control over their individual experiences on the platform. Regular reminders to review the information that the algorithms use and make adjustments, if necessary, can help keep users engaged in the process of determining the content that shows up in their content feeds.



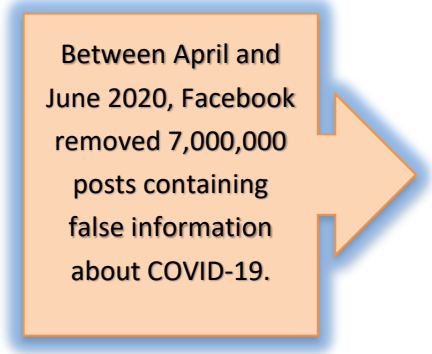
❖ Recommendation 3: Grant Users More Control over Content Feeds

2.2.2. Fact-checking



In general, publishers of information have an ethical, legal, and fiduciary responsibility to ensure that they publish information that is accurate. When mistakes are uncovered, publishers can retract articles and posts, send amended versions, and publicly announce the course of action taken to remedy the situation. Notable exceptions are media sites whose content is for satirical purposes or entertainment shows that generate fake news for comic effect. Social media companies are not publishers in the traditional sense of the word. These companies provide platforms where users of these platforms can add content. The user-driven content on these

platforms does not imply that the social media companies endorse the content. While these companies usually grant users the ability to moderate content on the pages and groups formed by the users themselves, content is not first subject to pre-approval by the social media companies prior to posting.



Between April and June 2020, Facebook removed 7,000,000 posts containing false information about COVID-19.

Figure 12 [Reuters](#).

Social media companies arguably play an outsized role in providing access to news and providing a means to share news and other types of information. The power to determine what content is permissible on a social media platform and what is not is a power that social media companies should exercise with great discretion.

These determinations should be made based on impartial and easily understood guidelines. Alerting users to the accuracy of information appearing in content feeds plays a useful role in encouraging users to make informed decisions.

Social media platforms, third-party entities, and users themselves can play a role in fact-checking information. If information is determined to be false, the information can be labeled as such, deleted, or supplemented by facts. To minimize the politicization of the process of removing or correcting disinformation, clear distinctions should be drawn between fact-checking, content moderation, and what constitutes improper censorship.

The goal of fact-checking is not to promote or suppress points of view, but to make sure that the information presented can be supported by verifiable information. We urge all fact-checkers to adhere to the principles identified below:



Figure 13 International Fact Checking Code of Principles, [IFCN](#).

PesaCheck

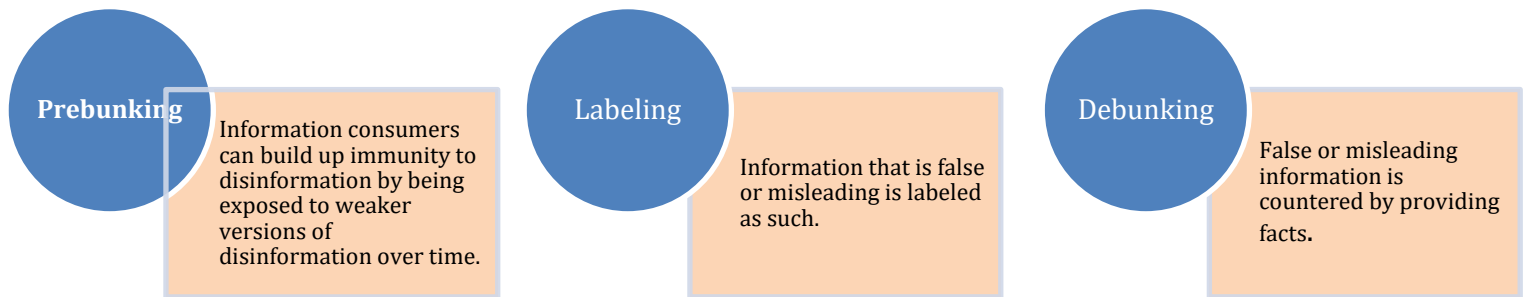
THE FACT CHECKING PROCESS



PESACHECK

Figure 14 The Fact Checking Process, (obtained from [PesaCheck](#)).

There are different methods of notifying readers that information has been fact-checked, but found to be unverifiable or false.



Researchers have found that the timing of fact-checks provided to readers makes a difference.²⁶ In one study, participants were exposed to 18 true headlines and 18 false headlines with true and false tags before (prebunking), during (labeling), and after (debunking) reading the headlines. The participants rated the accuracy of each headline. A week later, the participants were asked again to rate the accuracy of each headline. In comparison to prebunking and labeling, debunking had the greatest impact on their ability to discern the truthfulness of the headlines.

More research needs to be conducted into the efficacy of one method versus another, particularly on a longer time scale. However, having accurate information does not necessarily lead to a change in belief.²⁷ Some researchers maintain that the effect is

²⁶ Nadia M. Brashier et al., "Timing matters when correcting fake news", *PNAS* 118, no 5 (2021): e2020043118. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2020043118> (accessed August 24, 2021).

²⁷ Oscar Barrera et al., "Facts, alternative facts, and fact checking in times of post-truth politics", *Journal of Public Economics* 182, (2020). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpubeco.2019.104123> (accessed August 24, 2021).

weak.²⁸ Overall, the impact of fact-checking alone is limited.²⁹ The ability to spread disinformation far outpaces the ability to fact-check. Therefore, fact checkers need to prioritize where they can best employ their resources. We conclude that challenging misinformation and disinformation online is preferable to allowing both to flow unchecked.

❖ Recommendation 4: Increase Fact-Checking Efforts

3. The Demand for Disinformation



Disinformation campaigns wreak havoc because information consumers consume the disinformation, share it with others, and act upon it. For a variety of psychological and social reasons, information consumers are tempted to believe disinformation without weighing whether the disinformation is supported by evidence or sound reasoning.

A cognitive bias is a systemic error in thinking that occurs when people are processing and interpreting information in the world around them and affects the decisions and judgments that they make.

Kendra Cherry

Understanding the influence of cognitive biases and why information consumers make different choices about what to believe and share

²⁸ Nathan Walter, et. al., “Fact-checking: A Meta-Analysis of What Works and for Whom”, *Political Communication* 37, no 3 (2020): 350-375, DOI: 10.1080/10584609.2019.1668894 (accessed August 24, 2021).

²⁹ Andrew Tompkins, “Is fact-checking effective? A critical review of what works – and what doesn’t”, *DW AKADEMIE*, last modified December 10, 2020, <https://www.dw.com/en/is-fact-checking-effective-a-critical-review-of-what-works-and-what-doesnt/a-55248257> (accessed August 2, 2021).

with others can help make them more resilient to threat actors who exploit the way information consumers think and interact with one another.

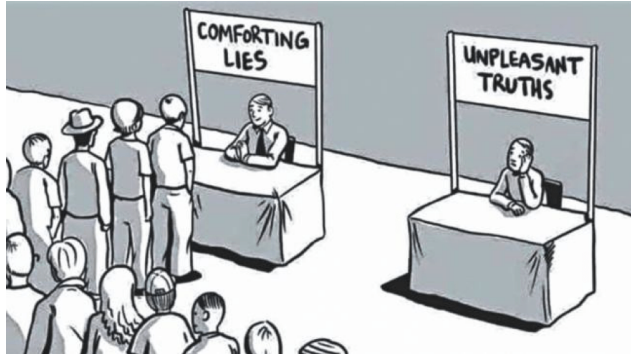


Figure 15 *Comforting Lies vs. Unpleasant Truths* (obtained from [News Literacy Matters](#)).

Threat actors are not alone in attempting to use the lessons of cognitive science and group psychology to their advantage. Governments, religious authorities, and retail advertisers have long taken advantage of psychological and social characteristics of information consumers

to induce conformity, sell products, discourage harmful health habits, and otherwise steer thinking and behavior in a desired direction. Information consumers use reverse psychology or play on known weaknesses of others to achieve certain aims. Information consumers are not always aware of these efforts to manipulate them.

The information ecosystem has a profound impact on how we view the world. An information ecosystem contaminated by disinformation can influence people to think, feel, and behave in ways not informed by evidence, but by the duplicity of determined threat actors.

An environment is, after all, a complex message system which imposes on human beings certain ways of thinking, feeling, and behaving. It structures what we can see and say and, therefore, do. It assigns roles to us and insists on our playing them. It specifies what we are permitted to do and what we are not.

Neil Postman

In this section, we conclude that information consumers can become more resilient to disinformation online by understanding how their brains process information, improving

their ability to think critically, and becoming aware of how their online activity can facilitate the spread of disinformation.

3.1. Cognitive Bias



The mechanisms by which human brains process information make information consumers vulnerable to disinformation. For the human brain to process the enormous amounts of sensory input it receives; the brain has evolved mental shortcuts or “cognitive biases”. However, these cognitive biases can undermine the ability to identify relevant facts, weigh the relevance of these facts, and form coherent courses of action based on these facts. Confirmation bias, belief bias, and the bandwagon effect are cognitive biases that are particularly relevant to understanding disinformation campaigns.

Confirmation bias

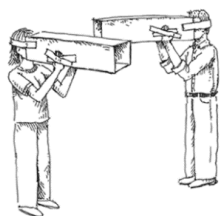


Figure 16 Tunnel Vision
(obtained from [Aftercare.com](https://www.aftercare.com)).

Information consumers who rely primarily on sources of information that conform to their ideological preferences are particularly vulnerable to disinformation. The design of online search engines, social media platforms, and smartphone applications, plus the availability of cable news programming catering to specific audiences, make it easy to screen information consumers from viewpoints that conflict with their ideological preferences.³⁰

³⁰ Silvia Knobloch-Westwick and Steven B. Kleinman, “Preelection Selection Exposure: Confirmation Bias Versus Informational Utility”, *Communication Research* 39, no. 2 (2012): 170-193.
<https://doi.org/10.1177%2F0093650211400597> (accessed August 24, 2021).

Belief bias



Figure 17 See hear speak no evil cartoon (obtained from [VectorStock](#)).

Information consumers tend to favor data and arguments which support their predetermined conclusions and view more harshly data and arguments which do not. While researching the spread of disinformation prior to the 2016 presidential election, researchers determined that whether a news item was accepted as true or rejected as false by information consumers strongly depended on how much it conformed to their belief system.³¹

Bandwagon effect



Figure 18 Blind Leading the Blind (obtained from [Conversion Uplift](#)).

Information consumers tend to adopt the beliefs that other people in their political and social networks have. Research has shown that exposure to pre-election polls increases the likelihood that voters will side with majority opinions.³²

Cognitive biases facilitate analytical errors, lapses in judgment, faulty conclusions, hasty generalizations, and other defects in sound reasoning. Since cognitive biases are features of the human brain, learning how to minimize their impact by developing critical thinking skills is essential to building resilience to disinformation.³³

³¹ Giovanni Luca Ciampaglia and Filippo Menczer, "Misinformation and bias infect social media, both intentionally and accidentally", *The Conversation*, last modified June 20, 2018, <https://theconversation.com/misinformation-and-biases-infect-social-media-both-intentionally-and-accidentally-97148> (accessed August 24, 2021).

³² Mike Farjam, "The Bandwagon Effect in an Online Voting Experiment With Real World Political Organizations", PDF file, *International Journal of Public Opinion Research* vol 33 (2) (Summer 2021): 412-421. <https://doi.org/10.1093/ijpor/edaa008> (accessed August 24, 2021).

³³ Paul Machete and Marita Turpin, "The Use of Critical Thinking to Identify Fake News: A Systematic Literature Review", PDF file, *IFIP International Federation for Information Processing*, (2020): 235-246. https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1007%2F978-3-030-45002-1_20.pdf (accessed August 24, 2021).

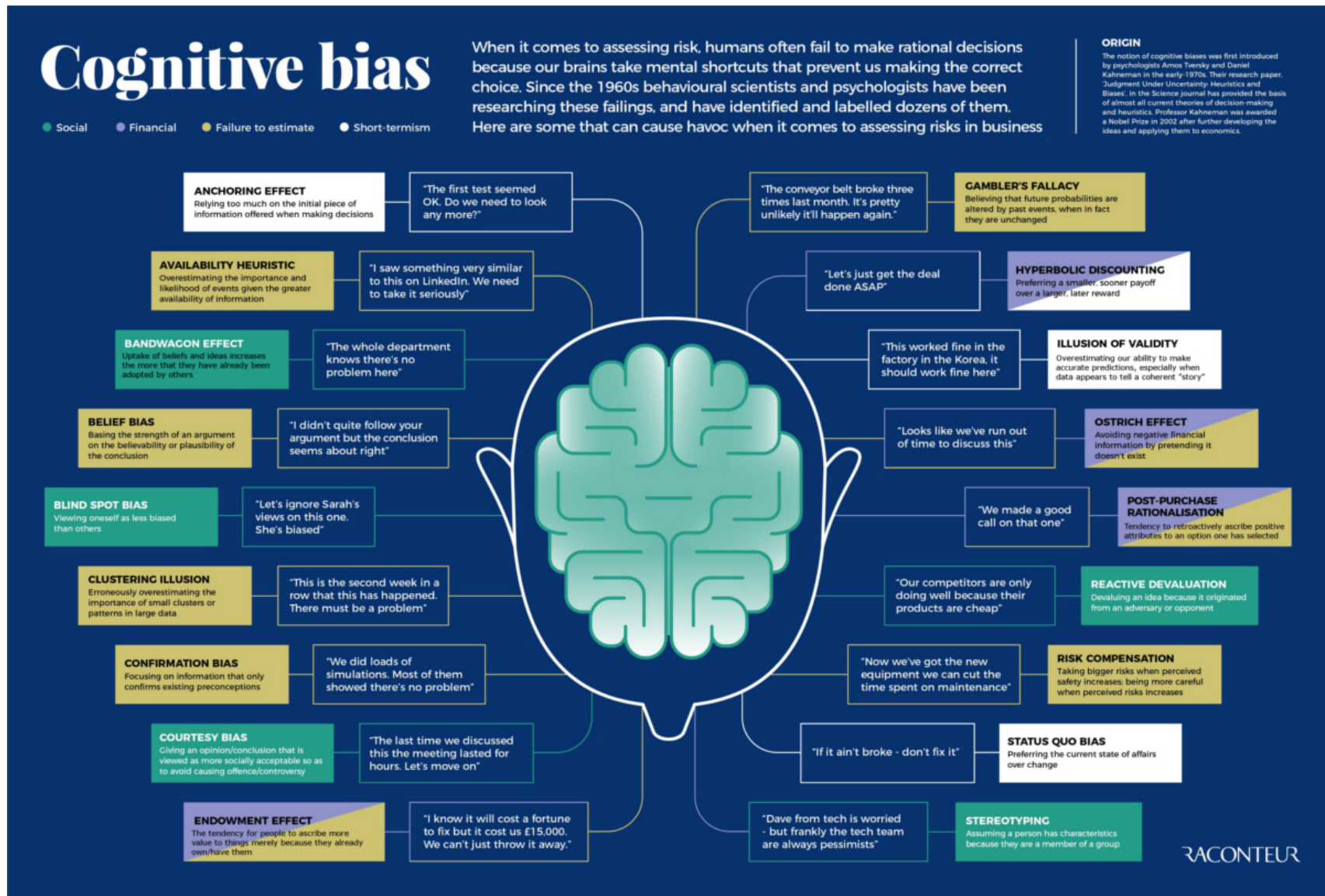


Figure 19 Cognitive Bias, [Raconteur](#).

3.2. Emotional reactions to disinformation



Strong emotions influence the ability of information consumers to process information. Information that elicits strong emotions can overwhelm an individual's ability to think rationally and make prudent decisions. Strong emotions fuel “outrage culture” and lend their force to the incessant volleys of mutual recriminations which are commonplace on social media platforms. Threat actors start disinformation campaigns not to inform, but to agitate, provoke, incite, and inflame. By doing so, they render their audiences more receptive to the disinformation they wish to promote.

The belief in the truthfulness of fake news is largely dependent on whether the information consumer relies primarily on reason or emotion to assess the information.³⁴

The more the information consumer relies on emotion, the more likely the information consumer is to believe in the fake



Figure 20 Angry Comments on Social Media (obtained from [ISM Works](#)).

news. Additionally, information consumers are more likely to share information if that information provokes emotional reactions.³⁵ Researchers determined that the ability to attract an information consumer's attention is key to whether the information consumer will later share this information. Information that does not elicit strong emotions is less

³⁴ Cameron Martel, Gordon Pennycook, and David G. Rand, “Reliance on emotion promotes belief in fake news”, *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*. 5:47 (2020). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41235-020-00252-3> (accessed August 24, 2021).

³⁵ William J. Brady et al., “Emotion shapes the diffusion of moralized content in social networks”, *PNAS* 114, no. 28 (2017): 7313-7318. Doi: 10.1073/pnas.1618923114 (accessed August 24, 2021).

likely to attract the attention of information consumers and therefore less likely to be shared.

The circumvention of thoughtful deliberation before acting, rather than the presence of strong emotions, is the key issue. Information consumers often make poor decisions in the heat of the moment, and when blinded by outrage or the desire for revenge. When information consumers encounter information online which elicits such reactions, these feelings should give the individual pause.

3.3. The Psychology Behind Sharing Information Online



Information consumers who share disinformation help sustain disinformation campaigns and contribute to the rapid spread of disinformation through the information ecosystem. Research suggests that relatively few people intentionally share disinformation on social media.³⁶ Three main factors that drive the decision to share disinformation are consistency, consensus, and authority.³⁷ First, the disinformation is consistent with the beliefs that the information consumers already possess. Second, the information consumer believes that most people in his or her social group believe the disinformation. Third, the information consumer believes that the disinformation derives from an authoritative source.

³⁶ Tom Buchanan, “Why Do People Share Disinformation on Social Media?”, PDF file, *Policy Brief*, September 2020, <https://crestresearch.ac.uk/download/3040/20-017-03-disinformation-on-social-media.pdf> (accessed August 24, 2021).

³⁷ Tom Buchanan, “Why Do People Spread Disinformation Online: The effects of message and viewer characteristics on self-reported likelihood of sharing social media disinformation”, *PLoS ONE* 15, no 10 (2020): e0239666. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0239666> (accessed August 24, 2021).

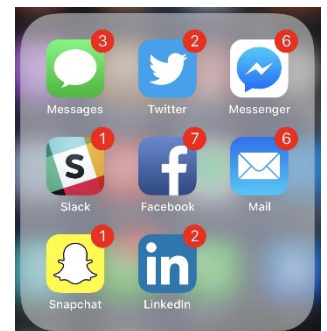


Figure 21 Eric Allie/Cagle Cartoons.

Other factors also play a role in the decision to share disinformation. Information consumers may share disinformation on social media platforms to demonstrate allegiance to a particular idea (similar to virtue signaling), to share novel information, or to draw attention to themselves to

increase 'likes', 'views', or 'followers'. Political partisanship motivates information consumers to share disinformation when this disinformation can be used to counter the arguments of political opponents.³⁸

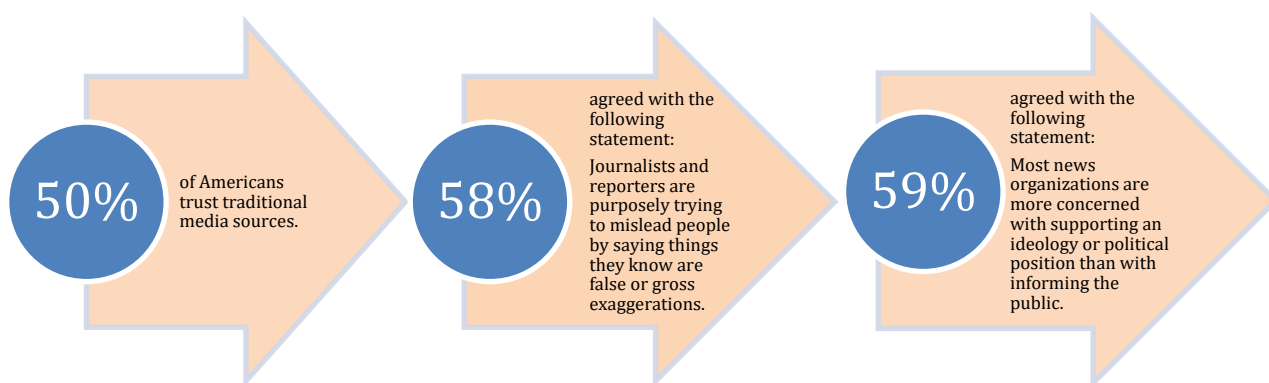
Social media platforms have features that incentivize information consumers to share information. These features often have addictive qualities that make it difficult for information consumers to resist the temptation to share information, including disinformation, or to disengage from the platform entirely. Before sharing information online, we encourage



information consumers to critically examine the information they wish to share and the motives they have for sharing it. Disinformation at rest is far less effective than disinformation in motion.

³⁸ Mathias Osmundsen et al, "Partisan Polarization is the Primary Psychological Motivation behind Political Fake News Sharing on Twitter," *American Political Science Review* 115, no 3, (2021): 1-17.

❖ Recommendation 5: Teach Information Consumers about the cognitive and emotional impact of social media and online information



[Edelman Trust Barometer 2021.](#)

4. Media Literacy and Critical Thinking Skills



Media literacy is the application of critical thinking skills to forms of information, whether print newspapers and magazines, along with their online counterparts, broadcasts on television and radio, online video or podcasts, and on social media platforms or messaging apps. Media literacy efforts typically involve training information consumers how to differentiate fact from opinion, how to assess sources of information, and how information can be manipulated to deceive the audience. Research suggests

that media literacy efforts can assist information consumers to distinguish real news from fake news.³⁹

Other approaches include helping information consumers understand the cognitive and mental health impact of using social media and other digital sources of information and helping them negotiate the many hazards found online.⁴⁰ One researcher maintains that media literacy efforts should encompass not only traditional forms of media, but also the information that passes through their networks of online connections.⁴¹ Using this approach, information consumers can more clearly appreciate their own roles in the dissemination of disinformation. An article, video, podcast, or photograph shared, a retweet, a like, a comment, a post to a listserv, all may have more impact than an individual might foresee.



It's about skill building, not prescribing a list of "good" or "bad" information sources to participants, or to criticize their choice of news outlets.

Figure 22 IREX Media Literacy Training Manual.

³⁹ Andrew Guess et al., “A digital media intervention increases discernment between mainstream and false news in the United States and India”, PDF file, PNAS Vol. 117, no.27 (2020): 15536-15545.
<https://www.pnas.org/content/pnas/117/27/15536.full.pdf> (accessed August 24, 2021).

⁴⁰ Amy Callahan, “Media Literacy Isn’t Coming to Save Us (But We Can Make It Better)”, *EdW*, last modified January 23, 2019, <https://www.edweek.org/teaching-learning/opinion-media-literacy-isnt-coming-to-save-us-but-we-can-make-it-better/2019/01> (accessed August 24, 2021).

⁴¹ Dana Boyd, "You Think You Want Media Literacy...Do You?," *Points: Data & Society*, last modified March 9, 2018, <https://points.datasociety.net/you-think-you-want-media-literacy-do-you-7cad6af18ec2> (accessed August 24, 2021).

Educational institutions and non-governmental organizations provide resources on media literacy for use in formal and information educational settings, and self-paced learning. In 2019, the Digital Citizenship and Media Literacy Act was introduced in the U.S. Senate to assist with nationwide efforts, including the study of best practices in media literacy programs.⁴²

Research indicates that many information consumers are not able to articulate the criteria by which they evaluate the trustworthiness of information and therefore are unable consistently to distinguish real news from fake news.⁴³ The development of critical thinking skills can help information consumers recognize faulty reasoning, weakly-



Figure 23 Critical Thinking Diagram (obtained from [Tycoonstory](https://tycoonstory.com/critical-thinking-skills/)).

⁴² A Bill to promote digital citizenship and media literacy, S. 2240, 116th Congress, 1st Session. (2019).

⁴³ Blanca Puig, Paloma Blanco-Anaya, and Jorge J. Pérez-Maciera, "'Fake News' or Real Science? Critical Thinking to Assess Information on COVID-19", *Frontiers in Education*, last modified May 3, 2021, <https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/educ.2021.646909/full> (accessed August 24, 2021).

supported arguments, and disinformation. Teaching critical thinking skills as a separate course, as well as incorporating the application of critical thinking in all courses, leads to better outcomes than not providing a course focused exclusively on the teaching of critical thinking skills.⁴⁴ We encourage the development of critical thinking skills in both formal and informal educational settings.

❖ **Recommendation 6: Teach Media Literacy and Critical Thinking Skills**

We also suggest information consumers to utilize the SMART mnemonic and practices. Based on Aesop's The Tortoise and the Hare, the SMART graphic on the next page illustrates the need to take time to reflect on information to verify its truthfulness before dissemination to others. Proceeding slowly, but prudently, before acting on information is preferable to proceeding rapidly, but carelessly. The tortoise bypasses the hurdles that impede the search for the facts. Meanwhile, the hare falls headlong into the traps set by those who promote disinformation.

⁴⁴ Shane Horn and Koen Veermans, "Critical Thinking efficacy and transfer skills defend against 'fake news' at an international school in Finland," *Journal of Research in International Education*, 18, no. 1 (2019): 23-41. <https://doi.org/10.1177%2F1475240919830003> (accessed August 24, 2021).

Be a SMART Turtle

How to Spot Dis/Misinformation

Source: What is the assertion based on? Are the quotes taken out of context? Is there evidence to support the assertion?

Medium: Check the outlet or domain. Where is it hosted? Does the URL look strange?

Author: Is there an author? What are his/her qualifications or credentials?

Reliability: Look for biases. Does it seem to lean toward a particular point of view? Is it objective or subjective?

Time: How current is the information? Is it outdated?

Content Created by: Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns Team 2021, DHS Public-Private Analytic Exchange Program

Illustration by: Peter Thielen, Booz Allen Hamilton



Figure 24 SMART Graphic | Source: Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns Team 2021

Conclusion

It is extremely improbable that disinformation campaigns will disappear in the foreseeable future. Despite the increasing effectiveness of countermeasures, threat actors will always find avenues to spread their disinformation and will adopt new tactics as new forms of technology emerge. Compared to many legitimate forms of persuasion and influence, disinformation campaigns are inexpensive and frequently have few downsides for the threat actor. Threat actors take ready advantage of software and communication platforms that they did not develop and benefit from political and social conditions that they did not create.

In this report, we concluded that disinformation campaigns are threats to national security because they undermine the well-being of our society. Though disinformation campaigns cannot be stopped fully, we believe that measures can be taken to impede these campaigns and reduce their impact. We believe that building the resilience of information consumers to disinformation will likely bear more fruit than focusing on technological solutions. To build such resilience, we believe that giving information consumers more tools with which they can verify the information they consume online, identify the threat actors behind disinformation campaigns, verify the claims of imposters hiding behind fake persona and credentials, and control their content feeds is essential.

The factors which make information consumers vulnerable to disinformation are rooted in human psychology, the divisions within our society, and the siloed nature of today's information ecosystem. As illustrated in the Disinformation Kill Chain, one result of

disinformation campaigns is that information consumers end up believing that truth no longer exists. Such a result demonstrates that supply and demand form a positive feedback loop. When information consumers lose the ability to distinguish fact from fiction, and become uninterested in doing so, demand for disinformation grows, which drives the supply of disinformation.

The prevalence of disinformation campaigns in our society is emblematic of the polarization of our society. Such polarization hampers a united response and even the ability to come to a common understanding of what a fact is, and what disinformation or misinformation are. Individual information consumers can build up their immunity to disinformation. But our society, as a whole, will not be able to build up its resilience until the larger problems that recent events have exposed are dealt with first.

Exhibits

Be a SMART Turtle

How to Spot Dis/Misinformation

Source: What is the assertion based on? Are the quotes taken out of context? Is there evidence to support the assertion?

Medium: Check the outlet or domain. Where is it hosted? Does the URL look strange?

Author: Is there an author? What are his/her qualifications or credentials?

Reliability: Look for biases. Does it seem to lean toward a particular point of view? Is it objective or subjective?

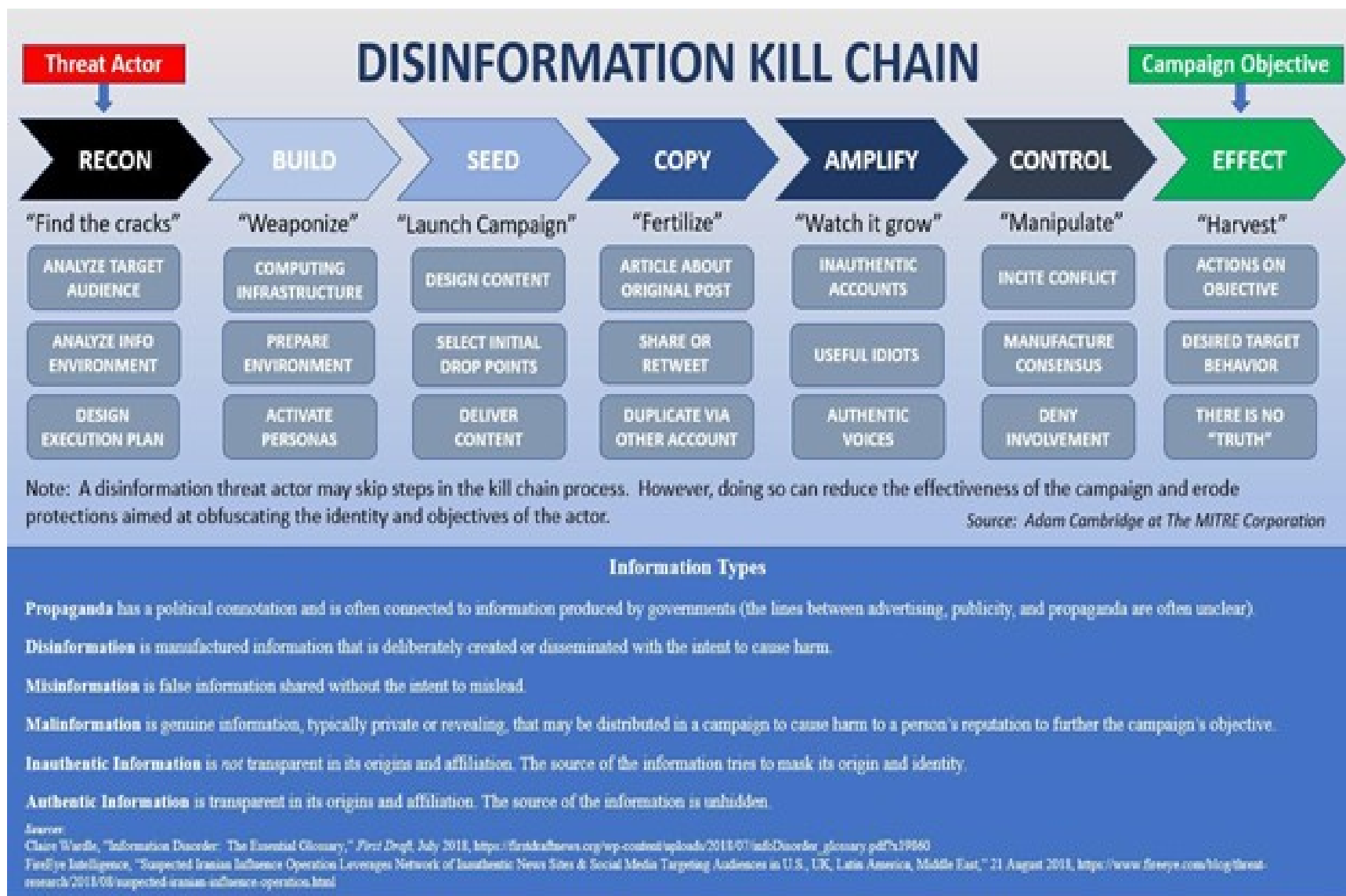
Time: How current is the information? Is it outdated?

Content Created by: Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns Team 2021, DHS Public-Private Analytic Exchange Program

Illustration by: Peter Thielen, Booz Allen Hamilton



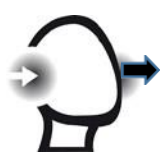
SMART Graphic | Source: Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns Team 2021.



Source: The MITRE Corporation.

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12 Cognitive Biases That Can Impact Search Committee Decisions

1. Anchoring Bias Over-relying on the first piece of information obtained and using it as the baseline for comparison.  For example, if the first applicant has an unusually high test score, it might set the bar so high that applicants with more normal scores seem less qualified than they otherwise would. PsychCentral: The Anchoring Effect and How it Impacts Your Everyday Life	2. Availability Bias Making decisions based on immediate information or examples that come to mind.  If search committee members hear about a candidate from Georgia who accepted a job and then quit because of the cold weather, they might be more likely to assume that all candidates from the southern U.S. would dislike living in Minnesota. VerywellMind: Availability Heuristic and Making Decisions	3. Bandwagon Effect A person is more likely to go along with a belief if there are many others who hold that belief. Other names for this are “herd mentality” or “group think.”  In a search, it may be difficult for minority opinions to be heard if the majority of the group holds a strong contrary view. WiseGEEK: What is a Bandwagon Effect? Psychology Today: The Bandwagon Effect
4. Choice-supportive Bias Once a decision is made, people tend to over-focus on its benefits and minimize its flaws.  Search committee members may emphasize rationale that supports decisions they have made in the past. “We hired someone from a prestigious university last time and it worked out really well.” Plexxi: On Choice-Supportive Bias and the Need for Paranoid Optimism	5. Confirmation Bias Paying more attention to information that reinforces previously held beliefs and ignoring evidence to the contrary.  A search committee member who believes that women are more intelligent might selectively focus on aspects of resumes that highlight the intelligence of female applicants. Psychology Today: What is Confirmation Bias? VerywellMind: Confirmation Bias	6. Fundamental Attribution Error Overemphasizing personal factors and under-estimating situational factors when explaining other people’s behavior.  For example, if an applicant is late to an interview the committee might conclude he is irresponsible or lazy, rather than remember that a major campus access road was closed unexpectedly. Ethics Unwrapped: Fundamental Attribution Error
7. Halo Effect Judging others similarly on all traits, assuming that because someone is good or bad at one thing they will be equally good or bad at another.  During a search, if a candidate has strong educational credentials the committee might conclude that she is also a strong leader. The Economist: The Halo Effect Robert Half: Hiring and the Halo-Effect Trap	8. Ingroup Preference Bias People tend to divide themselves into groups, and then attribute positive attributes to their own group.  Search committee members who perceive commonalities with applicants are more likely to view them favorably. Explore Psychology: What is the Ingroup Bias? Understanding Prejudice: Ingroup Favoritism	9. The “Jerk” Factor It’s not a cognitive bias, but research has shown an academic tendency to over-value individuals who display “brilliant but cruel” behavior and to attribute less intelligence to people with “nice” behavior.  Search committee members can be unduly impressed by an academic star that builds himself up at the cost of behaving disrespectfully toward others. WorkMatters: Brilliant but Cruel
10. Ostrich Effect Avoiding bad news about a decision by ignoring data that might be negative.  For example, a committee may choose not to pay attention to data about how their choice affects diversity goals or minority employment rates. 99u: The Ostrich Problem and the Danger of Not Tracking Your Progress Effectiviology: The Ostrich Effect-On the Danger of Burying Your Head in the Sand	11. Recency Effect Recent events are easier to remember, and can be weighed more heavily than past events or potential future events.  In a search, candidates that were interviewed early in the process may be evaluated less favorably. A similar bias is the proximity effect, in which candidates interviewed in person are viewed more favorably than those interviewed via distance technology. SKYbrary: Recency Bias	12. Zero-risk Bias Preferring the choice that provides certainty of a smaller benefit as opposed to an alternative with more risk and greater potential benefit.  Search committees may seek to avoid risk by hiring a “safer” candidate with a greater perceived likelihood of success rather than taking a reasonable amount of risk. Decision Lab: Zero Risk Bias

Helping Students Exercise Their Critical Thinking using the SEE-I

University of Louisville

Ideas to Action (i2a)

Dr. Patty Payette, Executive Director

Dr. Nisha Gupta, Specialist for Culminating Experiences

Dr. Cathy Bays, Specialist for Assessment

Dr. Edna Ross, Specialist for Critical Thinking

Promoting critical thinking with our students requires that we help them move beyond rote memorization and gain confidence with talking about and working with new concepts and ideas. The SEE-I is a useful process for clarifying almost anything. The letters in the SEE-I stand for steps in the process:

S: State

To state something is to say it briefly, clearly and sometimes it means offering the most basic but precise definition. Sometimes the “state it” definition is the textbook definition. Strategies to help students clearly state their idea or main point:

- Have the student complete the phrase “*I think...*” about their idea or main point.
- Ask the student to state their idea or basic point in one simple sentence.

E: Elaborate

To elaborate on the statement above is to expand it, explain it in your own words at a greater length. Strategies to help students expand on their idea or main point are:

- Have the student complete the phrase “*In other words...*” about their idea or main point.
- Ask the student to elaborate their basic point more fully.

E: Exemplify

To give a good example of a topic or concept is to clarify for yourself or your audience what you mean after “stating” and “elaborating.” It is best to have an original example that you pull from your own life or the world around you. Strategies to help students exemplify their idea or main point are:

- Have the student complete the phrase “*For example...*” about their idea or main point.
- Ask the student to give you an example of their point for their experience.

I: Illustrate

An illustration of a concept or topic provides a picture to clarify one’s thinking. It might be a graph, diagram or concept map. Typically, it can be a metaphor, simile or analogy that captures the meaning. Strategies to help students illustrate their idea or main point are:

- Have the student complete the phrase “*It is like...*” about their idea or main point.
- Ask the student to give you an analogy or metaphor to help you see what they mean.

Examples of the SEE-I Tool

SEE-I for “civil disobedience” (G. Nosich, p. 35)

State – A definition is the “active refusal to obey certain laws & a primary method of nonviolent resistance.”

Elaborate – In other words, a means by which citizens can actively rebel against unfair laws and the demands of the state

Example –An example would be like Rosa Parks refused to give up her seat on the bus

Illustrate – It’s like being a cliff at the edge of the ocean, waves crash against it, but the cliff remains there.

SEE – I for “Legal System”

State: The legal system of the U.S. is rigid, but nimble. It adapts to societal change.

Elaboration: Societal positions influence the law through the people it serves.

Exemplification: Sociological change brought about a major shift in the law as it relates to education, moving from segregated schools to integrated ones.

Illustration: It’s like how words enter the dictionary. We like to think the dictionary as fixed and set, and therefore permanent. Yet, it changes with society in a real way- words enter the dictionary all the time, such as “*unfriend*” or “*carbon footprint*.”

Paul, R. & Elder, L. (2008). *The miniature guide to critical thinking: Concepts and tools*. Dillon Beach, CA: Foundation for Critical Thinking.

Nosich, G.M. (2012). *Learning to think things through: A guide to critical thinking across the curriculum* (4th Edition). Upper Saddle River, NJ: Pearson Prentice Hall.

Sweet, C., Blythe, H. & Phillips, B. (2010). *Triple Play*. The National Teaching and Learning Forum.

<http://www.ntlf.com/html/ti/v19n2comp.pdf>

University of Louisville
Ideas to Action
SEEI Worksheet

I. What are some significant or central concepts that you teach in your AP course? (brainstorm two or three concepts with the person next to you)

II. Select one concept _____ with which to practice

State it as briefly, clearly and precisely as possible by constructing a good definition or a single, clear, well-formulated sentence

Elaborate on something to expand or explain it in your own words by starting with the phrase “In other words...”

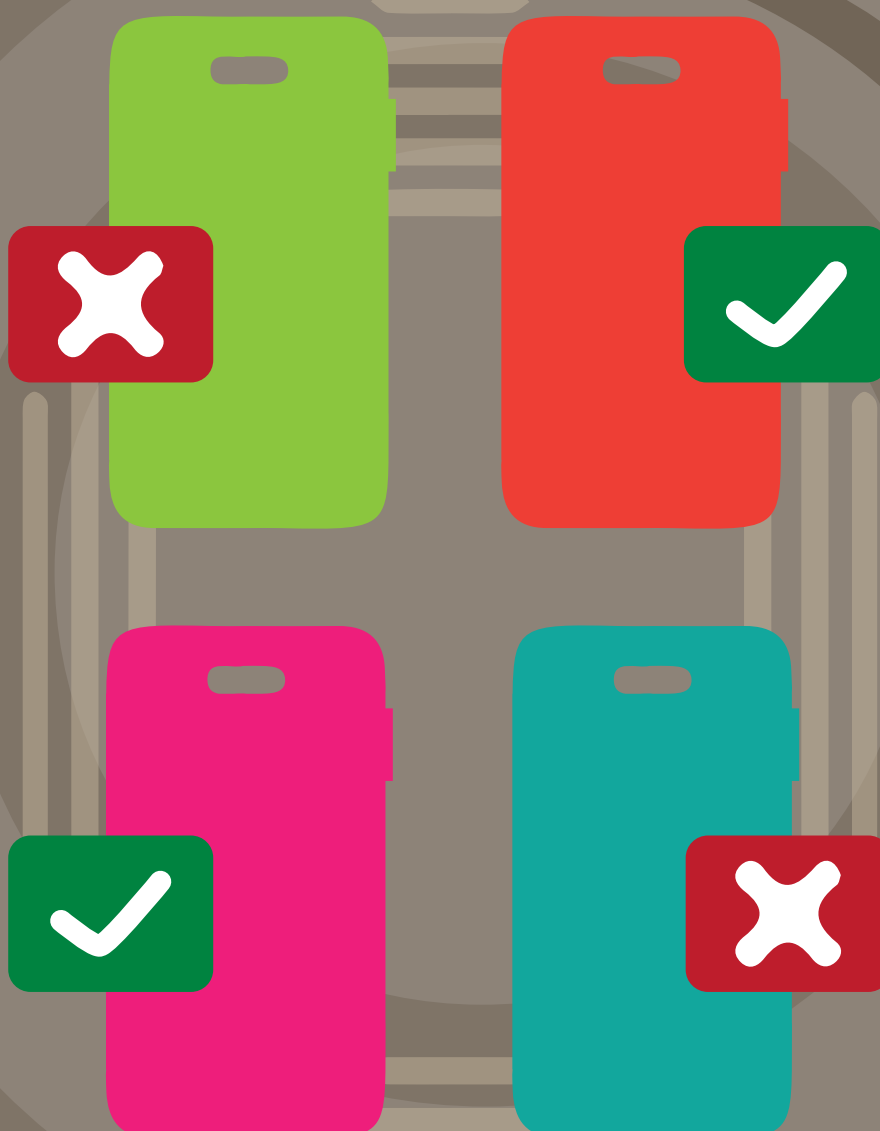
Exemplify clarifies what you mean by using a good, well-chosen, original example.
“For example...” or “By contrast...”

Illustrate to provide further clarity by giving a literal or an actual picture, metaphor, illustration, or diagram.
“It’s like...”

MAPPING AND ANALYSIS OF EFFORTS TO COUNTER INFORMATION POLLUTION

IN EUROPE AND CENTRAL ASIA REGION

NOVEMBER 2022





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LIST OF ACRONYMS

BIRN	Balkan Investigative Reporting Network	NATO	North Atlantic Treaty Organization
BTD	Balkan Trust for Democracy	NDI	National Democratic Institute
COE	Council of Europe	NED	National Endowment for Democracy
CPJ	Committee to Protect Journalists	OCCRP	Organized Crime and Corruption Reporting Network
CRD	Civil Rights Defenders	OSCE	Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe
EC	European Commission	OSI	Open Society Institute
ECA	Europe and Central Asia	RSF	Reporters Without Borders
EED	European Endowment for Democracy	SIDA	Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency
ENEMO	European Network of Elections Monitoring Organizations	TRF	Thomson Reuters Foundation
EU	European Union	UNDEF	United Nations Democracy Fund
EWMI	East-West Management Institute	UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
FES	Friedrich Ebert Stiftung	UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
FNF	Friedrich Naumann Foundation	UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
GIZ	German Corporation for International Cooperation	UNMIK	United Nations Mission in Kosovo ¹
GMF	German Marshall Fund	USAID	United States Agency for International Development
HBS	Heinrich Boll Stiftung	VIKES	Finnish Foundation for Media and Development
IFCN	International Fact-Checking Network	WFD	World Forum for Democracy
IREX	International Research and Exchanges Board		
IRI	International Republican Institute		
IWPR	Institute for War and Peace Reporting		
KAS	Konrad Adenauer Stiftung		
LGBT	Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender		
MIL	Media and Information Literacy		

¹ References to Kosovo shall be understood to be in the context of the UN Security Council Resolution 1244 (1999).

LIST OF DEFINITIONS



Information integrity²

Information integrity is determined by “the accuracy, consistency and reliability of the information content, processes and systems to maintain a healthy information ecosystem.”³ It requires public access to trustworthy, balanced and complete information “on current affairs, government actions, political actors and other elements relevant to their political perceptions and decision-making.”

Information pollution⁴

Information pollution refers to false, misleading and manipulated online and offline content, which is created, produced and disseminated intentionally or unintentionally, and which has the potential to cause societal or physical harm. An overabundance of information and a high incidence of low-quality information within an ecosystem reduce our ability to find and trust information. Information pollution can be categorized as disinformation, misinformation or malinformation.

Disinformation⁵

Information that is false and deliberately created to harm a person, social group, organization or country.

Misinformation⁶

Information that is false, but not created with the intention of causing harm.

Malinformation⁷

Information that is based on real facts, but manipulated to inflict harm on a person, organization or country.

Social cohesion

According to the United Nations Development Programme’s (UNDP) Conceptual Framework of Social Cohesion, social cohesion is “the extent of trust in

2 UNDP Strategic Guidance: Information Integrity: Forging a pathway to Truth, Resilience and Trust, 2 February 2022.

3 “What is Information Integrity?”, Yonder, 28 January 2019. <https://www.yonder-ai.com/resources/what-is-information-integrity/>

4 UNDP Strategic Guidance: Information Integrity: Forging a pathway to Truth, Resilience and Trust, 2 February 2022, p 4.

5 Ibid.

6 Ibid.

7 Ibid.

government and within society and the willingness to participate collectively toward a shared vision of sustainable peace and common development goals”⁸. It is a collective bond, or a common identity, members of a certain society share. It is not an ethnic, or a state identity, but more a shared common sense of mutual interests and common goals.

Hate speech

Hate speech is “any kind of communication in speech, writing or behaviour, that attacks or uses pejorative or discriminatory language about a person or a group based on who they are, in other words, based on their religion, ethnicity, nationality, race, colour, descent, gender or other identity factors. This is often rooted in prejudice, and generates intolerance and hatred and, in certain contexts, can be demeaning and divisive”⁹ and even lead to offline harm or violence.¹⁰

Propaganda

Propaganda is the more or less systematic effort to manipulate other people’s beliefs, attitudes, or actions by means of symbols (words, gestures, banners, monuments, music, clothing, insignia, hairstyles, designs on coins and postage stamps, and so forth). Deliberateness and a relatively heavy emphasis on manipulation distinguish propaganda from casual conversation or the free and easy exchange of ideas.¹¹

Influence campaigns

Influence campaigns are both coordinated and direct or indirect applications of activities that aim to affect the attitudes, behaviours and decisions of people within a country or a region in a way that can benefit the interests of the actors conducting the campaign.¹²

8 Theme: Social Cohesion, UNDP website <https://data.undp.org/covid-19/social-cohesion/#:~:text=Social%20cohesion%20is%20the%20extent,glue%20that%20holds%20societies%20together>.

9 United Nations Strategy and Plan of Action on Hate Speech, UN Secretary-General, May 2019. <https://www.un.org/en/genocideprevention/hate-speech-strategy.shtml>

10 United Nations Development Programme, Guidance Note: From Pilots towards Policies: Utilizing online data for preventing violent extremism and addressing hate speech, May 2022. <https://pveportal.org/research/from-pilots-towards-policies-utilizing-online-data-for-preventing-violent-extremism-and-addressing-hate-speech/>

11 Bruce L. Smith, “Propaganda”, Encyclopædia Britannica, Inc., 17 February 2016.

12 50 U.S. Code § 3021 - National Security Council., <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/50/3021>

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Information pollution is a key dilemma for societies on several levels. It is an important contributory factor to the growing security threats and development challenges in the Europe and Central Asia region.¹³ In the past decade, significant resources by international development partners have been invested in tackling this growing global phenomenon that is also negatively affecting social cohesion in the region. Through different and numerous examples of government-led and independent responses to information pollution, societies in the region are showing that they have recognized disinformation to be a serious threat to their countries' social, political and economic stability.

The COVID-19 pandemic has been an important driver that has allowed disinformation and conspiracy theories to thrive throughout the region. Coupled with growing trends of populist, xenophobic, and anti-migration narratives in politics, the pandemic contributed to the spread of false content and anti-establishment conspiracy theories that have significantly hampered public trust in institutions, which had detrimental impacts on public health. For example, in some countries, including Kazakhstan and Moldova, such trends contributed towards lower vaccination rates.

Moreover, election campaigns were recognized as one of the main flashpoints of disinformation. These campaigns targeted not just political opponents, but also journalists and civil society leaders.

This Mapping and Analysis has found that internet and social media usage correspond with the rise of access to alternative news sources in some ECA countries and territories. Accordingly, the manipulation of public opinion through social media has also been identified as an upward trend.

Governments, civil society organizations and the media are all taking measures to battle disinformation in the region. Many governments in the region have taken unique approaches to disinformation, often impacting the freedom of

¹³ The Mapping and Analysis Report consists of desk research, interviewing and consulting 40 organizations, experts, practitioners and international partners in the region between August 2020 and January 2021, covering interviewees from Albania, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Georgia, Kosovo, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic, Moldova, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Serbia, Türkiye, Tajikistan, Ukraine and Uzbekistan.

speech and the right to information. While some governments' actions in the region are being criticized for often using an anti-disinformation narrative to battle not false but unwanted information and for their repressive legislative measures, many independent organizations and civil society activists and journalists are creating local, national and international independent initiatives to battle disinformation through policy proposals and by conducting research and polling in attempts to better understand the roots of the problem. They are also organizing media and information literacy educational platforms and awareness campaigns, arranging capacity-building training for media and journalists, and creating fact checking and debunking platforms that disseminate disinformation.

This study also found that some initiatives focus on specific types of disinformation, such as gender-based disinformation, or political and electoral disinformation, or foreign influence operations, for example. Others are using a more holistic approach to the problem, focused on the causes, enablers and drivers of disinformation rather than countering specific examples of disinformation.

Development partners in the region are active and supportive of counter-disinformation initiatives. Among the most active are USAID, the EU, the Open Society Foundation and the UNDP. Among social media companies, META/Facebook are engaged in the region through their third-party fact checking initiative.

This study proposes a set of actions and approaches for building social resilience through the development and support for innovative media and information literacy initiatives and scientific research of the disinformation phenomenon in the region.

The analysis found that investing in networking and exchange of knowledge and experiences should be prioritized. The same applies to the improvement of government responses, with the emphasis on a human-rights sensitive approach in their design.

The set of proposed measures presented in this Mapping and Analysis is directed at improving the infosphere by investing in media development, improving programming development partners' programming and on urging social media companies to incorporate principles of social responsibility to help counter information pollution.

INTRODUCTION

Access to quality information plays a critical role in public trust, democracy, peace and social cohesion. Technological advances have democratized the infosphere by multiplying the actors and channels through which information is produced and disseminated. As information becomes more accessible, it also becomes more open to influences from non-traditional actors in the infosphere – in most contexts anyone can create and disseminate information. As a consequence, the traditional actors and gatekeepers of information and news – established media and government institutions – are struggling to compete with this new reality. The information ecosystem acts in a manner akin to natural ecosystems, and, as with natural resources, more users are creating more pollution.

However, the increase in users is not the key driver of information pollution – it has become a problem in the present environment because online business models and social media algorithms prioritize content based on its engagement value rather than being premised on its accuracy or truth. False – as well as exaggerated and provocative – information generates more attention than accurate and neutral content, and therefore travels faster. In the research report *The spread of true and false news online*, a group of authors have analysed verified true and false news content that has been shared on Twitter from 2006-2017 and concluded that:

“Falsehood diffused significantly farther, faster, deeper, and more broadly than the truth in all categories of information, and the effects were more pronounced for false political news than for false news about terrorism, natural disasters, science, urban legends, or financial information”¹⁴.

This has important ramifications for the democratic process as information pollution is affecting the public’s ability to make informed decisions. The Report of the Special Rapporteur on the promotion and protection of the right to freedom of opinion and expression¹⁵, entitled *Disinformation and freedom of opinion and expression*, identifies the correlation between information pollution and democratic backsliding around the world. Disinformation, misinformation

14 Soroush Vosoughi, Deb Roy, Sinan Aral, Research, “The spread of true and false news online”, *Science*, 359 p. 1146–1151, March 2018, p. 1 of 6.

15 United Nations Human Rights Council, Disinformation and freedom of opinion and expression. Report of the Special Rapporteur on the promotion and protection of the right to freedom of opinion and expression, Irene Khan, Forty-seventh session, 21 June-9 July 2021. <https://undocs.org/A/HRC/47/25>

and malinformation, together with the growth of hate speech and propaganda, especially online, are fomenting social divisions and creating mistrust towards public institutions and society. The COVID-19 pandemic proved that public health and public well-being are directly affected by this phenomenon.

The report also states, rather ominously, that information pollution, or disinformation, “is not the cause but the consequence of societal crises and the breakdown of public trust in institutions”.

This regional Mapping and Analysis report is part of UNDP’s efforts to understand information pollution as a global phenomenon, and to create coherent and effective responses by learning from the best practices applied by various actors.

Methodology

The analysis specifically focuses on information pollution in the ECA region, its many sources and platforms for dissemination. It examines disinformation trends and how different actors in the region respond to them. Further, the report looks at the gaps in the responses and the possibilities of action and overcoming these gaps. It also suggests areas of strategic action and possible engagement by UNDP and other stakeholders.

Following desk research, primary data was collected through a series of 47 interviews with recognized civil society leaders, journalists, diplomats, and some of the key personnel working for international organizations in the region. Most of the interviewees are directly involved in counter-disinformation initiatives, both regionally and within their respective countries and territories.

The report incorporates an analysis of the relevant literature, similar mappings, legal documents, relevant legislation and reports, as well as interviews. The report also closely examines media reports on current events in the countries of the region. However, the Mapping and Analysis on Belarus and Türkiye are limited to desk research.

The research was conducted from December 2021 – March 2022, hence, regarding the recent crises in the region, the events in Kazakhstan from 2-11 January 2022 and the Russia’s 24th of February invasion of Ukraine, it is still early to analyse the role and effects of disinformation during the protests and the war respectively. This in itself limits the impact of this report, without taking away from the value of this Mapping’s content.

CHAPTER 1.

BACKGROUND: THE LANDSCAPE

THE POLITICAL AND SOCIAL LANDSCAPE

When it comes to the main enablers and drivers of information pollution from the political, media, social and legislative environments of the region, the findings in the *Freedom House Nations in Transit* country reports state that governments of the countries in the region have played a predominant role in creating the conditions for information pollution to thrive in the region.

Unstable democracies, authoritarian and corrupted regimes, weak institutions and undeveloped economies in the region are generally seen as preconditions for the rise of populism, nationalism and violent extremism – trends also reflected in the digital space. Such an environment, negatively affects the general level of trust in institutions, hampers public participation in democratic processes and estranges vulnerable groups.

The widespread presence of disinformation negatively affects social cohesion and further amplifies social divisions thereby creating the potential for conflicts among countries and within societies.¹⁶ In addition, the region is home to many frozen unresolved and active ongoing conflicts and the weaknesses and underdevelopment of its transitional democracies make it a fertile ground for the spread of disinformation.

Distrust in institutions proved particularly crucial during the COVID-19 pandemic. As an example, exposure to disinformation and conspiracy theories caused a very low level of vaccine take-up in some countries in the region.¹⁷

A discriminatory discourse against migrants, ethnic and religious minorities and gender-based disinformation are omnipresent, especially during election campaigns. A factor that exacerbates the situation is the poor flow of information among different ethnic and linguistic communities. The language barrier is most visible between speakers of Slavic languages and of Albanian in different

16 UNHRC, Disinformation and freedom of opinion and expression. <https://undocs.org/A/HRC/47/25>

17 The Critical Mass, Contaminated Trust, Public Health Disinformation and its Societal Impacts in Georgia, Kazakhstan and Ukraine, 2021. https://issuu.com/thecriticalmass/docs/contaminated_trust

contexts in the Western Balkans, and among different ethnic groups in Georgia and Kyrgyzstan for example.

Gender-based disinformation and disinformation against the LGBTI community in the countries of the region usually accuse Western countries of “creating campaigns against traditional values”^{18 19}. Religious organizations and populist right-wing movements are common aggregators of these narratives, which sometimes results in violence against different groups, as in Georgia during the Gay Pride Parade in Tbilisi in 2021²⁰.

The sources of information pollution vary from country to country, as do the responses. To cite a case in point, in some countries, governments are seen as the main purveyors of disinformation, a fact we learned from our interviewees from experts in the region, for example:

“Government is controlling the infosphere through the complete control of the media in the country, and through internet censorship. During the initial stages COVID-19 pandemic, they were saying there aren’t any cases of infection in the country, and fining citizens for wearing masks in public. Later, they were imposing mask mandate, but for reasons unrelated to the pandemic, such as the desert dust.”²¹

In other countries, foreign malign influence is perceived as the main threat, as it was mentioned in Ukraine.

THE MEDIA AND INFORMATION LANDSCAPE

The level of development and heterogeneity of the media varies from subregion to subregion, and from country to country. However, according to relevant reports by Freedom House, the Committee to Protect Journalists, Reporters Without Borders and others, in most countries the traditional media landscape is either undeveloped or heavily politicized and biased. the delineation between

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- 18 Tetiana Kozak, “A landmark court case on “traditional values” in Ukraine ends strangely - in victory for both sides”, Open Democracy, 8 September 2020. <https://www.opendemocracy.net/en/odr/a-landmark-court-case-on-traditional-values-in-ukraine-ends-strangely-in-victory-for-both-sides/>
 - 19 Joanna Hoare and Maisy Weicherding, “Russia’s influence in shrinking civic space in Central Asia”, Foreign Policy Centre, 24 May 2016. <https://fpc.org.uk/russias-influence-shrinking-civic-space-central-asia/>
 - 20 Liselotte Mas, “Georgia: Right-wing extremists and Orthodox Church attack activists and ransack LGBT associations”, The Observers, France24, 6 July 2021. <https://observers.france24.com/en/europe/20210707-georgia-lgbt-pride-march-right-wing-orthodox-attacks>
 - 21 Interview, Ruslan Tukhbatulin, Chronicles of Turkmenistan, Budva/Vienna, 13 December 2021.

politics and the press is unclear even in well-established democratic states, and even more difficult in the countries covered by Nations in Transit, which are often classified as Hybrid/Transitional or Consolidated Authoritarian Regimes.²²

The reports show that public broadcasters are often controlled by ruling political parties, while the ownership of the privately-owned media is often non-transparent. Local and community media are usually invisible to the advertising market, to international donors and to capacity-building projects which leads to a situation where they are underserved and lacking in capacities to provide accurate and timely reporting.

Where there is a well-developed internet infrastructure, a growing trend of social media penetration has occurred. According to the Hootsuite's Digital 2021²³ survey, social media penetration varies in the region (e.g. Kazakhstan – 63.5 per cent, Serbia – 52.8 per cent, Ukraine – 58.9 per cent, Georgia – 84.3 per cent at the outset of 2022), but it mainly follows the same ratio to internet penetration in all the countries. The global trend in the increasing usage of social media as the main news source among youth is reflected in the region, according to the interviewees and relevant reports.^{24 25 26}

While the internet infrastructure in the Western Balkans and Western CIS subregions is well developed, and internet penetration and social media usage are high, in some countries in the Central Asia and South Caucasus regions, governments have not invested enough in providing a digital infrastructure in remote areas in the country which means vulnerable groups have restricted access to information.²⁷

Social media accounts, being the mass communication platforms and considering the high number of users, are super-spreaders of disinformation in the ECA region. While social media penetration in Georgia reaches as high as 84.3%, according to Information Ecosystem Assessment done by Internews, over two thirds of Georgians access information on public affairs using social

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- 22 Csaky Zselyke, "Media Matters", Freedom House Nations in Transit Report 2021, p. 14. https://freedomhouse.org/sites/default/files/2021-04/NIT_2021_final_042321.pdf
 - 23 2021 Digital Report – Digital Trends Q4 Update, Hootsuite. <https://www.hootsuite.com/resources/digital-trends-q4-update>
 - 24 Elira Turdubaeva, Report, The status of media and the role of social media in Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan, IWPR/CABAR 2018. https://cabar.asia/wp-content/uploads/2018/10/Status_of_media.pdf
 - 25 Western Balkans Regional Poll, International Republican Institute's Center for Insights in Survey. Research by Ipsos Bosnia and Herzegovina, 2 February 2020 - 06 March 2020, p. 82. https://www.iri.org/wp-content/uploads/legacy/iri.org/final_wb_poll_for_publishing_6.9.2020.pdf
 - 26 Between East and West Democracy, Disinformation and Geopolitics in Central and Southeastern Europe, Public Opinion Research. NDI, July 2021. <https://www.ndi.org/sites/default/files/REAPS2021researchpublicversion.pdf>
 - 27 Lilia Burunciuc, "How Central Asia can ensure it doesn't miss out on a digital future", World Bank Blogs, 21 June 2021. <https://blogs.worldbank.org/europeandcentralasia/how-central-asia-can-ensure-it-doesnt-miss-out-digital-future>

media platforms.²⁸ Throughout the region, various surveys and studies show a growing trend of people using platforms like Facebook and Telegram as their main news sources.

IWPR's "Development of New Media and Digital Journalism in Central Asia" project notes:

"The main news-sharing networks remain Facebook in Tajikistan and Uzbekistan, and Instagram in Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan. Among the messengers in Central Asia, the most popular news sources are WhatsApp, Telegram and Viber."²⁹

Considering their role of spreading disinformation, unfortunately, the largest social media corporations are not doing enough to contribute to the fight against disinformation and have been accused of choosing profit over society and integrity of democratic processes.³⁰ Often without giving a reasonable explanation, they continue with the practice of non-transparency in their policies and enforcement of their rules. Moreover, according to the findings of NED's 2021 report on the civil society responses to disinformation, they only selectively allow access to their databases that are in the public domain on their platforms.³¹ Additionally, previous research on the topic shows that they prioritize algorithms that feed sensationalism and the promotion of divisive and inflammatory ideas on their networks.³²

DISINFORMATION TRENDS

Political Disinformation

Political disinformation is an increasing concern in the region as governments, politicians and political parties, various far-right groups, and foreign powers

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- 28 "Georgia: An Information Ecosystem Assessment", Internews. February, 2021. https://internews.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/Georgia-Information_Ecosystem-Part_1.pdf
 - 29 Central Asian Audience Receives News from Social Media and Messengers, Editorial – IWPR Research, CABAR 30 September 2019. <https://cabar.asia/en/central-asian-audience-receives-news-from-social-media-and-messengers-iwpr-research>
 - 30 Jake Third, [How Social Media Should Respond to Misinformation?](#), March 2022
 - 31 Samantha Bradshaw and Lisa-Maria Neudert, "The Road Ahead: Mapping Civil Society Responses to Disinformation", National Endowment for Democracy, January 2021. <https://www.ned.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/01/The-Road-Ahead-Mapping-Civil-Society-Responses-to-Disinformation-Bradshaw-Neudert-Jan-2021-2.pdf>
 - 32 Chengcheng Shao & Pik-mai Hu, "Anatomy of an online misinformation network" <https://journals.plos.org/plosone/article?id=10.1371/journal.pone.0196087#sec012>, April 2018

weaponize narratives and technology to influence politics.

Some of the major political actors in the countries of the region are using social media to manipulate public opinion in a coordinated and inauthentic manner. Some of the activities, presented in the analysis chapter, include using government resources for the creation of so-called troll factories. Through the hiring of foreign PR companies, key political protagonists are also organizing the removal of unwanted content from the internet.

Reports of international organizations and of local civil society activists and journalists interviewed for this report, almost without exception, suggest that political actors are seeking to mobilize their support based on identity politics. A civil society leader from Montenegro noted that political leaders are more comfortable with focusing on identity issues than addressing important topics:

“Topics of ethnic and national identity completely overshadowed the public and political debate on other important topics in Montenegro - such as the battle against corruption, electoral reform, and other important issues critical for the country’s accession into the European Union.”³³

Politicians frequently use a divisive rhetoric such as “us against them” in their political discourse to silence and discredit critics and criticism. They also use different methods to enhance divisions by misusing both the media and social media to manipulate public opinion and stir up tensions. For example, populist narratives to galvanize support, or attack on the media or frequent attacks on LGBTI and gender-based hate speech.³⁴ Discriminatory discourse and hate speech against vulnerable groups and civil society and gender-based hate speech and disinformation are especially widespread during election campaigns.

Foreign Influence

Influence operations have become faster and cheaper in the digital environment, resulting in heightened activity in the information ecosystem and greatly impacting elections, social cohesion and democracy. ECA is a vast region with many sub-regions located in a tense geographical zone of influence between global powers and political interests.

Various campaigns from abroad often target one or more political actors in a competition over influence in the countries. Further, some authoritarian governments are using anti-western narratives to counter criticism of the corruption and lack of reform in their own countries, and activists and journalists

33 Interview, Civil society leader from Budva, Montenegro, 15 December 2021.

34 Csaky, Zselyke and Smeltzer, Mike. “Hope and Pushback: How Citizens and Political Leaders Can Band Together to Counter Repression”. Freedom House Nations in Transit Report 2021. p. 15. https://freedomhouse.org/sites/default/files/2021-04/NIT_2021_final_042321.pdf

are often presented as “foreign agents and traitors”. Some countries in the Central Asian region are passing legislation that exemplify these narratives. According to *Eurasianet* on 5 January 2022: “Kazakhstan adopted strikingly similar legislation to Russia’s in 2015, which requires NGOs that receive support from abroad to register as ‘foreign agents’ though it stopped short of using the term ‘foreign agent’.”³⁵ Some of the governments have also weaponized the fight against disinformation against local and foreign independent organizations.

Some governments in the region are taking actions to counter disinformation from foreign influences. Legislative and policy actions have been taken to contain Russian influence in media, as for example Montenegro, where in April 2022 the government suspended the broadcasting of Russia Today and Sputnik, in line with European Union sanctions on Russia related to its war on Ukraine.³⁶ Or Moldova whose parliament in 2018 passed a law banning television channels from broadcasting news from Russian news stations.³⁷ And Ukraine, where, on the eve of the Russian attack, Ukrainian TV channels ZIK, NewsOne and 112 were forced off the air late on 2 February after the official channel owner and opposition MP Taras Kozak was targeted with sanctions.³⁸

Western governments and international organizations, which are relatively new foreign actors in the region, have been investing in building civil societies’ capacities and media capacities for decades. USAID is supporting most of media development projects together with its implementing partners, such as Internews and Human Rights Watch. The United Nations and its agencies, the EU, UK AID Direct and the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (SIDA) are among the most active donors in this field.³⁹

By investing in independent media development, many of those organizations are becoming a target for disinformation campaigns by various political actors and being blamed for allegedly inspiring revolution such as ‘the inspiration behind the colour revolutions’.

Crisis-driven disinformation

Disinformation online expands significantly during times of political, economic and social grievances. In that way, it contributes to further polarising the public

35 Zholdas Orisbayev, “Russia’s foreign agent law ricochets around Kazakhstan”, *Eurasianet*, 5 January 2022. <https://eurasianet.org/russias-foreign-agent-law-ricochets-around-kazakhstan>

36 Samir Kajosevic, “Montenegro’s Divided Government Finally Silences Russian Media”, *Balkan Insight*, 8 April 2022. <https://balkaninsight.com/2022/04/08/montenegros-divided-govt-finally-silences-russian-media/>

37 Megan Reiss, “Moldova Bans Russian News Broadcasts”, *Lawfare Institute Blog*, 14 February 2018. <https://www.lawfareblog.com/moldova-bans-russian-news-broadcasts>

38 Peter Dickinson, “Analysis: Ukraine bans Kremlin-linked TV channels”, *Atlantic Council*, 5 February 2021. <https://www.atlanticcouncil.org/blogs/ukrainealert/analysis-ukraine-bans-kremlin-linked-tv-channels/>

39 Complete donors table in Annex C of the Report.

debate, to eroding public trust, to inciting violence and hatred against minorities, women and vulnerable groups and to disrupting democratic and development processes.

Emergencies and natural disasters show us the weaknesses of social resilience against information pollution in the region. COVID-19 related disinformation has been and remains pervasive throughout the region. The anti-vaccination narratives that question the very existence of the virus have significantly affected vaccination rates in some of the countries in the region. For example, according to the Critical Mass study “Contaminated Trust”, interviewed experts claimed that internet trolls, originating in Russia, impacted for the “decline in vaccination coverage” in the Ukraine.⁴⁰

Civil society leaders and journalists are increasingly being threatened and subjected to disinformation campaigns because of their investigative work, opinions, and reporting. The same applies for some ethnic and religious minorities. Moreover, times of crises have served as a pretext to further restrict freedom of speech in some countries, where the governments shut down the internet or blocked internet communication platforms.⁴¹

During the early days of the Russian invasion of Ukraine in February and March, it became very difficult to navigate the media reports on the rapidly unfolding events, since social media became the fastest and most used source of information. Russia has been proactively utilizing a combination of information warfare and cyberwarfare techniques to shape the narrative and justify its invasion. Notably, Russia resorted to coordinated inauthentic behaviour and fabricated material to sow confusion and push false claims on “denazification”.

Scholars and researchers are already making observations and recommendations on how to navigate the new reality.⁴² And social media companies have taken steps to slow the mass spreading of misinformation and to halt state-owned media disinformation. However, Telegram, now a hub for the unregulated sharing of information both in Ukraine and Russia, still permits inauthentic accounts to reach a vast audience.⁴³

40 The Critical Mass, Contaminated Trust, Public Health Disinformation and its Societal Impacts in Georgia, Kazakhstan and Ukraine, 2021, p. 27. https://issuu.com/thecriticalmass/docs/contaminated_trust

41 Freedom House, Twitter post, 4 January 2022. <https://twitter.com/freedomhouse/status/1478436670848524295?s=20&t=7WpzAGRj8wPvX9F2mRU0Q>

42 Scott Simon, “How to spot disinformation and propaganda emerging from the Ukraine-Russia conflict”, National Public Radio, 5 March 2022. <https://www.npr.org/2022/03/05/1084729621/how-to-spot-disinformation-and-propaganda-coming-out-of-the-ukraine-russia-conflict>

43 How Unmoderated Platforms Became the Frontline for Russian Propaganda, August, 2022 <https://www.lawfareblog.com/how-unmoderated-platforms-became-frontline-russian-propaganda-0>

CHAPTER 2.

MAPPING AND ANALYSIS OF KEY ACTORS AND INITIATIVES

TRENDS IN RESPONSES IN THE ECA REGION

This mapping exercise shows there are a plethora of different responses to disinformation in the region. The counter-disinformation ecosystem is diverse not just regionally, but also within countries. Some of the efforts are spearheaded by civil society organizations as in Georgia, where MDI and GRASS are leading some efforts to counter disinformation coming from abroad and from governments. In other countries, such as Kyrgyzstan, the new media, such as the website Kaktus.kg or Bolot Temirov's YouTube channel, play a critical role in debunking disinformation emanating from different sources. In countries like Ukraine, where information warfare is a part of an active conflict, a number of CSOs, media and the government are mobilized in an effort to counter disinformation and misinformation.

In addition, to the diverse counter-disinformation projects, the region does not lack donors and funding programmes.⁴⁴ Development partners in the region are active and supportive of counter-disinformation initiatives. Among the active partners engaged in responding to information pollution through various programmes such as media literacy, promoting civic engagement, raising awareness are USAID, the EU, and the Open Society Foundation. Among social media companies, META/Facebook are engaged in the region through their third-party fact checking initiative.

44 A complete list of donors is provided in the Annex C of this report.

Civil Society and Media

Civil sector and independent media are the most active players in the fight against information pollution in the region. Since the beginning of the democratic transition process in post-socialist countries three decades ago, international development programmes have been present throughout the region, and independent media associations have long been working on building media capacity by training journalists, developing ethical standards in reporting and improving the legislative framework related to freedom of speech, the independence of the media and freedom of information.

The media are developing their responses, monitoring and fact-checking platforms. They are also contributing to efforts by implementing reporting ethics and creating self-regulatory policies.

Other responses to information include education of the general population, i.e. the consumers of information, through media and information literacy (MIL) educational programmes and projects.

Governments and Public Institutions

Governments and public institutions have also taken action to combat disinformation. Government-organized and supported fact-checking platforms were reported in Armenia, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Kazakhstan and Türkiye.

Most often, with few exceptions, the means and initiatives they undertake are misused by the authorities to restrict freedom of speech and criticism of government policies. Sometimes governments do so through restrictive legislation, or sometimes by creating platforms that, under the guise of fighting disinformation, serve to undermine the credibility of critical media, journalists and activists. Our interviewees in most cases were backing up the claims which were found in numerous reports:

“The government in Kazakhstan is using the Russian example and creating a legal framework to battle unwanted criticism by designating activists and journalists as foreign actors.”⁴⁵

On a positive note, some governments, for example in Ukraine and North Macedonia, are piloting inclusive initiatives, in which they are trying to include civil society actors as partners in both the planning and implementation processes. Furthermore, some of the regulatory authorities are adopting preventive rather than punitive approaches by emphasizing educational policies within policy responses contained in national strategic documents. Some are actively engaging in MIL campaigns.

45 Interview with a Kazakh civil society leader, Budva/Astana, 17 December 2021.

Advocacy and Human Rights Activism

Some responses to countering disinformation are dealing with different challenges such as through engagement on human rights, freedom of information, internet freedom or digital rights, for example. Although associations focused on such themes are not directly engaged in the fight against disinformation, through support for journalists and media, through advocacy and policy and legislative analyses and recommendations, they are providing an added value to the creation of social resilience to information pollution. Digital movements on the region are critical to the work on free speech and access to accurate information.

CHAPTER 3.

CASE STUDIES

WESTERN BALKANS AND TÜRKİYE

Civil Society and media organizations have created sub-regional networks focused on counter-disinformation efforts in the Western Balkans. These regional initiatives include fact-checking initiatives, initiatives aimed at increasing critical thinking among the youth in the region, building media capacity to counter disinformation and strengthening media accountability.

This report identified two regional fact-checking initiatives – SEEcheck and the International Fact Checking Network (IFCN)-accredited effort that to a certain extent overlaps with Facebook’s curatorial third-party programme in the region. This network includes Croatia and Slovenia in addition to the six Western Balkan countries. The second initiative is the Anti Disinformation Network for the Balkans, which includes both Western Balkans countries and Bulgaria and Greece.

The Balkan Investigative Reporting Network (BIRN) is piloting several regional networking initiatives aimed at providing technical support to the media in the region. In addition to supporting capacity-building among the local and community media, a project financed by the UK Government, BIRN has initiated regional cooperation to promote and protect the public’s digital rights.

Apart from BIRN’s efforts, regional media development and journalists’ rights initiatives include the South East European Media Observatory and the UNESCO project, Building Trust in Media in Southeast Europe and Türkiye.

The initiative, *Strengthening Societal Resilience and Countering Foreign-Perpetrated Disinformation in Six Western Balkans Countries and Territories* is one of the activities within the Brdo Brdo-Brijuni Process⁴⁶ – which are efforts to “enhance resilience and boost regional cooperation in the fight against disinformation”.

46 The Brdo-Brijuni Process is an annual event aimed at EU integration of the Western Balkan countries.

SOUTH CAUCASUS AND WESTERN CIS

Government engagement varies across this subregion that encompasses Armenia, Azerbaijan and Georgia and Ukraine. In Ukraine, for example, there is a will and effort to involve the civil sector in the fight against disinformation, while in other countries the proclaimed fight against disinformation is often used to fight civil society and the local independent media.

There is a well-developed system of independent responses to information pollution in these societies, and there is a very active and large network of international donors that have significantly supported the creation of a systemic response to disinformation, notably by supporting the media and civil society.

There are several regional initiatives and networks which sometimes recruit journalists and activists from countries that are engaged in conflict with each other. Some of the responses provided by these networks and regional media can also serve as an innovative model for anti-disinformation activities which seek to counter the disinformation threat using a conflict-sensitive approach.

During the military hostilities in 2020, a regional media project [JAM news](#), with the aim to provide impartial analysis, conducted a fact-checking initiative through which Azeri journalists monitored and verified Armenian government statements, the Armenian media and social media. For their part, Armenian journalists undertook the same exercise with the information originating from Azeri sources.

JAM news was financially supported through the Confidence-Building Early Response Mechanism ([COBERM](#)), an EU-funded programme implemented by UNDP.

[COBERM](#) assisted two similar regional projects, a regional investigative reporting initiative [OC-Media](#), which a range of other international organizations also support. [Chai-Khana](#), another regional platform, uses a different, storytelling approach in its reporting. They are women-owned platforms focused in particular on gender equality and gender-sensitive reporting.

The Baltic Center for Media Excellence (BCME), together with the Baltic to Black Sea Alliance (BBSA) and in cooperation with the Media Development Foundation (Georgia), the Independent Journalism Center (Moldova), and the Ukrainian Media and Communication Institute, has initiated the [Media Literacy Advancement Program](#), and through it they have organized a series of roundtable discussions and conferences, analyses and mappings to support these countries in the development of a strategic, comprehensive approach to improving MIL in these countries.

CENTRAL ASIA

There are several Central Asian regional networking initiatives and projects]. [CAMP – The Central Asia Media Program](#) is funded by USAID and implemented by Internews. It is a five-year programme that aims to develop “a more balanced information environment in Kazakhstan, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan to increase openness among youth and adults for differing ideas, opinions and perspectives and, in turn, to increase their engagement in civic participation”.

[CABAR](#) is the IWPR’s regional analytical, informational and educational platform for Central Asia. Its mission is to develop expert and journalistic analytics, provide training on new media and extend analytical support for broad social processes in the countries of the region.

The Oxus Society for Central Asian Affairs is a Washington-based non-profit organization dedicated to fostering academic exchange between Central Asia and the rest of the world. It organizes regional roundtable discussions, provides scholars from the region with advice on scholarship and fellowship opportunities, and helps them liaise with publishers and partners in Europe and the United States.

The [Analytical Center for Central Asia \(ACCA\)](#) is an independent human rights media project which reports about human rights violations. Their investigative work on troll farms which were targeting activists and journalists critical of the government in Kazakhstan was mentioned in the Country Case Studies Industrialized Disinformation: 2020 Global Inventory of Organized Social Media Manipulation.⁴⁷

[BRYCA](#) is a project that aims to promote critical thinking and to strengthen the resilience of young people against disinformation and hate speech online, as part of its global objective to promote support for civil society in the protection and promotion of human rights and fundamental freedoms worldwide. A quiz game was created as a result of the project – Qlever. The game, which targets young people across Central Asia to build youth resilience to disinformation by equipping them with critical thinking skills and knowledge, is available on mobile phones and computers.

47 Group of Authors, “Country Case Studies Industrialized Disinformation: 2020 Global Inventory of Organized Social Media Manipulation”, University of Oxford, Oxford Internet Institute, 2021, pp. 221, 447. https://demotech.oii.ox.ac.uk/wp-content/uploads/sites/127/2021/03/Case-Studies_FINAL.pdf

CHAPTER 4.

CONCLUSIONS & RECOMMENDATIONS

a. The Integrity Coalition – Georgia

In Georgia, USAID has launched a five-year programme, the *Georgia Information Integrity Programme*, which is being implemented by a London-based consulting company, Zinc Network, engaged in research, media development and organizational capacity-building. The programme is a part of USAID's Development Framework for Countering Malign Kremlin Influence.

Although the armed conflict in Georgia ended in 2008 with the six-point cease-fire agreement⁴⁸, there are continuous disinformation campaigns with the aim to influence Georgian foreign policy and its internal affairs.⁴⁹

Among the broad range of activities envisioned by the Information Integrity project, a group of eight Georgian CSOs joined forces to establish the *Information Integrity Coalition* aiming to “identify, monitor and research sources of disinformation”. Georgian civil society is a highly competitive environment, which makes organizations with similar goals and areas of expertise compete for the same resources.⁵⁰ In that regard, the first significant success of the project is the mobilization of key counter-disinformation actors in the country.

Signatory organizations are the Media Development Foundation, iFact, Institute for Development of Freedom of Information (IDFI), Institute for War and Peace Reporting, International Society for Fair Elections and Democracy (ISFED), Georgia's Reforms Association (GRASS), the Georgian Charter of Journalistic Ethics and the Tolerance and Diversity Institute (TDI).

48 Repertoire of the Practice of the United Nations Security Council, 2008-2009, 26, Situation in Georgia, p. 2. https://www.un.org/en/sc/repertoire/2008-2009/Part%20I/Europe/08-09_Georgia.pdf

49 Naria Seskuria, “Russia's “Hybrid Aggression” against Georgia: The Use of Local and External Tools”, Center for Strategic and International Studies, Washington D.C., 21 September 2021. <https://www.csis.org/analysis/russias-hybrid-aggression-against-georgia-use-local-and-external-tools>

50 Gemma Piñol Puig, “Situation Analysis of Civil Society in Georgia”, Europe Foundation 2016, p. 27. <https://paperzz.com/doc/8323683/situation-analysis-of-civil-society-in-georgia>

The *Information Integrity Coalition* represents only part of the activities envisioned by the project team, which is also engaged in building societal resilience to disinformation in Georgian society in general. The *Information Integrity Coalition* was successful in creating an environment for the cooperation of key actors. By forming the coalition to counter-disinformation cooperation at the national level, the project goal was to help to reduce the duplication of efforts, and also to create a strong united voice which could react to major disinformation events in the country. Its effectiveness has already been demonstrated, especially in the disinformation campaigns produced by far-right actors in the country and in the ongoing war in Ukraine.

The Coalition Manager, Nino Zedelishvili, notes that there are four streams of activities in the coalition's practices: monitoring ad hoc events, monitoring ongoing events, advocacy and research.

When it comes to the measurable results of the endeavour, the project team members interviewed for this research claim that it is still early to tell what the final impact of their activities will be, but there are some early signs of significant results. The project's M&E strategy consists of qualitative and quantitative research which is measuring the coalition members' capacities through a qualitative self-reporting mechanism. When it comes to audience research, a biannual poll at the national level is being conducted, through which the general population's awareness of the disinformation problem is gauged, as are the coalition and project activities. They are also monitoring and evaluating the engagement of digital data (likes, shares, comments on social media) and measuring their media presence and the way the coalition is impacting the fight against disinformation.

b. Local and community media development – examples from three subregions

Western Balkans: In 2021 the British Government launched the Media for All programme⁵¹ called *Supporting Greater Media Independence in the Western Balkans*. The programme is implemented by the British Council, BIRN, the Thomson Foundation and the International NGO Training and Research Centre. It provides expert mentoring, training and support for local media outlets, journalists, editors, owners and audiences across the Western Balkans.

The stakeholders recognized the importance and role of the local and community media in shaping local public opinion. These media, which were

51 Davor Marko, "The backbone of professional and independent journalism", Thomson Foundation. <https://www.thomsonfoundation.org/latest/the-backbone-of-professional-and-independent-journalism/>

traditionally deemed underserved by international development funding opportunities, are closer to the consumers. Apart from offering service information about their community, they are often the main source of general information. The programme provided more than 50 local media in the Western Balkans with tailored business development support, capacity-building and trainings aimed at enhancing two-way communication with citizens, strengthening gender-sensitive reporting, encouraging youth reporters and public debates, networking and exchange.

Ukraine: The Ukrainian NGO “Center for Analytics and Investigations” founded “Bez Brekhny” (No lies), a fact-checking platform in 2016. Their projects, as most of the counter-disinformation efforts in Ukraine, are mainly focused on disinformation emanating from external actors.

According to the project’s founder, Oleksandr Gorohovskiy, since 2017, Bez Brekhny has mainly focused on developing the capacities of the ⁵² media in the Ukraine’s provinces, since the project has found regional media to be the weakest point in the country’s infosphere when it comes to dissemination of disinformation. During their investigations and fact-checking assignments, while they were tracking sources of disinformation published in the mainstream media on the national level, it was found that many of these were published in the regional media first.

In 2017 the project participated in the creation and launch of the interregional fact-checking platform Checkregion-ua.info. During the three iterations of the project, they organized more than 100 regional seminars attended by students, journalists and local civic activists. They are providing journalism students, journalists and civic activists with fact-checking tools and know-how, which they implement during local elections to monitor the work of local authorities.

They also organized the International Interregional Fact-Checking Conference involving representatives of the regional media and fact-checkers from the Czech Republic, Kazakhstan, Russia, and representatives of twelve Ukrainian regions. Best practices and know-how from Ukraine were shared and later implemented by fact-checkers in Central Asia and the Czech Republic.

Kyrgyzstan: the country is predominantly mountainous with many regions completely underserved by a communication infrastructure. Approximately 40% of Kyrgyzstan’s territory has limited access to information.⁵³ Some small remote rural communities have no access to traditional media at all. Due to long and complicated bureaucratic procedures for obtaining licenses and frequencies for broadcasting, some rural communities have recognized that the best option for overcoming these barriers was introducing local broadcasting serving small communities in rural areas, which does not require licensing.

Radio Most and the Multimedia Center “Mediamost” were founded with the help of UNESCO in 2004 in Talas. Radio Most soon became a gathering point

⁵² Regional refers to Ukraine’s provinces.

⁵³ Kyrgyzstan: Strengthening Sustainability of Community Media, UNESCO Kazakhstan, 3 October 2018. <http://en.unesco.kz/kyrgyzstan-strengthening-sustainability-of-community-media>

for other small community media in Kyrgyzstan. In 2013 the informal network of community media founded the Association of Community Media (ACM) in Kyrgyzstan which today has 27 members. Most of the community media work across the country is organized on a voluntary basis and organizations are home-grown.

ACM's main partners are UNESCO, through its office in Kazakhstan, the Deutsche Welle Academy, the FES and Kloop media organization, one of the most popular news sources in the country. ACM provides its members with logistical and legal aid, organizes trainings and introduces reporting standards.

GAPS AND POSITIVE OUTCOMES

The legal definition of disinformation remains a challenge for both governments and policy experts. In many cases in the region, the governments lack understanding of how to address disinformation while continuing to protect basic human rights such as access to information and freedom of expression. The governments in the region often use counter-disinformation campaigns not to fight against disinformation, but rather to counter unwanted information and criticism. The broad definition of norms allows for their arbitrary and uncontrolled interpretation and creates the preconditions for the abuse of the principled fight against disinformation.

There are some positive examples of governments being inclusive of civil society in the planning and implementation of their counter-disinformation actions and practices.

Women, ethnic, religious and sexual minorities have often been targets of dangerous disinformation campaigns. Civil society organizations with mandates on gender-equality are engaged in campaigns dealing with the specific problem of gender-based disinformation. When it comes to ethnic and regional minorities there is a space for cross-sectoral cooperation with actors dealing with both human rights and conflict-prevention.

NGOs chasing project funding often lose focus of their programme priorities. Rushing from project to project, organizations are becoming production lines for writing projects on all topics. As such, they shift their focus from their mission, resulting in short-term interventions. For those reasons, the effectiveness and credibility of the fact-checking platforms are on the decline⁵⁴. Some are flagged as extremely biased and as counter-propaganda activities that differ from propaganda activities only in the terminology applied. Additionally, there is also

54 Anastasia Starchenko, "Zaborona vs. StopFake: what is hiding behind Ukraine's ongoing media conflict?", New Eastern Europe, 3 August 2020. <https://neweasterneurope.eu/2020/08/03/zaborona-vs-stopfake-what-is-hiding-behind-ukraines-ongoing-media-conflict/>

overlap and loss of boundaries between journalism and the work of the NGO sector, in which NGOs often take on the role of the media in a range of contexts.

Monitoring and evaluation of the impact and effectiveness of the counter-disinformation efforts remain the challenge throughout the region. The actors are implementing traditional tools for qualitative and quantitative research: polls, self-evaluation and measuring of digital data and media presence. There is a space for more innovative and specialized approach to measuring the effectiveness of countering disinformation efforts. Long-term continuous general population polls focused on the research of disinformation trends, critical thinking and media literacy could be very useful instruments for measuring the effectiveness of counter-disinformation efforts at both regional and subregional levels.

There is lack of research and evidence on how the disinformation impacts crisis. The recent crises (reference is to the several crisis including in Azerbaijan, Belarus, Kazakhstan and Ukraine) and subsequent developments in the region make it important to understand what role disinformation and propaganda played in their preparation, during and after the events. Since this type of disinformation is serving to pre-empt or predict political intentions and actions, it is important to **invest in further research of crisis-related disinformation to support conflict-sensitive reporting initiatives, networking and cooperation as tools for conflict prevention.**

On the other hand, media and civil society across the region are producing effective and innovative responses to disinformation, especially in spheres where the cooperation and exchange of practices are applied. Their responses are diverse, from engaging in two-way communication with audiences, exploring different platforms for engagement with the general public, from developing interactive multi-media fact-checking platforms to introducing media literacy and critical thinking educational programmes in cooperation with the governments. However, while there is a growing number of initiatives, **there is a gap in meaningful regional networking**, networking events and dialogues among the organizations and activists.

Media development has also been boosted and protected with support from development partners in their fight to counter disinformation. The aforementioned development partners have been investing in building media capacities for decades in the region – independent media and journalists, who were supported by and whose journalistic skills were honed through these initiatives, are thriving in the region. There are many organizations that have experienced success on local investigative and fact-checking initiatives. Due to political pressure and the state of the economy in some countries in the region, many independent media are dependent on these organizations. Some media outlets and initiatives supported by international partners, managed to evolve into popular mainstream sources of information in their countries⁵⁵.

55 Maryse Zeidler, “Journalists at TED 2019 conference fight for truth — and democracy”, Canada Broadcasting Corporation, 15 April 2019. <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/journalists-at-ted-2019-conference-fight-for-truth-and-democracy-1.5099452>

Organizations that primarily deal with human rights and freedoms rather than with media and disinformation directly, have also played an important role in countering information pollution, mainly through providing legal aid and advocacy support for journalists and activists who are directly involved in counter-disinformation efforts.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Investing in information pollution prevention by building social resilience

Regional cooperation and networking among various actors are very important tools that are improving both the quality and effectiveness of counter-disinformation responses. All relevant stakeholders should support systemic and evidence-based approaches to build critical thinking and social dialogue at all levels, including in the education system, institutions, civil society and among the general public, through an inclusive and multisectoral approach.

This can be done through:

- Providing support for the projects aimed at MIL curriculum standardization, and working together with relevant government institutions and universities on their implementation.
- Facilitating communication among experts and the sharing of scientific knowledge with a wider audience through finding effective communication models. An apt example is the Experts Hub platform in Kazakhstan.
- Shaping and supporting government campaigns to raise media and information literacy among the general population.
- Supporting scientific research to understand the impact of information pollution on social cohesion, democratic processes and human rights. Sound points of contact for these initiatives could be already existing regional academic networks like [The Oxus Society for Central Asian Affairs](#).

Prioritizing Cooperation and Networking

Supporting stakeholders' regional cooperation projects and the exchange of experiences within and between countries, through regional and inter-subregional cooperation, networking events, workshops and roundtables.

Supporting the building of coalitions and alliances among public institutions, media, internet companies, civil society and others to develop multisectoral strategies to address disinformation.

Organizing regional and subregional platforms for the constant and continuous exchange of information among counter-disinformation actors, especially on disinformation trends.

Improving government responses

The governments of the region should invest in administrative capacity-building projects by offering trainings for civil servants, especially in the field of media and information literacy.

Cooperation within the non-governmental sector and the participation of its staff in drafting media laws and laws on the fight against disinformation can greatly contribute to combating information pollution. This can be done through the formation of multisectoral task forces for instance.

Governments should develop transparent governance and freedom of information policies. The governments should foster trust and promote credibility and integrity of official information. The fight against disinformation must be waged in transparency, with accurate, evidence-based and timely information. The COVID-19 pandemic, the military hostilities in Nagorno-Karabakh and Ukraine highlighted the need for governments to create protocols for emergency responses to disinformation during conflicts and natural disasters that are not in themselves misleading.

Developing human-rights-centred, socially-inclusive and conflict-sensitive approaches to counter disinformation efforts

Civil society organizations and policy experts should be encouraged to take part in the crafting of practical human rights-based responses to disinformation. This can be attained through the regional and subregional exchange networks and through events that could be used as advocacy platforms in the fight against disinformation and in support of critical voices, activists and organizations, among other functions.

Providing ongoing support to conflict-sensitive reporting platforms is critical, in particular those involving media and journalists from all countries/sides in conflicts. One example is JAM news in the South Caucasus and its reporting during the military hostilities in the Nagorno-Karabakh conflict zone in 2020.

Civil society and the media should build multilingual media initiatives to enable the free flow of information among communities where a language barrier separates them.

Particular emphasis should be placed on projects aimed at deescalating conflicts and preventing violent extremism. One of the proposed measures can be the integration of mandatory “digital ceasefires” into mediation efforts so that actors in a conflict are requested to desist from online disinformation campaigns as a condition for joining the negotiations. Coupled with this is the need to train

mediators in how to detect or manage online provocations.

Political parties and political activists should be encouraged to build ethical standards in political action with a special emphasis on influence campaigns and on distorting public opinion through the manipulation of social media platforms.

Donors should focus more on programmes for including representatives of marginalized social groups in the media – notably women and ethnic minorities and also people from rural and remote areas.

Investing in Media for a Healthy Infosphere

Donors should continue their support for the media in capacity-building and for journalists by providing legal and digital protection. Additionally, in order to build long-term sustainability, donors in the region should work closely with local NGOs to further strengthen their capabilities and ensure initiatives function over longer periods. Donors should design programmes promoting activities aimed at decentralizing the infosphere by investing in small-scale, local and community media which are often underserved in existing programming. Examples of good practices are reported in Kyrgyzstan, Ukraine and the Western Balkans – and they are covered in the Case Study in the Chapter 4.

Support projects to build and improve journalistic and ethical standards. Civil society organizations should act as mediators and create platforms to overcome the division of the media scene along the political divide where articles and investigations of the opposing media will also be published.

There is also a need for programming oriented at countering crisis-driven disinformation. Journalists should be equipped with conflict- and crisis-sensitive reporting knowledge and skills.

Improving Donor Programming

UNDP can act as a convener for donors' cooperation in the region through strengthening partnerships among donors and implementers of development projects already active in the region, for example, the European Endowment for Democracy, National Endowment for Democracy, OSCE, SIDA, UNESCO, UNICEF, USAID and others.

Donors should work on the development of a platform or a common database for exchanging information on existing actors and initiatives in the region.

Donors should work on the development of a joint strategic guidance document that would minimize duplicative programming and improve the efficacy of counter-disinformation efforts.

Insisting on the corporate responsibility of social media companies

Regional and subregional internet governance conferences should be organized more frequently.

Some topics that could be raised through this platform include the following ones:

- a. Social media companies should work on a more transparent approach when it comes to their algorithms, to their enforcement criteria policies and to the labelling of state-linked media in order to allow users for informed decisions,
- b. Social media companies should continue to engage with local organizations and individuals to develop third-party fact-checking projects.
- c. Social media companies should develop external, independent oversight boards, and employ an ombudsman to allow users and the public to institutionally challenge their decisions through easy and transparent procedures.
- d. Social media companies should be more open to sharing relevant and critical data that is already in the public domain and is shared by consenting users for the purposes of research and analysis.
- e. There is a need for additional vigilance and for action by social media platforms during times of heightened tensions, potentially divisive elections and conflicts. A case study of the social media policies during the Ukraine crisis could be beneficial for future actions – what differences they made and how they impacted human rights concerns.

ANNEX A: INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
1. The Albanian Media Institute	Albania	OSCE EU OSI FES KAS Norwegian Embassy, Netherlands Embassy, UK Embassy USAID EWMI IREX UNESCO Hedayah
2. Faktoje.AI	Albania	IFCN USAID NED
3. The Media Initiatives Center - Media.AM	Armenia	USAID
4. The Union of Informed Citizens - Fact Investigation Platform	Armenia	EU UNDEF USAID GMF Freedom House IRI RSF OSF
5. The Yerevan Press Club	Armenia	FES EU SIDA
6. The Media Diversity Institute	Armenia	UNESCO UNDP TRF

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
7. The Freedom of Information Centre Armenia	Armenia	USAID
8. The Oxygen Foundation	Armenia	SIDA UKAID USAID OXFAM EU NDI Visegrad Foundation Austrian Development Agency British Embassy
9. Media for Informed Civic Engagement MICE 10. Funded by USAID 11. Implemented by MIC	Armenia	USAID MIC
12. Azerbaijan Internet Watch	Azerbaijan	None listed on the website
13. The Institute for Democratic Initiatives: Fakt Yoxla	Azerbaijan	IFCN
14. The Press Club of Belarus - Media IQ	Belarus	Visegrad Fund Canadian Embassy in Belarus British Embassy in Belarus Netherlands Embassy in Belarus
15. The Digital Skills Coalition Belarus	Belarus	Eastern Partnership (EU)
16. The Belarusian Association of Journalists	Belarus	RSF Article 19 FES CPJ CRD
17. BIRN	Bosnia and Herzegovina	OSF NED OSCE EU Rockefeller Brothers Fund UNDP
18. Zašto Ne? - Raskrinkavanje.ba - Istinomjer.ba	Bosnia and Herzegovina	IFCN Facebook NED GMF

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
19. Media Centar Sarajevo	Bosnia and Herzegovina	EU
20. Social Media 4 Peace	Bosnia and Herzegovina	UNESCO EU Antena Sarajevo
21. CABAR	Central Asia	IWPR
22. The OXUS SOCIETY	Central Asia	IWPR CABAR United States Institute of Peace European Neighbourhood Council
23. The Analytical Centre for Central Asia ACCA	Central Asia	None listed on the website
24. Idea Central Asia	Central Asia	OSF
25. BRYCA : Qlever,	Central Asia	EU MediaNet – International Centre for Journalism MSCF – Media Support Center Foundation Public Organization “Gurdofarid” MJDC – Modern Journalism Development Centre
26. The Central Asia Media Program CAMP Funded by USAID Implemented by Internews	Central Asia	USAID Internews
27. Georgia’s Reforms Associates GRASS - Factcheck.ge	Georgia	USAID EED GMF Netherlands Embassy in Georgia
28. The Atlantic Council – Digital Forensic Research Lab	Georgia	Atlantic Council

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
29. The Institute for the Development of Freedom of Information IDFI	Georgia	UNDP USAID SIDA HBS GMF OSI Visegrad Fund UKAID
30. The Georgian Charter of Journalistic Ethics: Media Checker	Georgia	UNDP USAID OSI IREX UNICEF GIZ
31. The Tolerance and Diversity Institute (TDI)	Georgia	USAID Netherlands Embassy
32. iFACT	Georgia	None listed on the website
33. The Georgia Information Integrity Program Funded by USAID Implemented by ZINC	Georgia	USAID
34. The Media Development Foundation MDF- Myth Detector	Georgia	UNDP OSI USAID UNESCO Swiss Embassy in Georgia Netherlands Embassy in Georgia DW academy
35. Adil Soz	Kazakhstan	Article 19 UNESCO USAID OSCE Netherlands Embassy in Kazakhstan Norwegian Embassy in Kazakhstan VIKES

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
36. The Legal Media Center	Kazakhstan	USAID UNESCO Soros Fund IREX VIKES Netherlands Embassy Finnish Embassy British Embassy FES OSCE EU German Embassy
37. MediaNet - Factcheck.Kz	Kazakhstan	USAID Internews Chevron KAS
38. The National Teachers' Association KazTEA	Kazakhstan	US Embassy
39. Bilim Barine	Kazakhstan	US Embassy
40. Experts Hub	Kazakhstan	US Embassy, implemented by Red Point Communication
41. Infodemiya	Kazakhstan	US Embassy
42. The Geopost	Kosovo	US Embassy TechCamp Kosovo
43. The Institute for Development Policy INDEP	Kosovo	USAID GMF Rockefeller Brothers Fund EU
44. The New Social Initiative	Kosovo	UNMIK
45. The IPKO Foundation	Kosovo	UNDP OSCE WBF SIDA USAID US Embassy Norwegian Embassy Kosovo Government

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
46. Internews Kosova - Kallxo-Krypometer	Kosovo	IFCN UNDP NED Norwegian Embassy EU Kosovo Government
47. Edumedia	Kosovo	OSCE
48. Ponder	Kosovo	OSCE
49. Innovations Lab		
50. Monitoring Information Integrity Disorders	Kosovo	NDI
51. KLOOP	Kyrgyz Republic	Soros Fund Internews
52. Internews Kyrgyzstan	Kyrgyz Republic	USAID
53. The Community Media Association	Kyrgyz Republic	DW Academy UNESCO Internews UNDEF FES
54. The Soros Fund Kyrgyzstan	Kyrgyz Republic	None listed on the website
55. The Institute for Media Policy	Kyrgyz Republic	UNESCO
56. The Media Development Center - FactCheck.Kg	Kyrgyz Republic	Internews Soros Fund
57. T-Media	Kyrgyz Republic	None listed on the website
58. Politklinika	Kyrgyz Republic	EU Internews NED Soros Fund IWPR
59. Temirov Live	Kyrgyz Republic	None listed on YouTube channel.

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
60. Media-K Program Financed by USAID Implemented by Internews	Kyrgyz Republic	USAID
61. Promo-Lex	Moldova	CRD ENEMO ABA (American Bar Association) USAID Norwegian Embassy in Chisinau Netherlands Embassy in Chisinau UNDP Moldova GMF OSCE OSI SIDA NED EU British Embassy in Chisinau UN
62. MediaPoint	Moldova	OSI
63. The Association of the Independent Press - StopFals	Moldova	NED UNICEF USAID UNDP OSI
64. The Independent Journalism Center	Moldova	USAID Finnish Embassy in Romania US Embassy in Moldova DW Academy OSI IWPR OSCE EU British Embassy in Moldova
65. The Media M Program Funded by USAID and UKAID Implemented by Freedom House and Internews	Moldova	USAID UKAID Freedom House Internews

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
66. MIL training for teachers	Moldova	DW Academy
67. The Center for Democratic Transition CDT - Raskrinkavanje.me	Montenegro	IFCN Facebook GMF NED
68. The Atlantic Council of Montenegro - DFC	Montenegro	US Embassy NATO British Embassy GMF
69. Institut za medije Crne Gore	Montenegro	None listed on the website
70. The Macedonian Young Lawyers Association (MYLA) https://myla.org.mk/?lang=en	North Macedonia	CRD OSI Visegrad Fund UNCHR EU Netherlands Embassy
71. Metamorphosis - Vistinomer - Meta	North Macedonia	USAID EU NDI Visegrad Foundation British Embassy OSF EU Netherlands Embassy
72. MOST - F2N2	North Macedonia	OSF US Embassy
73. The Association of Journalists of Macedonia	North Macedonia	None listed on the website

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
74. The Center for Research, Transparency and Accountability CRTA - Istinomer	Serbia	IFCN Google USAID Microsoft GMF NDI OSCE Internews EU German Embassy SIDA FNF OSF
75. Crime and Corruption Reporting Network KRIK - Raskrikavanje	Serbia	OCCRP NED OSF EU Rockefeller Brothers Fund CRD SRT Internews SIDA US Embassy
76. Novosadska novinarska skola – Medijska pismenost 77. FakeNewsTragac https://fakenews.rs/	Serbia	EU SIDA Serbian Government GLOBSEC OSI NED US Embassy
78. The Media Coalition	Serbia	USAID
79. Go Group Media– JAM news	South Caucasus	EU UNDP

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
80. OC Media	South Caucasus	UNDP EED NED OSF British Embassy Georgia Netherlands Embassy Georgia GMF TRF Swiss Embassy Georgia
81. Chai Khana	South Caucasus	Israeli Government British Government UNDP EU Norwegian Embassy in Georgia
82. The COBERM program	South Caucasus	EU UNDP
83. The Open Society Institute (OSI) Tajikistan	Tajikistan	
84. Ravzana	Tajikistan	OSI US Embassy in Tajikistan
85. Media Consulting: Nuqta.tj https://www.linkedin.com/in/nabi-yusupov-84476194?originalSubdomain=tj	Tajikistan	OSI
86. Internews in Tajikistan	Tajikistan	USAID
87. Factcheck.tj	Tajikistan	None listed on the website
88. Your.TJ	Tajikistan	OSI
89. Mediasavod.tj	Tajikistan	OSI
90. Teyit	Türkiye	Facebook TikTok CRD HBS Ashoka
91. Alternatif Bilisim	Türkiye	None listed on the website

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
92. The Freedom of Expression Association	Türkiye	SRT Swedish Government CRD Netherlands government EED Article 19
93. The Common Future Association - Dogruluk Payi	Türkiye	IFCN
94. Factchecking Turkey	Türkiye	Bosphorus Center for Global Affairs
95. Turkey Blocks	Türkiye	None listed on the website
96. Chronicles of Turkmenistan	Turkmenistan	None listed on the website
97. Turkmen News	Turkmenistan	None listed on the website
98. The OSCE Centre in Ashgabat	Turkmenistan	OSCE
99. The Centre for Democracy and the Rule of Law CEDEM https://cedem.org.ua/en/who-we-are/	Ukraine	UNDP OSCE COE Internews IREX USAID EU SIDA
100. The Digital Security Lab	Ukraine	None listed on the website
101. The Center for Analytics and Research - BezBrehny https://without-lie.info/	Ukraine	Prague Civil Society USAID Internews German Embassy US Embassy
102. The Media Reforms Center – StopFake https://www.stopfake.org/en/main/	Ukraine	IFCN
103. Texty-Feykogryz	Ukraine	USAID Internews
104. TrollesUA	Ukraine	None listed on the website
105. The Media Literacy Academy	Uzbekistan	None Listed, Commercial Project

INDEPENDENT ACTORS AND INITIATIVES		
ACTOR OR INITIATIVE	COUNTRY/ TERRITORY OR REGION	DONORS AND PARTNERS
106. The Modern Journalism Development Centre	Uzbekistan	DW Academy USAID British Embassy in Uzbekistan Article 19 MediaNet, Kazakhstan
107. The Journalist Preparation Centre JM	Uzbekistan	UN USAID UNESCO OSCE
108. NeMolchi (focused on violence against women)	Uzbekistan	None listed on the website.
109. The National Association of Electronic Mass Media	Uzbekistan	None listed on the website.
110. Factchecking.Uz	Uzbekistan	Internews
111. Strengthening Societal Resilience and Countering Foreign Perpetrated Disinformation	Western Balkans	CEP Slovenia NED Slovenian Aid
112. The IRI Beacon project	Western Balkans	IRI
113. SEECheck	Western Balkans	Facebook IFCN
114. AND Balkans	Western Balkans	Regional grassroots factchecking network
115. The SEE Digital Rights Network	Western Balkans	BIRN SHARE Foundation
116. The Southeast European Media Observatory	Western Balkans	EU
117. Building Trust in Media in South East Europe and Türkiye	Western Balkans	UNESCO, EU

ANNEX B: DONORS AND PARTNERS

Donor/partner	Number of organizations/ Initiatives supported	Countries, territories, subregions
1. USAID	34	Albania, Armenia, Central Asia, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Kyrgyz Republic, Moldova, North Macedonia, Serbia, Tajikistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan
2. Open Society Foundation OSF, OSI, Soros Fund	25	Albania, Georgia, Moldova, North Macedonia, Serbia, Tajikistan, Armenia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Central Asia, South Caucasus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic
3. EU	25	Albania, Armenia, Belarus, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Central Asia, Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Kyrgyz Republic, Moldova, North Macedonia, Serbia, South Caucasus, Ukraine, Western Balkans
4. UNDP	13	Armenia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Georgia, Moldova, South Caucasus, Ukraine
5. Dutch Government (embassies, Foreign Ministry)	12W	Albania, Belarus, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Moldova, North Macedonia, South Caucasus, Türkiye
6. Meta (Facebook)	12	Bosnia and Herzegovina, Montenegro, Türkiye, Western Balkans, Georgia, North Macedonia, Ukraine, Serbia, South Caucasus
7. Internews	12	Central Asia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic, Moldova, Serbia, Tajikistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan
8. NED	12	Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo, Kyrgyz Republic, Moldova, Montenegro, Serbia, South Caucasus, Western Balkans

Donor/partner	Number of organizations/ Initiatives supported	Countries, territories, subregions
9. US Government (embassies, the State Department)	12	Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Moldova, Montenegro, Serbia, North Macedonia, Tajikistan, Ukraine
10. OSCE	11	Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Moldova, Serbia, Turkmenistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan
11. British Government (embassies, the Foreign Ministry)	10	Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Moldova, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Georgia, South Caucasus
12. GMF Balkan Trust for Democracy Black Sea Trust for Democracy	10	Armenia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Georgia, Kosovo, Moldova, Montenegro, Serbia, South Caucasus
13. UNESCO	10	Albania, Armenia, Bosnia and Herzegovina Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic, Uzbekistan
14. SIDA	9	Armenia, Georgia, Kosovo, Moldova, Serbia, Ukraine
15. IFCN	9	Albania, Azerbaijan, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo, Montenegro, Serbia, Türkiye, Ukraine, Western Balkans
16. Civil Rights Defenders	6	Belarus, Moldova, North Macedonia, Serbia, Türkiye
17. Norwegian Government (embassies, the Foreign Ministry)	6	Albania, Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Moldova, South Caucasus
18. Deutsche Welle	5	Georgia, Kyrgyz Republic, Moldova, Uzbekistan
19. FES	5	Albania, Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic
20. Visegrad Fund	5	Armenia, Georgia, Belarus, North Macedonia
21. Article 19	4	Belarus, Kazakhstan, Türkiye, Uzbekistan
22. German Government (embassies, the Foreign Ministry)	4	Moldova, Kazakhstan, Serbia, Ukraine
23. IREX	4	Albania, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Ukraine
24. IWPR	4	Central Asia, Moldova
25. KAS	4	Albania, Armenia, Kazakhstan, Serbia

Donor/partner	Number of organizations/ Initiatives supported	Countries, territories, subregions
26. EED	3	Georgia, South Caucasus, Türkiye
27. IRI	3	Armenia, Kyrgyz Republic, Western Balkans
28. Rockefeller Brothers Fund	3	Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo, Serbia
29. UKAID	3	Armenia, Georgia, Moldova
30. UNICEF	3	Georgia, Moldova, Montenegro
31. Atlantic Council	2	Georgia, Montenegro
32. Freedom House	2	Armenia, Moldova
33. HBS	2	Georgia, Türkiye
34. Prague Civil Society	2	South Caucasus, Ukraine
35. RSF	2	Armenia, Belarus
36. Swiss Government (embassies, Foreign Ministry)	2	Georgia, South Caucasus
37. Thomson Reuters Foundation	2	Armenia South Caucasus
38. VIKES	2	Kazakhstan
39. Austrian Development Agency	1	Armenia
40. Canadian Government (embassies, the Foreign Ministry)	1	Belarus
41. Council of Europe	1	Ukraine
42. CPJ	1	Belarus
43. EWMI	1	Albania
44. FNF	1	Serbia
45. GIZ	1	Georgia
46. GLOBSEC	1	Serbia
47. Hedayah	1	Albania
48. Israeli Government (embassies, the Foreign Ministry)	1	South Caucasus
49. OXFAM	1	Armenia
50. Slovenian Aid	1	Western Balkans
51. Swedish Government (embassies, Foreign Ministry)	1	Türkiye
52. TikTok	1	Türkiye

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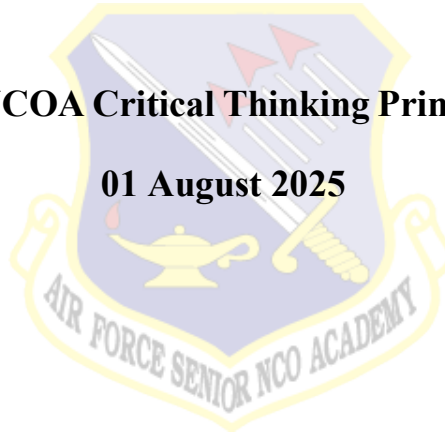
[Linkedin.com/showcase/UNDPEurasia](https://linkedin.com/showcase/UNDPEurasia)



[Youtube.com/UNDPEurasia](https://youtube.com/UNDPEurasia)

SNCOA Critical Thinking Primer

01 August 2025



Critical Thinking is an essential skill for SNCOs, as it allows us to make sound decisions leading to organizational success. Understanding various concepts of critical thinking, such as evaluating information by applying *universal intellectual standards*, applying *elements of reason* to complex issues, and adopting *essential intellectual traits*, helps leaders assess information, scrutinize thinking, challenge biases and identify potential solutions to problems.

Applying universal *intellectual standards*, such as clarity, accuracy, relevance, and logic, allows military personnel to scrutinize information and instructions effectively. For example, when analyzing reports, clarity ensures information is understood, while accuracy guarantees the data is reliable and up to date. Relevance can help military professionals focus on pertinent details, while logical reasoning ensures sound conclusions are made with the correctly applied information.

Employing the *elements of reasoning* fosters a methodical approach to problem solving and analyzing potentially convoluted situations. By clarifying the purpose of a mission, an operation or problem solving, SNCOs can tailor their strategies accordingly. Asking critical questions throughout the process helps identify potential gaps and weaknesses in the plan. Thoroughly evaluating information and interpreting it correctly can enable well-informed decisions, while drawing logical inferences helps anticipate possible outcomes.

Adopting *essential intellectual traits* can be considered a continuous exercise, the goal of which is the traits being ingrained in our own thought process, so the application becomes rather automatic. Each trait used independently can be a powerful tool for us to reflect and challenge our thoughts, however using them in concert with one another guarantees quality of thinking. For example, intellectual humility allows personnel to acknowledge their limitations and be open to considering alternative perspectives and solutions, fostering a culture of continuous learning and improvement. Embracing intellectual autonomy empowers military professionals to think independently, challenge assumptions, and make decisions based on well-reasoned analysis rather than blindly following orders. Furthermore, applying fair-mindedness ensures decisions and actions are just and

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unbiased, considering the welfare of all stakeholders and promoting ethical conduct in complex and sensitive scenarios.

By using critical thinking, leaders can enhance their decision-making abilities, allowing them to make informed and thoughtful choices beneficial to the Air Force. Critical thinkers must be willing to investigate viewpoints different from their own view, but at the same time recognize when to doubt claims that do not merit such investigation. SNCOs must be able to distinguish between accurate and misleading information to make informed decisions and maintain the credibility of the Air Force. They must ***challenge their own biases and assumptions and assist others*** in that endeavor. Overall, the ability to think critically is an indispensable tool for SNCOs to improve organizational success and navigate the complexities of the modern information landscape. *It is important to understand critical thinking, much like self-awareness, is not something you learn once and “know”, it is a continuous growth process of analysis and refinement, of applying and adopting while improving your efficiency.* You may have received similar lessons before, but we never truly “arrive” as critical thinkers, we evolve as we hone intellectual traits. We should continually pause, reflect and improve our minds over time and help others do the same.

In this lesson we’ll cover time-tested Critical Thinking concepts, many developed by Richard Paul and Linda Elder. Their bios are included in the *additional references* section of this primer. We will focus on the true benefit of critical thinking which is being able to analyze thinking and determining the quality of reasoning. We will break down some problems and apply the elements of reasoning and we’ll examine examples of biases. Finally, we will focus our efforts on a way to employ critical thinking concepts to counter mis or disinformation.

Critical Thinking Concepts – From: *The Foundation for Critical Thinking*

Universal Intellectual Standards

- **CLARITY:** *Could you elaborate further on that point? Could you express that point in another way? Could you give me an illustration? Could you give me an example?* Clarity is the gateway standard. If a statement is unclear, we cannot determine whether it is accurate or relevant.
- **ACCURACY:** *Is that true? How could we check? How could we find out if that is true?* A statement can be clear but not accurate, as in "Most dogs are over 300 pounds in weight."
- **PRECISION:** *Could you give more details? Could you be more specific?* A statement can be both clear and accurate, but not precise, as in "Jack is overweight." (We don’t know how overweight Jack is, one pound or 500 pounds.)
- **RELEVANCE:** *How is that connected to the question? How does that bear on the issue?* A statement can be clear, accurate, and precise, but not relevant to the question at issue. For example, students often think

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the amount of effort they put into a course should be used in raising their grade in a course. Often, however, the "effort" does not measure the quality of student learning; and when this is so, effort is irrelevant to their appropriate grade.

- **DEPTH:** *How does your answer address the complexities in the question? How are you considering the problems in the question? Is that dealing with the most significant factors?* A statement can be clear, accurate, precise, and relevant, but superficial (that is, lack depth). For example, the statement, "Just say No!" which is often used to discourage children and teens from using drugs, is clear, accurate, precise, and relevant. Nevertheless, it lacks depth because it deals with an extremely complex issue, the pervasive problem of drug use among young people, superficially. It fails to deal with the complexities of the issue.
- **BREADTH:** *Do we need to consider another point of view? Is there another way to look at this question? What would this look like from a conservative standpoint? What would this look like from the point of view of . . . ?* A line of reasoning may be clear accurate, precise, relevant, and deep, but lack breadth (as in an argument from either the conservative or liberal spectrum which gets deeply into an issue but only recognizes the insights of one side of the question.)
- **LOGIC:** *Does this really make sense? Does that follow from what you said? How does that follow? But before you implied this, and now you are saying that; how can both be true?* When we think, we bring a variety of thoughts together into some order. When the combination of thoughts is mutually supporting and makes sense in combination, the thinking is "logical." When the combination is not mutually supporting, it is contradictory in some sense or does not "make sense," the combination is not logical.
- **FAIRNESS:** *Do I have a vested interest in this issue? Am I sympathetically representing the viewpoints of others?* Human thought is often biased in the direction of the thinker - in what are the perceived interests of the thinker. Humans do not naturally consider the rights and needs of others on the same plane with their own rights and needs. We therefore must actively work to make sure we are applying the intellectual standard of fairness to our thinking. Since we naturally see ourselves as fair even when we are unfair, this can be very difficult. A commitment to fair-mindedness is a starting place.

Critical Thinkers Routinely Apply Intellectual Standards To The Elements Of Reasoning In Order To Develop Intellectual Traits

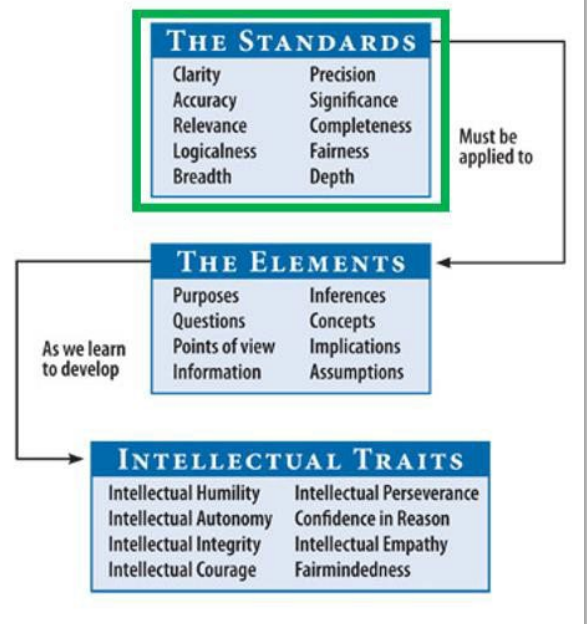


Figure 1 - <https://www.criticalthinking.org/pages/critical-thinking-where-to-begin/796>

Elements of Reasoning

Dr. Richard Paul was a prominent scholar and advocate of critical thinking. He co-founded the Foundation for Critical Thinking and developed a framework encompassing various elements of reasoning. Here's how the elements are defined in the context of his work:

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- **Purpose:** In critical thinking, purpose refers to the goal or objective one has in mind when engaging in the thinking process. It involves identifying the desired outcome or intention behind the thinking and clarifying why it is important.
- **Question:** Questions are central to critical thinking. They serve as the catalyst for inquiry and analysis. In this context, questions are used to stimulate thinking, explore ideas, and seek information. They can be open-ended, specific, or probing, depending on the purpose and context.
- **Information:** Information refers to the data, facts, evidence, or knowledge that is relevant to a particular topic or issue. Critical thinkers seek accurate and reliable information to support their reasoning and decision-making processes. Evaluating the quality, credibility, and relevance of information is an essential skill in critical thinking.
- **Concept:** Concepts are general ideas or categories that help us understand and organize our thinking. They represent abstract or mental constructs that capture common characteristics or attributes of specific phenomena. Critical thinkers analyze and clarify concepts to develop a deeper understanding of the subject matter.
- **Inference:** Inferences are conclusions or interpretations that are drawn based on the available evidence, reasoning, or logical connections. Critical thinkers engage in careful inference to make logical deductions or educated guesses about the meaning, implications, or consequences of the information at hand.
- **Assumption:** Assumptions are implicit beliefs or ideas that are taken for granted or accepted without being explicitly stated or proven. They often influence our thinking and shape our perspectives and conclusions. Critical thinkers identify, challenge, and evaluate assumptions to ensure they are valid and well-founded.
- **Point of View:** Point of view refers to a particular perspective or standpoint from which an individual perceives or interprets a situation, idea, or argument. Critical thinkers recognize different points of view and strive to understand, evaluate, and consider multiple perspectives to enhance their understanding and avoid bias.
- **Implications:** Implications are the logical consequences or outcomes following from a particular argument, decision, or line of reasoning. Critical thinkers analyze the potential implications of ideas, actions, or claims to assess their significance, validity, and potential effects.

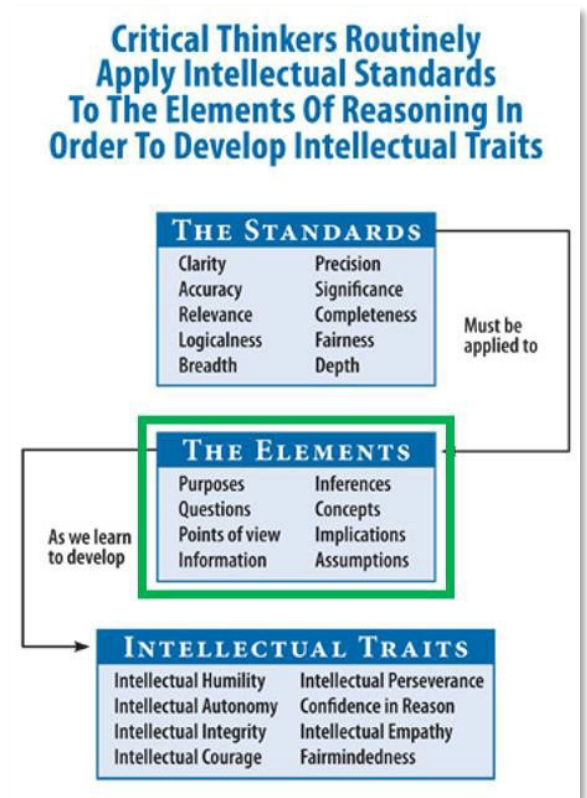


Figure 2 - <https://www.criticalthinking.org/pages/critical-thinking-where-to-begin/796>

These elements form a comprehensive framework for critical thinking, providing a structure for individuals to approach complex issues, make informed decisions, and engage in rigorous and reflective thought processes.

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Deliberate or Essential Intellectual Traits

- **Intellectual Humility:** Having a consciousness of the limits of one's knowledge, including a sensitivity to circumstances in which one's native egocentrism is likely to function self-deceptively; sensitivity to bias, prejudice and limitations of one's viewpoint. Intellectual humility depends on recognizing that one should not claim more than one knows. It does not imply spinelessness or submissiveness. It implies the lack of intellectual pretentiousness, boastfulness, or conceit, combined with insight into the logical foundations, or lack of such foundations, of one's beliefs.
- **Intellectual Courage:** Having a consciousness of the need to face and fairly address ideas, beliefs or viewpoints toward which we have strong negative emotions and to which we have not given serious hearing. This courage relates to the recognition that ideas considered dangerous or absurd are sometimes rationally justified (in whole or in part) and that conclusions and beliefs inculcated in us are sometimes false or misleading. To determine for ourselves, which is which, we must not passively and uncritically "accept" what we have "learned." Intellectual courage comes into play here, because inevitably we will come to see some truth in some ideas considered dangerous and absurd, and distortion or falsity in some ideas strongly held in our social group. We need courage to be true to our own thinking in such circumstances. The penalties for non-conformity can be severe.
- **Intellectual Empathy:** Having a consciousness of the need to imaginatively put oneself in the place of others to genuinely understand them, which requires the consciousness of our egocentric tendency to identify truth with our immediate perceptions of long-standing thought or belief. This trait correlates with the ability to reconstruct accurately the viewpoints and reasoning of others and to reason from premises, assumptions, and ideas other than our own. This trait also correlates with the willingness to remember occasions when we were wrong in the past despite an intense conviction that we were right, and with the ability to imagine our being similarly deceived in the case-at-hand.
- **Intellectual Autonomy:** Having rational control of one's beliefs, values, and inferences. The ideal of critical thinking is to learn to think for oneself, to gain command over one's thought processes. It entails a commitment to analyzing and evaluating beliefs based on reason and evidence, to question when it is rational to question, to believe when it is rational to believe, and to conform when it is rational to conform.
- **Intellectual Integrity:** Recognition of the need to be true to one's own thinking; to be consistent in the intellectual standards one applies; to hold oneself to the same rigorous standards of evidence and proof to which one holds one's antagonists; to practice what one advocates for others; and to honestly admit discrepancies and inconsistencies in one's own thought and action.

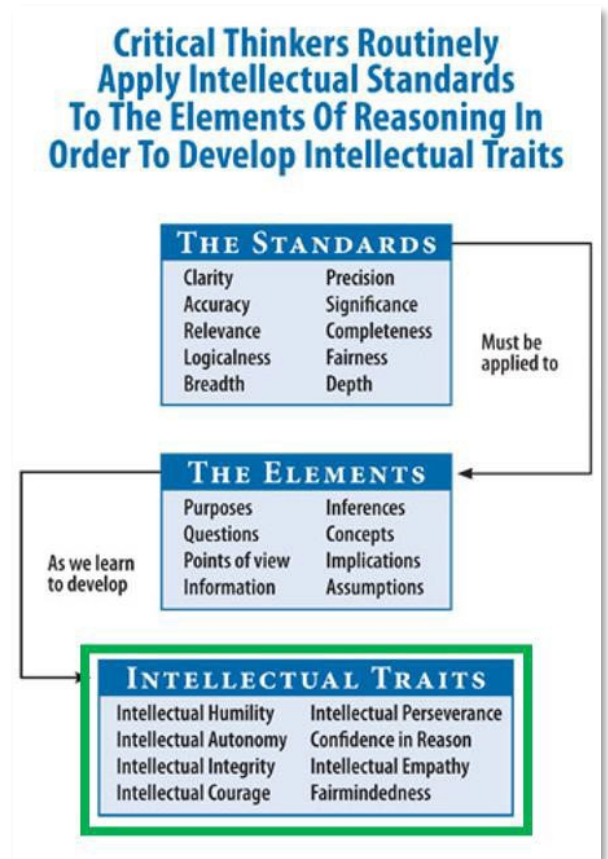


Figure 3 - <https://www.criticalthinking.org/pages/critical-thinking-where-to-begin/796>

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- **Intellectual Perseverance:** Having a consciousness of the need to use intellectual insights and truths despite difficulties, obstacles, and frustrations; firm adherence to rational principles despite the irrational opposition of others; a sense of the need to struggle with confusion and unsettled questions over an extended period to achieve deeper understanding or insight.
- **Confidence In Reason:** Confidence that, in the long run, one's own higher interests and those of humankind at large will be best served by giving the freest play to reason, by encouraging people to come to their own conclusions by developing their own rational faculties; faith that, with proper encouragement and cultivation, people can learn to think for themselves, to form rational viewpoints, draw reasonable conclusions, think coherently and logically, persuade each other by reason and become reasonable persons, despite the deep-seated obstacles in the native character of the human mind and in society as we know it.
- **Fairmindedness:** Having a consciousness of the need to treat all viewpoints alike, without reference to one's own feelings or vested interests, or the feelings or vested interests of one's friends, community or nation; implies adherence to intellectual standards without reference to one's own advantage or the advantage of one's group.

According to the Paul-Elder Critical Thinking Framework, habitual utilization of the *intellectual traits* produces a well-cultivated critical thinker who can:

- Raise vital questions and problems, formulating them clearly and precisely.
- Gather and assess relevant information, using abstract ideas to interpret it effectively.
- Come to well-reasoned conclusions and solutions, testing them against relevant criteria and standards.
- Think open-mindedly within alternative systems of thought, recognizing and assessing, as need be, their assumptions, implications, and practical consequences.
- Communicate effectively with others in figuring out solutions to complex problems.

System 1 vs System 2 Thinking

- **System 1 thinking** is a near-instantaneous process; it happens automatically, intuitively, and with little effort; it is driven by instinct and our experiences. Two examples of system 1 thinking are:
 - **Recognizing familiar faces:** Quickly recognizing and identifying a friend or colleague in a crowded room without consciously analyzing their facial features. It's an automatic, intuitive process that relies on your brain's ability to process and recognize patterns swiftly.
 - **Slamming on brakes:** While driving and suddenly encountering a pedestrian crossing the road unexpectedly, you instinctively react to slam on the brakes without much conscious thought. It's a rapid response to an immediate threat, allowing you to take quick action to avoid an accident.
- **System 2 thinking** is slower and requires more effort. It is conscious, systematic and logical. Critical Thinking is a form of System 2 thinking.

Two examples of system 2 thinking are:

- Solving a **Complex math problem:** Encountering a challenging mathematical equation requiring

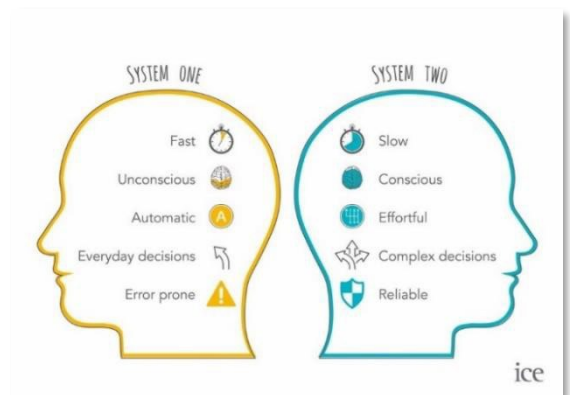


Figure 4 - <https://icecreates.com/insight/why-nudges-are-seldom-enough/>

Organizational Leader – Critical Thinking Primer

careful analysis and step-by-step reasoning to arrive at the correct answer. It involves deliberate, focused, and effortful cognitive processing to solve the problem accurately.

- Making a **Major life decision**: facing a significant life choice, such as selecting a career path or deciding where to live, reflective thinking comes into play. It involves weighing various factors, considering long-term consequences, and rational deliberation to make a well-informed and thoughtful decision.
- **Heuristics (or Mental Heuristics)** are intuitive forms of reasoning intended as cognitive shortcuts. They are formed through repeated exposure to certain patterns or situations, leading our brains to create simplified cognitive shortcuts. These shortcuts are developed to help us quickly make decisions and judgments without expending extensive mental effort. Over time, experiences, cultural influences, and social interactions contribute to the formation and refinement of these mental heuristics, allowing us to navigate the world more efficiently, but sometimes at the cost of accuracy and rationality. Biases are often linked to mental heuristics.

SEE Format

SEE is a thinking and writing technique to help individuals clarify their thoughts and express them effectively. It stands for **State, Elaborate, and Exemplify**. The **State** step involves stating a clear and concise thesis or main idea, the **Elaborate** step expands upon the thesis/idea by providing additional details and explanations and the **Exemplify** step provides concrete examples or anecdotes to support the main idea. When employed as a writing technique, the SEE format naturally incorporates intellectual standards like clarity & depth while presenting the reader with a logical format to digest complex ideas. Note, the E's in SEE are interchangeable. In some writing, you may wish to elaborate first while at other times you may wish to provide examples of your claim/main idea first.

S: State To state something is to **say it briefly, clearly** and sometimes it means offering the most basic but precise definition. Sometimes the “state it” definition is the textbook definition. Strategies to help students clearly state their idea or main point:

- Complete the phrase “*I think...*” about the idea or main point.
- State the idea or basic point in one simple sentence.

E: Elaborate To elaborate on the statement above is to **expand it, explain it in your own words** at a greater length. Strategies to help students expand on their idea or main point are:

- Complete the phrase “*In other words...*” about the idea or main point.
- Elaborate on the idea or basic point more fully.

E: Exemplify To give a good **example of a topic or concept is to clarify** for yourself or your audience what you mean after “stating” and “elaborating.” It is best to have an original example pulled from your own life or the world around you. Strategies to help students exemplify their idea or main point are:

- Complete the phrase “*For example...*” about the idea or main point.
- Give an example of the idea or point from your experience.

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Cognitive Biases, Hindrances & Fallacies

- **Ad Hominem:** Instead of addressing someone's argument or position, you irrelevantly attack the person
- **Ad Populum (bandwagon):** Persuading others by claiming something is true or right because a lot of people think so.
- **Anchoring Bias:** Over-relying on the first piece of information obtained and using it as the baseline for comparison.
- **Anecdotal Fallacy:** evidence based entirely on personal experience without real evidence.
- **Argument from ignorance:** An assertion that a claim is either true or false because of a lack of evidence to the contrary.
- **Authority Bias:** we value the opinion of an authoritarian; people follow authorities rather quickly.
- **Availability Bias:** Making decisions based on immediate information or examples that come to mind.
- **Bandwagon Effect:** A person is more likely to go along with a belief if there are many others who hold that belief. Other names for this are “herd mentality” or “group think.”
- **Choice-supportive Bias:** Once a decision is made, people tend to over-focus on its benefits and minimize its flaws.
- **Confirmation Bias:** Paying more attention to information that reinforces previously held beliefs and ignoring evidence to the contrary.
- **Double-speak or equivocation:** Definitions are not clearly used and therefore the double meanings of words might be wrongly incorporated into an argument.
- **Drone Mentality:** Pattern of not paying attention to the world, people or surroundings.
- **Dunning-Kruger Effect:** people without skills overestimate their own ability, people with lots of skills underestimate their own ability.
- **Egocentrism (egoism):** Viewing everything in relation to yourself (natural human tendency and a common barrier to critical thinking).
- **Empathy Gap:** we are bad at empathizing with others but expect others to empathize with us.
- **False memories or confabulation:** The production or creation of false or erroneous memories without the intent to deceive, sometimes called "honest lying."
- **Fundamental Attribution Error:** Overemphasizing personal factors and underestimating situational factors when explaining other people's behavior.
- **Gambler's Fallacy:** thinking that something will not happen soon in the future if it has happened many times in the past. And, believing something should happen since it has been a long time since it has occurred.
- **Groupthink:** a phenomenon that occurs when a group of individuals reaches a consensus without critical reasoning or evaluation of the consequences or alternatives.
- **Halo Effect:** Judging others similarly on all traits, assuming because someone is good or bad at one thing, they will be equally good or bad at another.
- **IKEA Effect:** we place more value on products that we have helped create.
- **Illusion of Transparency:** we assume others know how we feel.
- **Ingroup Preference Bias:** People tend to divide themselves into groups and then attribute positive attributes to their own group.
- **The “Jerk” Factor:** Tendency to over-value individuals who display “brilliant but cruel” behavior and to attribute less intelligence to people with “nice” behavior.
- **Just-World Hypothesis:** thinking that the world is fair and that everyone gets what is coming to them. People who do good things will be rewarded and people who do bad things will be punished.
- **Naïve Cynicism:** we think people are more selfish than they really are.
- **Naïve Realism / Bias Blind Spot:** we think we see the world objectively and others who do not see it the same way are misinformed, irrational or biased.
- **Ostrich Effect:** Avoiding bad news about a decision by ignoring data that might be negative.
- **Reactive Devaluation:** undervaluing something coming from someone who stands for something different than you.
- **Recency Effect:** Recent events are easier to remember and can be weighed more heavily than past events or potential future events.
- **Selective Perception:** we ignore certain things if they are not in line with what we believe.
- **Semmelweis Reflex:** rejecting new evidence because it doesn't match current norms, beliefs and paradigms.

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- **Sunk Cost Fallacy:** something paid for that cannot be reversed. Past costs incurred are no longer relevant to future decisions.
- **Superstition:** Making causal connections or correlations between two events not based on logic or evidence but primarily based on superstition.
- **Zero-risk Bias:** Preferring the choice that provides the certainty of a smaller benefit as opposed to an alternative with more risk and greater potential benefit.

Cognitive Bias Graphic

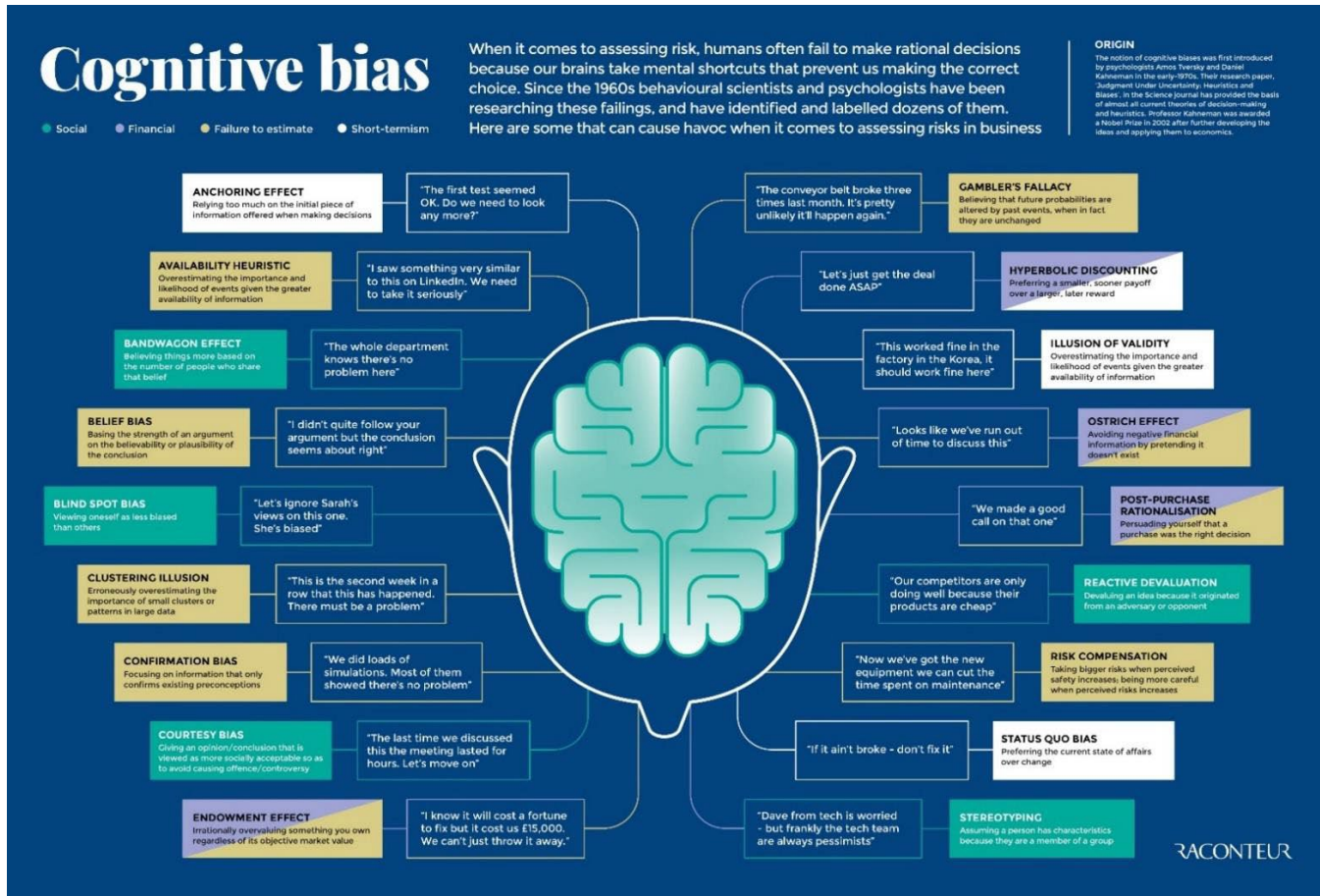


Figure 5 - Cognitive Bias (not all inclusive), AEP 2021 -Combating Targeted Disinformation Campaigns, Source: <https://www.raconteur.net/infographics/cognitive-bias>

Note: see the Cognitive Bias Codex link in the Resources attachment for a list of more than 180 biases

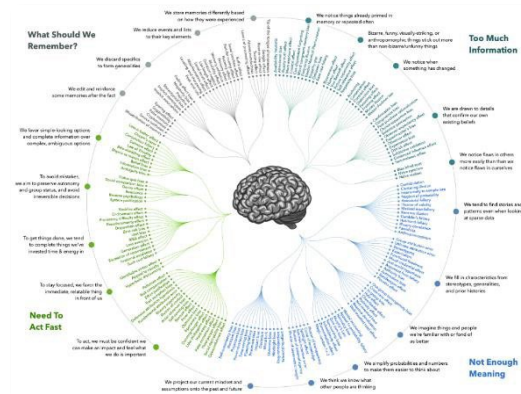


Figure 6 - Cognitive Bias Codex

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Media Literacy & Mis/Dis Information

Misinformation and disinformation are closely related concepts, but they differ in their intent and the way they are spread. **Misinformation refers to false or inaccurate information that is shared or disseminated without the intent to deceive.** It may be spread unintentionally by individuals who genuinely believe the information is true. Common sources of misinformation include rumors, urban legends, misconceptions, and even memes. Misinformation can still be harmful, as it can lead to the spread of false beliefs and misconceptions, but it is not necessarily spread with malicious intent. **Disinformation, on the other hand, is false or misleading information deliberately created and spread with the intent to deceive or manipulate people.** The key element with disinformation is the malicious intent behind its dissemination. Disinformation is often crafted to advance a particular agenda, manipulate public opinion, or damage the reputation of individuals, organizations, or governments. It can be spread through various means, including social media, fake news websites, and propaganda campaigns. Here are seven types of mis and disinformation according to perceived harmfulness:

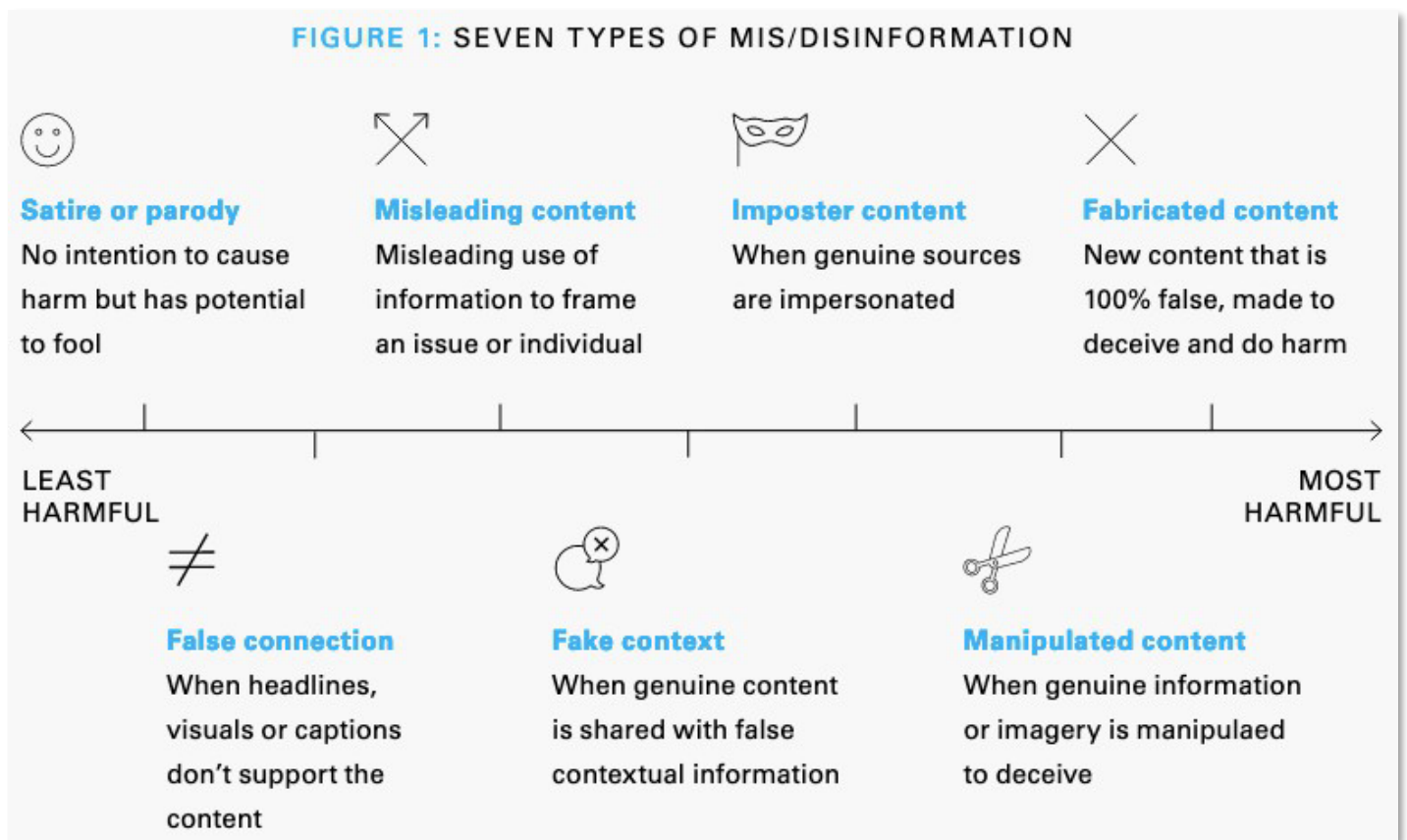


Figure 7 - <https://teacherbees.ca/media-literacy-resources/> Source: Claire Wardle, 'Fake news, It's Complicated', 2017

Critical Thinking Primer – Attachment 1 Reflection Questions

Question 1: Where could you apply two *Critical Thinking* concepts in your work environment? Which ones? Why? (consider Intellectual Standards, Elements of Reason, Intellectual Traits, etc.)

(Optional) Use the SEE format for the question above

State: *I would apply the Critical Thinking concepts of _____ and _____ to:*

Elaborate: *The reason for doing so is:* OR *in other words:*

Exemplify (examples): *For example, at work:*

Question 2: Which two *Biases* do you have difficulty with? How could you improve?

For example: *“I struggle with Point of View and seeing things from other people’s perspectives”*

Question 3: When have you seen *mis/disinformation* impact people you know?

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Critical Thinking Primer – Attachment 3 Resources

Student Preparation:

Read: The Miniature Guide to Critical Thinking (Full PDF in LMS)

(Pages 9, 12, 14-26)

Condensed Version: https://www.criticalthinking.org/files/Concepts_Tools.pdf

Read: Mapping and Analysis of Efforts to Counter Information Pollution.pdf (PDF in LMS)

[https://www.undp.org/sites/g/files/zskgke326/files/2023-](https://www.undp.org/sites/g/files/zskgke326/files/2023-02/Mapping%20and%20Analysis%20of%20Efforts%20to%20Counter%20Information%20Pollution.pdf)

[02/Mapping%20and%20Analysis%20of%20Efforts%20to%20Counter%20Information%20Pollution.pdf](https://www.undp.org/sites/g/files/zskgke326/files/2023-02/Mapping%20and%20Analysis%20of%20Efforts%20to%20Counter%20Information%20Pollution.pdf)

(List of Definitions and Executive Summary pages 5-8)

Watch: System I and II <https://youtu.be/wTtFciRcxz4>

Read: Combatting Targeted Disinformation Campaigns

https://www.dhs.gov/sites/default/files/publications/phase_ii_-_combatting_targeted_disinformation.pdf

(Page 7, Section 3.1 Cognitive Bias - pages 32-34, Section 4. Media Literacy and Critical Thinking Skills - pages 38-41)

Review: Helping Students Exercise Their Critical Thinking Using The SEE

<https://louisville.edu/ideastoaction/-/files/presentations/2011sacscoc/seei-handout.pdf>

Read: Critical Thinking Primer

Additional Resources (for increased understanding):

The Foundation for Critical Thinking:

<https://www.criticalthinking.org/>

Critical Thinking for the Military Professional

https://www.airuniversity.af.edu/LinkClick.aspx?fileticket=j_ZOmpEyioI%3D&portalid=10#:~:text=In%20the%20Paul%20model%20there,point%20of%20view%2C%20and%20implications.

Paul-Elder Critical Thinking Framework

<https://louisville.edu/ideastoaction/about/criticalthinking/framework>

Helping Students Exercise Their Critical Thinking using the SEE

<https://louisville.edu/ideastoaction/-/files/presentations/2011sacscoc/seei-handout.pdf>

Defining Critical Thinking.pdf

<https://www.criticalthinking.org/pages/defining-critical-thinking/766>

Cognitive Biases

<https://thedecisionlab.com/biases>

Cognitive Bias Codex

<https://www.teachthought.com/critical-thinking/cognitive-biases/>

Biography of Richard W. Paul

<https://www.criticalthinking.org/data/pages/37/ff640b6d016307b54cad91e5a9d4edfd4f18adb74215a.pdf>

Biography of Linda Elder

<https://www.criticalthinking.org/data/pages/14/fd4e6f74cc717ed36a9facc870b8a2e4fe0bd688b279.pdf>

RICHARD PAUL AND LINDA ELDER



EIGHTH
EDITION

THE MINIATURE GUIDE TO CRITICAL THINKING

Concepts and Tools



The Miniature Guide to

CRITICAL THINKING

Concepts and Tools

EIGHTH EDITION

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The Foundation for Critical Thinking and the Thinker's Guide Library

Founded by Dr. Richard Paul, the Foundation for Critical Thinking is the longest-running non-profit organization dedicated to critical thinking. Through seminars and conferences, online courses and resources, and a wide range of publications, the Foundation promotes critical societies through cultivating essential intellectual abilities and virtues across every field of study and professional area. Visit them at www.criticalthinking.org and learn about the Center for Critical Thinking Community Online.

The Thinker's Guide Library presents the framework of critical thinking across subject areas and audience levels to foster integration of critical reasoning throughout our world.

1. The Miniature Guide to Critical Thinking Concepts and Tools, Eighth Edition
2. The Thinker's Guide to Analytic Thinking
3. The Aspiring Thinker's Guide to Critical Thinking
4. The Thinker's Guide to Ethical Reasoning
5. The Thinker's Guide to Socratic Questioning
6. The Thinker's Guide to Fallacies
7. The Art of Asking Essential Questions, Fifth Edition
8. Student Guide to Historical Thinking
9. Thinker's Guide to the Human Mind
10. The Thinker's Guide to Scientific Thinking
11. The Thinker's Guide to Clinical Reasoning
12. The Thinker's Guide to Engineering Reasoning
13. The Nature and Functions of Critical & Creative Thinking
14. The Thinker's Guide for Conscientious Citizens on How to Detect Media Bias and Propaganda in National and World News, Fourth Edition
15. The Thinker's Guide for Students on How to Study & Learn a Discipline, Second Edition
16. How to Read a Paragraph: The Art of Close Reading, Second Edition
17. How to Write a Paragraph: The Art of Substantive Writing
18. The International Critical Thinking Reading and Writing Test, Second Edition
19. The Thinker's Guide to Intellectual Standards
20. A Critical Thinker's Guide to Educational Fads
21. The Miniature Guide to Practical Ways for Promoting Active and Cooperative Learning, Third Edition
22. How to Improve Student Learning: 30 Practical Ideas
23. A Guide for Educators to Critical Thinking Competency Standards

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Dedication to Richard Paul

This book is dedicated to the life and work of Richard W. Paul (1937–2015), one of the few truly original thinkers and scholars in the field of critical thinking studies, who dedicated his life to understanding and illuminating the essential, the most foundational, and the most integrated core concepts and principles in critical thinking. Through these intellectual tools and, further, by insisting upon strong sense or fairminded critical thinking, Paul revolutionized the theory and course of critical thinking.

About the Authors



Dr. Linda Elder is an educational psychologist who has taught both psychology and critical thinking at the college level. She is the president of the Foundation for Critical Thinking and executive director of the Center for Critical Thinking. Dr. Elder has a special interest in the relation of thought and emotion, the cognitive and the affective, and has developed an original theory of the stages of critical thinking development. She has coauthored four books on critical thinking, as well as twenty-five Thinker's Guides. She is a dynamic presenter with extensive experience in leading workshops on critical thinking.



Dr. Richard Paul was a leading proponent of critical thinking until his death in August of 2015. In his work and legacy, Paul remains an international authority on critical thinking. He founded the Center for Critical Thinking at Sonoma State University in 1980, followed by the Foundation for Critical Thinking. In his lifetime, he developed concepts, principles, and theory essential to a robust and fairminded conception of critical thinking; he worked tenaciously to advance ethical, or strong-sense, critical thinking throughout education and society. In his lifetime, Paul authored more than two hundred articles and seven books on critical thinking. He presented workshops to hundreds of thousands of educators over his thirty-five-year history as a primary leader in the critical thinking movement.

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Introduction

This small but powerful book contains core critical thinking concepts and principles distilled into compact size. These principles are universally applicable to human reasoning in every legitimate academic field, discipline, and profession. They give rise to the skills, abilities, and characteristics of those who think critically; they illuminate innate barriers to criticality.

Throughout human history, the concept of critical thinking has been treated, on the whole, superficially. Within academic disciplines, critical reasoning is still largely misunderstood or ignored. Yet the only way to understand any subject is to reason through problems and issues within that subject using one's own reasoning. When you develop skill in reasoning your way through questions within an academic discipline and begin formulating questions of your own, you are learning to think like a scholar.

Critical thinkers routinely clarify their purposes and the questions at issue in a given situation or context. They question information, conclusions, and points of view. They strive to be clear, accurate, precise, and relevant. They do not distort information or use false information in arguing for their position. They act in good faith in relation to others and in representing others' views. They look beneath the surface; they are logical and reasonable. They apply critical reasoning skills to their reading and writing, as well as to their speaking and listening. They apply these skills in history, science, math, philosophy, the arts, and professional and personal life.

Developing as a critical thinker entails explicitly focusing on the naturally occurring processes in your reasoning and learning to intervene in your poor-quality reasoning. It means developing a keen interest in how your mind moves cognitively from one idea to another, in what causes these particular moves to occur rather than others, and in how to intervene in the process when flaws are uncovered in any of your thinking. Put another way, critical thinkers have an abiding interest in the problematic aspects of their own thinking, and they seek out these problem areas, target them, and change something about their thinking in order to reason more rationally, logically, and justifiably. Embracing critical thinking means learning to take command of the thoughts that control you, thereby experiencing a happier, more satisfied inner sense of self.

This newest edition of *The Miniature Guide to Critical Thinking Concepts and Tools* contains all the original work from our previous version and continues to unpack and contextualize the theoretical work found in the original guide—focusing fundamentally on the elements of reasoning, universal intellectual standards, and intellectual virtues or character traits. This book offers additional critical thinking theory and strategies for improving reasoning within the various parts of human life and human study, which will help readers better internalize the basic tools of critical thinking and apply them within subjects and fields. More material has been included in this book on the barriers to critical thinking to help the reader come to terms with the power of these barriers to impede critical thought. We place these impediments under the broad categories of egocentric and sociocentric thought, which account for such common phenomena as close-mindedness, self-deception, rationalization, intellectual arrogance, hypocrisy, greed, selfishness, herd mentality, prejudice, and many other pathological ways in which people think, feel, and act. Finally, we end with an elaboration on our conception of critical societies and what would be widely or universally valued in human life, were critical thinking ever to become a far-reaching reality.

This book opens up many avenues for improving personal and professional decisions through critical thinking. For students, it is a critical thinking supplement to any textbook for any course, as it lays foundations for reasoning through all subjects, disciplines, and professions. For faculty, it provides a shared concept of critical thinking. Faculty can use this book to design instruction, assignments, and assessment methods in any subject. When this guide is used as a supplement to the textbook in multiple courses, students begin to perceive the usefulness of critical thinking in every domain of learning. If their instructors provide examples of the application of the subject to daily life, students begin to properly perceive education as a tool for improving the quality of their lives.

If you are a student using this guide, consult it frequently in analyzing and synthesizing what you are learning. Aim for deep internalization of the principles you find in it—until using them becomes second nature. If successful, this guide will serve faculty, students, and the public simultaneously.

Why Critical Thinking?

The Problem:

Everyone thinks; it is our nature to do so. But much of our thinking, left to itself, is biased, distorted, partial, uninformed, or downright prejudiced. Yet the quality of our life and that of what we produce, make, or build depends precisely on the quality of our thought. Shoddy thinking is costly, both in money and in quality of life. Excellence in thought, however, must be systematically cultivated.

A Definition:

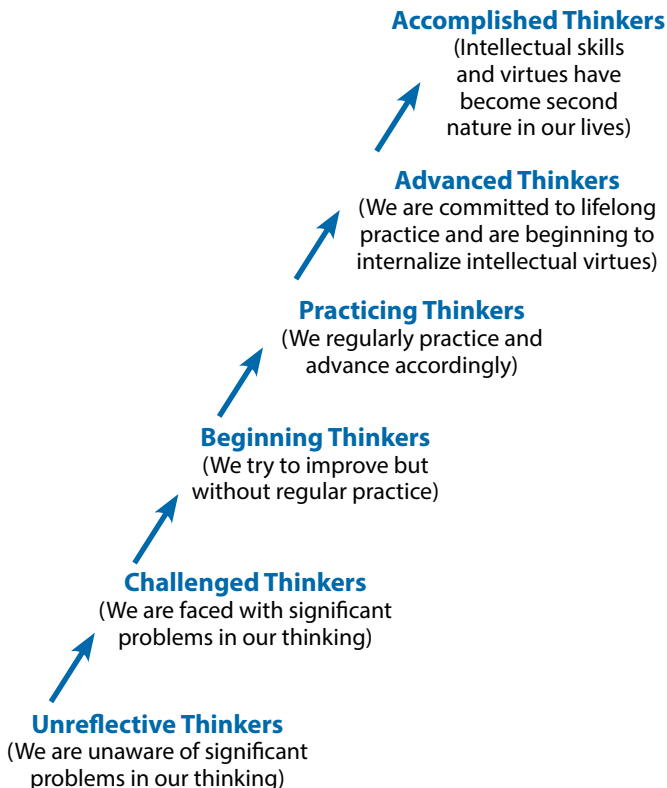
Critical thinking is the art of analyzing and evaluating thought processes with a view to improving them. Critical thinking is self-directed, self-disciplined, self-monitored, and self-corrective thinking. It requires rigorous standards of excellence and mindful command of their use. It entails effective communication and problem solving abilities, as well as a commitment to overcoming our native egocentrism and sociocentrism. It advances the character and ethical sensitivities of the dedicated person through the explicit cultivation of intellectual virtues.

The Result:

A well-cultivated critical thinker:

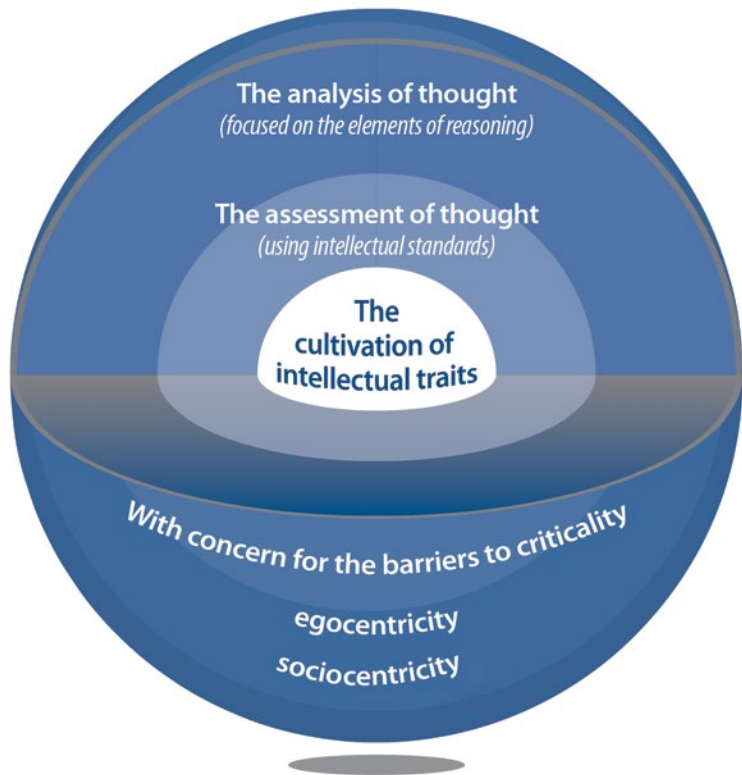
- raises vital questions and problems, formulating them clearly and precisely;
- gathers and assesses relevant information, using abstract ideas to interpret it effectively;
- comes to well-reasoned conclusions and solutions, testing them against relevant criteria and standards;
- thinks openmindedly within alternative systems of thought, recognizing and assessing, as need be, their assumptions, implications, and practical consequences;
- communicates effectively with others in figuring out solutions to complex problems; and
- is scrupulously careful not to misrepresent or distort information in developing an argument or position, and sees through false information and fake news.

Stages of Critical Thinking Development



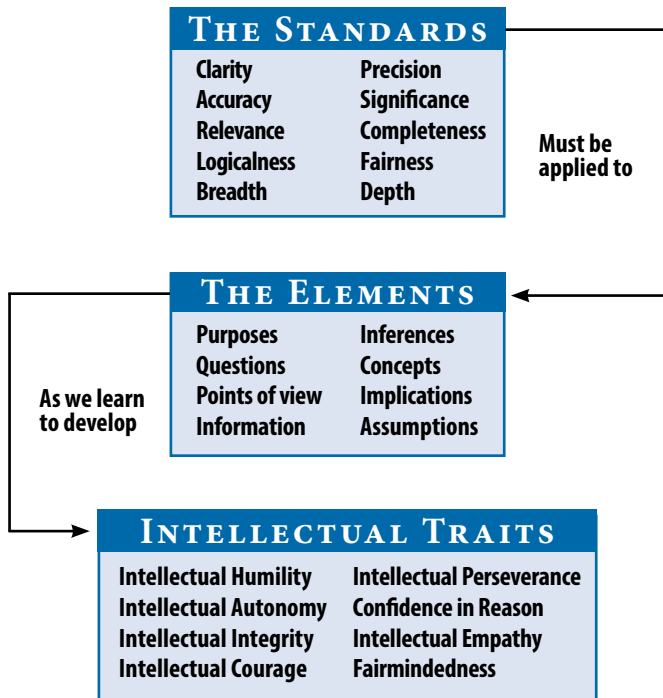
A Substantive Approach to Critical Thinking

A useful concept of critical thinking includes the disciplined analysis and assessment of reasoning as one cultivates intellectual virtues. This process entails concern for two primary barriers to criticality—egocentric and sociocentric thinking—which are prevalent and widespread in human thought and life.



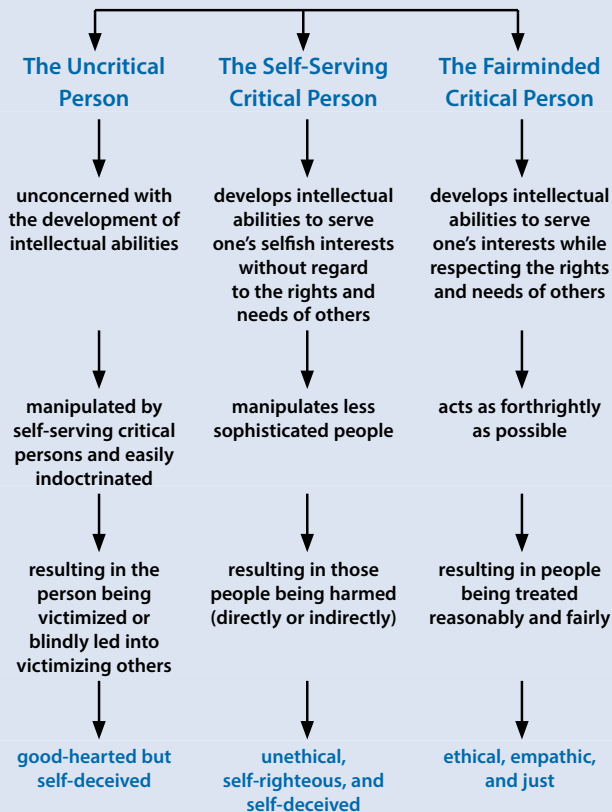
Critical Thinkers Routinely Apply Intellectual Standards to the Elements of Reasoning

Those who adhere to relevant intellectual standards when reasoning through issues in the essential parts of human life develop intellectual virtues increasingly over time.



Three Types of Character

The Fairminded Critical Person aspires to embody intellectual virtues in all situations. The Self-Serving Critical Person is skilled at reasoning but generally not concerned with the rights of others. The Uncritical Person is unconcerned with thought and therefore easily manipulated. In reality, every person embodies some part of each of these character types.



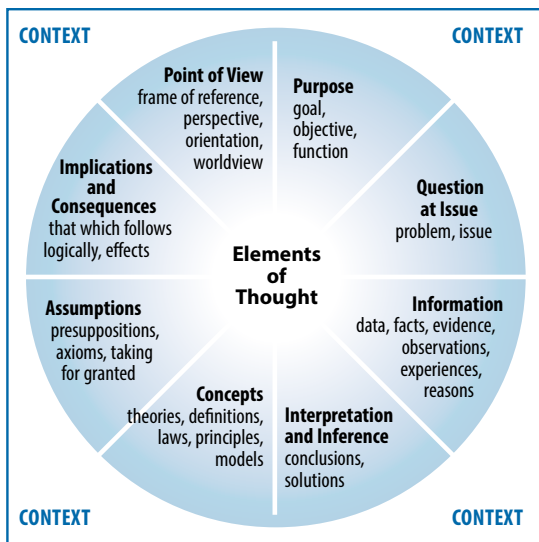
The Elements of Thought

Eight Elements Define All Reasoning

Eight basic structures are present in all thinking: Whenever we think, we think for a purpose within a point of view based on assumptions that lead to implications and consequences. We use concepts, ideas, and theories to interpret data, facts, and experiences in order to answer questions, solve problems, and resolve issues.

Thinking, then:

- generates purposes
- raises questions
- uses information
- utilizes concepts
- makes inferences
- makes assumptions
- generates implications
- embodies a point of view



Critical thinkers use the elements of reasoning with sensitivity to universal intellectual criteria, or standards, such as clarity, precision, accuracy, relevance, significance, depth, breadth, logicalness, sufficiency, and fairness.

Questions Using the Elements of Thought

Remember that the elements of reasoning are embedded in all reasoning, both your own and that of others. Use these questions to open up and deconstruct reasoning when writing a paper or reading something for class or of significance to you personally.

Purpose:	What am I trying to accomplish? What is my central aim? My purpose?
Questions:	What question am I raising? What questions should we be addressing? Am I considering the complexities in the question?
Information:	What information am I using in coming to this conclusion? What information do I need to settle the question? How do I know the information is true?
Inferences/ Conclusions:	How did I reach this conclusion? Is there another way to interpret the information?
Concepts:	What is the main idea here? Can I explain this idea?
Assumptions:	What am I taking for granted? What assumption has led me to this conclusion?
Implications/ Consequences:	If someone accepted my position, what would be some of the important implications? In other words, what might follow? What am I implying?
Points of View:	From what point of view am I looking at this issue? Is there another point of view I should consider?

A Checklist for Reasoning

1) All reasoning has a **PURPOSE**.

- Can you state your purpose clearly?
- What is the objective of your reasoning?
- Does your reasoning stay focused throughout on your goal?
- Is your purpose fair in context, considering all relevant persons or other species?
- Is your goal realistic?

2) All reasoning is an attempt to figure something out, to settle some **QUESTION**, or to solve some **PROBLEM**.

- What main question are you trying to answer?
- Are there other ways to think about the question?
- Can you divide the question into sub-questions?
- What questions would you need to ask and answer before you could answer the main question?
- Is this a question that has one right answer or can there be more than one reasonable answer?
- Does this question require judgment rather than facts alone?

3) All reasoning is based on **ASSUMPTIONS**.

- What assumptions are you making? Are they justified?
- How are your assumptions shaping your point of view?
- Which of your assumptions might reasonably be questioned?

4) All reasoning is done from some **POINT OF VIEW**.

- What is your point of view? What insights is it based on? What are its weaknesses?
- What other points of view should be considered in reasoning through this problem? What are the strengths and weaknesses of these viewpoints? Are you fairmindedly considering the insights behind these viewpoints?

5) All reasoning is based on DATA, INFORMATION, and EVIDENCE.

- To what extent is your reasoning supported by relevant data?
- How can you make sure your reasoning is based on information that is accurate or true?
- How do you know you are not distorting information to fit your selfish or vested interests?
- Do the data suggest explanations that differ from those you have given?
- How clear, accurate, and relevant are the data to the question at issue?
- Have you gathered sufficient data to reach a reasonable conclusion?

6) All reasoning is expressed through, and shaped by, CONCEPTS and THEORIES.

- What key ideas and theories are guiding your reasoning?
- What alternative explanations might be possible, given these concepts and theories?
- Do you deliberately take command of the ideas that guide your reasoning and control the quality of your life?
- Are you distorting ideas to fit your agenda?

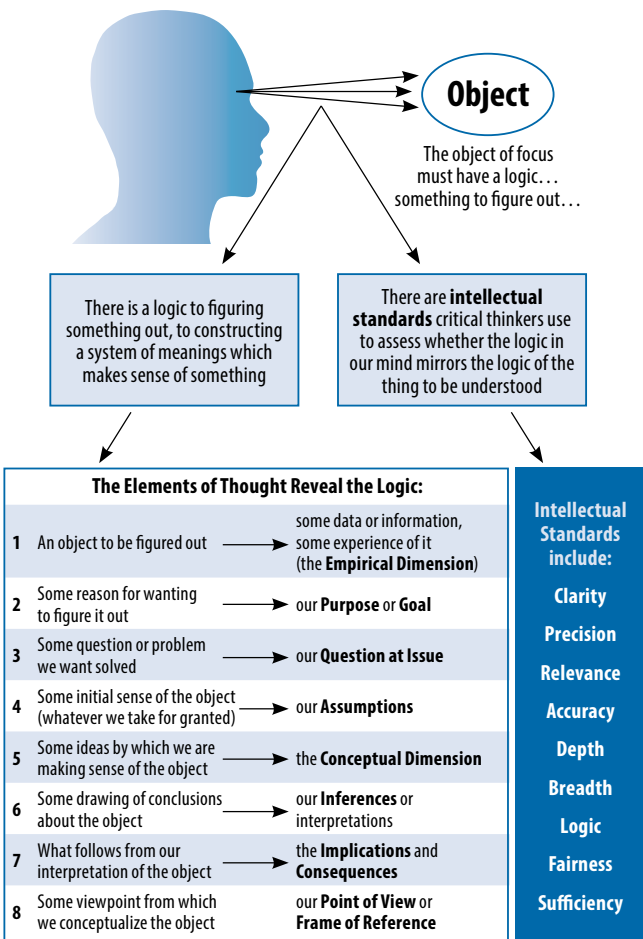
7) All reasoning contains INFERENCES or INTERPRETATIONS by which we draw CONCLUSIONS and give meaning to data.

- To what extent do the data support your conclusions?
- Are your inferences consistent with each other?
- Are there other reasonable inferences that should be considered?
- Are you able to consider alternative possibilities when coming to conclusions, or do you lock yourself into one way of interpreting situations?

8) All reasoning leads somewhere and has IMPLICATIONS and CONSEQUENCES.

- What implications and consequences follow from your reasoning?
- If we accept your line of reasoning, what implications or consequences are likely?
- If you decide to do X, what might immediately follow from your decision? What might follow from acting upon that decision in the long run as the implications and consequences spiral out?

The Figuring Mind



Universal Intellectual Standards

And Questions That Can Be Used to Apply Them

To be effective thinkers, we must go beyond taking thinking apart. We also must apply standards to the elements of reasoning to assess our thinking and ensure its quality. Routine, consistent, and deliberate application of intellectual standards to reasoning, over time, leads to the cultivation of intellectual virtues. To be learned, these standards must be taught explicitly. The ultimate goal is for these standards to become infused in your thinking, forming part of your inner voice and guiding you to reason better.

Clarity

Clarity is a gateway standard. If a statement is unclear, we cannot determine whether it is accurate or relevant. In fact, we cannot tell anything about it because we don't yet know what it is saying. For example, the question "What can be done about the education system in America?" is unclear. In order to adequately address the question, we would need to have a clearer understanding of what the person asking the question is considering the "problem" to be. A clearer question might be "What can educators do to ensure that students learn the skills and abilities which help them function successfully on the job and in their daily decision-making?"

Accuracy

A statement can be clear but not accurate, as in "Most dogs weigh more than 300 pounds."

Precision

A statement can be both clear and accurate but not precise, as in "Jack is overweight." (We don't know how overweight Jack is, one pound or 500 pounds.)

Relevance

A statement can be clear, accurate, and precise but not relevant to the question at issue. For example, students often think that the amount of effort they put into a course should be used in raising their grade in a course. Often, however, "effort" does not measure the quality of student learning, and when that is so, effort is irrelevant to their appropriate grade.

Depth

A statement can be clear, accurate, precise, and relevant, but superficial (that is, it lacks depth). For example, the slogan “Just Say No,” which was used for a number of years to discourage children and teens from using drugs, is clear, accurate, precise, and relevant. Nevertheless, those who use this approach treat a highly complex issue—the pervasive problem of drug use among young people—superficially. It fails to deal with the complexities of the issue.

Breadth

A line of reasoning may be clear, accurate, precise, relevant, and deep but lack breadth (as in an argument from either conservative or liberal standpoints that gets deeply into an issue but only recognizes the insights of one side of the question).

Logic

When we think, we bring a variety of thoughts together into some order. When the combination of thoughts are mutually supporting and make sense in combination, the thinking is “logical.” When the combination is not mutually supporting, is contradictory in some sense, or does not “make sense,” the combination is “not logical.”

Fairness

We naturally think from our own perspective, from a point of view that tends to privilege our position. Fairness implies the treating of all relevant viewpoints alike without reference to one’s own feelings or interests. Because we tend to be biased in favor of our own viewpoint, it is important to keep the standard of fairness at the forefront of our thinking. This is especially important when the situation may call on us to see things we don’t want to see or give something up that we want to hold onto.

Some Essential Intellectual Standards for All Human Thought

Clarity

Could you elaborate further?
Could you give me an example?
Could you illustrate what you mean?

Accuracy

How could we check on that?
How could we find out if that is true?
How could we verify or test that?

Precision

Could you be more specific?
Could you give me more details?
Could you be more exact?

Relevance

How does that relate to the problem?
How does that bear on the question?
How does that help us with the issue?

Depth

What factors make this a difficult problem?
What are some of the complexities of this question?
What are some of the difficulties we need to deal with?

Breadth

Do we need to look at this from another perspective?
Do we need to consider another point of view?
Do we need to look at this in other ways?

Logic

Does all this make sense together?
Does your first paragraph fit in with your last?
Does what you say follow from the evidence?

Significance

Is this the most important problem to consider?
Is this the central idea to focus on?
Which of these facts are most important?

Fairness

Do I have any vested interest in this issue?
Am I sympathetically representing the viewpoints of others?
Have we fully and fairly considered all the important information relevant to the issue?

Sufficiency

Do we have sufficient information to answer the question?
Are we unfairly leaving out information we would rather not consider in order to get more for our group while ignoring or downplaying the rights and needs of others?

Where Do Intellectual Standards Come From?

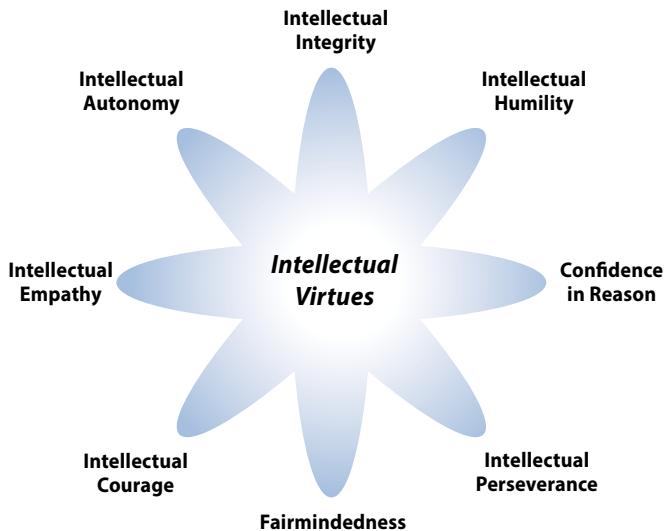
Intellectual standards ultimately derive from the nature of thought itself and what we characteristically need thought to do.

- Thus, the intellectual standard of *clarity* derives from the fact that we want or need to communicate a certain meaning to others, and unclear language undermines or defeats that purpose.
- The intellectual standard of *accuracy* derives from the fact that we are trying to understand or communicate things as they actually are, without any distortions. Inaccurate thought defeats that purpose.
- The intellectual standard of *precision* derives from the fact that we often need details and specifics to accomplish our purpose. Imprecision, or the failure to provide details and specifics, defeats that purpose.
- The intellectual standard of *relevance* derives from the fact that some information—however true it might be—does not bear upon a question to which we need an answer. Irrelevant information, thrust into the thinking process, diverts us from the information we do need and prevents us from answering the question at hand.
- The intellectual standard of *depth* derives from the fact that some issues involve complexity, and thinking that ignores these complexities is necessarily inadequate.
- The intellectual standard of *breadth* derives from the fact that some issues can be dealt with only by reasoning within multiple points of view. Thinking that is one-sided when many-sidedness is called for cannot be adequate.
- The intellectual standard of *logic* derives from the fact that reasoning that is inconsistent and self-contradictory necessarily lacks intelligibility.
- The intellectual standard of *fairness* derives from the fact that humans commonly ignore relevant facts and insights when they are not in line with one's interest or agenda.
- The intellectual standard of *sufficiency* derives from the fact that it is possible to gather detailed and vast information that is relevant and accurate, but that is still not sufficient to answer the question at issue or solve the problem at hand.

To generalize, it would be unintelligible to say, “I want to reason well, but I am indifferent as to whether my reasoning is clear, precise, accurate, relevant, logical, consistent, or fair.”

Intellectual Virtues of the Fairminded Critical Thinker

Fairminded thinkers pursue their own needs, desires, and goals while also considering, to the same degree and in good faith, the rights and needs of others. Yet it is possible to learn to use one's skills of mind in a narrow, self-serving way—many highly skilled thinkers do just that. Those who wish to develop as ethical critical reasoners work to embody the following character traits:



Essential Intellectual Traits

Fairminded critical reasoners cultivate not only intellectual abilities but also intellectual dispositions. These attributes are essential to excellence of thought. They determine with what insight and integrity you think. Here we briefly describe the intellectual virtues and provide related questions that foster their development. Only to the extent that you routinely and abidingly ask these questions of yourself are you able to develop these virtues.

Intellectual Humility

vs

Intellectual Arrogance

Having a consciousness of the limits of one's knowledge, including a sensitivity to circumstances in which one's native egocentrism is likely to function self-deceptively, as well as a sensitivity to bias, prejudice, and the limitations of one's viewpoint. Intellectual humility depends on recognizing that one should not claim more than one actually knows. It does not imply spinelessness or submissiveness. It implies the lack of intellectual pretentiousness, boastfulness, or conceit, combined with insight into the logical foundations, or lack of such foundations, of one's beliefs.

- What do I really know (about myself, about the situation, about another person, about my nation, about what is going on in the world)?
- To what extent do my prejudices or biases influence my thinking?
- To what extent have I been indoctrinated into beliefs that may be false?
- How do the beliefs I have uncritically accepted keep me from seeing things as they are?

Intellectual Courage

vs

Intellectual Cowardice

Having a consciousness of the need to face and fairly address ideas, beliefs, or viewpoints toward which we have strong negative emotions and to which we have not given a serious hearing. This courage is connected with the recognition that ideas we consider dangerous or absurd are sometimes rationally justified (in whole or in part) and that conclusions and beliefs inculcated in us are sometimes false or misleading. To determine for ourselves which is which, we must not passively and uncritically accept what we have "learned." Intellectual courage comes into play here, because inevitably we will come to see some truth in some ideas considered dangerous and absurd, and distortion or falsity in some ideas strongly held in our social group. We need courage to be true to our own thinking in such circumstances. The penalties for nonconformity can be severe.

- To what extent have I analyzed the beliefs I hold?
- To what extent have I questioned my beliefs, many of which I learned in childhood?
- To what extent have I demonstrated a willingness to give up my beliefs when sufficient evidence is presented against them?
- To what extent am I willing to stand up against the majority, even though people might ridicule me?

Intellectual Empathy**vs****Intellectual Narrow-mindedness**

Having a consciousness of the need to imaginatively put oneself in the place of others in order to genuinely understand them, which requires the consciousness of our egocentric tendency to identify truth with our immediate perceptions of long-standing thought or belief. This trait correlates with the ability to reconstruct accurately the viewpoints and reasoning of others and to reason from premises, assumptions, and ideas other than our own. This trait also correlates with the willingness to remember occasions when we were wrong in the past despite an intense conviction that we were right, and with the ability to imagine our being similarly deceived in the case at hand.

Intellectual Autonomy**vs****Intellectual Conformity**

Having rational control of one's beliefs, values, and inferences. The ideal of critical thinking is to learn to think for oneself, to gain command over one's thought processes. It entails a commitment to analyzing and evaluating beliefs on the basis of reason and evidence, to question when it is rational to question, to believe when it is rational to believe, and to conform when it is rational to conform.

- To what extent am I a conformist?
- To what extent do I uncritically accept what I am told by my government, the media, or my peers?
- Do I think through issues on my own, or do I merely accept the views of others?
- Having thought through an issue from a rational perspective, am I willing to stand alone despite the irrational criticisms of others?

Intellectual Integrity**vs****Intellectual Hypocrisy**

Recognition of the need to be true to one's own thinking; to be consistent in the intellectual standards one applies; to hold one's self to the same rigorous standards of evidence and proof to which one holds one's antagonists; to practice what one advocates for others; and to honestly admit discrepancies and inconsistencies in one's own thought and action.

- Do I behave in accordance with what I say I believe, or do I tend to say one thing and do another?
- To what extent do I expect the same of myself as I expect of others?
- To what extent are there contradictions or inconsistencies in my life?
- To what extent do I strive to recognize and eliminate self-deception in my life?

Intellectual Perseverance**vs****Intellectual Laziness**

Having a consciousness of the need to use intellectual insights and truths in spite of difficulties, obstacles, and frustrations; firm adherence to rational principles despite the irrational opposition of others; a sense of the need to struggle with confusion and unsettled questions over an extended period of time to achieve deeper understanding or insight.

- Am I willing to work my way through complexities in an issue, or do I tend to give up when I experience difficulty?
- Can I think of a difficult intellectual problem in which I have demonstrated patience and determination in working through the difficulties?
- Do I have strategies for dealing with complex problems?
- Do I expect learning to be easy, or do I recognize the importance of engaging in challenging intellectual work?

Confidence in Reason

vs

Distrust of Reason and Evidence

Confidence that, in the long run, one's own higher interests and those of humankind at large will be best served by giving the freest play to reason and by encouraging people to come to their own conclusions by developing their own rational faculties; faith that, with proper encouragement and cultivation, people can learn to think for themselves, to form rational viewpoints, draw reasonable conclusions, think coherently and logically, persuade each other by reason, and become reasonable persons, despite the deep-seated obstacles in the native character of the human mind and in society as we know it.

- Am I willing to change my position when the evidence leads to a more reasonable position?
- Do I adhere to principles of sound reasoning when persuading others of my position, or do I distort matters to support my position?
- Do I deem it more important to "win" an argument or to see the issue from the most reasonable perspective?
- Do I encourage others to come to their own conclusions, or do I try to force my views on them?

Fairmindedness

vs

Intellectual Unfairness

Having a consciousness of the need to treat all viewpoints alike, without reference to one's own feelings or vested interests, or the feelings or vested interests of one's friends, community, or nation; implies adherence to intellectual standards without reference to one's own advantage or the advantage of one's group.

- To what extent do self-interests or biases tend to cloud my judgment?
- How do I tend to treat relevant viewpoints? Do I tend to favor some over others? If so, why?
- To what extent do I appropriately weigh the strengths and weaknesses of all significant relevant perspectives when reasoning through an issue?
- What personal interests do we have at stake here and how can we ensure that we don't favor our own interests over the common good?

How Intellectual Virtues Are Interrelated

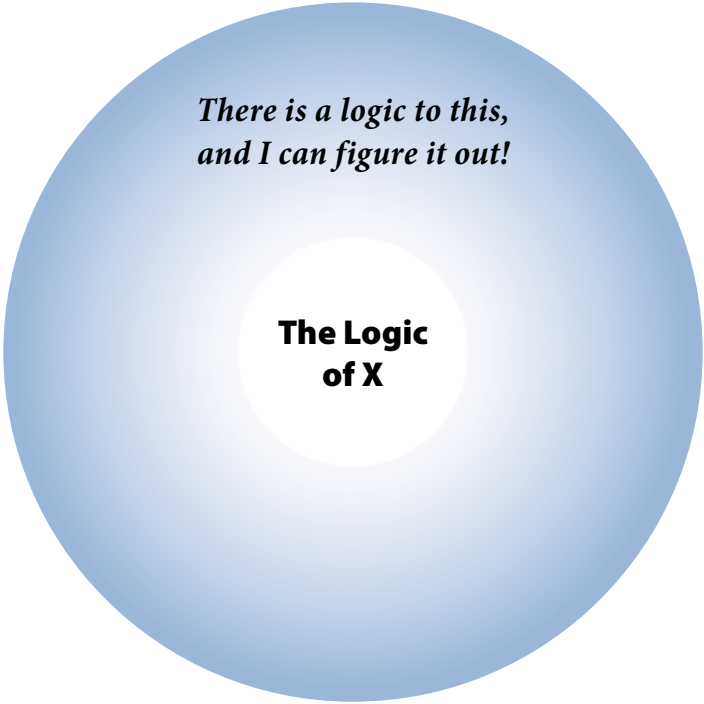
The characteristics of mind essential to fairminded critical thinking are interdependent. Each requires the others to advance reasoning to the highest levels of skill and justifiability. Consider *intellectual humility*: To become aware of the limits of your knowledge, you need the *intellectual courage* to face your prejudices and ignorance. To discover your own prejudices, in turn, you often must *intellectually empathize* with and *fairmindedly* reason within viewpoints with which you disagree. Achieving this end typically requires *intellectual perseverance* because learning to enter viewpoints that differ from your own can take significant effort, requiring you to work your way through misconceptions, uncover faulty assumptions you have been using in your thinking, and rework these assumptions to fit a more reasonable or logical picture of reality. This effort will not seem reasonable unless you have the necessary *confidence in reason* to believe you will not be tainted or “taken in” by false or misleading ideas in considering alternative views.

Furthermore, merely believing you won’t be harmed by considering “alien” viewpoints is not enough to motivate most people to consider them seriously. You also must be motivated by an *intellectual sense of justice*. You must recognize an *intellectual responsibility* to be fair to views you oppose. You must feel obliged to hear them in their strongest form to ensure that you are not condemning them out of ignorance or bias.

See if you can write out your own description of how the intellectual virtues interrelate. There are many ways to articulate these interrelationships. What is most important is that you clearly understand each virtue, that you see them existing in relationship with one another, and that you consistently and persistently work to cultivate and embody them in your own thinking.

The Spirit of Critical Thinking

Critical thinkers have confidence in their ability to figure out the logic of anything they choose. They continually look for interrelationships and order within systems of ideas. They use the tools of critical thinking every day to improve their thinking, thereby improving their lives.



*There is a logic to this,
and I can figure it out!*

**The Logic
of X**

Template for Analyzing the Logic of an Article

Use this template to deconstruct any article, essay,
or chapter of a textbook.

The Logic of “(name of the article)”

- 1) The main purpose of this article is _____.
(State as accurately as possible the author's purpose for writing the article.)
- 2) The key question that the author is addressing is _____.
(Figure out the key question in the mind of the author when s/he wrote the article.)
- 3) The most important information in this article is _____.
(Figure out the facts, experiences, and data the author is using to support her/his conclusions.)
- 4) The main inferences/conclusions in this article are _____.
(Identify the key conclusions the author comes to and presents in the article.)
- 5) The key concept(s) we need to understand in this article is (are) _____.
By these concepts, the author means _____.
(Figure out the most important ideas you would have to understand in order to understand the author's line of reasoning.)
- 6) The main assumption(s) underlying the author's thinking is (are) _____.
(Figure out what the author is taking for granted [that might be questioned].)
- 7a) If we take this line of reasoning seriously, the implications are _____.
(What consequences are likely to follow if people take the author's line of reasoning seriously?)
- 7b) If we fail to take this line of reasoning seriously, the implications are _____.
(What consequences are likely to follow if people ignore the author's reasoning?)
- 8) The main point(s) of view presented in this article is (are) _____.
(What is the author looking at, and how is s/he seeing it?)

Criteria for Evaluating Reasoning

- 1) **Purpose:** What is the purpose of the reasoner? Is the purpose clearly stated or clearly implied? Is it justifiable?
- 2) **Question:** Is the question at issue well stated? Is it clear and unbiased? Does the expression of the question do justice to the complexity of the matter at issue? Are the question and purpose directly relevant to each other?
- 3) **Information:** Does the writer cite relevant evidence, experiences, and/or information essential to the issue? Is the information accurate? Does the writer address the complexities of the issue? Does the writer distort any information or use false information to serve a given interest?
- 4) **Concepts:** Does the writer clarify key concepts when necessary? Are the concepts used justifiably? Is the writer aware of the concepts that s/he is using in reasoning through the issue?
- 5) **Assumptions:** Does the writer show a sensitivity to what s/he is taking for granted or assuming (insofar as those assumptions might reasonably be questioned)? Does the writer use questionable assumptions without addressing problems that might be inherent in those assumptions?
- 6) **Inferences:** Does the writer develop a logical line of reasoning, detailing how s/he arrived at the main conclusions?
- 7) **Point of View:** Does the writer show sensitivity to alternative relevant points of view or lines of reasoning? Does s/he consider and respond to objections framed from other relevant points of view?
- 8) **Implications:** Does the writer show a sensitivity to the implications and consequences of the position s/he is taking?

A Template for Problem-Solving

To be an effective problem solver:

- 1) Figure out, and regularly re-articulate, your goals, purposes, and needs. Recognize problems as obstacles to reaching your goals, achieving your purposes, or satisfying your needs.
- 2) Wherever possible, take problems one by one. State each problem as clearly and precisely as you can.
- 3) Study the problem to determine the “kind” of problem you are dealing with. For example, what do you have to do to solve it?
- 4) Distinguish problems over which you have some control from problems over which you have no control. Concentrate your efforts on problems you can potentially solve.
- 5) Figure out the information you need to solve the problem. Actively seek that information.
- 6) Carefully analyze and interpret the information you collect, drawing reasonable inferences.
- 7) Determine your options for action. What can you do in the short term? In the long term? Recognize your limitations in terms of money, time, and power.
- 8) Evaluate your options, determining their advantages and disadvantages.
- 9) Adopt a strategy. Follow through on it. This may involve direct action or a carefully thought-through wait-and-see approach.
- 10) When you act, monitor the implications of your action. Be ready to revise your strategy if the situation requires it. Be prepared to change your analysis or statement of the problem as more information about the problem becomes available.

Analyzing and Assessing Research

Many research projects are ill defined and focus on a topic rather than an issue or set of issues to be reasoned through. To keep reasoning at the heart of any research you are doing or evaluating, use the following guidelines. They are based in the elements of reasoning and intellectual standards.

1) All research has a fundamental **PURPOSE** and goal.

- Research purposes and goals should be clearly stated.
- Related purposes should be explicitly distinguished.
- All segments of the research should be relevant to the purpose.
- All research purposes should be realistic and significant.

2) All research addresses a fundamental **QUESTION, problem, or issue**.

- The fundamental question at issue should be clearly and precisely stated.
- Related questions should be articulated and distinguished.
- All segments of the research should be relevant to the central question.
- All research questions should be realistic and significant.
- All research questions should define clearly stated intellectual tasks that, once fulfilled, will settle the questions.

3) All research identifies data, **INFORMATION**, and evidence relevant to its fundamental question and purpose.

- All information used should be clear, accurate, and relevant to the fundamental question at issue.
- Information gathered must be sufficient to settle the question at issue.
- Information contrary to the main conclusions of the research should be explained.

4) All research contains INFERENCES or interpretations by which conclusions are drawn.

- All conclusions should be clear, accurate, and relevant to the key question at issue.
- Conclusions drawn should not go beyond what the data imply.
- Conclusions should be consistent and reconcile discrepancies in the data.
- Conclusions should explain how the key questions at issue have been settled.

5) All research is conducted from some POINT OF VIEW or frame of reference.

- All points of view in the research should be identified.
- Objections from competing points of view should be identified and fairly addressed.

6) All research is based on ASSUMPTIONS.

- Clearly identify and assess major assumptions in the research.
- Explain how the assumptions shape the research point of view.

7) All research is expressed through, and shaped by, CONCEPTS and ideas.

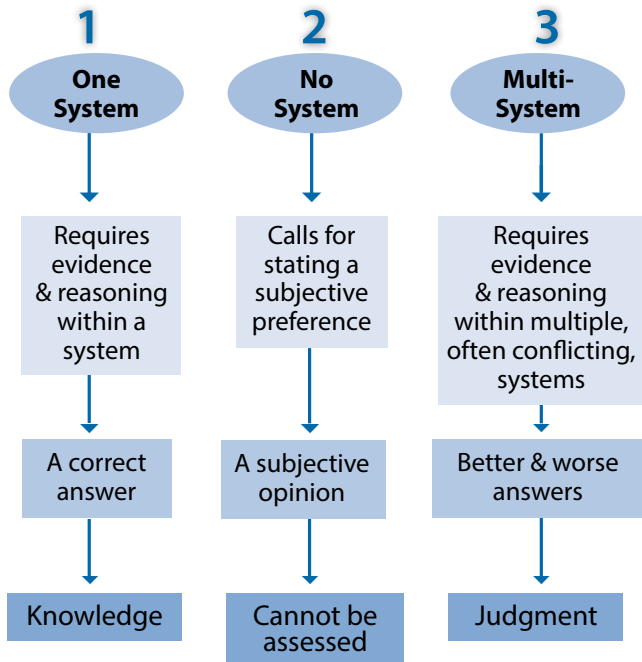
- Assess for clarity the key concepts in the research.
- Assess the significance of the key concepts in the research.

8) All research leads somewhere (i.e., has IMPLICATIONS and consequences).

- Trace the implications and consequences that follow from the research.
- Search for negative as well as positive implications.
- Consider all significant implications and consequences.

Three Kinds of Questions

In approaching a question, it is useful to figure out what type it is. Is it a question with one definitive answer? Is it a question that calls for a subjective choice? Or does the question require you to consider competing points of view?



There are a number of useful ways to categorize questions for the purpose of analysis. One powerful way is to focus on the type of reasoning required by the question.

Questions of Procedure (established or one system): These include questions with an established procedure or method for finding the answer. These questions are settled by facts, by definition, or both. They are prominent in mathematics, as well as the physical and biological sciences. Examples:

- What is the boiling point of lead?
- What is the size of this room?
- What is the differential of this equation?
- What is the sum of 659 and 979?

Questions of Preference (no system or personal system): Questions with as many answers as there are different human preferences (a category in which subjective taste rules). Examples:

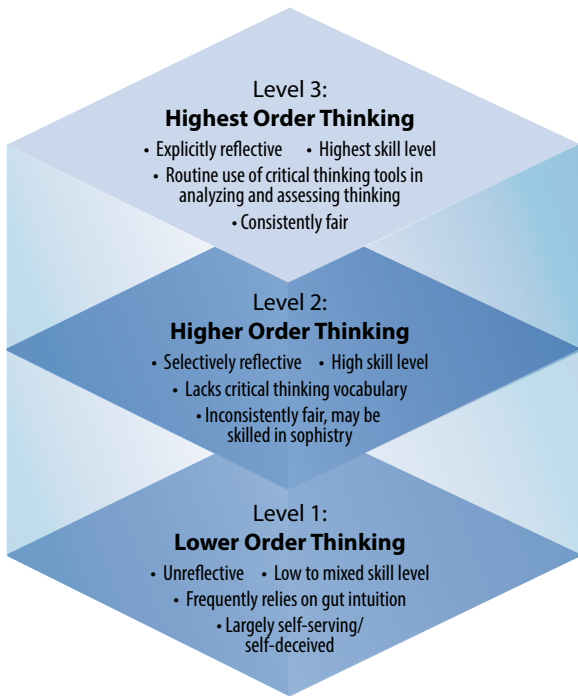
- Which would you prefer: a vacation in the mountains or one at the seashore?
- Do you like to go to the opera? Which is your favorite?
- What color scheme do you prefer in your house?

Questions of Judgment (conflicting systems): Questions requiring reasoning, but with more than one arguable answer. These are questions with better-or-worse answers (well supported and reasoned or poorly supported and/or poorly reasoned). We evaluate answers to these questions using intellectual standards such as clarity, accuracy, relevance, and so on. These questions are predominant in the human disciplines (history, philosophy, economics, sociology, art, etc.). Examples:

- How can we best address the most basic and significant economic problems of the nation today?
- What can be done to significantly reduce the number of people who become addicted to illegal drugs?
- How can we balance business interest and environmental preservation?
- Should capital punishment be abolished?

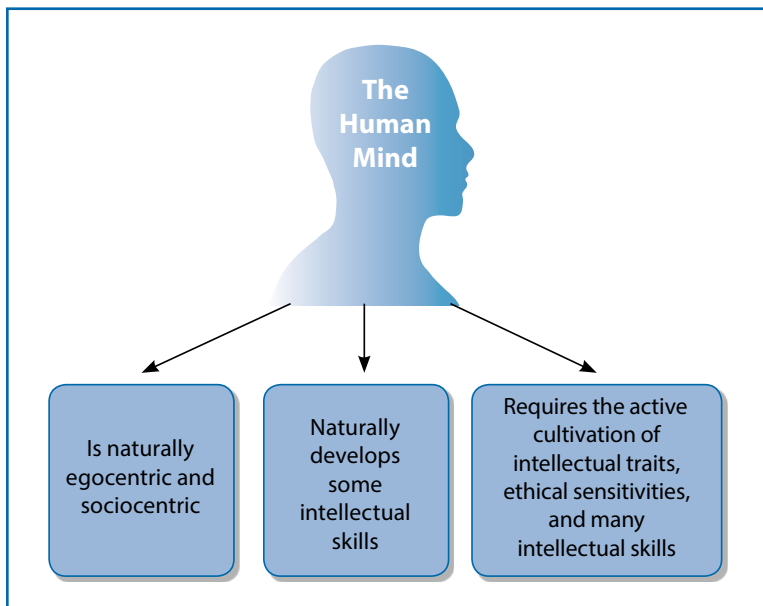
Three Levels of Thought

We may think of reasoning as occurring at three levels: lower order (entailing very few critical thinking skills), higher order (which is selectively or partially skilled and is only inconsistently fair, if at all), and then highest order (which is both highly skilled and fair). To think at the highest level of quality, we need not only intellectual skills but also intellectual virtues. It is only through cultivating intellectual virtues that reasoning moves to the highest order.

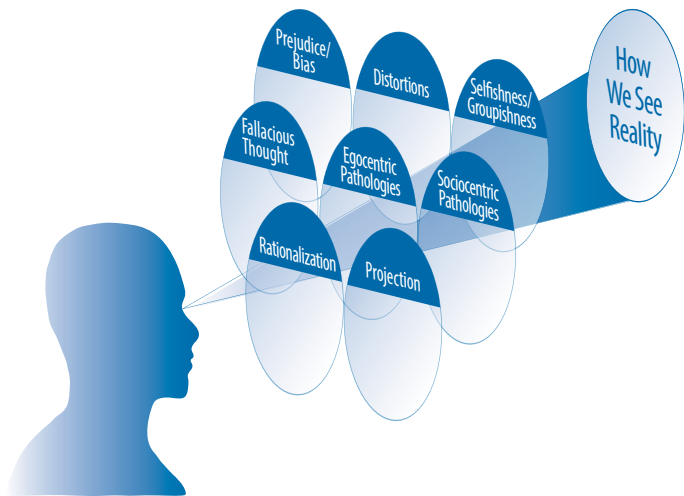


The Human Mind Is Frequently Irrational While Having the Capacity for Rational Thought

All humans are innately egocentric and sociocentric. Humans also have (largely undeveloped) rational capacities. Humans begin life as primarily egocentric creatures. Over time, infantile egocentric self-centered thinking merges with sociocentric group-centered thinking. All humans regularly engage in both forms of irrational thought. The extent to which any of us is egocentric or sociocentric is a matter of degree and can change significantly in various situations or contexts. While egocentric and sociocentric propensities are naturally occurring phenomena, rational capacities must be largely developed. It is through the development of rational capacities that we combat irrational tendencies and cultivate critical societies.



Humans Often Distort Reality Through Irrational Lenses



When engaging in irrational pursuits, the mind must deceive itself; it relies on pathologies of thought to do this. The pathologies of thought can be pictured as a set of filters or lenses that:

- cause or enable us to see the world according to our perceived interests, without regard to others;
- distort reality so we can get what we want; and
- lead us to ignore relevant information to paint a favored picture of the world, based on our vested interests.

These pathologies allow us to deceive ourselves into believing what we want to believe (in order to get what we want or maintain our viewpoint). Pathologies of thought, hence, serve their master—self-deception. They are manifest in both egocentric and sociocentric thought.

The Problem of Egocentric Thinking

Egocentric thinking results from the unfortunate fact that humans do not naturally consider the rights and needs of others. We do not naturally appreciate the point of view of others or the limitations in our own point of view. We become explicitly aware of our egocentric thinking only if trained to do so. We do not naturally recognize our egocentric assumptions, the egocentric way we use information, the egocentric way we interpret data, the source of our egocentric concepts and ideas, or the implications of our egocentric thought. We do not naturally recognize our self-serving perspective.

As humans we live with the unrealistic but confident sense that we have fundamentally figured out the way things actually are, and that we have done this objectively. We naturally believe in our intuitive perceptions, however inaccurate they may be. Instead of using intellectual standards in thinking, we often use self-centered psychological standards to determine what to believe and what to reject. Here are the most commonly used psychological standards in human thinking.

"IT'S TRUE BECAUSE I BELIEVE IT" Innate egocentrism: I assume that what I believe is true even though I have never questioned the basis for many of my beliefs.

"IT'S TRUE BECAUSE WE BELIEVE IT" Innate sociocentrism: I assume that the dominant beliefs of the groups to which I belong are true even though I have never questioned the basis for those beliefs.

"IT'S TRUE BECAUSE I WANT TO BELIEVE IT" Innate wish fulfillment: I believe in whatever puts me (or the groups to which I belong) in a positive light. I believe what "feels good," what does not require me to change my thinking in any significant way and/or what does not require me to admit I have been wrong.

"IT'S TRUE BECAUSE I HAVE ALWAYS BELIEVED IT" Innate self-validation: I have a strong desire to maintain beliefs that I have long held, even though I have not seriously considered the extent to which those beliefs are justified by the evidence.

"IT'S TRUE BECAUSE IT IS IN MY BEST INTEREST TO BELIEVE IT" Innate selfishness: I believe whatever justifies my getting more power, money, or personal advantage even though these beliefs are not grounded in sound reasoning or evidence.

Feelings That Accompany Egocentrism

These are some of the many feelings that might accompany egocentric thinking. They often occur when egocentric thinking is “unsuccessful.” Note that some of these emotions may be concomitant with rational thought—depending on the context and particulars in a given case.

When egocentric thinking is successful in getting what it wants, positive feelings accompany it. But when egocentric thinking is not able to achieve its purposes, negative feelings result.



The Problem of Sociocentric Thinking

Most people do not understand the degree to which they have uncritically internalized the dominant prejudices of their society or culture. Sociologists and anthropologists identify this condition as the state of being “culture bound.” This phenomenon is caused by sociocentric thinking, which includes:

- The uncritical tendency to place one’s culture, nation, and/or religion above all others.
- The uncritical tendency to select self-serving positive descriptions of ourselves and negative descriptions of those who think differently from us.
- The uncritical tendency to internalize group norms and beliefs, take on group identities, and act as we are expected to act—without the least sense that what we are doing might reasonably be questioned.
- The tendency to blindly conform to group restrictions (many of which are arbitrary or coercive).
- The failure to think beyond the traditional prejudices of one’s culture.
- The failure to study and internalize the insights of other cultures (improving thereby the breadth and depth of one’s thinking).
- The failure to distinguish universal ethics from relativistic cultural requirements and taboos.
- The failure to realize that mass media in every culture shapes the news from the point of view of that culture.
- The failure to think historically and anthropologically (and hence to be trapped in current ways of thinking).
- The failure to see sociocentric thinking as a significant impediment to intellectual development.

Sociocentric thinking is a hallmark of an uncritical society. It can be diminished only when replaced by cross-cultural, fairminded thinking—critical thinking in the strong sense.

Primary Forms of Sociocentric Thought

Consider four distinct forms of sociocentric thought. These forms function and are manifest in complex relationships with one another; all are destructive.¹ They can be summarized as follows:

1. **Groupishness² (or group selfishness)**—the tendency on the part of groups to seek the most for the in-group without regard to the rights and needs of others, in order to advance the group's biased interests. Groupishness is almost certainly the primary tendency in sociocentric thinking, the foundational driving force behind it (probably connected to survival in our dim dark past). Everyone in the group is privileged; everyone outside the group is denied group privileges and/or seen as a potential threat.
2. **Group validation**—the tendency on the part of groups to believe their way is the right way and their views are the correct views; the tendency to reinforce one another in these beliefs; the inclination to validate the group's views, however dysfunctional or illogical. These may be long-held or newly established views, but in either case, they are perceived by the group to be true and, in many cases, to advance its interests. This tendency informs the worldview from which everyone outside the group is seen and understood and by which everything that happens outside the group is judged. It leads to the problem of in-group thinking and behavior—everyone inside the group thinks within a collective logic; everyone outside the group is judged according to the standards and beliefs of the in-group.

¹ The term "sociocentric thought" is reserved for those group beliefs that cause harm or are likely to cause harm. Group thought that is reasonable, useful, or helpful would not fall into this category.

² By groupishness, we mean group selfishness. This term refers to group pursuit of its interests without sufficient regard for the rights and needs of those outside the group. Its counterpart is selfishness, which refers to individual pursuit of one's interests without sufficient regard for the rights and needs of others.

3. **Group control**—the tendency on the part of groups to ensure that group members behave in accordance with group expectations. This logic guides the intricate inner workings of the group, largely through enforcement, ostracism, and punishment in connection with group customs, conventions, rules, taboos, mores, and laws. Group control can also take the form of “recruitment” through propaganda and other forms of manipulation. It is often sophisticated and camouflaged.
4. **Group conformity**—a byproduct of the fact that in order to survive, people must figure out how to fit themselves into the groups they are thrust into or voluntarily choose to join. They must conform to the rules and laws set down by those in control. Dissenters are punished in numerous ways. Group control and group conformity are two sides of the same coin—each presupposes the other.

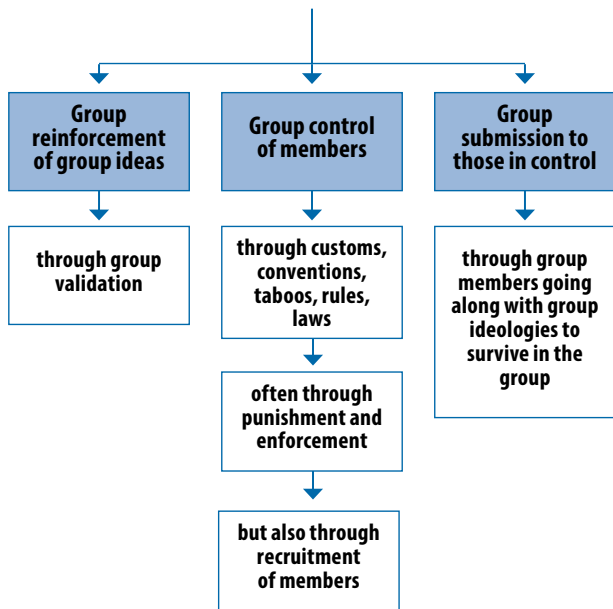
These four sociocentric tendencies interrelate and overlap in any number of ways and thus should be understood as four parts of an interconnected puzzle.

Sociocentric tendencies largely lie at the unconscious level. It isn't that people are aware of these tendencies and consciously choose to go along with them. Rather, these dispositions are, at least to some extent, hidden by self-deception, rationalization, and other native mechanisms of the mind that keep us from seeing and facing the truth in our thoughts and actions. The mind tells itself one thing on the surface (e.g., we are being fair to all involved) when in fact it is acting upon a different thought entirely (e.g., we are mainly concerned with our own interests). In most instances, the mind can find ways to justify itself—even when engaging in highly unethical acts.

It should be pointed out that there are many circumstances in which rational behavior might be confused with sociocentric behavior. For instance, group members may well validate among themselves views that are reasonable. Groups should also expect group members to behave in ethical ways.

Unethical Pursuit of Group Agendas

Focused on getting the most for a group, Groupishness (or Group Selfishness) is driven by these sociocentric forces:



Groupishness, to be effectively achieved, requires group reinforcement, group control, and group submission. This diagram begins to illuminate the complex relationships among the four primary forms of sociocentric thought.

Envisioning Critical Societies

The critical habit of thought, if usual in society, will pervade all its mores, because it is a way of taking up the problems of life. Men educated in it cannot be stampeded by stump orators. . . . They are slow to believe. They can hold things as possible or probable in all degrees, without certainty and without pain. They can wait for evidence and weigh evidence, uninfluenced by the emphasis or confidence with which assertions are made on one side or the other. They can resist appeals to their dearest prejudices and all kinds of cajolery. Education in the critical faculty is the only education of which it can be truly said that it makes good citizens.

William Graham Sumner, 1906

Humans have the capacity to be rational and fair, but this capacity must be cultivated. It will be significantly developed only if critical societies emerge. Critical societies will develop only to the extent that:

- Critical thinking is viewed as essential to living a reasonable and fairminded life.
- Critical thinking is routinely taught and consistently fostered.
- The problematics of thinking are an abiding concern.
- Closed-mindedness is systemically discouraged; open-mindedness is systematically encouraged.
- Intellectual integrity, intellectual humility, intellectual empathy, confidence in reason, and intellectual courage are social values.
- Egocentric and sociocentric thinking are recognized as a bane in social life.
- Children are routinely taught that the rights and needs of others are equal to their own.
- A multicultural worldview is fostered.
- People are encouraged to think for themselves and discouraged from uncritically accepting the thinking or behavior of others.
- People routinely study and diminish irrational thought.
- People internalize universal intellectual standards.

If we want critical societies, we must create them.

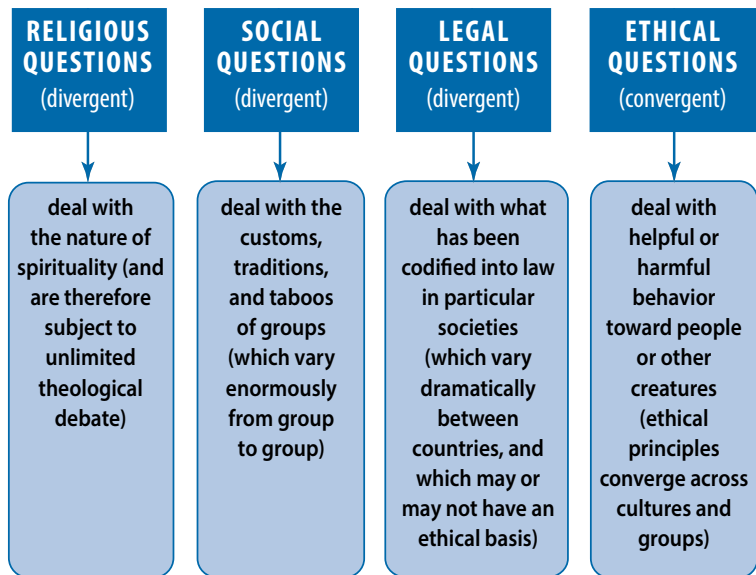
20 BARRIERS TO CRITICAL SOCIETIES

To illustrate the fact that we as humans tend not to take thinking seriously in today's cultures, consider the following 20 barriers to critical societies. Most people:

1. are only superficially aware of critical thinking.
2. cannot clearly articulate the ideal of critical thinking, know of it only as a positive buzz term, and, in any case, habitually violate its standards in multiple ways. Most humans, in other words, have not aspired to the ideal of critical thought, and most who have done so (having only an implicit idea of it) have succeeded only modestly.
3. uncritically accept the traditional, mainstream views and beliefs of their culture.
4. are "culture bound" (enslaved within social conventions).
5. uncritically accept the views of authority figures.
6. are not aware of, and do not attempt to explicitly use, intellectual standards in their thinking.
7. do not understand human thinking (their own or others') or the impediments to reasonability.
8. (unconsciously) believe much that is arbitrary or irrational.
9. uncritically accept bureaucratic rules, procedures, and formulas.
10. accept a variety of forms of authoritarianism (such as blindly following a religious ideology).
11. are uncreative and unoriginal.
12. are trapped in their social class.
13. never come to think well within any subject and have no sense of what it is to think beyond subject-matter compartments.
14. do not believe in freedom of thought and speech or in a wide range of other inalienable freedoms.
15. are biased on questions of gender, culture, species, and politics.
16. use their intellects only superficially.
17. have little command over their primitive emotions and desires; rather, they tend to be at the mercy of their own irrational impulses and passions.
18. do not value true spontaneity, naturalness, or artlessness.
19. are unable and/or unwilling to think within the viewpoints of others who hold a different worldview.
20. are unable to achieve self-actualization, self-command, or enlightenment because they lack command of their thoughts, as well as understanding of the relationship between thoughts and emotions.

It Is Essential to Distinguish Among Questions of Ethics, Social Conventions, Religion, and the Law

If we hope for fairminded critical societies in the long run, the majority of humans will need to distinguish between ethics and other, distinctly different, modes of thinking that are currently confused with ethics across human societies. Though overlap exists between these diverse modes of thought, it is essential to understand the ways in which they are markedly dissimilar. Most important, ethical reasoning must be disconnected from other modes of thought so that one can then turn to, and internalize, principles most proper for use in reasoning through ethical questions or problems.



Any given religious, social, or legal edict or practice may, or may not, be ethical in orientation. If we are ever to reach a point in human development where skilled ethical reasoning is the norm, each of us must cultivate in ourselves the ability to determine whether any belief system, practice, rule, or law is ethical. Being skilled in ethical reasoning means developing a conscience not subservient to fluctuating social conventions, theological systems, or unethical laws.

As we face problems in our lives, we must distinguish the ethical from the unethical (or the pseudo-ethical), and we must routinely apply ethical principles to those problems that are genuinely ethical in nature. The more often we do so, the better we become at ethical reasoning.

THE COMPETING VALUES ASSESSMENT OVERVIEW



**Competing
Values**

BRIEF BACKGROUND OF THE COMPETING VALUES FRAMEWORK (CVF)

The Competing Values Framework (CVF) emerged over twenty-five years ago during research about organizational effectiveness and organizational culture and has since been validated by numerous studies. The concept of “organizational effectiveness” is deceptively simple to understand. How do we know if one organization is more effective than another? In order to answer this question, it is necessary to consider that not all organizations and organizational leaders will reach a consensus on what it means for their organization to be effective. Furthermore, how do we assess the culture of an organization and know if one organization’s culture differs from that of another organization?

Organizational leaders regularly confront issues such as how to be innovative, how to organize and deploy resources, and how to collectively grow and change as a system. Leaders must then determine how to confront these and other issues while recognizing that “effectively” doing so within the scope of an organizational culture requires an awareness of the everyday tensions that exist within their organizations. Thus, these competing positive tensions comprise the Competing Values Framework.

The horizontal axis (x-axis) of the CVF indicates a tension in organizational focus as represented in a contrast between internal and person-oriented focus (toward the left) and external and organization-oriented focus (toward the right). The vertical axis (y-axis) indicates a tension in differing perspectives on organizational structure as represented in a contrast between an interest in flexibility and change (toward the top) and an interest in stability and control (toward the bottom). Each quadrant has two complementary quadrants (those on either side of it), and one quadrant to which it is highly contrasted (the one directly diagonal to it).

CVF AND ORGANIZATIONAL OUTCOMES

The assessment questionnaire has been developed around the CVF to illustrate three dimensions—the future outcomes (*Purposes*) that a company desires to achieve; current organizational *Practices*; and the individual leadership approach of each respective organizational member (*People*). Research shows that companies that are aligned among the dimensions of *Purposes*, *Practices*, and *People* are much more effective than companies without such alignment. The CVF illustrates the different tensions in the

LEADING INNOVATION & GROWTH (LIG) SERIES



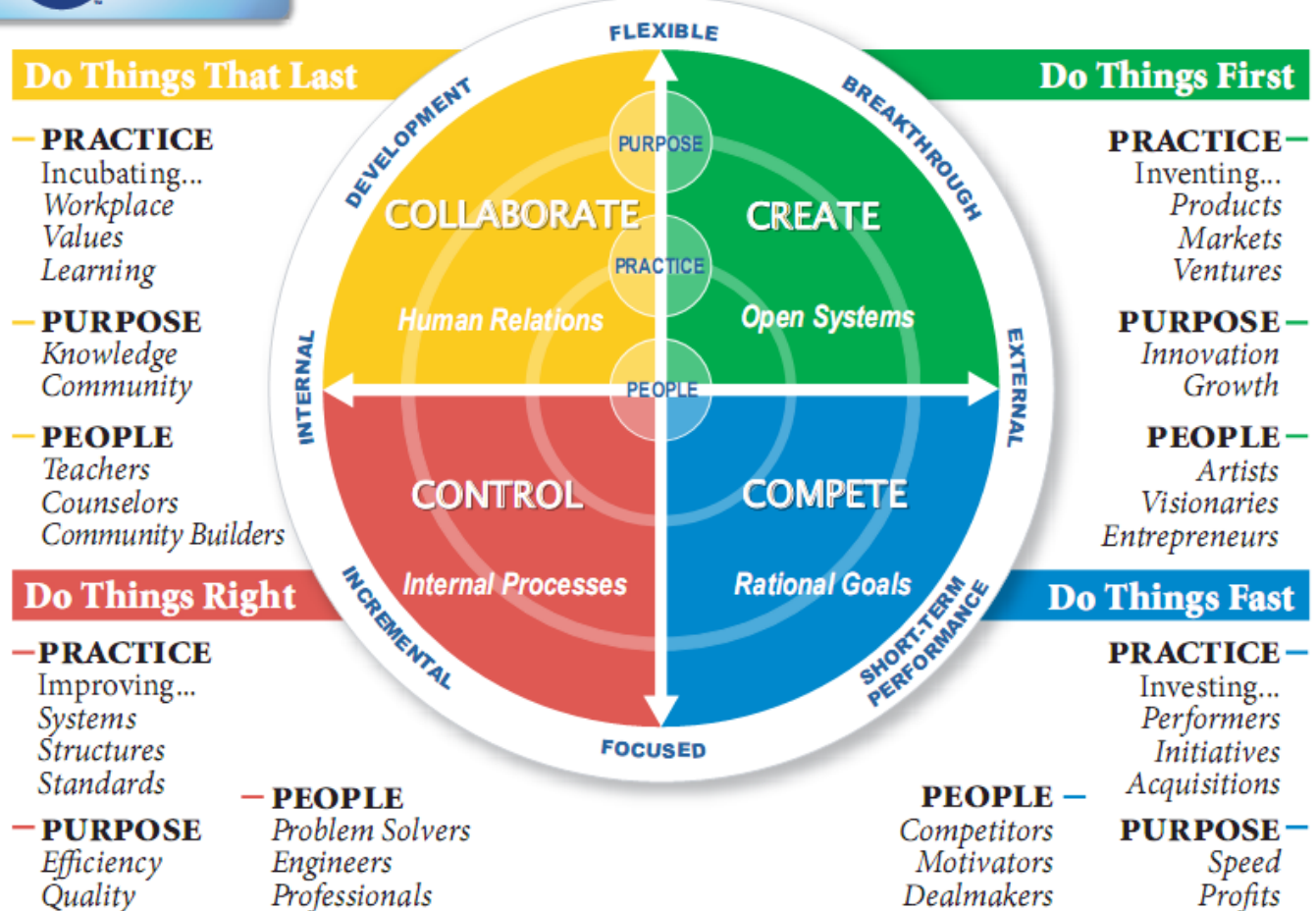
LIG 1—Leading Innovation Enterprise Program
LIG 2—Shared Vision & Jumpstart Program
LIG 3—Black Belt Development Program
LIG 4—Innovation & Growth Summit
LIG 5—Competing Values Assessment

This series follows the principles of the Competing Values Framework (CVF). The result of over 25 years of academic research and testing, the CVF is a broadly applicable model that fosters successful leadership, improves organizational effectiveness and promotes value creation. The premise of the CVF is that there are four basic competing values within every enterprise: Collaborate, Create, Compete and Control. These values compete in a very real sense for a corporation’s limited resources (funding, time, and people). How leadership responds to the tension created between these competing values will shape a company’s culture, practices, products, and ultimately, how they innovate and grow. Recognized by the *Financial Times* as one of the 40 most important frameworks in the history of business, the CVF has been implemented by hundreds of companies.

TO LEARN MORE

Visit www.CompetingValues.com or contact the Competing Values Company directly at Info@CompetingValues.com or 734-604-1012.

COMPETING VALUES™ FRAMEWORK



way in which effectiveness can be defined. A key message of the CVF is that despite the different ways for defining organizational effectiveness, it is important that companies are appropriately aligned in their respective definition of effectiveness. Once aligned, companies can find their innovation sweet spot and achieve the growth outcomes that they desire.

USES OF THE COMPETING VALUES ASSESSMENT

Individual Level

- ▶ Personal development.
- ▶ Career planning.

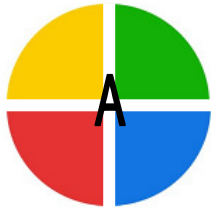
Team Level

- ▶ Team Development.
- ▶ Creating a shared vision and shared values

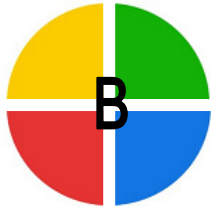
Once the members of your entire company or strategic business unit complete the *Competing Values Assessment*, the aggregated assessment results can be compared to industry competitors by using the *Competing Values Innovation Index*. This index (an industry-specific ranking of companies) enables leaders to quickly understand companies positioned for growth in the marketplace and how their company compares to the competition.

Additionally, the *Innovation Index* shows how adjustments along the quadrants of the Competing Values Framework will yield revenue to the company. These yields are based on over a decade's worth of validated statistical analysis, which demonstrates the value of the CVF for predicting financial performance.

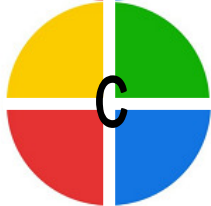
THE ASSESSMENT EVALUATES THREE APPROACHES TO CHANGE, INNOVATION, AND GROWTH...



PURPOSES – *Outcomes*, or value the organization intends to create.



PRACTICES – Culture, competency, and processes of *the organization*.



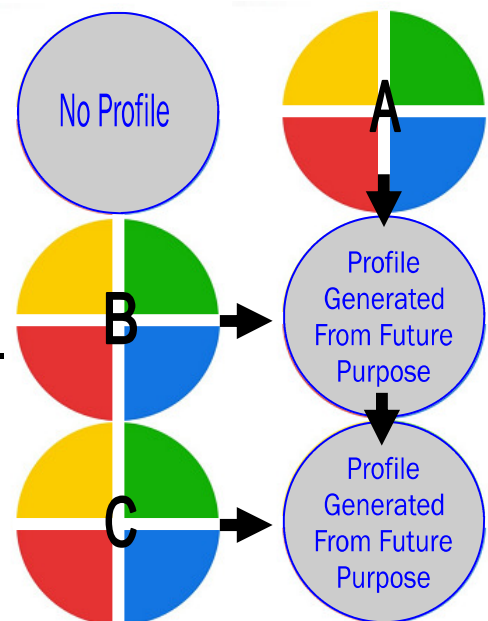
PEOPLE – *You*, and your personal values, as a leader and as an individual.

IT THEN ALIGNS BEHAVIORS AND PRACTICES WITH DESIRED RESULTS

PURPOSES – *Outcomes*, or value the organization intends to create.

PRACTICES – Culture, competency, and processes of *the organization*.

PEOPLE – *You*, and your personal values, as a leader and as an individual.



IF YOU ARE A “YELLOW” (COLLABORATE QUADRANT)...

The Collaborate quadrant is a human relations model that emphasizes cohesion, morale, human resources, and training. This quadrant represents a cross between an internal, person-oriented focus and a flexible, change-oriented organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant nurture their people, cultivate human capital, and are adaptive in their actions in that they focus on long-term development.

Leader types: Facilitator, mentor, and team builder.

Value drivers: Commitment, communication, and development.

Theory of effectiveness: Human development and high commitment produce effectiveness.

Culture type: Clan.

Metrics associated with the Collaborate quadrant:

- Knowledge—Future growth values, the difference between the firm’s current market value and its market value if its profits did not grow.
- Community—Sales divided by the number of employees.

Advantages to being anchored in this quadrant:

- People are highly valued and leadership is internally cultivated.
- Human capital yields organizational success.
- The organization focuses on the long-term.

Drawbacks to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Taken to an extreme, organizations resemble a country club.
- Projects are slow to produce outcomes.
- Goals become moving targets and focus suffers.

How the Collaborate quadrant relates to the other quadrants:

- Complements the Create and Control quadrants.
- Contrasts with the Compete quadrant.

TABLE 1 – THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE COLLABORATE QUADRANT AND THE OTHER CVF QUADRANTS

Collaborate	If <u>you</u> are a “Yellow”	If <u>your team</u> is “Yellow”	If <u>your business unit</u> is “Yellow”	If <u>your firm</u> is “Yellow”
Then...	You will create value through your commitment to teaching and mentoring others.	Value is created through the team’s commitment to nurturing learning among team members.	Value is created through commitment to fostering organizational learning.	Value is created when human capital and organizational knowledge are nurtured to create sustainable competitive advantage.
And you work with “Reds” (Control), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when you place a collective emphasis on learning to do things the right way.	Your team will create value with other teams when best practices for doing things the right way are shared.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units when structured learning systems are built and shared.	Your firm will create value with other firms through the nurturing of long-term and trusting relationships that build industry specific knowledge and practices.
And you work with “Greens” (Create), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when you collectively try new things, generate new ideas, and mutually learn what works and what doesn’t work in a supportive manner.	Your team will successfully create value with other teams by collaborating on creative projects in order to learn about things that work and things that don’t work as well as ways to improve.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units when large-scale innovation projects are launched and nurtured for long-term success.	Your firm will create value with other firms through innovative, long-term joint ventures when the objective of the venture is to generate new industry knowledge.
And you work with “Blues” (Compete), then...	The difficulties in your relationship with these individuals will center on matters of individual deadlines and responsibilities. Make sure to let the others set deadlines, but take a leading role in clarifying details and encouraging positive communication about mutual responsibilities.	Your team will have a difficult time agreeing on mutual objectives with other teams. Your team’s objectives might seem vague to the other team, and the other team’s objectives might appear to be doing too much. Push your own team to be more concrete, and use the language of the other team’s objectives in the articulation your own objectives.	Your business unit will have a difficult time with other units because of a disconnect over matters of speed toward completion as well as specific project objectives. Keep your business unit focused on setting realistic objectives that balance the need for speed with the need to learn what works and what doesn’t work while maintaining strong communication.	Your firm will find it difficult to establish deep trust with other firms because of a disconnect over the speed at which collaboration should occur and the time it takes to establish trust. To overcome this, focus the relationship toward a specific project. Set realistic project deadlines and use the various project steps as checkpoints for issues of trust.

TABLE 2 – COLLABORATE QUADRANT METRICS AND OUTCOMES

Collaborate Quadrant		
	Community...	Knowledge...
Key performance metrics	Sales, divided by the number of employees.	Future growth values - the difference between the firm's current market value and its market value if its profits did not grow.
Additional metrics	- Employee satisfaction and morale surveys. - Employee turnover rate. - Turnover rate due to poor performance. - Absence rate. - Reduction in employee grievances and complaints. - Headcount as a percentage of forecasted needs. - Job posting response rate. - Percent of accepted job offers. - Percent of promoted employees. - Customer satisfaction survey ratings.	- Percentage of fulfilled training requirements. - Number of training days per employee. - Training expenditures as a percentage of the operating budget. - Training investment per employee. - Percentage of employees with a career development plan. - Number of approved employee suggestions. - Number of best practices communicated and applied across departments. - Skill targets achieved. - Impact and value evaluation of training and development. - Average experience level of personnel.
To achieve Community and/or Knowledge, your organization should nurture...	- Workforce commitment. - Shared values. - Inclusion. - Teamwork. - High-performing culture. - Employee motivation.	- Workforce competence. - Continuous learning. - Employee retention. - Employee support. - Advancements in knowledge. - Requisite variety of knowledge for adapting to uncertainties.
Companies that emphasize Community and/or Knowledge, have a tendency to...	Focus on internal capabilities and the long-term development of culture.	Focus on situational adaptability and the long-term development of culture.
When your company excels at nurturing Community and/or Knowledge, it does so by...	- Focusing on internal maintenance. - Focusing on people. - Productivity through workforce motivation, shared values and inclusion. - Teamwork and consensus. - Developing a strong culture over time.	- Focusing on internal maintenance. - Focusing on people. - Exploiting latent competencies and growth-relevant knowledge. - Being a great place to work and fostering employee satisfaction. - Building organizational development strategies.
Companies that emphasize Community and/or Knowledge, have organizational cultures characterized by...	- Friendly atmosphere. - Participation. - Team goals. - Mentorship. - Shared values. - People-focus. - Customer communities. - Good communication.	- Information sharing. - Collaborative learning. - Dedicated masters-as-teachers. - Personal growth. - Long-term solution-building. - Diversity. - Organizational development practices. - Employee retention.
Individuals who excel at building Community and/or Knowledge, have the following leadership characteristics...	- Facilitator. - People oriented. - Consensus builder. - Tolerance for diversity. - Effective communicator. - Empathetic.	- Mentor. - Effective teacher. - Solution builder. - Tolerance for ideas. - Supportive.
When leading a culture that is oriented toward Community and/or Knowledge, avoid such blind spots as...	Assuming that peoples' beliefs are minor; allow adequate time to address concerns and to address attitudinal changes.	Assuming that the correct people, values, and skills are in place; keep an eye out for new talent, and do not settle for underperformance.
Avoid such culture blind spots as...	- Issue avoidance. - Overly eager participation. - Group think. - Slow reaction. - Inward and narrow outlook.	- Forsaking of the short term. - Slow reaction. - Soft feedback. - Inward and narrow outlook.
Avoid your personal blind spots that...	- Overemphasize people more than tasks. - Default to cliques. - Disregard metrics.	- Wanders through unnecessary knowledge. - Lacks focus. - Avoids direct confrontation.
When looking for examples of Community and/or Knowledge, consider...	- Mission/advocacy-based organizations. - Associations. - Family businesses. - Lifestyle organizations. - Partnerships.	- Mission/advocacy-based organizations. - Associations. - Family businesses. - Lifestyle organizations. - Partnerships.
Specifically...	McKinsey	Ericsson

IF YOU ARE A “GREEN” (CREATE QUADRANT)...

The Create quadrant is an open system model that can be described as organic, flat, loosely-coupled, matrix-oriented, and temporary. The Create quadrant represents a cross between an external, organization-oriented focus and a flexible, change-oriented organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant take risks, focus broadly about the big picture and big ideas, and are agile in their actions and the resources that they cultivate.

Leader types: Innovator, entrepreneur, and visionary.

Value drivers: Innovative outputs, transformation, and agility.

Theory of effectiveness: Innovativeness, vision, and constant change produce effectiveness.

Culture type: Adhocracy.

Metrics associated with the Create quadrant: Growth, sales growth, and innovation (idiosyncratic stock return risk—the difference between a company's actual returns and the portion of the returns that can be explained by co-movement with the overall market return).

Advantages to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Bold and breakthrough ideas frequently materialize.
- Flexibility and novelty yield organizational success.
- The organization focuses on the long-term.

Drawbacks to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Taken to an extreme, organizations become chaotic.
- Radical ideas are costly and often fail.
- Stretch goals are frequent and are often difficult to achieve.

How the Create quadrant relates to the other quadrants:

- Complements the Collaborate and Compete quadrants.
- Contrasts with the Control quadrant.

TABLE 3 – THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE CREATE QUADRANT AND THE OTHER CVF QUADRANTS

Create	If <u>you</u> are a “Green”	If <u>your team</u> is “Green”	If <u>your business unit</u> is “Green”	If <u>your firm</u> is “Green”
Then...	You will create value through your ability to turn creative risk into growth projects.	Value is created through the team's support of playfulness, divergent thinking, and risk.	Value is created through the creation of idea spaces and idea structures that support creativity and divergence.	Value is created through systems and cultures of risk-taking and divergence. Free-thinking projects are nurtured and provide a channel for growth.
And you work with “Yellows” (Collaborate), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when there is an emphasis on trying new things, coming up with new ideas, and learning from them in a supportive manner	Your team will successfully create value with other teams by collaborating on creative projects in order to learn about things that work and things that don't work as well as ways to improve.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units when large-scale innovation projects are launched and nurtured for long-term success.	Your firm will create value with other firms through innovative, long-term joint ventures when the objective of the venture is to generate new industry knowledge.
And you work with “Blues” (Compete), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when there is a mutual emphasis on generating attention (or cheerleading) for a common visible project.	Your team will create value with other teams when there is a mutual enthusiasm for launching new projects.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units when knowledge about stage-gating profitable, visible, growth-oriented projects is shared.	Your firm will create value with other firms when such a partnership generates capital for large, visible, and highly innovative, growth projects.
And you work with “Reds” (Control), then...	The difficulties in your relationship with these individuals will center on matters of risk. Your big ideas will likely be perceived as “risky” if they are not carefully shared. All projects have some degree of risk, so you must direct your efforts toward outlining reasonable risks and reasonably foreseeable rewards in an analytical way.	Your team will have a difficult time working with other teams because of disagreements about the nature of new ideas. Reds will challenge the functional feasibility of these ideas. In order to overcome this, make sure your team develops a proof of concept for the idea that addresses any issues of feasibility.	Your business unit will have a difficult time with other units because of conflicting perspectives on the ways in which the company should pursue new growth ideas. Both sides will have a difficult time balancing and evaluating functional risk and reward. Your business unit must recognize that risk is inevitable and present some creative ways in which it might be mitigated.	Your firm might find it challenging to partner with Control quadrant firms on a macro-level. Instead, look to these firms as a potential resource for specific capabilities, and try to form smaller scale alliances rather than larger scale joint ventures.

TABLE 4 – CREATE QUADRANT METRICS AND OUTCOMES

Create Quadrant		
	Innovation...	Growth...
Key performance metrics	Idiosyncratic stock return risk - the difference between a company's actual returns and the portion of the returns that can be attributed to the company's investment in innovation projects.	Sales growth.
Additional metrics	• Number of new products or services launched. • Number of new sources of revenue. • New products or services developed, as a percentage of sales. • Revenues derived from new products or services, as a percentage of total revenue. • ROI for new products or services. • R&D investment/Total expenditures. • Ratio of R&D expenditures in core research versus development of applications. • Diversity of innovation portfolio mix. • New product and service process pipeline flow rate. • New product and service survival rate.	• Growth in total sales. • Total market share against competitors. • Growth in sales by segment. • Growth in sales by channel. • Growth in sales by geography. • New market growth in sales. • Growth in sales through joint ventures. • Growth in sales through new applications of existing products and technology. • Measures of brand recognition. • Growth in sales per person.
To achieve Innovation and/or Growth, your organization should nurture...	• Product innovation. • Long term risk acceptance. • Exceptions. • Experimentation. • Change. • The ability to capitalize on changing innovation trends.	• Capacity to change. • Long term risk acceptance. • Vision of possibility. • Exploration. • Transforming emerging trends.
Companies that emphasize Innovation and/or Growth, have a tendency to...	Adapt and transform ideas through breakthrough channels.	Transform ideas through breakthrough channels both within the company and through external collaboration.
When your company excels at nurturing Innovation and/or Growth, it does so by...	• Creative crisis to overturn the status quo • Risk-seeking • Demanding flexibility and uniqueness • Attracting entrepreneurs • Seeking continual breakthroughs	• Demanding vision and future outlook • Focusing on new frontiers • Exploiting ambiguity • Succeeding through development and test scenarios • Transformation of opportunities
Companies that emphasize Innovation and/or Growth, have organizational cultures characterized by...	• Entrepreneurship. • Creative workspaces. • An ongoing acquisition of resources. • Individual freedoms. • Experimentation. • Ambiguity. • Risk.	• Adventure. • Curiosity. • Emergent opportunities. • Clear vision. • Trend following. • Confrontation of the unknown.
Individuals who excel at building Innovation and/or Growth, have the following leadership characteristics...	• Innovative. • Clever and creative. • Risk taking. • Learns from failure. • Experimentation. • Tolerance for ambiguity. • Abstract thinking.	• Visionary. • Future oriented. • Visualizes new outcomes. • Opportunistic. • Intuitive. • Risk taker.
When leading a culture that is oriented toward Innovation and/or Growth, avoid such blind spots as...	Assuming that continued success depends solely on continuous change; continuously weigh risks and rewards associated with potential change.	Assuming that the future is an extension of the present; expect that something will disrupt growth rates, and have a plan to confront such disruption.
Avoid such culture blind spots as...	• Excessive individualism. • Superficiality at the expense of complexity.	• Mismatched incentives. • Organizational disloyalty.
Avoid your personal blind spots that...	• Exhibit risky behavior. • Falls in love with ideas. • Micromanages. • Is unable to rally support.	• Is unable to produce viable ideas. • Is disloyal to the organization. • Micromanages. • Fails to adjust personal ideas and won't satisfy other objectives.
When looking for examples of Innovation and/or Growth, consider...	• Mature firms in a death cycle. • Start-up firms. • Design/creative businesses.	• Mature firms in a death cycle. • Start-up firms. • Design/creative businesses.
Specifically...	Google	Apple

IF YOU ARE A “BLUE” (COMPETE QUADRANT)...

The Compete quadrant is a rational goal model that emphasizes profit and bottom line measures and is underlined by the concept of rational action. The Compete quadrant represents a cross between an external, organization-oriented focus and a focused organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant do things quickly for immediate gain, focus heavily on bottom line measures of profitability, and relentlessly acquire resources that give them a competitive advantage.

Leader types: Hard-driver, competitor, and producer.

Value drivers: Market share, goal achievement, and profitability.

Theory of effectiveness: Aggressively competing and customer focus produce effectiveness.

Culture type: Market.

Metrics associated with the Create quadrant: Profit; Economic value added (EVA) – net operating profits after tax, minus a capital charge, where capital charge equals the firm’s weighted-average cost of capital, times net assets deployed; and speed (the change in a firm’s EVA growth rate from one year to the next, over a five-year time period).

Advantages to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Initiatives focus heavily on the needs of customers and shareholders.
- Planning and focus yield organizational success.
- Lucrative, short-term gains create value.

Drawbacks to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Taken to an extreme, organizations become sweat shops.
- Failures are not easily translated into learning opportunities.
- Competitive goals often lead to unsustainable behaviors.

How the Compete quadrant relates to the other quadrants:

- Complements the Create and Control quadrants.
- Contrasts with the Collaborate quadrant.

TABLE 5 – THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE COMPETE QUADRANT AND THE OTHER CVF QUADRANTS

Compete	If <u>you</u> are a “Blue”	If <u>your team</u> is “Blue”	If <u>your business unit</u> is “Blue”	If <u>your firm</u> is “Blue”
Then...	You will create value through your ability to get things done quickly and by meeting pre-scribed metrics.	Value is created when a team acts as a filtering mechanism for leaders and winners.	Value is created when it performs well enough against other business units in order to justify its existence within the organization.	Value is created through systems that position the firm to provide superior returns to shareholders relative to other competitors.
And you work with “Greens” (Create), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when there is a mutual emphasis on generating attention (or cheerleading) for a common visible project.	Your team will create value with other teams when there is a mutual enthusiasm for launching new projects.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units when knowledge about stage-gating profitable, visible, growth-oriented projects is shared.	Your firm will create value with other firms when such a partnership generates capital for large, visible, and highly innovative, growth projects.
And you work with “Reds” (Control), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when there is a mutual interest in minimizing some sort of risk.	Your team will create value with other teams when there is a mutually specific goal that minimizes risk and maximizes return on investment.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units through key projects with clear goals, timelines, responsibilities, and outcomes.	Your firm will create value with other firms when there are clear objectives for and resources available to mutual ventures. Ventures will be transaction based and will focus more on the outcome of the exchange rather than the exchange itself.
And you work with “Yellows” (Collaborate), then...	The difficulties in your relationship with these individuals will center on matters of individual deadlines and responsibilities. Make sure to allow adequate time for positive communication and the discussion of responsibilities, but take a leading role in setting reasonable targets and deliverables.	Your team will have a difficult time agreeing on mutual objectives with other teams. Your team’s objectives might seem too aggressive and unrealistic to the other team, and the other team’s objectives might seem too vague. Push your own team to set more realistic goals that allow some room for a reasonable amount of failure and learning.	Your business unit will have a difficult time with other units because of a disconnect over matters of speed toward completion as well as specific project objectives. Keep your business unit focused on setting realistic objectives that balance the need for speed with the need to learn what works and what doesn’t work while maintaining strong communication.	Your firm will find it difficult to make things happen quickly because of a disconnect over the speed at which collaboration should occur and the time it takes to establish trust. To overcome this, focus the relationship toward a specific project. Set realistic project deadlines and use the various project steps as checkpoints for issues of trust.

TABLE 6 – COMPETE QUADRANT METRICS AND OUTCOMES

Compete Quadrant		
	Speed...	Profits...
Key performance metrics	The change in a firm's Economic Value Added (EVA) growth rate from one year to the next, over a five-year period.	Economic value added (EVA) - shareholder focused growth rate over a five year period.
Additional metrics	• First to market with products and services. • Cycle time to design and develop products and services. • Cycle time to market for new products and services. • Time to profitability for existing products and services. • Time to profitability for new products and services. • Number of projects launched ahead of schedule. • Number of products delivered ahead of schedule. • Ratio of launched projects to projects advanced through review gates. • Time to new market penetration achieved through acquisitions. • Number of employees qualified to jumpstart projects.	• Return on assets. • Total revenue. • Net present value. • Gross profit. • Stock price. • Shareholder value. • Operating income. • Earning per share. • Available cash on-hand (cash flow). • Bid and quote success rate.
To achieve Speed and/or Profits, your organization should nurture...	• Market share. • Opportunities. • Quick response. • Domination. • Aggressiveness. • The ability to adapt to rapidly changing market conditions.	• Shareholder value. • Predictable opportunities. • Focus to compete. • Short-term results. • Managed resources.
Companies that emphasize Speed and/or Profits, have a tendency to...	Combine external opportunities with successful short-term performance.	Balance short-term performance and stability.
When your company excels at nurturing Speed and/or Profits, it does so by...	• Requiring speculation analysis. • Dominance through acquisitions and alliances. • Seeking skills to win. • A compete-for-results culture. • Attracting logic and predictability.	• Seeking stability through discipline. • Focused goals that yield short-term results. • Managed assets that yield shareholder value. • Maximizing the bottom line.
Companies that emphasize Speed and/or Profits, have organizational cultures characterized by...	• Market domination. • Fast decision-making. • Hard-driving. • Expansion of leadership power. • Leveraging of assets. • Mergers and acquisitions to speed up innovation. • Analytical prowess.	• Results-orientation. • Targeted-focus. • Demanding leadership. • Alignment of resources for specific purposes. • Managerial discipline. • Maximization of value. • Analytical prowess. • Cost competition.
Individuals who excel at building Speed and/or Profits, have the following leadership characteristics...	• Producer. • Task focused. • Stealthy. • Aggressive and decisive. • Resourceful.	• Competitor. • Aggressive and decisive. • Demanding. • Energizing. • Strategic. • Resourceful.
When leading a culture that is oriented toward Speed and/or Profits, avoid such blind spots as...	Assuming that all prospective ideas or products have the capabilities necessary for entering and dominating new markets; good analysis should precede knee-jerk quick decisions.	Assuming that shareholder value is of little importance; business decisions must consider the long-term value to shareholders.
Avoid such culture blind spots as...	• Burn-out work pace. • Unnecessary aggression.	• Stinginess. • Unrealistic targets. • Waste.
Avoid your personal blind spots that...	• Takes the easy route to a quick fix. • Is overly aggressive. • Is too fast. • Is bad with people.	• Takes the easy route to a quick fix. • Is myopic. • Is unrealistic in demands. • Is bad with people.
When looking for examples of Speed and/or Profits, consider...	• Large, diversified, public companies. • Financial institutions. • Leaders in large industries.	• Large, diversified, public companies. • Financial institutions. • Leaders in large industries.
Specifically...	Microsoft	General Electric

IF YOU ARE A “RED” (CONTROL QUADRANT)...

The Control quadrant is an internal process model and adheres to a traditional notion that organizing occurs in a highly structured and hierarchical way. The Control quadrant represents a cross between an internal, process-oriented focus and a stable organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant minimize risk, focus on details and continuous improvement, and are strategic in their actions and resources they cultivate.

Leader types: Coordinator, monitor, and organizer.

Value drivers: Efficiency, timeliness, consistency and uniformity.

Theory of effectiveness: Control and efficiency with capable processes produce effectiveness.

Culture type: Hierarchy.

Metrics associated with the Create quadrant: Quality; gross margin (a price premium of higher quality products and services drives gross margin as defined by the sum of sales revenue less cost of goods sold, divided by sales revenue); efficiency; and asset turnover (sales, divided by assets in a given year).

Advantages to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Incremental improvements frequently materialize.
- High quality and consistency yield organizational success.
- The organization focuses on the long-term.

Drawbacks to being anchored in this quadrant:

- Taken to an extreme, organizations become static bureaucracies.
- Radical ideas are often suppressed.
- Goals and metrics become ends rather than means to an end.

How the Control quadrant relates to the other quadrants:

- Complements the Collaborate and Control quadrants.
- Contrasts with the Create quadrant.

TABLE 7 – THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE CONTROL QUADRANT AND THE OTHER CVF QUADRANTS

Control	If <u>you</u> are a “Red”	If <u>your team</u> is “Red”	If <u>your business unit</u> is “Red”	If <u>your firm</u> is “Red”
Then...	You will create value through your attention to detail and your ability to recognize incremental opportunities.	Value is created when the team’s long-term reliability and consistency are institutionalized as best practices or processes.	Value is created when it connects practices, processes, and systems with growth objectives.	Value is created through consistent identification of growth projects from the careful ongoing evaluation of practices and processes.
And you work with “Yellows” (Collaborate), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when you place a collective emphasis on learning to do things the right way.	Your team will create value with other teams when best practices for doing things the right way are shared.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units when structured learning systems are built and shared.	Your firm will create value with other firms through the nurturing of long-term and trusting relationships that build industry specific knowledge and practices.
And you work with “Blues” (Compete), then...	Your relationship with these individuals will succeed when there is a mutual interest in minimizing some sort of risk.	Your team will create value with other teams when there is a mutually specific goal that minimizes risk and maximizes return on investment.	Your business unit will successfully create value with other units through key projects with clear goals, timelines, responsibilities, and outcomes.	Your firm will create value with other firms when there are clear objectives for and resources available to mutual ventures. Ventures will be transaction based and will focus more on the outcome of the exchange rather than the exchange itself.
And you work with “Greens” (Create), then...	The difficulties in your relationship with these individuals will center on matters of risk. Others will perceive your assessment of risk and caution as an obstruction of ideas and progress. Make sure your concerns are reasonable and look for ways to turn these concerns into opportunities for new ideas.	Your team will have a difficult time working with other teams because of disagreements about the nature of new ideas. Greens will appear to disrespect the practicality and feasibility of these ideas. Your team should use its expertise to help the other team develop a proof of concept of the actual idea while recognizing that some degree of failure is normal during this stage.	Your business unit will have a difficult time with other units because of conflicting views on the ways in which the company should pursue growth. Both sides will have a difficult time balancing and evaluating risk and reward. Your unit must recognize that some risk is necessary for growth. Look for common ground that represents reasonable risk but yields significant growth potential.	Your firm might find it challenging to partner with Create quadrant firms on a macro-level. Instead, look to these firms as a potential resource for ideas. A formal partnership might not work, but consulting, solutions-oriented, or technology transfer arrangements might be more appropriate.

TABLE 8 – CONTROL QUADRANT METRICS AND OUTCOMES

Control Quadrant		
	Efficiency...	Quality...
Key performance metrics	Asset turnover - sales, divided by assets in a given year.	Gross margin - a price premium of higher quality products and services drives gross margin, as measured by the sum of sales revenue, less cost of goods sold, divided by sales revenue.
Additional metrics	• Unit cost. • Target versus cost achievement. • Actual versus planned production. • Days supply of finished goods inventory. • Percentage of backorders. • Percentage of achieved milestones. • Percentage of on-time deliveries. • Total interest cost savings. • Labor productivity variance. • Throughput time.	• Percentage of initial quality. • Percentage of scrap. • Number of safety violations. • Number of product failures by product group. • Improvement on error or defect rate. • Percentage reduction in redundancy or waste. • Number of engineering changes after release (manufacturability). • Percentage of certified suppliers. • Number of warranty claims.
To achieve Efficiency and/or Quality, your organization should nurture...	• Cost control. • Regulation. • Monitoring. • Improvement. • Stability.	• Reliability. • On-time delivery. • Process improvement. • Technical capability. • Systems and technology.
Companies that emphasize Efficiency and/or Quality, have a tendency to...	Innovate and grow through stability and incremental improvement.	Innovate and grow through incremental improvement and the development of internal capability.
When your company excels at nurturing Efficiency and/or Quality, it does so by...	• Policies and regulation. • Driving of improvements. • Seeking better, faster, and cheaper. • Data-driven standards. • Monitoring of controls. • Elimination of error and variation.	• Systems and technology to ensure quality. • Superior capability through incremental improvement. • Regular process review • Smooth operations • Consistency of brand value
Companies that emphasize Efficiency and/or Quality, have organizational cultures characterized by...	• Structure. • Rules and policies. • Risk aversion. • Cost control. • Specialization of functions. • Task focus. • Preservation of order.	• Improvement-focus. • Technology emphasis. • Best practices. • Workflow management. • Emphasis on troubleshooting. • Data focus. • Smooth operation. • Best-in-class focus.
Individuals who excel at building Efficiency and/or Quality, have the following leadership characteristics...	• Administrator. • Technologically adept. • Conservative of resources. • Standardizing. • Diligent.	• Engineer. • Technologically adept. • Dependable and reliable. • Systems thinker. • Diligent. • Technical expert.
When leading a culture that is oriented toward Efficiency and/or Quality, avoid such blind spots as...	Assuming that laws, policies, and procedures can be circumnavigated; have a system in place for double-checking adherence to such standards.	Assuming that operationalizing an idea at scale can be done without details or planning phases; run simulations and other models that test scaled ideas under various scenarios.
Avoid such culture blind spots as...	• Excessive control. • Idea retardation. • Distrust. • Ignorance of people.	• Predictability. • Micromanagement. • Ignorance of people.
Avoid your personal blind spots that...	• Over analyzes. • Gets lean and mean. • Ignores new ideas. • Lacks social skills.	• Uses best practices as a crutch. • Informs but won't teach. • Lacks social skills.
Consider...	• Manufacturing firms. • Operationally-complex businesses. • Discount retailers. • Governments.	• Manufacturing firms. • Operationally-complex businesses. • Discount retailers. • Governments.
Specifically...	Wal-Mart	Toyota

TOP OF THE CVF MODEL: COLLABORATE/CREATE

"Yellows" (Collaborate) complement "Greens" (Create). Yellow and Green companies have structures that are flexible, change-oriented, and are generally focused on some degree of long-term excellence. Companies in these quadrants can be identified by their sometimes-unorthodox leadership structures and chains of command. They differ in the scope of their focus. Yellow organizations focus on the people within them and on the social system that those people comprise, while Green organizations emphasize the organization itself and on the logic of resource acquisition for the necessary competition in a market. A Yellow company might prioritize the internal development of intangible knowledge resources, while a Green company might prioritize the acquisition of tangible capital resources.

BOTTOM OF THE CVF MODEL: COMPETE/CONTROL

"Blues" (Compete) complement "Reds" (Control). Blue and Red companies have stable and rigid structures in place. Formal leadership structures and hierarchies are indicative organizations in these companies. They differ in the scope of their focus. Red companies are rigid in processes and procedures, both of which are aimed at internal operational performance. Blue companies are rigid in financial metrics, which are aimed at external stakeholder performance. Both may employ "dashboard" style systems for monitoring key metrics. A Red company might orient its dashboard toward quality management, which it believes will ultimately drive the bottom line. A Blue company might orient its dashboard toward real time financial management, which it believes will ultimately drive the bottom line.

RIGHT OF THE CVF MODEL: CREATE/COMPETE

"Greens" (Create) complement "Blues" (Compete). Green and Blue companies are externally focused. Both of these companies are market leaders among their competitors. They differ in the way in which they become leaders. Green companies emphasize the flexibility of ideas and innovation leadership as a means to financial excellence, while Blue companies focus on rigid cost controls and market leadership as a means to financial excellence.

LEFT OF THE CVF MODEL: CONTROL/COLLABORATE

"Reds" (Control) complement "Yellows" (Collaborate). Reds and Yellows are internally focused. These companies emphasize elaborate systems for continuous improvement, best practices, and training. While companies anchored in both quadrants focus internally, Yellow companies focus on people while Red companies focus on processes. A Yellow company might prioritize frequent performance reviews and continuous employee feedback, while a Red company might prioritize frequent after-action reviews.

COMPETING VALUES AND OTHER ORGANIZATIONAL TOOLS

The CVF links *People*, *Practices*, and *Purposes* to organizational outcomes, allowing companies to appropriately strategize priorities in order to achieve specific innovation and growth objectives. The CVF also complements many other organizational tools that companies routinely utilize. Collectively, these tools help leaders make sense of their organizations and gain a clearer snapshot of their people and their teams.

TABLE 9 – CVF QUADRANTS AND THEIR RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER ORGANIZATIONAL TOOLS

Other Tools	Collaborate	Create	Compete	Control
Herrmann Brain Dominance	"Teamist" Limbic (Emotional processing). Right (Holistic). Characteristics: Interpersonal, emotional, people-oriented, helping.	"Imaginist" Cerebral (Intellectual processing). Right (Holistic). Characteristics: Integrative, imaginative, insightful, visionary.	"Producer" Limbic (Emotional processing). Left (Analytical). Characteristics: Organized, planned, detailed, business.	"Analyst" Cerebral (Intellectual processing). Left (Analytical). Characteristics: Logical, analytical, technical, financial.
Myers-Briggs	Feeling – the way in which information is gathered. Extroversion – the source of Energy.	Intuiting – the way in which information is evaluated and decisions are made. Perception – external persona.	Sensing – the way in which information is evaluated and decisions are made. Judgment – external persona.	Thinking – the way in which information is gathered. Introversion – source of energy.
DISC Assessment	"Influence" Active/people-oriented. "Steadiness" Passive/people-oriented.		"Dominance" Active/task-oriented.	"Conscientious" Passive/task-oriented.
Situational Leadership	Ambidextrous leaders move among directing, coaching, supporting, and delegating.	Ambidextrous leaders move among directing, coaching, supporting, and delegating.	Ambidextrous leaders move among directing, coaching, supporting, and delegating.	Ambidextrous leaders move among directing, coaching, supporting, and delegating.

ACTION STEPS YOU CAN TAKE, NOW

1

Take the individual Competing Values assessment for free at www.CompetingValues.com.

2

Use the assessment to take an inventory of *People* (yourself and your team), *Practices* (corporate culture and competencies), and *Purposes* (outcomes, or value the organization intends to create).

3

Map out the assessment results in all four quadrants, creating a picture of the current state of innovation and growth. It reveals strengths and weaknesses, as well as the competencies and gaps that will need to be addressed in order to reach desired goals and outcomes.

4

A group of key leaders (who have the ability to shape or influence management practices) should review the assessment results along with the situation (outside forces such as customers, trends, or competition) and determine the strategic goals.

5

Working from the outcome desired, plan the changes on a personal level, team level, and on an organizational level (what to do more, do less, stop, improve, or do the same). Recognize that in order to begin something new, it will likely mean that you will have to scale back something else. Resources are limited, so make the choices that create value.

6

Use the next four tables (Tables 10-13) to help you and your team determine what needs to be done next. You and your team will need to consider the assessment results and the leaders' recommendations in order to determine an appropriate course of action.

7

Use Table 14 to summarize your course of action.
Table 15 is an example of what a course of action might resemble.

TABLE 10 – USING THE COLLABORATE QUADRANT AS A STRATEGIC PRIORITY

If You Need to be More “Yellow”...		
	Community...	Knowledge...
Examples of actions you can take that impact...	- Involve people who will be affected by change in the planning and implementation. - Allow people to talk about their reactions and feelings, especially when they feel that they are losing something due to change. - Identify a change champion in your organization, and work with them to support and initiate change. - Hold feedback meetings in order to give employees the opportunity to express their feelings about how the change is going.	- When planning change, ensure that objective, responsibilities, time frame, etc. are defined and clearly communicated to people and then give them freedom to experiment. - Tell people what you think the change will mean for them and then request and listen to their feedback and reactions. - Ask for a lot of advice in a change situation - Meet with someone who has successfully implemented change. Discuss the steps that were taken throughout the change process. Review your own plans for change with this person.
Examples of priorities that your team can determine that impact...	- Creating a sense of cohesion in the organization. - Establishing shared values among people. - Facilitating conflict resolution. - Integrating personal and professional goals. - Encouraging commitment.	- Training, mentoring, and coaching. - Develop a learning organization. - Building cross-functional teams. - Nurturing communities of practice. - Organizational competency and culture development.

TABLE 11 – USING THE CREATE QUADRANT AS A STRATEGIC PRIORITY

If you need to be more “Green”...		
	Innovation...	Growth...
Examples of actions you can take that impact...	- Hold idea-sharing events in your work setting such as cross-functional task forces, focus groups, and book reviews. The idea is to address questions such as – <i>What is new? What problems do we have that we don't expect anyone to solve?</i> - Encourage action learning. Try things first. Then analyze what you have learned from success or failure. Don't wait until you are certain of success before you take action. - Purposefully take a risk in your decisions by trying a new alternative solution or a different process. - Create a file of new ideas. Each time you think of something innovative related to your work, write it down, and file it.	- Establish goals, and hold people accountable for producing innovative ideas. Make it part of everyone's job description. - Establish a “practice field” that is separated from normal daily work where new ideas can be tried and low-cost experimentation can occur. This could be an actual physical location with time off and some resources. - Create a climate in which people feel free to fail and admit it. Remember that the best baseball hitters succeed only 33% of the time. - Generate as many options as you can during problem identification and the generation of alternatives in a problem-solving process.
Examples of priorities that your team can determine that impact...	- Jumpstarting breakthrough experiments. - Launching radical change programs. - Stimulating people to think creatively. - Destroy the old way of doing things. - Hiring and staffing for diversity. - Creating a flexible and open workplace.	- Forecasting the future. - Launching entrepreneurial ventures and spin-offs. - Developing new products and services. - Speculating emerging opportunities.

TABLE 12 – USING THE COMPETE QUADRANT AS A STRATEGIC PRIORITY

If you need to be more “Blue”...		
	Speed...	Profits...
Examples of actions you can take that impact...	- Give customers what they want the first time, every time, then work toward exceeding those expectations, and surprise them with levels of service they would never expect or request. - Keep track of trends and predictions of the future of your industry or sector. Monitor what is happening demographically with your competitors, foreign and domestic. - Acknowledge and legitimize improvements that save as little as one second. - Never let 24 hours pass without asking at least one customer what they want. Constant inquiry will produce a constant flow of ideas.	- Identify cutting-edge organizations that to establish trends in their businesses. Based on what you observe, project a future for your organization. What will you have to do in order to achieve world-class status? - Acknowledge and legitimize improvements that save as little as one cent. - Make continuous improvements a key feature of the vision that was articulated for your unit. - Make it easy for employees as well as customers to complain and give suggestions. Make the assumption that more input is better. Actively seek improvements from employees and customers.
Examples of priorities that your team can determine that impact...	- Deploying small elite troubleshooting project teams. - Quickly eliminating underperforming initiatives. - Confronting problems as soon as they occur. - Making real time decisions in a fast moving workplace. - Driving through barriers.	- Driving for superior returns on investments. - Focusing on a few quantifiable performance objects. - Rewarding high performance disproportionately from others. - Maximizing value through project portfolio management. - Initiating mergers and acquisitions.

TABLE 13 – USING THE CONTROL QUADRANT AS A STRATEGIC PRIORITY

If you need to be more “Red”...		
	Efficiency...	Quality...
Examples of actions you can take that impact...	- Learn to use computer software packages to forecast and monitor work (e.g. budget, human resources). - Use computer software packages to monitor and measure work processes and outcomes. - Break problems and issues apart into smaller components in order to thoroughly understand details. - Repeatedly ask “why” questions regarding unclear processes. - Refuse to be intimidated by confusing processes. Ask, probe, and discuss until you do.	- Measure improvement, not just task or goal accomplishment. - Institute regular audits of each unit in your organization in order to find ways to improve it. - Establish past performance as the standard against which to measure success. - Critically analyze the key reports that are produced by and for your unit in order to assure accuracy and usefulness.
Examples of priorities that your team can determine that impact...	- Conserving fiscal resources. - Implementing systems to control complex tasks. - Making internal work processes routine. - Employing technology on a large scale. - Compelling suppliers to reduce costs. - Establishing clear roles and responsibilities.	- Applying quality control systems to prevent costly mistakes. - Complying with regulations. - Adhering to professional standards. - Using continuous improvement processes.

TABLE 14 – A TEMPLATE FOR TAKING ACTION

Taking Action Template	Practices that need to start	Practices that need to stop	Measures that support the Practices	Behaviors	Action Steps	Person who owns the Strategic Priority	Deliverable Date
Strategic Priority #1							
Strategic Priority #2							
Strategic Priority #3							
Strategic Priority #4							

TABLE 15 – EXAMPLE, TEMPLATE FOR TAKING ACTION

Taking Action Template	Practices that need to start	Practices that need to stop	Measures that support the Practices	Behaviors	Action Steps	Person who owns the Strategic Priority	Deliverable Date
Strategic Priority #1 Create Quadrant	- Become familiar with other teams - Network with colleagues	- Over-analysis - Hostility towards new ideas	- Inventory of ideas - List of potential projects stemming from ideas	- Creative thinking - Free exchange of ideas - Brainstorming	- Establish an innovation coordinating group - Create idea spaces	Jay Grant	Two months from Today
Strategic Priority #2 Compete Quadrant	- Set definitive timelines - Increase awareness of competitors	- Group-think - Complacency	- Comparative reports of our company against competitors - Detailed project time lines	- Observe competitors' actions - Increasingly read market trendnews	- Update project management software - Update dashboard tracking software	Pat Smith	Three months from Today
Strategic Priority #3 Control Quadrant	- Energy reduction - Waste recycling	Traditional waste disposal	- Waste reduction reports - Energy usage reports	- Ecological awareness training - Environmental impact training	- Update the company recycling guidelines - Launch a 'green' energy initiative	Terry Green	Four months from Today
Strategic Priority #4 Collaborate Quadrant	- Become familiar with other teams - Learn how to give constructive feedback	Traditional performance reviews	Employee satisfaction surveys	Continue to offer spontaneous feedback	- Plan a company retreat - Launch 360 feedback assessment	Tim Wells	Six months from Today



Jeff DeGraff—Making Innovation Happen



Known as the 'Dean of Innovation,' Jeff DeGraff is a Professor at the University of Michigan's Ross School of Business, teaching MBA and Executive Education courses, and the Co-Creator of the Competing Values methodology that integrates finance, strategy, management, innovation, and leadership into a system that boosts the business bottom-line. As the Managing Partner of the Competing Values Company, a consulting firm that assists leaders in facilitating change, innovation and growth, DeGraff has developed a broad array of tools that make innovation happen. He has significant experience in numerous industries and market segments and he has worked all over the world. Representative clients would include 3M, American Express, Apple Computers, GE, Johnson & Johnson, LG, Pfizer, Reuters, Toyota, and Yahoo. DeGraff has shared his expertise with many publications such as *BusinessWeek*, *CIO*, *Leadership Excellence*, *T+D* (Training + Development), *Training*, and *USA Today*. He has written numerous articles and three books: *Leading Innovation: How to Jump Start Your Organization's Growth Engine* (McGraw-Hill, 2006), *Competing Values Leadership* (Edward Elgar, 2006), and *Creativity at Work: Developing the Right Practices to Make Innovation Happen* (Jossey-Bass, 2002).

Organizational Leader – The Creative Thinker

SNCOA The Creative Thinker Primer

1 August 2025



Creative Thinking is an essential skill for SNCOs in today's Air Force. Considering Air Force Chief of Staff Gen. David W. Allvin's action orders focus on strengthening the team, decision-making, accelerating change, and competitively readying forces across the Air Force, emphasizing the need to stay ahead of evolving threats and challenges. To effectively carry out these orders, SNCOs must be willing to think creatively and innovatively, developing new ideas and solutions to meet the demands of an ever-changing environment. They must be willing to challenge the status quo, take calculated risks, and seek out new technologies and approaches. By engaging in creative thinking, understanding preferred innovation style and employing innovations tools SNCOs can help build stronger teams and solve complex problems while ensuring the Air Force remains a leader in the defense community, able to meet any challenge that may arise.

In the Creative Thinking lesson we'll explore the Competing Values Framework, Innovation and Design Thinking.

Divergent & Convergent Thinking Processes

(<https://www.stephanhitchins.com.au/divergent-convergent/>)

Divergent: The ability to generate multiple solutions to a problem and view issues from numerous perspectives: *"think outside the box and come up with unconventional solutions that may not have been considered before. This type of thinking is essential in creative fields"*

Convergent: The ability to deduce a single solution to a problem; rule-following or problem-solving: *"focused on finding the best solution or answer to a problem. It is a more analytical process that involves evaluating and selecting the most promising ideas from a range of options"*

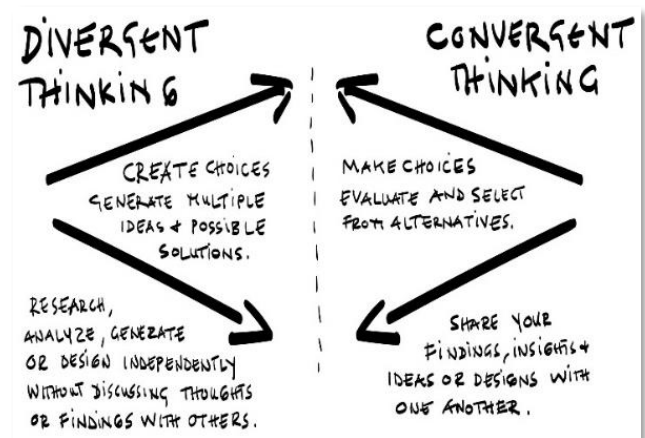


Figure 1 - <https://www.stephanhitchins.com.au/divergent-convergent/>

Organizational Leader – The Creative Thinker

The Competing Values Framework

(<https://denverleadership.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/01/Competing-Values-Framework.pdf>)

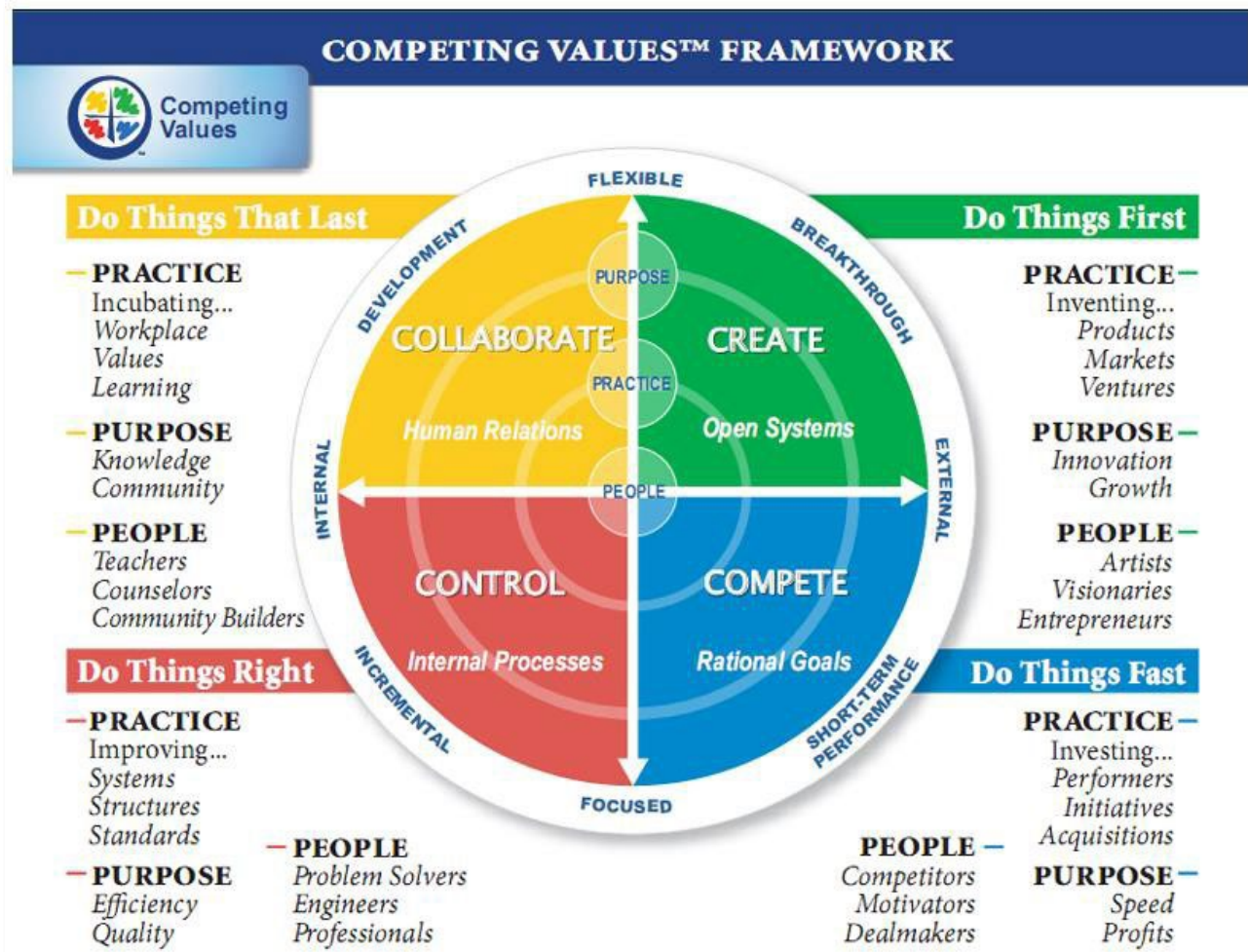


Figure 2 - CFV, from: <https://denverleadership.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/01/Competing-Values-Framework.pdf>

Competing Values Framework (CVF) profiles/quadrants:

- The **Collaborate quadrant** is a human relations model that emphasizes cohesion, morale, human resources, and training. This quadrant represents a cross between an internal, person-oriented focus and a flexible, change-oriented organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant nurture their people, cultivate human capital, and are adaptive in their actions in that they focus on long-term development.
- The **Create quadrant** is an open system model that can be described as organic, flat, loosely-coupled, matrix-oriented, and temporary. The Create quadrant represents a cross between an external, organization-oriented focus and a flexible, change-oriented organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant take risks, focus broadly on the big picture and big ideas, and are agile in their actions and the resources that they cultivate.
- The **Compete quadrant** is a rational goal model that emphasizes profit and bottom-line measures and is underlined by the concept of rational action. The Compete quadrant represents a cross between an external, organization-oriented focus and a focused organizational structure.

Organizational Leader – The Creative Thinker

Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant do things quickly for immediate gain, focus heavily on bottom line measures of profitability, and relentlessly acquire resources that give them a competitive advantage.

- The **Control quadrant** is an internal process model and adheres to a traditional notion that organizing occurs in a highly structured and hierarchical way. The Control quadrant represents a cross between an internal, process-oriented focus and a stable organizational structure. Organizations that are anchored in this quadrant minimize risk, focus on details and continuous improvement, and are strategic in their actions and resources they cultivate.

The Competing Values Framework is sometimes referred to as the ‘*Innovation Genome*.’ In truth, the Innovation Genome is an offspring of the Competing Values Framework refined by Dr. Jeff DeGraff. The Innovation Genome is a meta-model upon which a wide variation of leadership types can be compared and evaluated based on **dominant worldview (defining quality) or approaches to innovation**. The Innovation Genome has three levels: **Situational, Organizational & Individual** and four types: **Artist (Create), Engineer (Control), Athlete (Compete) & Sage (Collaborate)**.

Results can be used to create teams with diverse perspectives to harness the power of **constructive conflict**.

LEVEL/TYPE	CREATE TYPE	CONTROL TYPE	COMPETE TYPE	COLLABORATE TYPE
Individual Level	Artist	Engineer	Athlete	Sage
Attributes • Examples	Creativity • Aesthetic vision • Artistic expression Discovery • Psychological • Spiritual exploration	Security • Safety • Savings Productivity • Accomplishment • Advancement	Vitality • Physical health • Emotional health Prosperity • Financial well-being • Best in class	Capability • Apprenticeship • Continuing education Community • Family outings • Service associations
Organizational Level	Adhocracy	Hierarchy	Market	Clan
Value propositions • Examples	Innovation • Discovery strategy • Radical experiments Growth • New market speculation • Greenhouse funds	Efficiency • Lean manufacturing • Supply chain innovation Quality • Total quality control • End to end IT system	Speed • Mergers and acquisitions • Rapid action problem solving teams Profit • Revenue insight processes • Market adjacencies	Community • Communities of practice • Culture development Knowledge • Knowledge management • Search and reapply
Situational Level	Unique	Predictable	Contentious	Cooperative
Strategies • Examples	Breakthrough • Miracle drugs • Visual prosthetics Differentiation • Craft beers • Haute couture fashion	Scale • Airline logistics • Heavy manufacturing Cautious • Surgical procedures • Power generation	Aggressive • Smart phones • Snack foods Demanding • Financial services • College football	Beliefs • Fair trade coffee • Not for profit groups Lifestyle • Bicycle lanes • Gaming

Figure 3 - <https://jeffdegraff.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/12/Screen-Shot-2018-12-03-at-11.23.24-AM.png>

Organizational Leader – The Creative Thinker

7 Sources of Innovation

(<https://hbr.org/2002/08/the-discipline-of-innovation>)

Inside the Organization

1. **The unexpected:** The unexpected success, failure, or outside event. *When one person or team succeeds, when many others fail given similar circumstances, when something failed when everyone thought it would succeed.*
2. **The incongruity:** Between reality as it is and reality as it is assumed to be or as it “ought to be”. *When everything changes except the “We’ve always done it this way” parts of an operation.*
3. **Innovation based on process needs:** *A current process cannot meet the mission's needs, even when everything is working how it is supposed to.*
4. **Changes in industry structure or market structure that catch everyone unaware:** *What seems like a novelty rapidly expands. Example: locally sourcing aircraft parts or toolbox handles from 3D printers.*

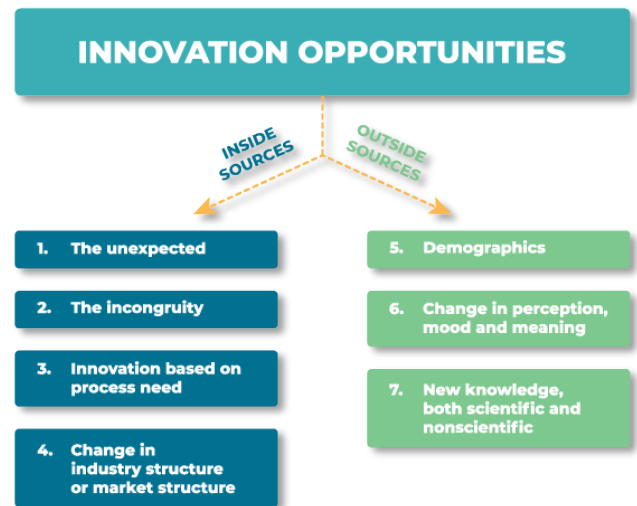


Figure 4 - <https://innovationcloud.com/blog/searching-for-innovative-opportunities-these-7-sources-will-boost-your-creativity.html>

Outside the Organization

5. **Demographics:** Population changes. *Changing recruitment policies regarding piercing and tattoos to match changes in population trends.*
6. **Changes in perception, mood, and meaning:** *The realization that Cyber and Electronic warfare may be more critical than F-22's flying combat missions in a high-end fight.*
7. **New Knowledge:** Both scientific and non-scientific.

Design Thinking

Empathize

This is a *Diverging* step. This means we are trying to cast a wide net to capture as much information about the problem as possible. Remember that this is a Human-Centered approach, which means getting several perspectives on the issue using interviews, observations, and expert opinions is critical. Not just Data.

Define

This is a *Converging* step. In this step, you understand that you have limited resources and energy to address the issues identified in the Empathize step. Working with stakeholders, you must select an issue identified in the Empathize step before moving on.

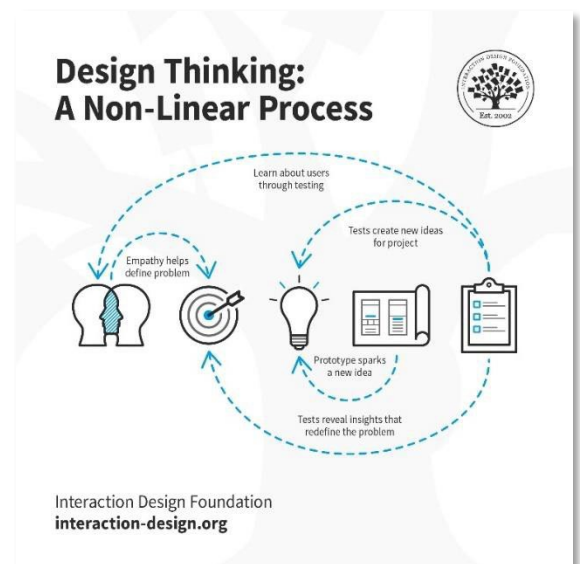


Figure 5 - <https://www.interaction-design.org>

Organizational Leader – The Creative Thinker

Ideate

This is a *Diverging* step. In this step, the team tries to generate as many solutions to your selected problem as possible. In true brainstorming fashion, you are not concerned with realism but with the number of solutions.

Prototype

This is a *Converging* step. In this step, you and your team are determining which ideas from the ideate step could be demonstrated and what you need to learn about your ideas to find the best solution. This is one of the most challenging steps because you need to devise a way to manifest your potential solutions for people to interact with.

Test

This is a *Converging* step. Once a prototype has been devised and selected, your team will present them to customers and stakeholders to determine if their solutions will work. Feedback is taken to refine ideas and prototypes. As the figure shows, you may be retested several times until you solve to consider for real-world implementation.

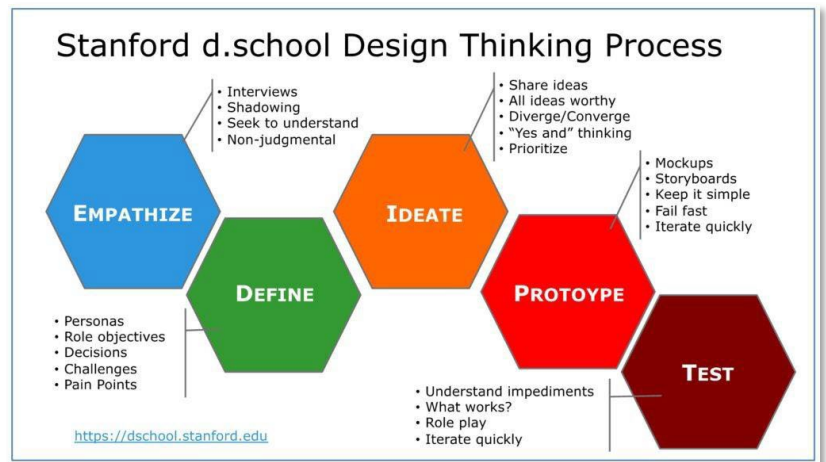


Figure 6 - <https://dschool.stanford.edu/>

The Stanford d.school is the Hasso Plattner Institute of Design. According to the d.school, “*At the Hasso Plattner Institute of Design (the d.school) we challenge students to tackle some of the world’s most urgent problems. We work with nonprofit, corporate and public entities to develop projects that address real-world problems. Your gift enables the d.school to advance its big-picture vision: a fundamental shift in how people teach, practice and think about creativity and innovation.*”

The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 1 Reflection Questions

Question 1: What is the most prominent *Source of Innovation* in your organization? How could you capitalize on it?

(Optional) Use the SEE format for the question above

State: *The most prominent Source of Innovation in my organization is:*

State: *I could capitalize on this source of innovation by:*

Elaborate: *The reason for doing so is:* OR *in other words:*

Exemplify (examples): *For example, at work:*

Question 2: Considering your *Competing Values Framework* profile, pair your profile with another personality assessment you have taken in the past and discuss some similarities and differences?

Examples: DISC, Myers-Briggs, Kirton's Adaptation-Innovation, Big 5, True Colors, etc.

Question 3: Describe a lingering problem in your organization. How could *Design Thinking* help you in dealing with the problem?

[illegible]

The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 3 Resources

Student Preparation:

Watch: Convergent vs. Divergent Thinking

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?app=desktop&v=xjE2RV6IQzo>

Read: <https://denverleadership.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/01/Competing-Values-Framework.pdf>

Watch: Competing Values Framework (CVF) Introduction

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=45veR-Se-rI>

Complete: CVF sample assessment xls (*located in the LMS*)

Consider: Which of the CVF profiles you typically use at work

Read: The Creative Thinker Primer

Additional Resources (for increased understanding):

The Innovation Genome Assessment Overview

<https://jeffdegraff.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/06/Assessment-Overview-3-Single.pdf>

7 Sources of Innovation

<https://hbr.org/2002/08/the-discipline-of-innovation>

The Discipline of Innovation

<https://hbr.org/2002/08/the-discipline-of-innovation>

The Stanford D School

<https://dschool.stanford.edu/>

IDEO – Innovation Design Engineering Organization

<https://www.ideo.com/>

The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 3 Resources

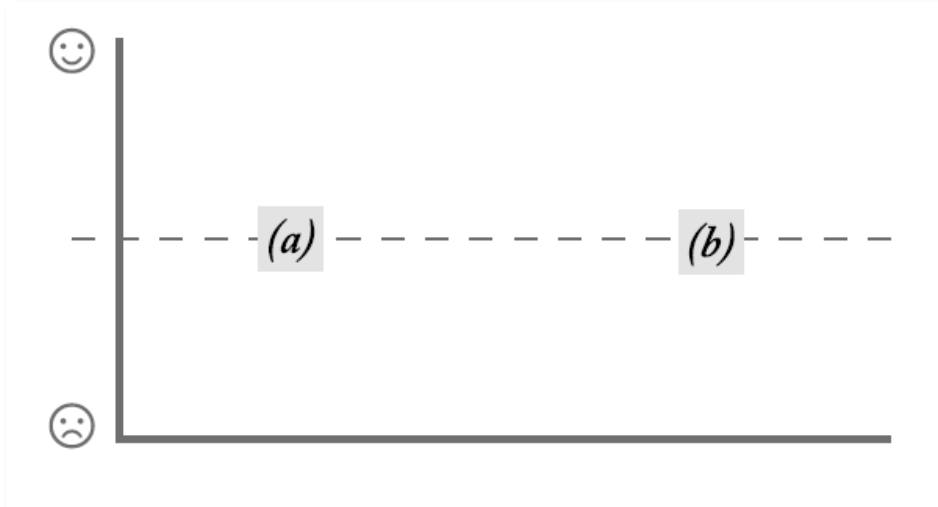
The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 4 – Journey Map (Empathize)

Journey Map

Identify areas of improvement in a user's experience by creating a map of it.

By mapping the steps of your service or product, you can start identifying your user's level of frustration or delight at any given stage. Doing this helps you see how the experience can be improved by making frustrating steps less impactful.

1. This team will draw an x and y-axis with a smiley face at the top and a frowny face at the bottom with points a and b plotted halfway up the y axis. See below:



2. The team will plot the "journey" of the commute to work (*example*) with (a) leaving their home (b) arriving at work using sticky notes.
3. Instruct the students to write the user's steps before, in-between, and after the two points.
4. As a team, they will discuss each sticky note and decide its position along the y axis based on how enjoyable or frustrating that step is.

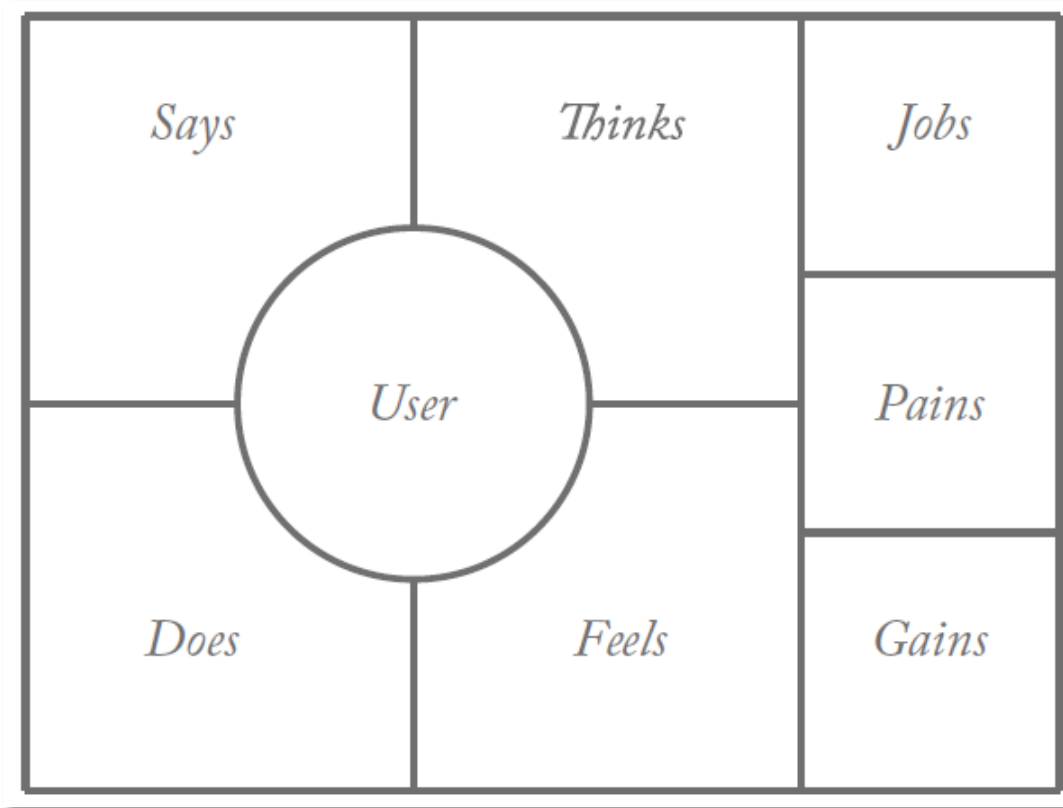
The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 5 – Empathy Map (Empathize)

Empathy Map

Empathize with your audience so you can make better design decisions. The goal is to get from sympathizing with your user to understanding/experiencing the user's experience.

Getting people into the persona of the person they are solving a problem for impacts the solutions and ideas people come up with. An empathy map can also be used to make sense of qualitative research, discover gaps in your current knowledge and amplify your understanding of the user.

1. Have the team draw the following on a whiteboard/butcher block paper:



Write the goal of the user in the middle. For example: Buying a Car

2. The team will spend the rest of their time putting their ideas about the hypothetical user into each category.
 - a) What is the user saying, thinking, doing, feeling about their goal?
 - b) What does the user need to do? Example: Keep the kids entertained
 - c) What pains do they have to achieve their goal? Example: Silver-tongued salesperson
 - d) What do they gain from reaching their goal?

The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 6 – How Might We? (Define)

How Might We...

Transform a problem, point of friction, or observation into a solvable question.

Note: A problem on its own can seem daunting; rephrasing problems as a question is a powerful way to switch the mind from panic to solution mode.

1. The stakeholder selects one of the issues indicated on the empathize map to address.
2. Rephrase the issue as a question so that it asks for a solution. For example:
Problem: Customers aren't contacting us when they have issues with the product.
Question: How might we get customers to contact us when they have an issue?
3. If your subject doesn't allow for various solutions, broaden the issue.
4. Select another issue from the empathize map and rephrase the issue.
5. The team will stick all their potential questions on the board.
6. Use an affinity map or similar product to group the questions by themes.
7. Prioritize the questions that will have the most positive impact on the user.

The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 7 – Problem Statement (Define)

Problem Statement

A statement captures the project's goals, problems, and measurable success criteria.

Note: This exercise will give the team a clear focus for their work, similar to the problem statement from the practical problem-solving model. In addition, it will define explicit constraints for the team, which will act as guardrails to keep the team aligned towards a solution.

The PPSM problem statement model is more quantitatively driven, while the Design Thinking version is qualitative.

1. Stakeholders will select an issue highlighted on the empathize maps to ensure the team will work on one problem.
2. On sticky notes, the team will answer the following questions and then sort them for common themes:
 - a. What are the current goals for the product or system?
 - b. What problem does the stakeholder want to be addressed?
 - c. Which goals aren't being met?
 - d. What is the explicit request for improvement that does not dictate a specific solution?
3. The team will complete the following template from the group's answers. Discuss and amend until everyone agrees with the problem statement.

"[Our service/product] was designed to achieve [these goals]. We have observed that the product/service isn't meeting [these goals], which is causing [this adverse effect] to our [mission/business/lifestyle/culture/etc]. How might we improve [service/product] so that our customers are more successful based on [these measurable criteria]?"

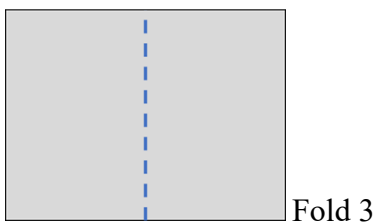
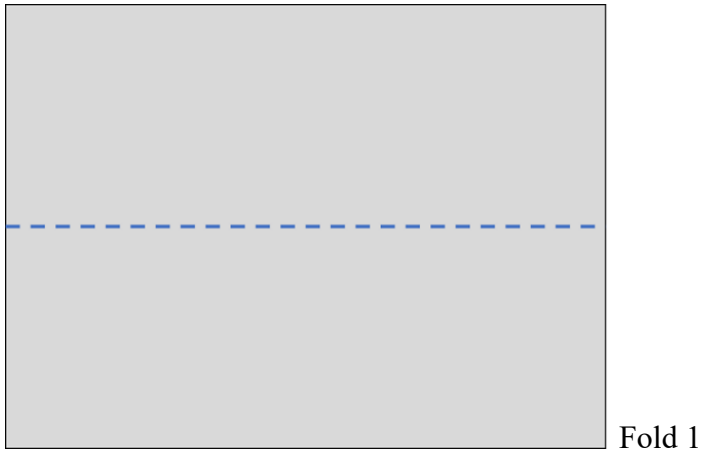
The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 8 – Crazy 8s (Ideate/Brainstorm)

Crazy 8s

Generate many ideas quickly—eight different ideas in roughly eight minutes.

Structure and rules have their place, and this tool utilizes both to generate eight ideas in the space of eight minutes. These rules restrict space and time but let everyone know that anything that goes forces thoughts out fast. Drawing is a great equalizer; an artist and kindergartner can visualize an idea using a sketch.

1. Hand out a piece of paper to each student participating. Have the student fold it three times to make a grid of eight rectangles.



2. Instruct the students to open the folds to show the eight regions of the grid.
3. Make sure everyone understands the problem the team is trying to ideate for by forming a How might we... question.
4. Have a timer ready and explain that everyone will have one minute per idea box. Ideas should be drawn.
5. Start the timer and encourage the group to move to the next idea as each minute passes. The pace will feel uncomfortable, but that is the point.
6. At the end of the eight minutes, ask each person to discuss their ideas. Encourage the group to steal each other's ideas for the next phase.
7. Have the team select the top two to three ideas to brief the flight.

The Creative Thinker Primer – Attachment 9 – Round Robin (Ideate/Brainstorm)

Round Robin

Evolve each other's ideas quickly.

You already have a rough outline of an idea, but you want to develop it further (hello, everyone trying to solve the problem in step 1 or phase 1). Thinking of the following "version" of the idea will help you evolve it into a more robust and fully formed solution.

1. Give each person a large sheet of paper. Ask them to fold their piece of paper to divide it into four equal sections.
2. With the paper in portrait positioning, ask the group to write the name of their idea and the problem it solves at the top.
3. Give them five minutes to draw the idea in the top left box with enough detail that someone can understand it without explanation.
4. Afterward, instruct everyone to pass their paper to the person on their left.
5. The following person should look at the previous idea and develop it further, drawing their version in the next section of the paper. Additionally, they can include a statement about why their addition makes it likely for the idea to succeed.
6. Carry on doing this until all sections of the paper are complete.
7. Prepare the final idea for presentation to the flight.

Organizational Leader – The Emotionally Intelligent Leader

SNCOA The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer

01 August 2025



“Leadership is about taking care of people. That means understanding their struggles, celebrating their successes, and being there for them when they need you most.”

~18th Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force, Kaleth O. Wright.

The subject of **Emotional Intelligence (EQ)** is something of an enigma. It is promoted at all levels of leadership, discussed at base level professional development events and is even outlined in our Airman Leadership Qualities (ALQs). Yet, it is one of the most misunderstood and rarely observed skills. Why is that? Emotional intelligence is more than empathy. It is more than simply being aware of negative emotions. The missing link is the gap between the subjects of *Awareness and Regulation*.

In this Emotional Intelligence lesson, we will study emotional intelligence through the lens of Daniel Goleman’s four domains of EQ. We will examine each domain and discuss specific tools for use in those domains. *Note: not all tools are described in this primer.* When put into practice, the tools will help us improve our domains and ultimately further develop our emotional intelligence by bridging the gap between *Awareness and Regulation*.

“If your emotional abilities aren’t in hand, if you don’t have self-awareness, if you are not able to manage your distressing emotions, if you can’t have empathy and have effective relationships, then no matter how smart you are, you are not going to get very far.”

~Daniel Goleman

Here’s how emotional intelligence is outlined in our ALQs:

Emotional Intelligence: *Exercises self-awareness manages their own emotions effectively; demonstrates an understanding of others’ emotions, and appropriately manages relationships.*

Organizational Leader – The Emotionally Intelligent Leader

Now let's examine what the ALQs say relative to Daniel Goleman's EQ framework displayed in the graphic:

ALQ: Exercises self-awareness (Self-Awareness) **manages their own emotions effectively** (Self-Management); **demonstrates an understanding of others' emotions** (Social-Awareness), and **appropriately manages relationships** (Relationship-Management).

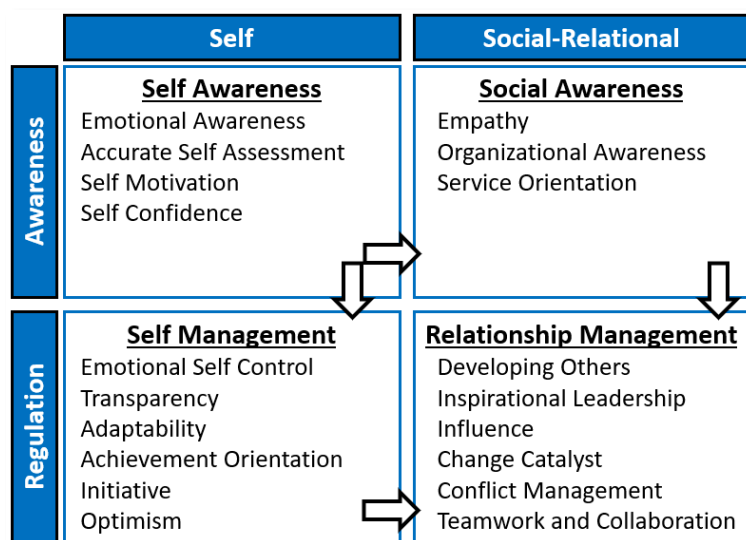


Figure 1 - Daniel Goleman's Emotional Intelligence framework

According to Daniel Goleman's emotional intelligence model, **Awareness and Regulation** are two fundamental components of emotional intelligence. **Awareness** involves recognizing and understanding one's own emotions and the emotions of others. **Self-awareness and Social-awareness** form the foundation for applying emotional regulation. **Regulation** refers to the ability to manage and control one's own emotions (*self-management*), as well as the capacity to influence and guide the emotions of others in a positive and constructive manner (*relationship-management*). Together, awareness and regulation enable individuals to navigate social interactions, make informed decisions, and build healthier relationships, contributing to overall emotional intelligence.

In the **self-awareness** domain, individuals exhibit an acute understanding of their own emotions, recognizing and accurately labeling their feelings as they arise. They are attuned to their strengths, weaknesses, values, and desires, fostering a deep sense of self-reflection and authenticity, which serves as a foundation for other emotional intelligence skills as they develop motivation and confidence.

The **social-awareness** domain focuses on an individual's ability to empathize and tune into the emotions and needs of others. It involves keen observation and active listening to understand the feelings and perspectives of those around them. Those with high social awareness are skilled at picking up on nonverbal cues, demonstrating empathy, and showing genuine concern for the well-being of others, which enables them to build strong and meaningful relationships.

The **self-management** domain focuses on an individual's ability to regulate and control their own emotions and behaviors effectively. It involves skills such as emotional self-control, adaptability, and resilience, enabling individuals to handle challenging situations with composure and flexibility. Those proficient in self-management can harness their emotional impulses, stay calm under pressure, and make thoughtful decisions that align with their values and long-term goals.

The **relationship-management** domain centers on an individual's ability to cultivate and maintain positive interactions and connections with others. It encompasses skills like effective communication, conflict resolution, and building strong interpersonal relationships. People with strong relationship management skills are adept at inspiring and influencing others, fostering teamwork, and resolving conflicts constructively, ultimately leading to successful collaborations and healthy, productive relationships.

Organizational Leader – The Emotionally Intelligent Leader

Emotional Intelligence Tools – Judger Learner Mindset

From: <https://executiveeducation.wharton.upenn.edu/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/1706-Shifting-Mindsets.pdf>

The Judger-Learner Mindset tool was created by Dr. Marille Adams, an award-winning author and pioneer in the fields of inquiry-based coaching, leadership and organizational culture. “Our mindsets are determined by the questions we ask. Some questions have the potential to catalyze breakthroughs and inspire transformations. Others lead to stagnation and demoralization. The difference lies in whether you ask Learner Questions or Judger Questions. *Learner Questions* are open-minded, curious, and creative. They promote progress and possibilities, and typically lead to discoveries, understanding, and solutions. By contrast, *Judger Questions* are more closed-minded, certain, and critical. They focus on problems rather than solutions and often lead to defensive reactions, negativity, and inertia. Learner Questions facilitate progress by expanding options; Judger Questions impede progress by limiting perspectives.”

Judger Questions	Learner Questions
Who is to blame? Why can't they perform?	What are my goals? What am I responsible for?
How can I prove I'm right?	What are the facts and what am I assuming?
How can I protect my turf?	How can I help?
Why aren't we winning?	What do our customers/stakeholders want?
What could we lose?	What steps can we take to improve the situation?
Why bother?	What's possible?

Figure 2 - © University of Pennsylvania, The Wharton School

Emotional Intelligence Tools – Reframing

Cognitive restructuring, or **‘Reframing’** in emotional intelligence refers to the process of *identifying and challenging negative or irrational thought patterns* that contribute to emotional distress. It is based on cognitive behavioral therapy work by Aaron T. Beck, Albert Ellis, and Albert Bandura and involves examining and reframing thoughts to promote more balanced and constructive thinking.

By addressing and changing cognitive distortions, individuals can improve their emotional well-being, reduce stress, and enhance their ability to respond to challenging situations in a more adaptive and resilient manner.

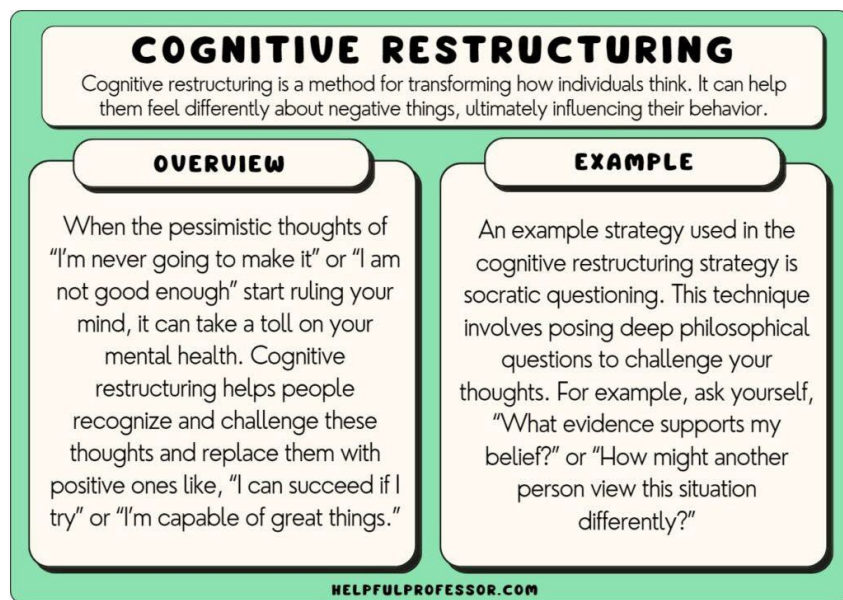


Figure 3 - <https://helpfulprofessor.com/cognitive-restructuring-examples/>

“People don't just get upset.
They contribute to their upsetness”
~Albert Ellis

Figure 4 - Albert Ellis

Frame & reframe example (*feel free to draft a few of your own*):

Frame	Reframe
My boss is a micromanager	<i>My boss cares about my development</i>
We are going to fail	<i>We are going to learn a ton!</i>
There are too many new people at work	<i>Once they are trained, we'll be unstoppable</i>
My friend is annoyingly positive	<i>Their perspective is needed and refreshing</i>
My coworker is an idea fairy	<i>I hadn't considered we could fix that!</i>
My subordinate always quotes AF instruction	<i>They know their job well</i>

Figure 5 - Frame & Reframe Example

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 1 Reflection Questions

Question 1: What quadrant of *Goleman's 4 Domains of EQ* needs the most work in your organization (holistically)? How could you start building that domain in your organization?

(Optional) Use the SEE format for the question above

State: *The quadrant that needs the most work in my organization is:*

State: *I could build that domain by:*

Elaborate: *The reason for doing so is:* OR *In other words:*

Exemplify (examples): *For example, at work:*

Question 2: Considering the *Framing & Reframing* tool, what is a subject you have negative emotions or viewpoints of? How could you reframe the subject in a neutral or positive light? What are some of the benefits of doing so?

Question 3: Describe a situation in your organization requiring *emotional intelligence*. How could you employ the *tools or concepts* in this lesson in dealing with the situation?

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 3 Resources

Student Preparation:

Read the Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer

Complete: EQ Self-Assessment located in attachments of lesson primer

Watch: Emotional Intelligence and its four elements

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7wIf-2SaP1Y>

Additional Resources (for increased understanding):

Judger Learner Tool

<https://executiveeducation.wharton.upenn.edu/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/1706-Shifting-Mindsets.pdf>

Mind Tools Content Team. *Cognitive Restructuring, Reducing Stress by Changing Your Thinking*

<https://www.mindtools.com/aef000n/cognitive-restructuring>

Emotional Intelligence (and How to Get It): A Short Guide for Talent Professionals

https://uk.indeed.com/lead/why-emotional-intelligence-matters-for-talent-professionals?gclid=EAIaIQobChMIu4GZ5Y2rgQMvQ-bjBx1xPQphEAAYASAAEgJOrPD_BwE&acid=&gclsrc=aw.ds

Additional Emotional Intelligence Assessments

<https://globalleadershipfoundation.com/geit/eitest.html> (Based on Goleman's four quadrant EI Model)

<https://www.truity.com/test/emotional-intelligence-test>

Goleman D. (1998). *Working With Emotional Intelligence*

<https://archive.nytimes.com/www.nytimes.com/books/first/g/goleman-working.html>

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 4 Give & Take

Highest Domain: _____ Strategies to give: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ QUAD 1	Lowest Domain: _____ Strategies to take: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ QUAD 4
High Domain: _____ Strategies to give: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ QUAD 2	Low Domain: _____ Strategies to take: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ QUAD 3

Give

Take

Figure 6 - Give and Take Exercise

Using the EQ self-assessment homework assignment in this lesson primer, complete the quad charts according to your results.

Quad 1 - Students write their highest scoring domain.

Quad 2 - Students write their second highest scoring domain.

Quad 3 - Students write their second lowest scoring domain.

Quad 4 - Students write their lowest scoring domain.

Once you have identified each domain, list one or two strategies, tips or tools that reinforce the *two high domains*.

Ask: “How could I further develop this domain?” or “What could I tell others who want to develop this domain?”

Note: Quads 3 & 4 will be received (taken) from other students.

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 4 Give & Take

Give & Take (*Digital Option*)

Highest Domain: Strategies to Give: 	Lowest Domain: Strategies to Take:
High Domain: Strategies to Give: 	Low Domain: Strategies to Take:

Give **Take**

Using the EQ self-assessment homework assignment in this lesson primer, complete the quad charts according to your results.

Quad 1 - Students write their highest scoring domain.

Quad 2 - Students write their second highest scoring domain.

Quad 3 - Students write their second lowest scoring domain.

Quad 4 - Students write their lowest scoring domain.

Once you have identified each domain, list one or two strategies, tips or tools that reinforce the *two high domains*.

Ask: “*How could I further develop this domain?*” or “*What could I tell others who want to develop this domain?*”

Note: Quads 3 & 4 will be received (take) from other students.

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 5 Assessment

The Emotional Intelligence Quick Assessment (*complete prior to class*)

**Adapted from the San Diego City College MESA Program from a model by Paul Mohapel*

- Circle the appropriate response for each statement (0-4) in Sections 1-4
- Add your results in each section and record them in the section totals

Rank each statement as follows:

0 (Never) 1 (Rarely) 2 (Sometimes) 3 (Often) 4 (Always)

SECTION 1

My feelings are clear to me at any given moment.

Emotions play an important part in my life.

My moods impact the people around me.

I find it easy to put words to my feelings.

My moods are easily affected by external events.

I can easily sense when I'm going to be angry.

I readily tell others my true feelings.

I find it easy to describe my feelings.

Even when I'm upset, I'm aware of what's happening to me.

I am able to stand apart from my thoughts and feelings and examine them.

Never
Rarely
Sometimes
Often
Always

0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4

Section 1 Total:

SECTION 2

I accept responsibility for my reactions.

I find it easy to make goals and stick to them.

I am an emotionally balanced person.

I am a very patient person.

I can accept critical comments from others without becoming angry.

I maintain my composure, even during stressful times.

If an issue does not affect me directly, I don't let it bother me.

I can restrain myself when I feel anger towards someone.

I can control urges to overindulge in things that aren't good for me.

I direct my energy into creative work or hobbies.

0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	3	4

Section 2 Total:

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 5 Assessment

The Emotional Intelligence Quick Assessment *(cont.)*

- Circle the appropriate response for each statement (0-4) in Sections 1-4
- Add your results in each section and record them in the section totals

Rank each statement as follows:

0 (Never) 1 (Rarely) 2 (Sometimes) 3 (Often) 4 (Always)

Never
Rarely
Sometimes
Often
Always

SECTION 3

I consider the impact of my decisions on other people.	0	1	2	3	4
I can easily tell if the people around me are annoyed.	0	1	2	3	4
I sense it when a person's mood changes.	0	1	2	3	4
I am able to be supportive when giving bad news to others.	0	1	2	3	4
I am generally able to understand the way other people feel.	0	1	2	3	4
My friends can tell me personal things about themselves.	0	1	2	3	4
It genuinely bothers me to see other people suffer.	0	1	2	3	4
I usually know when to speak and when to be silent.	0	1	2	3	4
I care what happens to other people.	0	1	2	3	4
I understand when the plans of other people change.	0	1	2	3	4

Section 3 Total:

SECTION 4

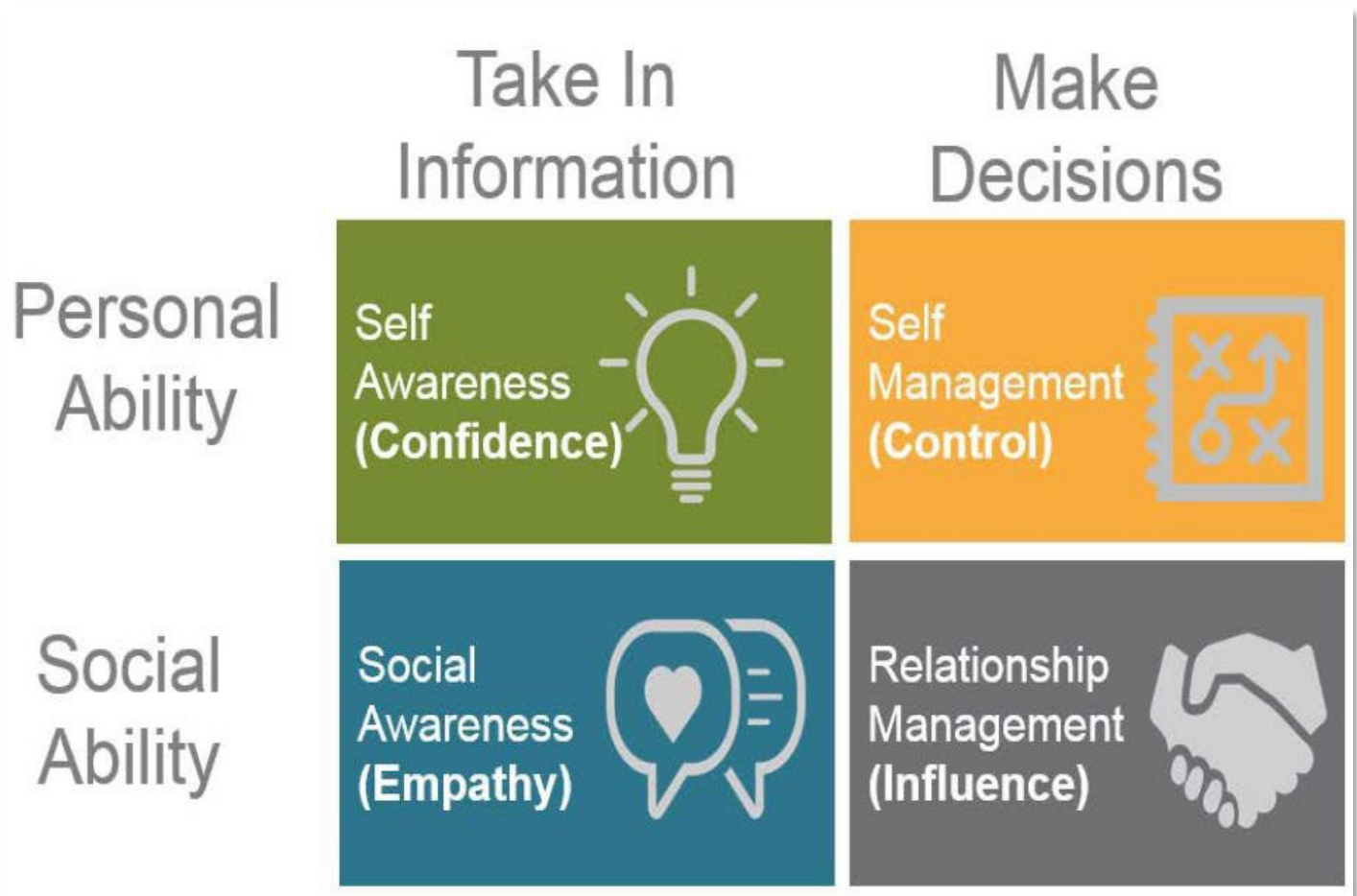
I am able to show affection.	0	1	2	3	4
My relationships are safe places for me.	0	1	2	3	4
I find it easy to share my deep feelings with others.	0	1	2	3	4
I am good at motivating others.	0	1	2	3	4
I am a fairly cheerful person.	0	1	2	3	4
It is easy for me to make friends.	0	1	2	3	4
People tell me I am sociable and fun.	0	1	2	3	4
I like helping people.	0	1	2	3	4
Others can depend on me.	0	1	2	3	4
I am able to calm someone down if they are very upset.	0	1	2	3	4

Section 4 Total:

The Emotionally Intelligent Leader Primer – Attachment 5 Assessment

- Using the results from each section, circle the ranges in Sections 1-4 below

EI Domain		Improvement Opportunity Consider Developing	Functionally Skilled Consider Reinforcing	Advanced Strength Consider Leveraging
Section 1	Emotional Self Awareness	0 - 24	25 - 34	35 - 40
Section 2	Emotional Self Management	0 - 24	25 - 34	35 - 40
Section 3	Emotional Social Awareness	0 - 24	25 - 34	35 - 40
Section 4	Relationship Management	0 - 24	25 - 34	35 - 40



Ethics vs. Morals

https://www.diffen.com/difference/Ethics_vs_Morals

Ethics and **morals** relate to “right” and “wrong” conduct. While they are sometimes used interchangeably, they are different: **ethics** refer to rules provided by an external source, e.g., codes of conduct in workplaces or principles in religions. **Morals** refer to an individual’s own principles regarding right and wrong.

Comparison chart

Ethics versus Morals comparison chart

	Ethics	Morals
What are they?	The rules of conduct recognized in respect to a particular class of human actions or a particular group or culture.	Principles or habits with respect to right or wrong conduct. While morals also prescribe dos and don'ts, morality is ultimately a personal compass of right and wrong.
Where do they come from?	Social system - External	Individual - Internal
Why we do it?	Because society says it is the right thing to do.	Because we believe in something being right or wrong.
Flexibility	Ethics are dependent on others for definition. They tend to be consistent within a certain context, but can vary between contexts.	Usually consistent, although can change if an individual’s beliefs change.
The "Gray"	A person strictly following Ethical Principles may not have any Morals at all. Likewise, one could violate Ethical Principles within a given system of rules in order to maintain Moral integrity.	A Moral Person although perhaps bound by a higher covenant, may choose to follow a code of ethics as it would apply to a system. "Make it fit"

Ethics versus Morals comparison chart

	Ethics	Morals
Origin	Greek word "ethos" meaning "character"	Latin word "mos" meaning "custom"
Acceptability	Ethics are governed by professional and legal guidelines within a particular time and place	Morality transcends cultural norms

Source of Principles

Ethics are external standards that are provided by institutions, groups, or [culture](#) to which an individual belongs. For example, lawyers, policemen, and doctors all have to follow an ethical code laid down by their profession, regardless of [their](#) own feelings or preferences. Ethics can also be considered a social system or a framework for acceptable behavior.

Morals are also influenced by culture or society, but they are personal [principles](#) created and upheld by individuals themselves.

Consistency and Flexibility

Ethics are very consistent within a certain context, but can vary greatly between contexts. [For example](#), the ethics of the medical [profession](#) in the 21st century are generally consistent and do not change from hospital to hospital, but they are different from the ethics of the 21st century legal profession.

An individual's moral code is usually unchanging and consistent across all contexts, but it is also possible for certain events to radically change an individual's personal beliefs and values.

Conflicts Between Ethics and Morals

One professional example of ethics conflicting with morals is the work of a defense attorney. A lawyer's morals may tell her that [murder](#) is reprehensible and that murderers should be punished, but her ethics as a professional lawyer, require her to defend her client to the best of her abilities, *even if she knows that the client is guilty*.

Another example can be found in the medical field. In most parts of the world, a doctor may not euthanize a patient, even at the patient's request, as per ethical standards for health professionals. However, the same doctor may *personally* believe in a patient's right to die, as per the doctor's own morality.

Origins

Much of the confusion between these two words can be traced back to their origins. For example, the word "ethic" comes from Old French (*etique*), Late Latin (*ethica*), and Greek (*ethos*) and referred to customs or moral philosophies. "Morals" comes from Late Latin's *moralis*, which referred to appropriate behavior and manners in society. So, the two have very similar, if not synonymous, meanings originally.

Morality and ethics of the individual have been [philosophically studied](#) for well over a thousand years. The idea of ethics being principles that are set and applied to a group (not necessarily focused on the individual) is relatively new, though, primarily dating back to the 1600s. The distinction between ethics and morals is particularly important for philosophical [ethicists](#).

Videos Explaining the Differences

The following video explains how ethics are [objective](#), while morals are subjective.

References

- [The Definition of Morality - Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy](#)
- [Ethics Definition - Dictionary.com](#)
- [Ethic Origins - Online Etymology Dictionary](#)
- [Moral Origins - Wiktionary](#)
- [Morals Definition - Dictionary.com](#)

Application of the Ethical Triangle in the 2014 Ebola Epidemic: A Case Study

by Katie Martinez and Marcos Martinez

I don't think that there could be any fair distribution of something which is available in such a small quantity.

**— Marie-Paul Kieny, Assistant Director General
of the World Health Organization**

Since 1976 there have been 25 Ebola outbreaks reported worldwide. Eight of these outbreaks occurred in the West Africa region.¹ Although recent drug research shows promising results, there are no approved vaccines or known curative therapies available. At the time of the 2014 Ebola outbreak, experimental Ebola therapies had not yet made it through human trials. The 2014 West Africa Ebola epidemic resulted in an international containment effort and expedited the research and development of experimental drugs and vaccines. However, the supply and availability of these experimental therapies were extremely limited. Two American aid workers were among the first to be treated with an experimental drug called ZMapp. The provision of this experimental drug to two Americans ignited international controversy over the ethical allocation of a limited supply of experimental treatment.

Background

The 2014 West Africa Ebola epidemic was the largest outbreak of the virus in history.² Initial outbreak estimates indicated 70 percent case-fatality rates; the World Health Organization

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(WHO) declared a “public health emergency of international concern.”³ The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) estimates more than 11,000 individuals died in West Africa during the 2014 Ebola crisis.⁴

Humans contract the Ebola virus from contact with the blood, skin, or bodily fluids of infected primates.⁵ Symptoms are relatively non-specific and include fever, headache, muscle pain, vomiting, diarrhea, fatigue, and unexplained hemorrhage.⁶ Left untreated, the Ebola virus typically results in death. There is currently no Food and Drug Administration (FDA) approved vaccine or curative therapy available for the Ebola virus.⁷ Treatment is focused on supportive care to allow the patient’s immune system to mount an adequate response to the virus.

During previous outbreaks, offering African patients drugs that had not been tested on humans or proven safe and effective for Ebola was considered unethical. One example of why this is considered unethical occurred in 1996 when Pfizer conducted a clinical trial of an experimental antibiotic in children during a meningitis outbreak in Nigeria.⁸ The Nigerian government and ethical council of Nigeria approved the provision of the experimental drug. However, Pfizer did not seek FDA approval because the clinical trial occurred outside the U.S.⁹

The use of this unproven experimental antibiotic was widely considered unethical for many reasons. Consent was not documented, there were charges that the patients were unaware that they were receiving experimental treatment, the medication had not been previously proven safe or effective in children, and some children receiving the therapy experienced complications or died as a result of receiving the medication.¹⁰ This Pfizer clinical trial conducted outside commonly accepted ethical guidelines is just one example of why using experimental therapies during disease outbreaks has historically been

considered unethical.

In August 2014, the WHO shifted its stance and declared that it was ethical to offer patients experimental treatments for the Ebola outbreak.¹¹ Due to the size and fatality rate of the 2014 West Africa outbreak, the consensus at the WHO was that the change in ethical guidelines was necessary to help contain the spread of the Ebola virus and reduce the fatality rate. Because these experimental treatments are not commercially made and available, the quantity and availability were limited, and not everyone infected with Ebola would receive them. This

During previous outbreaks, offering African patients drugs that had not been tested on humans or proven safe and effective for Ebola was considered unethical.

decision by the WHO led to a significant shift in the ongoing ethical debate about experimental drug use during a disease outbreak. The previous ethical question centered around the ethics of using experimental treatment during a disease outbreak. The WHO’s declaration that experimental treatment was ethical during the 2014 Ebola Crisis spawned a debate over a different ethical question: Who should receive the limited quantity of experimental drugs available during an epidemic?

In its statement declaring the shift in ethics regarding provision of experimental treatments, the WHO also issued a set of guidelines. One of these guidelines was a mandate to fairly distribute the scarce resource of experimental drugs.¹² The WHO acknowledged in its declaration that further ethical analysis and guidance would be needed to achieve this fair distribution.¹³ However, no further guidance to ensure ethical distribution of scarce experimental treatment was ever published by governing medical bodies

such as the WHO, CDC, or National Institutes of Health. There have been several authors who have provided ethical guidance for the allocation of a limited quantity of experimental drugs.¹⁴ However, none of these guidelines have been adopted by the international community.

ZMapp, the experimental drug for Ebola, garnered the most attention. Mapp Biopharmaceutical developed this experimental treatment in collaboration with the Public Health Agency of Canada, Defyrus, the U.S. Army Medical Research Institute of Infectious Diseases, and Kentucky BioProcessing.¹⁵ The

Further convoluting the ethical question of how to allocate experimental treatment is the question of who makes this determination.

Department of Defense has a long history of involvement in research surrounding infectious diseases such as Ebola.¹⁶ This involvement stems from the military's concern of diseases that could potentially impact the effectiveness and readiness of troops. Two American aid workers were among the first individuals to receive ZMapp. Questions soon arose over why Americans were the first to receive the experimental treatment over others infected with Ebola in West Africa. This led to a global debate over the ethical allocation of experimental treatments available in limited quantities. This question has proven challenging to answer.

Further convoluting the ethical question of how to allocate experimental treatment is the question of who makes this determination. When responding to the ethical questions that arose after the provision of ZMapp to the American aid workers, it was made clear that Mapp Biopharmaceutical's only role in the distribution of experimental treatment was to respond to requests for the treatment.¹⁷ With no agency

stepping forward to provide concrete guidelines to ensure fair distribution, the determination of who would receive experimental treatment fell largely to the government. For example, Liberia received the last three doses of ZMapp in August 2014, and it was left to its government to determine who should receive the doses.

The Ethical Triangle

The Ethical Triangle is a model that can be used when faced with an ethical dilemma (see Figure 1). This ethical model allows the user to test a course of action (COA) against three different ethical approaches: principles, virtues, and consequences.¹⁸ Although the Ethical Triangle was originally intended for use by an individual, it can also serve as a model beyond the individual level because it allows for the testing of complex ethical decisions through three different approaches. Applying the Ethical Triangle to a situation allows for greater understanding of complicated ethical decisions. A more complete understanding of an ethical dilemma leads to the development of a logical and ethically-justified solution.

A principles-based approach emphasizes making ethical decisions on universally-accepted rules that always apply. These rules are often referred to as maxims. This approach also takes into consideration one's moral obligation. With a principles-based ethical approach, there is little focus on the immediate effects of a decision. More consideration is given to universally-applicable maxims that apply in the situation. When using a principles-based approach, two key questions are considered: "What rules exist?" and "What are my moral obligations?"¹⁹

A consequences-based ethical approach can also be considered a utilitarian-based approach. A consequences-based ethical approach primarily considers the consequence(s) as part of the act itself.²⁰ A key tenet of this approach is to focus on what decision produces the greatest good for the greatest number of people.²¹ When

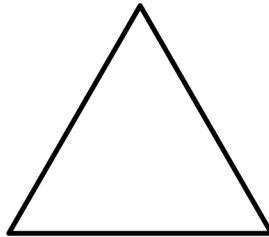
THE ETHICAL TRIANGLE

Principles

“Act as if the maxim of your action
was to become a
universal law of nature.”
What rules exist?
What is my moral obligation?

Consequences

“Do what produces the greatest
good for the greatest number.”
What gives the best “bang for the buck?”
Who wins and loses?



Virtues

Golden Rule: “Do to others what
you would have them do to you.”
What would Mom think? WWJD?
What if my actions show up on the front page?

Figure 1. The Ethical Triangle depicting three different approaches to an ethical dilemma.

Source: Source: Jack D. Kem. “Ethical Decision Making: Using the ‘Ethical Triangle,’”
Command and General Staff College, Fort Leavenworth, KS, August 2016.

using a consequences-based approach, two key questions are considered: “What gives the biggest bang for the buck?” and “Who wins and who loses?”

A virtues-based ethical approach focuses on making ethical decisions based on a set of requisite skills or virtues.²² Virtues are not innately known, but are instead learned from others and practiced.²³ A fundamental tenet of a virtues-based approach is the old axiom “do unto others what you would have them do unto you.”²⁴ When using a virtues-based approach, two key questions are considered: “What would my grandmother think?” or “What if my actions showed up as the lead story in the news?”

The Ethical Triangle provides an ethical model that brings together three very different ethical approaches. This three-dimensional approach provides greater insight into complex ethical decisions and ensures that the resulting answer is well-reasoned and ethically sound. Application of the Ethical Triangle will ensure that the allocation of a limited supply

of experimental drugs during an epidemic or pandemic is ethically sound.

Application of the Ethical Triangle to Experimental Drug Allocation

Application of the Ethical Triangle to the decision of experimental drug allocation is a six-step process (see Figure 2, page 38).

To demonstrate the validity of applying the Ethical Triangle to the allocation of experimental drugs during an epidemic or pandemic, this article uses a case study from the 2014 Ebola Crisis. The case study chosen occurred in August 2014 when Liberia received three doses of the experimental drug ZMapp. Although not yet tested in humans, the results of using this drug in animal trials showed promise in the treatment of Ebola. These were the last known available doses of this potentially lifesaving drug. This case study will look at how the Liberian government could have used the Ethical Triangle when determining how to allocate these doses of ZMapp.

The Ethical Triangle Decision Making Model

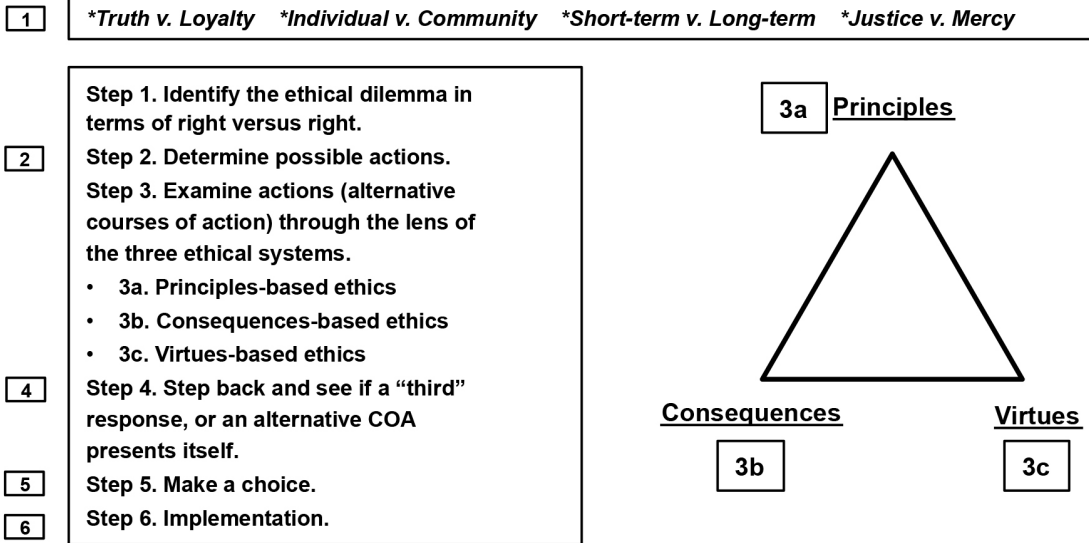


Figure 2. Depiction of the six-step process used when applying the Ethical Triangle to an ethical dilemma.

Source: Jack D. Kem. "Ethical Decision Making: Using the 'Ethical Triangle,'" Command and General Staff College, Fort Leavenworth, KS, August 2016.

Application of the Ethical Triangle: Step One

The first step is to identify the ethical dilemma.²⁵ This step is critical because identification of the ethical dilemma provides clarity and ensures that a predetermined decision is not made. As stated in the *Army Leadership Manual*, “Ethical choices may be between right and wrong, shades of gray or two rights.”²⁶ Using the Ethical Triangle, the ethical dilemma of allocation of experimental treatment is defined in terms of right versus right. There are four categories of right versus right dilemmas: truth versus loyalty, individual versus community, short-term versus long-term, and justice versus mercy.²⁷ Framing the ethical problem in this manner will allow testing of recommended actions.

It is critical to take into consideration relevant contextual factors when fully ascertaining the ethical dilemma. One important contextual factor is that the supply of the experimental treatment

is extremely limited. In our case study, only three doses of ZMapp are available. Because the number of patients infected with Ebola greatly outnumber the number of available ZMapp doses there are many individuals who will not receive the treatment. Cultural attitudes toward the receipt of experimental treatment should also be a consideration. Studies have shown that fear of treatment already exists in the Liberian population despite communication about the treatments.²⁸ When taking these contextual factors into account, the ethical dilemma can be stated as, “Who should the Liberian government select to receive the three doses of ZMapp for the Ebola virus?”

Application of the Ethical Triangle: Step Two

The second step is to determine the possible COAs or decisions that can be made.²⁹ Although there may be COAs which are obvious, such as doing nothing, it is critical that all COAs be considered. In this case study, after considering

all choices, three possible COAs are identified:

- COA 1 would be to provide ZMapp to those involved in the provision of healthcare to others infected with Ebola. The rationale for this COA is that healthcare workers provide supportive care to others infected with Ebola. Supportive care could contribute to additional lives saved. At first glance, this course may provide the “biggest bang for the buck.”
- COA 2 takes a more egalitarian approach. Everyone infected with Ebola, who could clinically benefit from the drug, would be entered into a lottery providing a truly equal chance of receiving ZMapp.
- COA 3, doing nothing is always COA. The Liberian government could take an all-or-nothing approach and choose not to provide the three remaining doses to anyone with the Ebola virus. While no action may seem like it wastes the limited supply of ZMapp, with thousands of people infected with Ebola, COA 3’s “do nothing” approach is one way to ensure equitable distribution. In other words, if no one is prioritized to receive the experimental treatment, then everyone is treated fairly with regards to the distribution of ZMapp.

Application of the Ethical Triangle: Step Three

The third step is to examine the two most likely COAs through the perspectives of the three ethical systems of the Ethical Triangle.³⁰ When considering the three courses of action identified in step two, the first and second courses of action are the two most likely. The first is prioritizing healthcare workers infected with Ebola to receive the experimental treatment. The second is conducting a lottery, which includes all individuals infected with Ebola, to determine who receives the three

ZMapp doses. We will examine these courses of action from a principles-based ethical approach, a consequences-based ethical approach, and a virtues-based ethical approach.

Principles-based approach

When looking at each COA through the lens of a principles-based approach, the focus is on universally accepted rules and one’s moral obligation. Two primary questions are asked to analyze each COA through a principles-based viewpoint: “What rules exist?” and “What are my moral obligations?”³¹ The answers to these questions will provide insight into the ethical ramifications of each COA from a principles-based ethical lens.

The first question when analyzing courses of action from a principles-based approach is “What rules exist?”

In general, there are commonly-accepted, egalitarian principles that require resources to be distributed to minimize inequality in any form.³² When conditions of scarcity and competition for resources exist, the principles of material distributive justice come into play.³³ There are six commonly agreed upon material distributive justice principles: to each person an equal share, to each person according to need, to each person according to effort, to each person according to contribution, to each person according to merit, and to each person according to free-market exchange.³⁴ Which of the six principles are applied varies depending on the context and nature of the situation.³⁵

- The principles of “to each person an equal share” and “to each person according to need” do not apply to this case study given that the thousands of patients with Ebola who need treatment greatly outnumbers the three doses of ZMapp available. There is no feasible way to provide each person an equal share, and the need was overwhelming in the 2014 Ebola outbreak.

- The principle of “to each person according to effort” refers to how much an individual “tries” in a society regardless of the outcome.³⁶ This rule is not applicable to the case study or the courses of action chosen due to the sheer volume of individuals needing this medication and the extremely limited supply.
- The principle of “to each person according to contribution” refers to the overall economic contribution of an individual to society and could be considered applicable in this case.³⁷
- The principle of “to each person according to merit,” which is distribution based on what each person deserves would only apply on a small scale in this case. For example, an individual in prison for having committed murder would arguably be less

...given the limited supply of ZMapp there is no feasible way to ensure that all citizens were provided equal treatment.

deserving of receiving a drug that was in limited supply than an individual who abides by the laws of society. However, given the scale of this Ebola outbreak, it is not practicable to distribute three doses of ZMapp based on merit.

- The principle of “each person according to free-market exchange” refers to a capitalist-type approach of supply and demand.³⁸ Given that there is a clear demand for a drug in limited supply in this case study, this principle is applicable. The supply of ZMapp in this case is limited, which inherently brings about competition for who will be selected to receive this potentially life-saving experimental treatment.

Choosing COA 1 violates the basic egalitarian principles of minimizing inequality by prioritizing a group of individuals (health care workers) above another (non-healthcare workers). It is also important to analyze COA 1 with the principles of distributive justice that apply to this case: to each person according to contribution and to each person according to free-market exchange. It appears that prioritizing healthcare workers supports the principle of “to each person according to contribution” by considering the healthcare workers’ current contribution to society. The healthcare workers provide necessary supportive care to other patients with Ebola, contributing to the saving of lives in Liberia. Prioritizing healthcare workers does not support the principle of “to each person according to free-market exchange.”

COA 2, a lottery including all Ebola patients, appears to better support egalitarian principles by minimizing inequality. A lottery does not support the two distributive justice principles that apply in this case which are: to each person according to contribution and according to free-market exchange. This COA essentially negates any form of consideration of a person’s contribution. It also does not allow for free-market distribution of ZMapp in this case.

The second question when analyzing COAs from a principles-based approach is “What are my moral obligations?”

Inherently, one’s moral obligations would be to treat all individuals as equal. In this case, the Liberian government is the decisionmaker, and the state’s moral obligation is to ensure that all its citizens are provided equal treatment and have equal access.³⁹ Regardless of which COA we are looking at, given the limited supply of ZMapp there is no feasible way to ensure that all citizens were provided equal treatment. However, equal access to treatment could also be considered a moral obligation. A third moral obligation should also be considered and that is the obligation of the Liberian government to save as many lives

as possible.

COA 1, which prioritizes healthcare workers does not align with the moral obligation of ensuring equal access for all citizens to ZMapp. If the experimental treatments save the lives of the healthcare workers, then arguably additional lives will be saved because of those healthcare workers continuing to provide care to other Ebola patients. While this may border on a consequences-based ethical approach, it still supports the moral obligation that the Liberian government should save as many of its citizens lives as possible.

COA 2, a lottery, would better ensure equal access to treatment. With no established prioritization, everyone is given a fair shot at receiving ZMapp. This COA firmly supports the moral obligation of the Liberian government to ensure that all its citizens are provided equal access to treatment. COA 2 does not support the moral obligation that the Liberian government should save as many lives as possible.

From a principles-based ethical approach, there are arguments for both COAs. Prioritization of healthcare workers supports the widely-accepted distributive just principle “to each person according to contribution.” It also supports the moral obligation that the Liberian government should save as many lives as possible. COA 2 supports the moral obligation of the Liberian government is to provide equal civilian access to treatment. COA 2 also supports the egalitarian principle of minimizing inequality. Following a principles-based approach, it appears that both COAs are on relatively equal ethical footing. However, there are still two other ethical approaches to take into consideration when deciding between these two COAs.

Consequences-based approach

When looking at each COA through the lens of a consequences-based ethical approach, the focus is on the consequences of the action. This

analysis can be challenging especially when considering all the potential second and third-order effects.⁴⁰ For this case study, we will be asking two primary questions to analyze each COA: “What gives the biggest bang for the buck?” and “Who wins and who loses?”

“Bang for the buck” in this case study centers on the number of lives saved and containment of the Ebola outbreak.

The first question when analyzing COAs from a consequences-based approach is, “What gives the biggest bang for the buck?”

In this case study, it is important to consider this question from the perspective of the Liberian government. They are primarily concerned with the containment of this Ebola crisis to protect the health and welfare of its citizens and ensure the survival of the country. “Bang for the buck” in this case study centers on the number of lives saved and containment of the Ebola outbreak.

COA 1, which prioritizes healthcare workers to receive ZMapp, potentially results in lives saved of healthcare workers. These healthcare workers can further aid in the management of the Ebola crisis and save additional lives. Given that the focus of the Liberian government is the health and welfare of its citizens, this COA potentially provides more than just three lives saved from the initial ZMapp doses.

COA 2, a lottery for determining who receives ZMapp, will most likely save the lives of only the individuals selected to receive ZMapp. When considering “bang for the buck,” those chosen from the lottery will most likely not be healthcare workers. Therefore, the assumption is that number of lives saved will most likely be only the three individuals that receive ZMapp, and that those individuals who receive ZMapp will not directly aid in the containment of the Ebola outbreak.

The second question when analyzing COAs from a consequences-based approach is “Who wins and who loses?” From the perspective of the Liberian government, the focus on who wins and who loses centers around the containment of this Ebola crisis and the protection of the health and welfare of Liberian citizens to ensure the survival of the country. To “win” lives need to be saved, and the Ebola crisis needs to be contained.

From the perspective of the Liberian government, the focus on who wins and who loses centers around the containment of this Ebola crisis and the protection of the health and welfare of Liberian citizens...

At first glance, it appears that with COA 1 it is just the healthcare workers receiving ZMapp who win, and all others not prioritized for treatment lose. However, if the healthcare workers survive because of their treatment and continue to provide care to other Ebola patients, then those that receive care are “secondary” winners. With COA 1, it is likely that there will be more “winners” than just the three workers. Providing care to patients will help contribute to the containment of Ebola. Both the secondary winners and contributions to the containment of the Ebola outbreak translates to a win for the Liberian government due to the focus on the health and welfare of its citizens and containment of the Ebola outbreak. However, the Liberian government may lose trust with its citizens if perception of fair treatment with ZMapp is lacking.

COA 2, a lottery for determining who receives ZMapp, reveals a different set of winners and losers. The three individuals who receive ZMapp are winners; however, it is unlikely that there will be any “secondary” winners as in COA 1. Arguably another winner

with COA 2 is the Liberian government. COA 2, which does not prioritize any individuals, may help in maintaining the people’s trust by proving that the government fairly considered all its citizens for treatment.

Based on the analysis above, COA 1 better aligns with a consequences-based ethical approach. Prioritization of healthcare workers provides the biggest “bang for the buck” by having the potential to result in more lives saved than just those with the three initial ZMapp doses. COA 1 also leads to more individuals who “win” when looking at “secondary winners.” Following a consequences-based approach, it appears that COA 1 is more ethically sound. However, there is still one other ethical approach to take into consideration when deciding between these two COAs.

Virtues-based approach

When looking at each COA through the lens of a virtues-based approach, the focus is on what a virtuous person would do.⁴¹ For a virtues-based ethical approach the two questions typically considered are “What would my grandmother think?” and “What if my actions showed up as the lead story in the news?” These questions are more fitting for an individualized approach, so for this case study we will be using a broader question to analyze each COA: “What if the decision appears as the lead story in the news?”

The question of “What if the decision appears as the lead story in the news?” is important for the Liberian government to consider.

It is important that the decision made is one that the Liberian people and global community regards as virtuous.

COA 1, which prioritizes healthcare workers, would most likely appear as the lead story in the news as not a virtuous decision. We can say this with relative certainty because when two American healthcare workers were prioritized to receive ZMapp, it was portrayed as an unethical

decision. The reason it was viewed as unethical is because it appeared to prioritize individuals based on their status as healthcare workers over equally deserving Liberians impacted by Ebola.⁴² However, a better characterization of this would be that it was not an ethical decision from a virtues-based, ethical decision-making lens. Prioritizing individuals based on any criteria, be it social status, financial status, or job status went against our commonly-held and accepted set of virtues.

COA 2, a lottery to determine who receives ZMapp, may be regarded as the more virtuous choice. It does not prioritize individuals based on any criteria and affords everyone an equal chance. COA 2 would most likely be portrayed in a positive manner as a sound ethical decision if it were to be the lead story in the news. Treating all humans as equal aligns with the global societies espoused set of virtues.

Based on the analysis above, COA 2 better aligns with a virtues-based ethical approach. By not prioritizing any individual based on job or status, this COA best adheres to the principle of “do unto others as you would have them do unto you.” Following a virtues-based approach, it appears that COA 2 is more ethically sound.

Application of the Ethical Triangle: Step four

The fourth step is to revisit all potential COAs again and see if an alternative COA has presented itself. The reason for revisiting COAs again is that during step three, another solution outside of the two selected COAs may have presented itself. In this case study, only one additional COA presented itself.

During the application of a principles-based ethical approach, one principle of distributive justice “to each according to free-market exchange” revealed another COA not previously considered. This COA would be allocation of ZMapp based on an individual’s ability to pay. In other words, true supply and demand principles,

where ZMapp would go to the highest bidder. However, because this capitalistic approach would not be considered an ethical COA among the global community, it was not considered further in this case study.

Prioritizing individuals based on any criteria, be it social status, financial status, or job status went against our commonly-held and accepted set of virtues.

Application of the Ethical Triangle: Step Five

The fifth step is to make a choice based on the analysis conducted in steps one through four. When making a choice, it is important that the context of the organizational climate and culture as well as the professional values of the organization are taken into consideration. In this case study, the Liberian government values the health and welfare of all citizens above other interests. From a principles-based approach, both COAs appear to be on equal ethical footing. From a consequences-based approach, COA 1 was a clear choice. From a virtues-based approach, COA 2 was a clear choice. Given that the Liberian government must consider all citizens, and a virtues-based approach tends to be more individualistic, more weight was given to the consequences and principles-based ethical approaches when making a final decision in this case study. Based on the ethical analysis above, COA 1, prioritizing health care workers to receive ZMapp, is the COA that should be chosen.

Application of the Ethical Triangle: Step Six

The sixth and final step is implementation of the choice.⁴³ After working through the previous five steps, the decision for allocation

of experimental treatment has been examined from multiple ethical angles and is well reasoned. Three healthcare workers with Ebola, who meet the necessary clinical parameters, should be given ZMapp. In this case study, this is exactly what the Liberian government chose to do.⁴⁴

Military Application

As evidenced by the collaboration involved in the development of the drug ZMapp, the U.S. military is often involved in the research and development of experimental therapies. However, with regards to the distribution of experimental therapies, military leaders are more likely to function as advisors when allocation decisions are made or implementers of allocation decisions. Although the decision for how to allocate experimental treatment will more than likely continue to fall to the state, for military leaders to effectively implement the treatment allocation decisions, it is crucial that there is an understanding of the ethical reasoning process used to make these decisions.

Conclusion

In the event of another epidemic or pandemic without a curative therapy available, the need to use experimental treatments could occur again. Given the ethical implications that arise with allocation of these experimental treatments with scarce availability, we recommend the deciding authority apply the Ethical Triangle to assist in determining the allocation of experimental drugs. Application of the Ethical Triangle will lead to a well-reasoned ethical approach to a situation that has shades of gray or two “right” answers. Additionally, when implementing the decision, it allows the decision-making authority to better articulate and maintain transparency with the community regarding the ethical reasoning that led to the decision that was made. The Ethical Triangle is a useful tool in ensuring that the allocation of a limited supply of experimental drugs during an epidemic or pandemic is ethically sound. **IAJ**

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Ethical Decision Making: Using the “Ethical Triangle”

Dr. Jack D. Kem

*Doing the right thing is good. Doing the right thing
for the right reason and with the right goal is better.*

ADRP 6-22, *Army Leadership*, para 3-27

Background

In May 1968 soldiers of Charlie Company, 11th Infantry Brigade of the Americal Division entered the village of My Lai in Vietnam and within three hours over 500 civilians had been massacred. This horrible memory of the United States Army at war was again remembered in 2004 as the case of the Abu Ghraib prison in Iraq exposed atrocities that were an embarrassment for the military. The war in Iraq also had a number of high profile cases that related to ethical behavior, such as the court-martial for six reservists who had “scrounged” vehicles to deliver supplies to troops in the field and the scene of a marine reacting to a perceived threat and subsequently killing an unarmed Iraqi prisoner in a mosque in Fallujah. In recent years, misconduct of senior officers has also received notoriety and embarrassment to the military.

In all of these cases, the public has had widely different opinions of how to treat the military involved in the incidents. For Lieutenant Calley and those involved in My Lai, many in the public viewed the actions of Charlie Company as understandable because of the nature of the war in 1968 – everyone seemed to be the enemy, and the “search and destroy” missions of that time were based upon intelligence that indicated the enemy was using hamlets such as My Lai for refuge. As a result, the punishment for all of those involved in My Lai was very light or nonexistent; Lieutenant Calley was the only one convicted but he only served three days in prison and was pardoned by President Nixon after serving three and a half years on “house arrest.”¹ For the cases in Iraq, the reaction was mixed in the public, from widespread support for the Marine in Fallujah and the reservists who “scrounged” vehicles, to disgust at the Abu Ghraib cases and calls for courts-martial for senior officials.

These highly publicized cases admittedly involve only a small portion of the military, but have had an impact on the culture and climate of the military. These ethical issues indicate a need for a closer look at the ethical reasoning and decision making processes of the military. This article will briefly discuss the current doctrinal approach for ethical reasoning in the Army, followed by an alternative approach for ethical decision making.

The Army’s Current Approach to Ethical Reasoning

The United States Army prides itself on being a “value-based” institution with the admonition in its doctrine to “do what is right.” In the Army’s leadership manual, it states that “Leaders draw from deep-rooted values and professional competence to demonstrate resolve to do what is right at the right time for the right reason.”² The manual continues by stating the “Leaders of integrity do the right thing because their character permits nothing less. To instill the Army Values in others, leaders must demonstrate them.”³ The leadership manual continues with

the list of “values” that define character for soldiers using the acronym *LDRSHIP*: loyalty, duty, respect, selfless service, honor, integrity, and personal courage.⁴

The Army’s current leadership manual contains a relatively short section on the subject of Ethical Reasoning. The description of Ethical Reasoning starts with the following:

*To be an ethical leader requires more than knowing the Army Values. Leaders must be able to apply them to find moral solutions to diverse problems. Ethical reasoning must occur during the operations process. Leaders consider ethics in planning, preparing, executing, and assessing operations.*⁵

*Ethical choices may be between right and wrong, shades of gray, or two rights. Some problems center on an issue requiring special consideration of what is most ethical. Leaders use multiple perspectives to think about ethical concerns, applying the following perspectives to determine the most ethical choice. One perspective comes from the view that desirable virtues such as courage, justice, and benevolence define ethical outcomes. A second perspective comes from the set of agreed-upon values or rules, such as the Army Values or Constitutional rights. A third perspective bases the consequences of the decision on whatever produces the greatest good for the greatest number as most favorable.*⁶

*Army leaders are expected to do the right things for the right reasons. It is why followers count on their leaders to be more than just technically and tactically proficient. They rely on them to make ethical decisions. Determining what is right and ethical can be difficult.*⁷

The Army’s leadership manual continues by stating that “ethical reasoning is complex in practice” and “no formula will work every time.” The last paragraph of the Ethical Reasoning section states:

*Ethical reasoning is complex in practice. If time allows in particularly ill-defined situations, using concepts from the Army Design Methodology (see ADRP 5-0) can help to frame the right problem and consider ethical implications in detail. Resolving ethical problems requires critical thinking based on the Army Values. No formula will work every time. By embracing the Army Values to govern personal actions, developing an understanding of regulations and orders, learning from experiences, and applying ethical reasoning, leaders will be better prepared to face tough decisions.*⁸

Unfortunately, these passages from the Army’s leadership manual does not provide a lot of guidance on how to address ethical issues, other than to embrace the Army Values. Although I agree that all Soldiers should embody the Army Values, the term itself is problematic. These traits of loyalty, duty, respect, selfless service, honor, integrity, and personal courage are more properly thought of as *virtues*. None of the Army Values is more important than the others; all Soldiers are expected to embody all of these traits as part of their character. Values, however, indicate a relative worth or importance – we value a quarter more than a dime; a quarter has more “value” than the dime. In fact, the Army’s leadership manual describes the virtues-based approach as an ethical perspective that “comes from the view that desirable virtues such as

courage, justice, and benevolence define ethical outcomes.”⁹ We will discuss more about virtues and the “virtues-based approach to ethics” later.

Defining the Ethical Dilemma

The Army’s leadership manual also states that “Ethical choices may be between right and wrong, shades of gray, or two rights.”¹⁰ Let’s look at this in detail.

When an ethical choice is between right and wrong, deciding what to do is more of an issue of moral courage to do what is right. If the choice is this clear, it should not pose a problem for leaders of character. Dr. Donald “Ducky” Mallard (David McCallum) in the CBS television series “NCIS,” stated that “The ethical man knows he shouldn’t cheat on his wife, whereas the moral man actually wouldn’t.” As this clearly shows, ethics is the study of what is right and wrong; morality is concerned with the issue of “what should be.”¹¹

Determining what is the ethical or moral thing to do when the choices are between shades of gray or between two rights is much more difficult. This is the case of ethical dilemmas – when virtues come into conflict with each other, or when you have to make a choice that either upholds one “right virtue” or another “right virtue.” Ethical dilemmas essentially consist of competing virtues that we consider important, but which we cannot simultaneously honor.¹²

To bring clarity to an ethical dilemma, it is useful to define the problem – the ethical dilemma – in terms of a “right versus right” conflict. There are four common “right versus right” dilemmas that can be used to define the problem – truth versus loyalty, individual versus community, short term versus long term, and justice versus mercy.¹³ Defining ethical dilemmas in these terms is difficult at first, but this process helps to define the problem and set up the testing of the problem against ethical standards. To define a problem in terms of “right versus wrong” either defines a problem that isn’t an ethical dilemma – or, worse yet, pre-defines the solution to the problem since one virtue or value is stated in a positive way while the other virtue or value is stated in a negative way.

Four Common “Right versus Right” Ethical Dilemmas

- Truth versus Loyalty
- Individual versus Community
- Short term versus Long term
- Justice versus Mercy

Figure 1. Common Ethical Dilemmas

The Army’s leadership manual states that “leaders will be better prepared to face tough decisions” by “embracing the Army Values to govern personal actions, developing an understanding of regulations and orders, learning from experiences, and applying ethical reasoning.”¹⁴ Knowing the Army Values, understanding the rules, and drawing from experience should not give a predetermined answer to an ethical dilemma. Before developing possible courses of action, “defining the problem” in terms of the ethical dilemma (right versus right) should be done first. After defining the ethical dilemma, an analysis of potential “courses of

action” or action choices should then be made. Based upon an analysis of an ethical dilemma, there will normally be two obvious courses of action; to do something or to not do something. Keeping these two options in mind – while being open to a possible, unthought-of alternative ‘third choices’ (such as ‘win-win’ possibilities or no decision at all), should help set the stage for testing the actions that appear to be obvious.

Three Alternative Bases for Ethics

Once an actor has defined the problem in terms of ‘right versus right’ and identified the obvious courses of action, these courses of action should be tested against three completely different criteria for ethical decision making. They are: rules or principles-based approach; utilitarian or consequences-based approach; and virtues-based approach. These are the three basic schools of thought for ethics – the “ethical triangle” – which are worthy of further study for clarification.

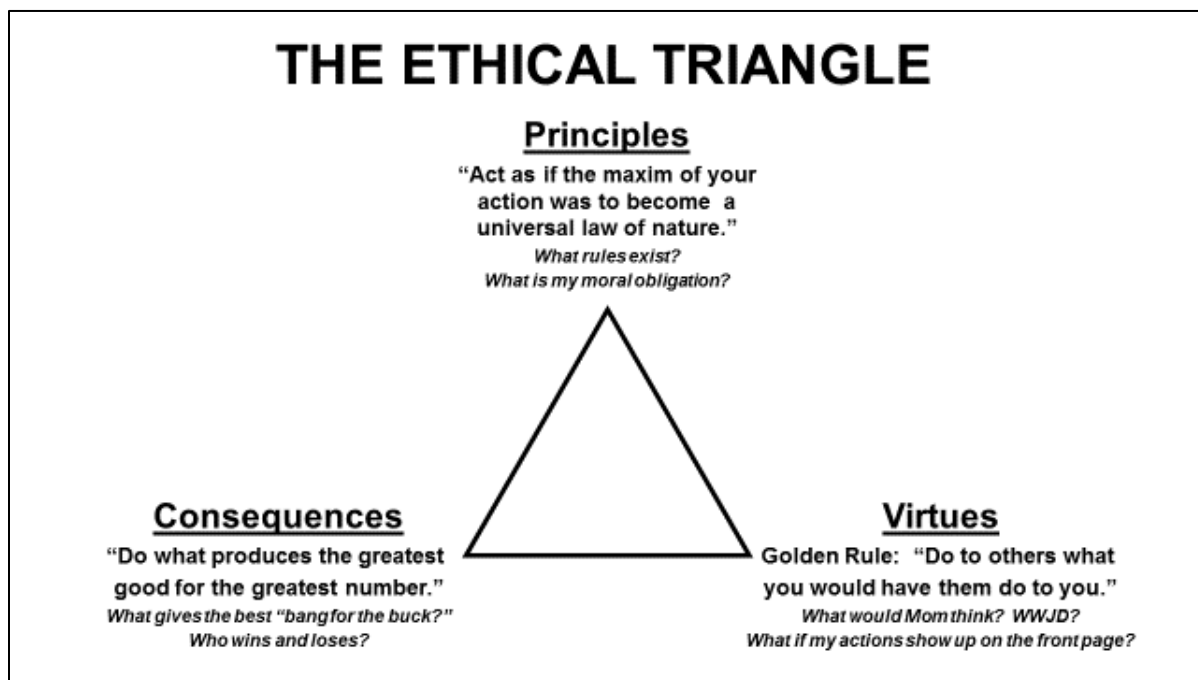


Figure 2. The “Ethical Triangle”

The Ethical Triangle: The ethical triangle considers these three different approaches to ethical reasoning. As the Army’s leadership manual states, “Leaders use multiple perspectives to think about ethical concerns, applying the following perspectives to determine the most ethical choice. One perspective comes from the view that desirable virtues such as courage, justice, and benevolence define ethical outcomes. A second perspective comes from the set of agreed-upon values or rules, such as the Army Values or Constitutional rights. A third perspective bases the consequences of the decision on whatever produces the greatest good for the greatest number as most favorable.¹⁵ The ethical triangle considers these three different perspectives.

There are a number of questions that could be asked about these three perspectives: Which of the ethical philosophies are the most useful – rules or principles-based ethics,

utilitarian or consequences-based ethics, or virtues-based ethics? Which one of the philosophies is the best fit for human behavior? All three appear to have some merit; all three can be used for decision-making as “distinct filters that reveal different aspects of a situation requiring an ethical choice.”¹⁶ To only consider one of the different theoretical bases runs the risk of being one-sided in analysis. Whether principles, consequences, or virtues provide the true reasons for ethical decision-making, all three of the theories and their lineage are useful for gaining insight into the complexity of ethical decision making.

Principles-based ethics: Principles, or rule-based ethics, has one primary philosopher that rises as the strongest voice – Immanuel Kant. Principle-based ethics is defined in many ways, but one general definition is that one should not act according to the consequences of an action, but instead according to agreed-upon or settled values and principles.¹⁷ Kant states that “the moral worth of an action does not lie in the effect in which is expected from it or in any principle of action which has to borrow its motive from this expected effect.”¹⁸ From this emphasis on moral worth – regardless of the consequences of actions – Kant derives one categorical imperative: “Act as if the maxim of your action was to become a universal law of nature.” Morality is found in following rules that are absolute with no exceptions, come what may – and by following this imperative, society and individuals will be better off.¹⁹ Man knows, in Kant’s view, what is right and moral and merely has to choose to do what is right – just as he would have others do in the same situation.

Thomas Hobbes’ social contract theory did not go as far as Kant in his philosophy of following rules without exception, but is generally accepted as a principles or rules-based approach. Hobbes’ view was that people have a common knowledge of natural laws – of the principles that all should understand. His writings described the theory that there is a “natural law” in which man’s nature is determined by the sum of all his experiences and abilities – yet as a result of these experiences there is a common understanding of what is right and wrong. Hobbes defines natural law, or a law of nature, as “a precept or general rule, found out by reason, by which a man is forbidden to do what is destructive of his life or takes away of preserving the same...”²⁰ Because of this common understanding, written laws and agreements in society should be based upon a rational self-interest to benefit all for a peaceful society. Knowing these common laws, coupled with mutual trust in others, provides an incentive for all to cooperate in a consistent, principled manner.

When looking at ethical dilemmas through the ‘lens’ of principles, or rule-based ethics, consideration must be made for the rules that exist – or should exist. The consequences of actions are not considered – but the principles related to the actions one makes in response to the ethical dilemma. Kant’s categorical imperative, “Act as if the maxim of your action was to become a universal law of nature,” should help to focus the decisions made using this approach. The key questions to ask when considering the principles or rules-based approach would be “what rules exist” and “what are my moral obligations?”

Consequences-based ethics: The second general basis for ethics is consequences-based ethics, or utilitarianism, which is closely aligned with the philosopher John Stuart Mill. Ethical decisions determined under this basis are made on the likely consequences or results of the actions. “Decisions are judged by their consequences depending on the results to be maximized –

security, happiness, pleasure, dignity, and the like.”²¹ The utility of an action, or how that action produces happiness, is “the ultimate appeal on all ethical questions” that is “grounded on the permanent interests of man” according to Mill.²²

Both Georg W.F. Hegel and David Hume are considered utilitarians. Hume is considered to be an ethical subjectivist, which holds that right and wrong are relative to the attitudes of each individual – morality is a matter of sentiment rather than fact.²³ Hegel emphasized the consequences of actions as a part of the actions themselves.²⁴ He stated the principle “judge an act by its consequences, and make them the standard of what is right and good,” which, according to Hegel, provides the basis for law.

*... by the theft of a bread a property is no doubt injured. Still, if the act was the means of prolonging life, it would be wrong to consider it as ordinary theft. If the man whose life is in danger were not allowed to preserve himself, he would be without rights; and since his life is refused him, his whole freedom is denied to him also... Hence only the need of the immediate present can justify a wrong act. Yet the act is justified, because the agent, abstaining from it, would commit the highest wrong, namely, the total negation of his realized freedom.*²⁵

Friedrich Nietzsche may also be considered a utilitarian, but a flawed utilitarian – a hedonistic, selfish utilitarian. Nietzsche provides perhaps the most disturbing theory of ethics – not only because of its implications for society, but because of its apparent appeal to many. Nietzsche did not believe that there is a universal definition of a “good man,” but instead each man should be different with different traits.²⁶ Nietzsche defines “good” not in terms of a person’s relationship with others, but rather in terms of the person’s relationship to himself. He writes that ethical philosophers look for good in the wrong place: “the judgment ‘good’ does not originate with those to whom the good has been done. Rather it was the ‘good’ themselves, that is to say the noble, mighty, highly placed, and high-minded who decreed themselves and their actions to be good....”²⁷

When looking at ethical dilemmas through the ‘lens’ of consequences-based ethics, or utilitarianism, consideration must be made for who wins and who loses – the consequences of actions are the prime considerations. John Stuart Mill should help to focus the decisions made using this approach: “Do what produces the greatest good for the greatest number.” Key questions to ask when considering the consequences-based ethics or utilitarianism would be “what gives the biggest bang for the buck” and “who wins and loses?”

Virtues-based ethics: Plato and Aristotle provided the first ethics theory – virtue, or in today’s political language, “character matters.” The focus in virtue ethics is not on “what one should do” but rather “what kind of person should one be?” Good character, or virtues, is central to virtue theory.²⁸ According to Plato, men must be given the right instruction on what is good: “... given the right instruction, it must grow to the full flower of excellence; but if a plant is sown and reared in the wrong soil, it will develop every contrary defect.”²⁹ Morality and virtue are skills learned from others – not theoretical knowledge, but knowledge put into practice.³⁰

Aristotle emphasized virtue as desirable for society so that all may become good citizens and law-abiding people. This human goodness is not goodness of body, but of the soul. Aristotle describes virtues in two categories: intellectual and moral. For example, Wisdom and Understanding are considered intellectual virtues, while Liberality and Temperance are moral virtues. All of these virtues are gained through knowledge and application of the virtues – by exercising and actually doing virtuous acts.³¹

Virtues-based ethics differs from principles-based and consequences-based ethics in several basic ways. First, virtue based ethics is based upon learning from others rather than by the individual coming to the realization of what is ethical; this process is learned from others. Second, in applying principles-based and consequences-based ethics, there is a right answer and a wrong answer. For example, in Kantian principles-based ethics, your actions are guided by what is or should be the law for everyone; in consequences-based ethics, your actions are guided by what gives the greatest benefit to the greatest number.

In virtues-based ethics, it's not that easy – there is a middle ground known as the *golden mean*. Virtues, by their very nature, have to be applied in a judicious manner. For example, it is necessary to have confidence, but one can have an excess of confidence (rashness) or a defect of confidence (cowardice); the *golden mean* of confidence is courage. One can have an excess of shame (bashfulness), a defect of shame (shamelessness), and a *golden mean* of modesty.³² Learning how to have the *golden mean* of a particular attribute is a lifetime endeavor, learned from others and experience.

When looking at ethical dilemmas through the “lens” of virtues-based ethics, consideration must be made for what a virtuous person would do. The Golden Rule can be used to focus the decisions made using this approach: “Do to others what you would have them do to you.” Key questions to ask when considering virtues-based ethics would be “what would my mom think?” or “what if my actions showed up on the front page of the newspaper?” For some, the question could be the popular question among some Christians of “what would Jesus do?”

Using the Ethical Triangle for Ethical Decision Making

Now that we have discussed how to define an ethical dilemma in terms of right versus right, have considered potential courses of action or action choices, and have understood the different ethical perspectives that are used in the ethical triangle, it is time to put it all together in a model for ethical decision making. The steps in this approach are:

- Define the problem (ethical dilemma) in terms of right vs. right
- Consider alternative courses of action or action choices
- Test the courses of action against the “ethical triangle”
 1. Principles-based ethics
 2. Consequences-based ethics
 3. Virtues-based ethics
- Consider additional alternative courses of action (such as ‘win-win’ possibilities or no decision)
- Choose the course of action or action choice
- Implement the course of action

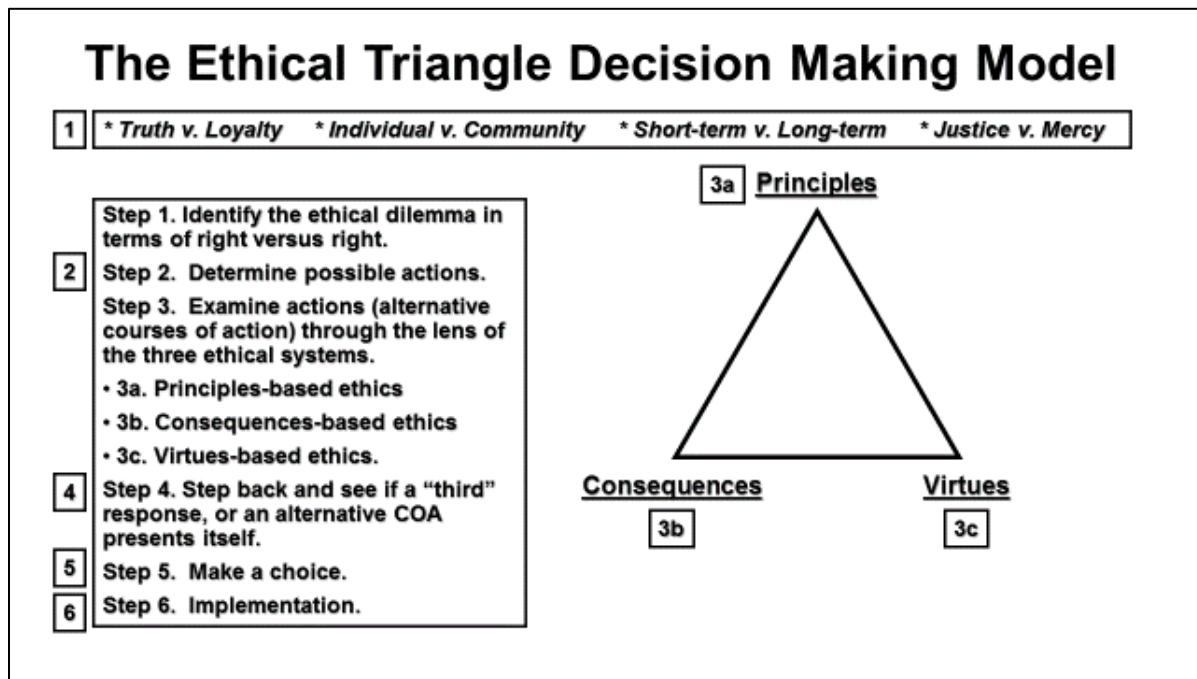


Figure 3. The “Ethical Triangle” Ethical Decision Making Model with Steps

The first step is to identify the problem, the ethical dilemma, in terms of right versus right. Again, this is necessary to provide clarity to the dilemma while ensuring that a predetermined decision is not made. The four dilemmas listed cover just about every ethical dilemma – and some ethical situations may include one or more of the dilemmas. Stating the problem in this format will help to test the actions that should be taken.

The second step, as mentioned earlier, is to determine the possible actions. There will probably be two obvious responses – to do or not do some action. Of course, this is not the dilemma – these courses of actions are responses to the dilemma. It is important during this step to realize and even hope for a possible alternative third response to the dilemma.

The third step is to examine the two most apparent alternative courses of action through the lens of the three ethical systems. The most methodical means to do that is to first look through principles-based ethics, then consequences-based ethics, and finally through virtues-based ethics. Generally, the principles will be relatively easy, while the consequences will not be as easy – particularly when you look at all of the potential second- and third-order effects of actions. Because virtues-based ethics uses discretion to determine the “golden mean,” it can serve as the integrating approach to ethics.

The fourth step is to step back and see if a “third” response, or an alternative course of action has presented itself (such as ‘win-win’ possibilities or no decision at all). Going through the process may indicate that there is another answer rather than the two courses of action initially determined. This will not always be true, but it’s best to step back and see if there is another alternative.

The fifth step is that a choice has to be made. That choice should be made based upon an analysis using all three of the ethical systems – but, in the end, the choice is also made in the context of the organizational climate and culture, as well as the professional values of the organization.

The final step is implementation. This is where the rubber meets the road; by this time, the choice should be well thought out. The judgments that military leaders at all ranks make on a daily basis – especially in combat – imply a necessary level of discretion in determining the “right thing to do” in ethical decision making.³³ Military leaders are more than implementers of policy, but are also charged with “support for the realization of democratic principles” and commitment to obeying the law.³⁴ This is particularly true when decisions need to be made quickly and involve lives – and when there is no “top cover” guaranteed for the decisions made. Due to the nature of warfare today, the high level of discretion for ethical choices will be made by leaders at all levels (officers and non-commissioned officers) of military leadership. Putting ethical decisions into action requires moral character.

Heinz and the Druggist

Let me provide an example to work through the ethical decision making model. This scenario is a common scenario that is used in many tests for moral development.³⁵

A woman was near death from a unique kind of cancer. There is a drug that might save her. The drug costs \$4,000 per dosage. The sick woman's husband, Heinz, went to everyone he knew to borrow the money and tried every legal means, but he could only get together about \$2,000. He asked the doctor scientist who discovered the drug for a discount or let him pay later. But the doctor scientist refused.

Should Heinz break into the laboratory to steal the drug for his wife?

The first step in the “Ethical Triangle EDMM” is to identify the problem, the ethical dilemma, in terms of right versus right. One possible answer would be the issue of individual versus community. Heinz has an obligation to do what he can for his wife (individual), but he also has an obligation to uphold community laws. Another possible answer would be long term versus short term. Heinz wants to save his wife as a short term immediate answer, but he should also be concerned that the price of the drug doesn’t go up (because of theft) so that others will be saved in the long term.

For the second step, Heinz has tried a number of possible courses of action, such as trying to borrow the money and asking for discounts. He has only two obvious answers at this point – break into the laboratory or not break into the laboratory and watch his wife die. At this point, he does not see any other alternatives.

The third step is to test his courses of action against the different ‘lens’ of the ethical triangle. He follows these in order: principles-based ethics, consequences-based ethics, and virtues-based ethics.

The principles-based answer is relatively easy. The law says that he should not break in; and even if the law didn't say that, he would have a moral obligation to respect the property of the scientist. He would expect others to respect his right to property as well. He has an obligation to do what he can for his wife, but he considers the fact that as a moral actor, he isn't the one killing his wife, nor is it the druggist – it's the cancer. If he broke into the laboratory, he would be the actor. From a principles-based response, he concludes the answer is to not break into the laboratory.

The consequences-based response is much more difficult. Heinz has a lot of unknowns in this area. First of all, he doesn't know if the drug will cure his wife; he only knows that it "might" save her. He also doesn't know if he'll be caught or not; if he is caught, he doesn't know if the jury would give him mercy because of his motivation, or if they would 'throw the book' at him. After he thinks about it a bit, he realizes that even if he's not caught, he would be the prime suspect, especially if his wife is cured 'miraculously.' The police would know that he was the one who stole the drug... He doesn't know if the price of the drug would go up for others with similar cancers, nor does he know how many lives that would actually mean. The more Heinz thinks about it, the greater the number of potential consequences he has to consider. Heinz loves his wife dearly, though, so he concludes that her life is worth saving in spite of the consequences.

Finally, Heinz looks at the virtues based approach. Being a regular church-goer, he asks himself the question "what would Jesus do?" Heinz rejects that quickly – Jesus might possibly heal his wife on the spot and wouldn't bother with a drug, he muses to himself. He also realizes that in this case he cannot answer this question firmly without lots of speculation. What would his father do in the same situation? He respected his father, and his father always seemed to do the right thing. It would be tough telling his father that he broke into a laboratory, but perhaps his father would understand. If Heinz was caught, how would he feel if his picture was on the front page of the paper? What would other people he respects do in these circumstances?

Heinz doesn't have a magic answer that comes to him – but regardless of the answer he comes up with, he has thought it through. He understands the rules, has weighed the consequences, and has considered what a virtuous person would do in these circumstances.

Major Smith and the Car Bomb

Let me provide another example to work through the ethical decision making model. This scenario is a fictional example but one that resonates closely to the reality for military leaders because of the context of the time dimension in a combat situation and the potential consequences of the ethical choice to be chosen:

You are Major Smith, the new Operations Officer for the 1st Infantry Brigade, just having joined the unit in the last week. Things have not been going well for the Brigade in the last month, with a number of soldiers having been killed – including your predecessor, a good friend – by Improvised Explosive Devices (IEDs) set by local insurgents. The Brigade is deployed throughout a major city, patrolling the streets. As the senior man on duty, you get a call from one of the company commanders, who reports he just caught an insurgent leader; the company commander says the insurgent leader is bragging that a

car bomb has been set to go off in the next 30 minutes and said “there’s nothing you can do about it.” The company commander says he is prepared to do some “serious persuasion” to find out where the bomb is. “All of the interrogators are gone, and I know the new directives say they have to do all interrogations by the book – but time is running out. I know how to make a man squeal, so I can get the information. These attacks have to come to an end. Request guidance, sir.”

What should Major Smith do?

Major Smith has as a truth-versus-loyalty dilemma. The truth is that the new directives are very specific about the conduct of interrogations, and he has an obligation to follow those rules – rules that were established for good reasons. But he also has an obligation of loyalty to the soldiers in his command who are at risk right now, as well as the civilians in the city who are also at risk. If he gets the information about the location of the bomb in the next ten minutes, he can probably avert a disaster; if he waits to do things the right way, more people will die. He can either tell the company commander to stop or he can tell the company commander to do what it takes.

From a principles-based approach, the answer is easy. The rules state that only interrogators can do the interrogation, and it’s obvious that if the company commander does an interrogation he’s not going to use legal means. From a consequences-based approach, it is complicated. The best thing that could happen if the interrogation is authorized is that one insurgent gets hurt and a lot of lives are saved; but, that’s only if the information is correct and the timing is right to get everyone out of the area of the bomb. Careers could be in jeopardy based on the interrogation and the conscious decision to violate the rules; Major Smith has an aversion to the term “careerism” but he would still like to see the next promotion – and he certainly doesn’t want to be testifying before Congress in the near future. A report of torture of the insurgent could hit the press within the hour and only play in the hands of the insurgents who want to embarrass the United States military. From a pure consequences-based approach, he feels that he should authorize the interrogation; the math says one tortured insurgent versus the lives of many, although he realizes that it is a short-term approach to the problem. From a virtues-based approach, he’s heard commanders and senior officers in the past take both approaches – the approach always upholding the “rule of law” and honor, while others have taken the road of “soldiers first, mission always.” The conflict goes even further: his dad would probably understand if they did what it took, but his mother would be horrified at the prospect of her son taking actions tantamount to authorizing torture. Either way, at least some of the results of his actions right now will probably be in the paper tomorrow. What headline will it be?

Conclusion

Following the “ethical triangle” ethical decision making model is not an automatic process; it requires understanding and practice before it is mastered. Nonetheless, it is designed to provide a methodology for coming to an answer to an ethical dilemma that is well-thought out and supportable. The “ethical triangle” ethical decision making model does provide a better model than the simplistic Army model that merely states that the decision should be made based on the course of action that “best represents Army values.” Applying the model to a variety of

ethical dilemmas and testing the model against those dilemmas (such as My Lai and Abu Ghraib) helps to master the necessary “ethical fitness” for application in the real world.

Every time you make a serious moral judgment, you become that judgment; every time you issue a command, you not only tell your subordinates what to do but what to be. That is why, in the horrible circumstances in which you or your soldiers might find yourselves in the months ahead in a world seemingly gone morally mad, I trust in you because of the moral compass which is yours from your education, your experience, your expertise. You do on the basis of your information; you are on the basis of your formation. Ethics, in the final analysis, is caught, not taught.³⁶

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Scenario 5 – Afghan Police *(Trigger warning – child abuse)*

You are part of a Security Forces detachment at a remote forward operating base (FOB) in Afghanistan, where you and your team have been training local police to protect civilians. Your relationship with the locals is very good, and your training is proving effective for them. One evening your interpreter approaches you with a disturbing report from some of the local villagers. They claim that one of the local police officers being trained by your unit has been kidnapping and abusing local children, and the other local officials have ignored their complaints or laughed them off.

The following day your team is present as you question the accused officer through your interpreter. The officer laughs off the questions and tells you that you are a guest in his country. He continues by telling you that he can do whatever he wants, and your team has no power over him. While it may not be ok for American values, he says in Afghanistan it is common.

Scenario 3 – Capt Semrau

A Canadian soldier has been kicked out of the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), but spared a stint in prison, for shooting a severely wounded insurgent on the battlefields of Afghanistan. Capt. Robert Semrau, whose controversial case sparked a nationwide debate about the ethics of mercy killing in a war zone, stood at the front of a packed courtroom as a military judge announced his punishment: a demotion in rank, and dismissal from the Forces.

Capt. Semrau was on patrol in Helmand Province on the morning of Oct. 19, 2008 when his unit, a small band of CAF troops mentoring a company of Afghan National Army (ANA) soldiers, encountered an unidentified man lying on a dirt path. He had been shot by a U.S. Apache helicopter, and in the words of one eyewitness, was “98 per cent” dead.

Canadian soldiers are bound by the Geneva Conventions and the military’s own code of conduct to offer First Aid to all casualties, friend or foe. But the senior Afghan officer on the scene decided that the man was too wounded to save, telling the others: “If Allah wants him, he will die. If not, he will live.” In his capacity as a mentor, Semrau had no authority to overrule the ANA commander.

But rather than leave the man to suffer his fate, Semrau made a “difficult choice”: he raised his C-8 rifle, aimed it at the insurgent’s chest, and pulled the trigger. According to numerous witnesses, he later confessed that it was a “mercy kill.”

When military investigators caught wind of the incident two months later, Semrau was charged with four offences, including second-degree murder and negligent performance of duty. He was arrested, flown home, and put on trial. The first Canadian soldier ever accused of homicide on the battlefield.

Countless Canadians rallied behind Semrau, convinced that he did the moral thing by putting a gravely injured insurgent “out of his misery” (a Facebook page was even set up in his honor with thousands of members). But the Canadian judge, Lt.-Col. Jean-Guy Perron, painted a very different portrait, saying he violated the military’s most basic rules of discipline and no longer deserves to serve. “Shooting a wounded, unarmed insurgent is so fundamentally contrary to our values, doctrine and training that it is shockingly unacceptable behavior, you made a decision that will cast a shadow on you for the rest of your life.”

At one point, Semrau was facing the possibility of life behind bars. However, a military jury found him guilty of only one count: disgraceful conduct. The members concluded that Semrau did indeed shoot the unarmed man, but with no corpse and no forensic evidence, they were not convinced beyond a reasonable doubt that his bullets actually killed the insurgent.

Nevertheless, his career in uniform was over. “You failed in your role as a leader,” said the judge. “How can we expect our soldiers to follow the rules of war if their officers do not?” Capt. Semrau was demoted to second lieutenant (the lowest rank in the officer corps) and ordered his release from the CAF. “Your actions may have been motivated by an honest belief you were doing the right thing,” the judge said. “Nonetheless, you have committed a serious breach of discipline.”

Perron said the sentence strikes a proper balance between punishment and deterrence, and sends a strong message to the rank-and-file that every soldier is obliged to obey orders, not their own moral code. “Decisions based on personal values cannot prevail over lawful commands,” he said. At one point, Perron specifically criticized Semrau for putting his subordinates in the difficult predicament of either tattling on their commander or keeping quiet, which is itself a punishable offence. “Your actions did have a negative impact on your team,” he said. “Capt. Semrau, I do not know if you have taken any time to reflect on this question in the last year. If not, do so.”

Semrau has never spoken publicly about what happened that morning, and even after his conviction he chose not to address the court. His sentencing hearing was no different. When the judge finished reading his reasons, Semrau stood at attention, saluted, and walked through a side door with his wife, his brother and his parents. He left the building without speaking to reporters.

Scenario 2 – Deployed Contractor Trustee

Lieutenant Colonel (Lt Col) Sarah Johnson is the commander of an engineering squadron deployed to a forward operating base (FOB) in a deployed environment where her unit is responsible for infrastructure development. To accomplish these tasks, Lt Col Johnson's unit relies heavily on local contractors.

One of the most reliable and effective contractors is a local businessman named Omar. Omar's company consistently delivers high-quality work on time and within budget. He's become a trusted partner, and Lt Col Johnson has come to rely on him.

However, Lt Col Johnson receives intel from one of her junior officers that overheard Omar is paying "protection money" to local insurgents to ensure the safety of his workers and equipment. The junior officer claims that Omar is essentially funding the very people the U.S. military is trying to defeat.

Lt Col Johnson confronts Omar with the allegations. Omar vehemently denies them. He explains that the region is extremely dangerous, and he must make arrangements with various groups to ensure the safety of his employees. He insists that these arrangements are purely for protection and do not involve supporting the insurgents' activities. He claims he's being extorted.

Scenario 1 – Kabul Drone Strike

In 2021, the U.S. military conducted a drone strike in Kabul, Afghanistan, during the chaotic withdrawal of U.S. forces and the evacuation of civilians following the Taliban's takeover of the country. The strike targeted a vehicle that the military believed posed an imminent threat to U.S. forces at Hamid Karzai International Airport.

Initially, the U.S. military reported that the strike had successfully eliminated a vehicle carrying explosives and prevented an imminent ISIS-K (Islamic State group in Afghanistan) attack on the airport. They claimed that secondary explosions after the strike indicated the presence of explosives in the vehicle.

Subsequent reporting by *The New York Times*, *The Washington Post*, and other news organizations raised serious doubts about the military's initial account. These investigations revealed that the vehicle targeted was driven by Zemari Ahmadi, an aid worker for Nutrition and Education International (NEI), a U.S.-based aid organization. Ahmadi was not an ISIS-K operative, and the vehicle did not contain explosives. The strike killed Ahmadi and nine other civilians, including seven children.

Following these reports, the U.S. military conducted its own internal review. The review concluded that the strike was a "tragic mistake" and that there had been a breakdown in the intelligence and targeting process. The military admitted that Ahmadi was not a threat and that the strike was a result of "confirmation bias" and "cognitive biases" that led analysts to misinterpret the available information. The U.S. Central Command (CENTCOM) commander, Gen. Kenneth McKenzie Jr., issued an apology for the deaths of the civilians.

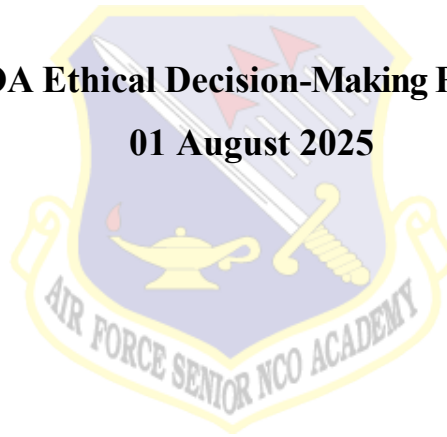
Scenario 4 – Medical Leave (Trigger warning – adultery)

As a SMSgt who recently PCS'd to your base of preference, life is good. Your new unit seems to be one of your better ones. The mission is getting done, morale is high, and everyone is looking forward to some well-earned time off around the holiday season. In your usual fashion, you walk into the shop early one morning to get a jump on the day. Waiting for you there is SSgt Lopez, one of your shop members. She asks to speak with you privately and tells you in confidence that you really need to speak with her close friend A1C Benton about an issue she is having. You recognize A1C Benton as one of your other subordinates, but SSgt Lopez won't give any further details about what the issue may be. Reassuring SSgt Lopez that you will speak to A1C Benton today, you decide to wait until mid-morning to bring her into your office.

When A1C Benton walks into your office and closes the door, you give her positive feedback on a recently completed project she assisted with, ask her how she is doing, if she has any plans for the upcoming holiday season. She answers you nervously, then asks if she would have to take leave to have an abortion done. You ask her if her husband is supportive of her decision, and she states that he doesn't know. When you tell her that her PCM at medical could probably better answer the medical leave question than you could, she says that she doesn't want to ask medical because she doesn't want anyone there finding out. As you try to explain to her about HIPAA, she states that one of the married doctors at the medical group is the father and he doesn't know anything about the pregnancy. She states that they had been having an affair for a few months, but she ended it with him about a week before she found out she was pregnant.

SNCOA Ethical Decision-Making Primer

01 August 2025



The intent of the **Ethical Decision-Making** lesson is to build upon Critical Thinking and discuss tools and concepts for framing difficult ethical decisions. The tools and concepts discussed in this lesson will help us break the habit of incorrectly rationalizing tough decisions that only temporarily reconcile values conflicts or ethical dilemmas. We must understand our role as SNCOs in organizational decision-making and correctly apply ethical decision-making concepts; the stakes are high as we impact our organizations at an increased scope and level. Faltering ethically can and will have negative ripple effects throughout the organization. Our goal is to incorporate ethical decision-making concepts into everyday decision making to improve decision-making in an Organizational Leader Environment. This lesson isn't about what's clearly illegal, immoral, or tests of integrity. This lesson focuses on situations where ethical dilemmas or competing values are present; situations where we are dealing with a right-vs-right.

As stated previously, as we grow in rank and gain increased responsibility, our obligations, authority, and scope of influence increase. We have pressures exerted on us daily that can affect our decision-making. Those pressures could be pressure to perform, competing priorities and at times pressures related to loyalty. As pressures mount it can become convenient to take "the path of least resistance" rather than making sound ethical decisions. Our actions can have a profound impact on those around us and our organizations.

Now it's time to pause. It's time to recognize the issue we all face in rationalizing negative actions towards the path of least resistance and discuss a few ways we can "take a step back" and analyze situations. By pausing and disconnecting from automatic rationalization, we can analyze situations, clear up confusing ethical dilemmas and make the "most right" decision. Ethical decision-making tools and concepts play a huge role helping us break the rationalization cycle by scrutinizing the situation and selecting the "most right" courses of action. For ease of understanding, Ethical Decision Making is very similar to Critical Thinking in that we pause, reflect, then act.

In this lesson we will discuss a variety of concepts and tools related to ethical decision-making. We will study in-depth a model the Army employs to frame ethical decision-making in a logical way. We will also cover an approach to ethical decision-making common to Air Force instruction, the Agent, Action, Outcome

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Framework. Please understand, there are numerous ways to analyze ethical decisions, we are simply presenting two useful methods. Note: We are not endorsing the Army framework; we are simply providing it as a means for decision-making. We will introduce both models and employ them to discuss ethical situations.

Ethics Defined

Ethics refers to a systematic and philosophical study of principles that guide human behavior and decision-making in a broader societal context, often involving the analysis of moral concepts, ethical dilemmas or even value conflicts. **Morality**, on the other hand, typically pertains to an individual's personal beliefs, values, and sense of right and wrong, which may or may not align with established ethical frameworks. Morals can influence a person's ethical decision-making by serving as a foundation upon which ethical principles and standards are built.



Morals	Ethics
Principles and rules of right conduct	Formal reasoning process used to determine right conduct
Private and personal	Professionally and publicly stated
Commitment to principles and values are usually defended in daily life	Inquiry or study of principles; Process of questioning and perhaps changing one's morals

Figure 1 - Morals vs Ethics. Chart from: Nursing Ethics, West Visayas State University

In this way, individual morals can impact the development of ethical frameworks and guide individuals in making ethical choices within a given cultural or professional context. However, it's important to note that ethical principles can also evolve independently of individual morals through collective societal norms, laws, and philosophical discussions.

Ethics and Virtue

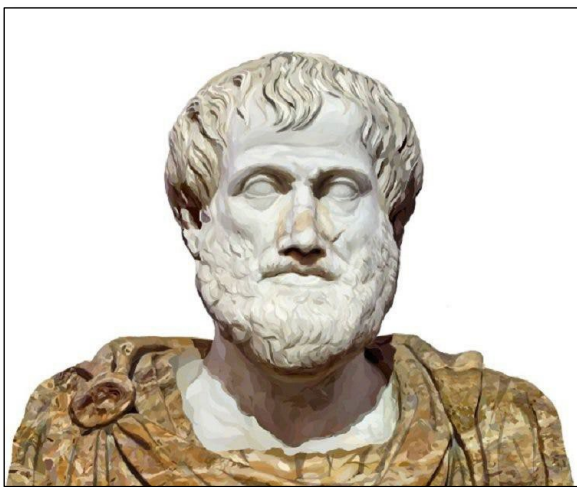


Figure 2 - Aristotle

Sound ethical decision-making hinges upon having the discernment to determine what is the “most right” decision and the courage to follow through, especially if the decision is unpopular. We know virtue deficits occur; they are some of the most common causes of rationalizing our ways into bad decisions. What about virtue excesses?

“A person is neither too much of a coward, nor too reckless. Instead, he is courageous. He has learnt to find a balance between these two extremes.” ~Aristotle

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How could excess virtue affect decision-making? This graphic has been provided by Dr. Robert S. Hink, the Associate Professor of Leadership and Director of Research at the Air War College (AWC) Leadership and Innovation Institute. It is based on Aristotle's tool for Virtue Ethics, The Golden Mean. Note: Aristotle viewed virtues leaning too far to either side, excess or deficiency, as inappropriate and therefore vices.



Figure 3 - Virtue Continuum - Dr. Robert S. Hink, AWC

"Virtue is the golden mean between two vices" ~Aristotle

The Ethical Triangle

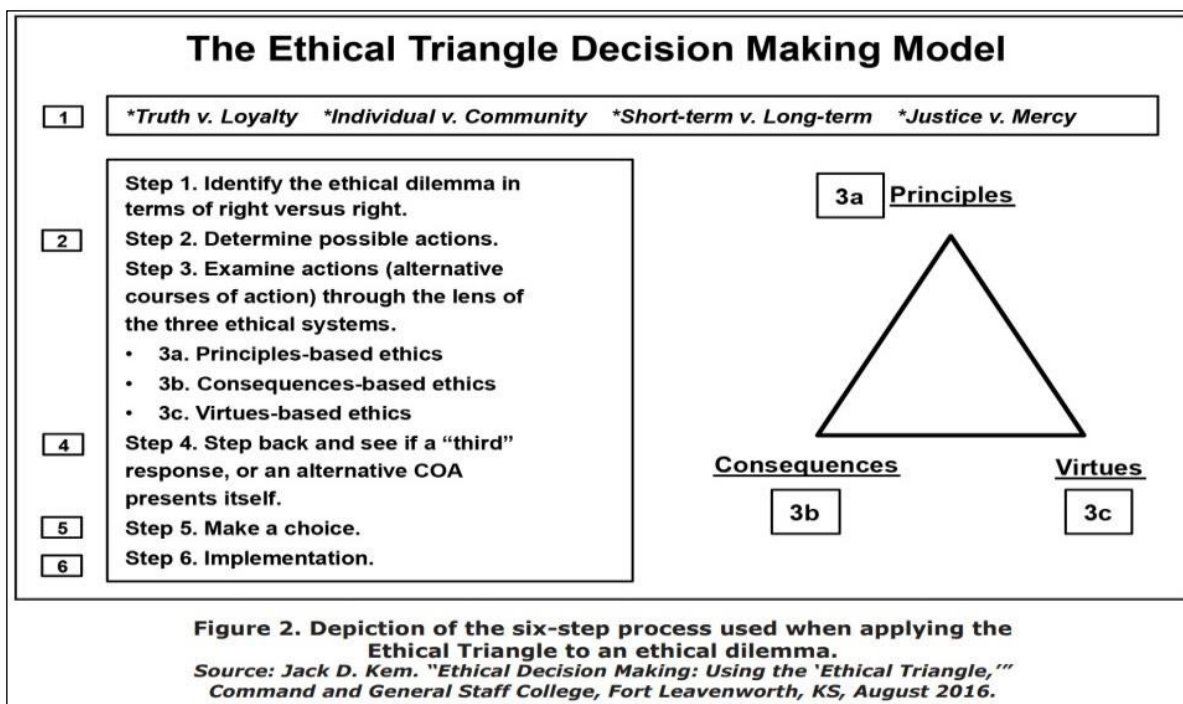


Figure 4 – The Ethical Triangle Decision Making Model - Dr. Jack D. Kem, Ph.D.

The Ethical Decision-Making Model was founded by Dr. Jack D. Kem, Ph.D., who served as a Supervisory Professor of Joint, Interagency, and Multinational Operations and Teaching Team Leader at the US Army Command and General Staff College, Fort Leavenworth, Kansas.

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The Ethical Decision-Making Model is adopted by the U.S. Army and was created in 2016 in response to highly publicized events stemming from ethical decisions that profoundly affected the public/world viewpoint of the U.S. military. Abu Ghraib in 2004 is just one example of profound unethical decision-making. In response, Dr. Kem outlined the principles of ethical processing in accordance with the Army's leadership manual. This ethical model allows the user to test a course of action (COA) against three different ethical approaches: **principles**, **virtues**, and **consequences**. Applying the Ethical Triangle to a situation allows for greater understanding of complicated ethical decisions. This three-dimensional approach provides greater insight into complex ethical decisions and ensures that the resulting answer is well-reasoned and ethically sound.

Concepts Related to Ethical Decision-making

Ethical Dilemma: Situations where one is forced to choose between two alternatives (both alternatives can be unfavorable and/or less right and more right or less wrong and more wrong). In the Army's ethical triangle there are 4 sources of ethical dilemmas used in step 1:

- **Truth vs Loyalty**
- **Individual vs Community**
- **Short-term vs Long-term**
- **Justice vs Mercy**

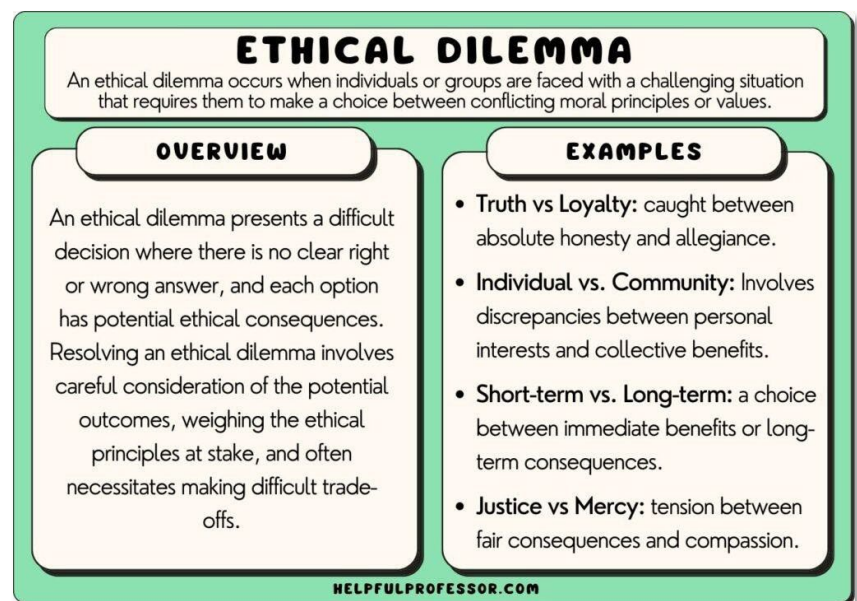


Figure 5 - Ethical Dilemmas - <https://helpfulprofessor.com/ethical-dilemma-examples/>

Principles: *aka Rules-Based ethics or Deontology.* Some things are intrinsically wrong. Ends do not justify means. Universally accepted rules or maxims. Certain things you must do vs must not do. i.e., “never lie”. What if your actions were to become law? What rules exist? What is your moral obligation?

Consequences: *aka Ends-Based ethics, Consequentialism or Utilitarianism.* Ends justify the means. What means gives the best consequences? Focuses on the outcome. Do what produces the greatest good for the most people. What option gives the most “bang for the buck?” Who wins and who loses?

Virtues: *aka Character-Based ethics.* What is important is not what you do, but why you do it. Golden rule. What kind of person are you? What is your character? What if my actions make the front page of the paper?

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Ethical Traps: while not covered specifically in the Ethical Triangle, ethical traps may be considered on their own as they are common reasons for ethical lapses and are self-explanatory. Consider how these ethical traps relate to The Golden Mean. Four common traps are:

- **Ethical Relativism:** Whether an action is right or wrong depends on the moral of the culture or society.
- **Loyalty Syndrome:** Making decisions based solely on respect and/or loyalty to an individual, unit, or organization.
- **Worry over image:** Making decisions based solely on how they'll impact your reputation or standing.
- **Drive for success:** Decisions are made based on a “win at all costs” attitude.

Working Through the Ethical Triangle (Steps)

- **Step 1. Define the problem (ethical dilemma) in terms of right vs. right.** Explain how both (or all) possibilities in the situation have value and merit. For instance, in the Trolley Problem: saving 1 person has merit because every life matters and you are not actively manipulating the situation to kill a human being (right). Saving 5 people has merit because preventing the death of more people aligns with the greater good (right).
- **Step 2. Determine possible courses of action.** There will probably be two obvious responses. It is important during this step to realize and even hope for a possible alternative third response to the dilemma.
- **Step 3. Test the courses of action against the “ethical triangle”.**
The most methodical means to do so is to first look through deontology-based ethics (**Principle/Rule-based**), virtue-based ethics (**Character-Based**) and ends-based ethics (**Consequentialist-Based /Utilitarianism**). Generally, the principles will be relatively easy, while the consequences will not be as easy, particularly when you look at all the potential second-and third-order effects of actions.

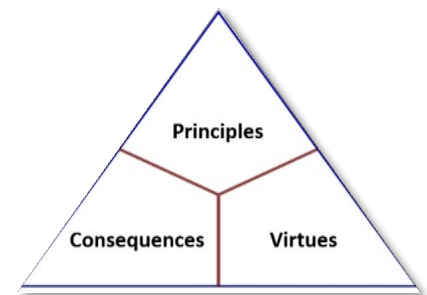


Figure 6 - Ethical Triangle

(1. Principles-based ethics 2. Consequences-based ethics 3. Virtue-based ethics)

- **Step 4. Consider additional alternative courses of action,** see if a “third” response, or an alternative course of action has presented itself (such as ‘win-win’ possibilities or no decision at all). Going through the process may indicate that there is another answer rather than the two courses of action initially determined. This will not always be true, but it’s best to step back and see if there is another alternative.
- **Step 5. Choose the course of action that best represents Air Force values.** The choice should be made based upon an analysis using all three of the ethical theories while also considering the organizational

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climate and culture, as well as the professional values of the organization.

- **Step 6. *Implement the best, chosen course of action.*** Critical thinking should be incorporated, and the choice should be well thought out.

Agent, Action & Outcome Frameworks

A simple method for analyzing ethical decisions employed by the Profession of Arms Center of Excellence (PACE) is the Agent, Action, Outcome method. This method breaks down the ethical decision into three different frameworks, each focusing on a different angle. There are similarities between the Agent, Action, Outcome method and step 3 of the Army’s Ethical Decision-Making Model where the Ethical Triangle is taken into consideration. Making the best ethical decision requires balance between the three frameworks. Note: each framework can be used to analyze an ethical decision but also is also used to determine where ethical dilemmas or values conflicts are stemming from. For example: *is there a conflict between the Agent & the Outcome?*

- The **Agent** framework describes how one should live one’s life. It is concerned with integrity, avoiding vices, and building virtues. The key question is, “*what type of person do I want to be?*” The goal of the Agent framework is to continue developing personal integrity. *The assumption in this framework is: “good” people do “good” things.*

- The **Action** framework considers whether specific acts are “right” or “wrong.” The question here is, “*what obligations do I owe, and to whom or what do I owe them?*” The Action

framework can be synonymous with duty, rules, and regulations. The goal of this framework is to act according to the proper rules in a specific situation. *The assumption in this framework is: rules define what morally appropriate behavior is.*

Comparison of Ethical Frameworks

	 Agent “How to live your life”	 Action “Is it right?”	 Outcome “Are the results good?”
Key question to ask:	What kind of person do I want to be?	What obligations do I owe and to whom?	What impact does my behavior have on the world?
Goals:	Develop personal integrity, avoid vices	Act according to the proper rules in a situation	Greatest good for greatest number of people
Assumption:	Good people do good things	Rules define good behavior	Consequences determine what is good
Example:	<i>I want to be a person of integrity by having the courage to treat all people with respect. Regardless of policy or procedure, I always call people out for when they discriminate or make disparaging remarks. Rules may change, but my integrity stays constant.</i>	<i>It is my duty to follow orders and procedure, regardless of the outcome or my intentions. I never sign off on work I haven't personally done. As long as I am following orders, I am doing my duty.</i>	<i>I believe that ensuring the mission is accomplished is most important, no matter how it is done.</i>

Figure 7 - Agent, Action, Outcome from PACE Leadership Toolkit

Organizational Leader – Ethical Decision-Making Primer

- The **Outcome** framework only considers the results of our decisions. The key question is, “*what impact does my decision or action have?*” The decision/action should focus on the greatest amount of good (or positive results) for the greatest number of people. *The assumption in this framework is: only the consequences of our behavior, or decisions, matter.*

Note: PACE was deactivated on 01 Oct 2022; their products are curated by the Leadership & Innovation Institute at Air University.

Employing Agent, Action & Outcome

The steps for resolving ethical dilemmas using the **Agent, Action, and Outcome** method are to ***recognize, identify, weigh, and decide***:

1. **Recognize** an ethical decision needs to be made
2. **Identify** all potential decisions you can make or actions you can take
3. **Weigh** all potential decisions or actions using each of the frameworks (Agent, Action, Outcome)

Note: Analyze and record any conflicts between frameworks. Consider how to resolve them.

4. **Decide** which decision or action you will take (will you do nothing?)

Cultural Embedding Mechanisms

Once ethical decision-making becomes a norm for the Organizational Leader, it is important to “embed” ethical decision-making into an organization’s culture. So, how are we to proceed? Thankfully, Edgar Schein, a renowned organizational psychologist and scholar known for his work in organizational culture, introduced the concept of “cultural embedding mechanisms.” The mechanisms serve to understand how culture becomes deeply ingrained and sustained within an organization. Cultural embedding mechanisms refer to the processes and practices that help establish and maintain a particular culture within a group or organization. Schein identified several key Primary and Secondary mechanisms:

Table 3. Primary and secondary culture embedding mechanisms

<i>Primary embedding mechanisms</i>	<i>Secondary embedding mechanisms</i>
What leaders pay attention to, control, measure, and control on a regular basis	Organization design and structure
How leaders allocate resources	Rites and rituals of the organization
Deliberate role modeling, teaching and coaching	Design of physical space, facades, and building
How leaders allocate rewards and status	Stories about important events and people
How leaders recruit, select, promote, and excommunicate	Formal statements of organizational philosophy, creeds, and charters

Figure 8 - Edgar E. Schein, Organizational Culture and Leadership, 2nd ed.

Ethical Decision-Making Primer – Attachment 1 Reflection Questions

Question 1: A. Where could you apply two *Ethical Decision-Making* concepts in your work environment?
B. Which ones? C. How?

(Optional) Use the SEE format for the question above

State: *I would apply the Ethical Decision-Making concepts of _____ and _____ to:*

Elaborate: *The reason for doing so is:* OR *in other words:*

Exemplify (examples): *For example, at work:*

Question 2: A. What are some common *Ethical Dilemmas* you encounter? B. Where do they come from or what caused them?

Question 3: A. Considering the *Ethical Triangle*, how do you typically approach ethical decisions?
(deontology-based ethics (***Principle/Rule-based***), virtue-based ethics (***Character-Based***), ends-based ethics (***Consequentialist-Based /Utilitarianism***))
B. How will you change your approach?

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Ethical Decision-Making Primer – Attachment 3 Resources

Student Preparation:

Watch: [Rationalizations | Ethics Defined - Bing video](#)

Review: https://www.diffen.com/difference/Ethics_vs_Morals

Read: The Ethical Decision-Making Primer

Additional Resources (For Increased Understanding):

Ethical Decision Making: Using the “Ethical Triangle”

<https://www.cgscfoundation.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/04/Kem-UseoftheEthicalTriangle.pdf>

Application of the Ethical Triangle

<https://thesimonscenter.org/wp-content/uploads/2017/11/IAJ-8-4-2017-pg34-46.pdf>

Types of Ethical Dilemmas – 4min 24sec

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7eGrzGc3X-Q>

Ethical Decision-Making (Defaults) – 3min 29sec

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n0uwTBrqgqI>

Ethical Tests – 7min 45sec

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5QJgKCtfAzg>

Consequentialism, Deontology and Virtue Ethics explained – 4min 1 sec

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i_G32gwKLE4

Virtue Ethics | Ethics Defined (Virtue based Ethics vs Consequentialism & Deontology – Batman) – 1min 42 sec

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NMbIKpkKYao>

A Framework for Ethical Decision Making

<https://www.scu.edu/ethics/ethics-resources/a-framework-for-ethical-decision-making/>

Air Force Innovation & Leadership Institute

<https://www.airuniversity.af.edu/Leadership-Institute/>

In-Class Activity (Case Studies):

Reading: David Barno and Nora Bensahel, “When America’s All-Volunteer Force Loses a War,” *War on the Rocks*, September 21, 2021

<https://warontherocks.com/2021/09/when-americas-all-volunteer-force-loses-a-war/>

Hinck, Robert S. “Ethics as a Strategic Resource in an Age of Strategic Competition.” (2022)

<https://www.airuniversity.af.edu/Wild-Blue-Yonder/Article-Display/Article/3218782/ethics-as-a-strategic-resource-in-an-age-of-strategic-competition/>

WHEN AMERICA'S ALL-VOLUNTEER FORCE LOSES A WAR

DAVID BARNO AND NORA BENSACHEL

SEPTEMBER 21, 2021

SPECIAL SERIES - STRATEGIC OUTPOST



The sudden fall of Afghanistan marks the very first time that the U.S. military has clearly lost a war fought solely by volunteers. This defeat will have many strategic consequences, but it also may have a deeply corrosive effect on the nation's all-volunteer military. Losing a war can be debilitating for any military organization and can deeply erode morale and confidence. For a force that is widely viewed as the most capable and professional military in the world, the potential for such harmful consequences should not be underestimated. Left unaddressed, they could imperil the long-term health and effectiveness of the all-volunteer force.

Arguments will rage for a long time about whether the United States could have won the war in Afghanistan with another approach — or even won at all. But after the nation invested two decades, more than \$2 trillion, and the lives of almost 2,500 military personnel, the outcome remains the same. Afghanistan is now occupied and controlled by essentially the same Taliban movement that governed the country in 2001 and which is gleefully celebrating its victory over the United States, NATO, and the internationally backed government in Kabul. The U.S. military now faces the challenge of processing this defeat on two different levels: as individuals, among those who deployed and fought, and as an institution, in which the military's leaders should now help the all-volunteer force process this painful outcome while simultaneously ensuring that it remains strong and capable of winning the nation's future wars.

Individually, those who served in Afghanistan are reeling from the speed and shock of the final collapse that capped a frustrating war many of them committed years of their lives to fighting. Watching scenes of the chaotic evacuation of Americans and some of their Afghan allies from Kabul, those who served in the Hindu Kush — one of us included — are inevitably experiencing painful and clashing emotions of anger, loss, grief, and resentment. They face an existential question about their service: Why did I sacrifice years of my life and lose friends in a war that essentially ended up where it began, with Afghanistan in the hands of the Taliban?

That angst will be compounded by a deep sense that the humiliating departure from Afghanistan — nearly the worst imaginable way to leave — represented a violation, an abandonment even, of the deepest ethos instilled among those who serve in uniform. All of the U.S. military services subscribe to a version of what the Army calls its warrior ethos: “I will always place the mission first. I will never accept defeat. I will never quit. I will never leave a fallen comrade.” The Marine Corps reflects this commitment in its recruiting pitch, “Battles Won,” and in its famed motto, Semper Fidelis (always faithful). And in the special operations community, “no one left behind” is a sacrosanct bond. An untold number of military servicemembers have been killed and wounded fulfilling that specific commitment to their brothers and sisters in arms during the past 20 years.

Yet the chaotic bumbling of the last days of the Afghanistan War undercut every aspect of this ethos. Committing to leave no one behind is especially important when creating bonds between the men and women who choose to place themselves in harm's way for the nation. Many servicemembers now believe that the nation violated that bedrock principle by leaving behind 100 to 200 Americans and tens or even hundreds of thousands of Afghans who supported the United States at great personal risk over the last 20 years. *Ad hoc* veteran and military efforts to help get those people out in the last weeks of the U.S. withdrawal, which have been brilliantly described as a “digital Dunkirk,” powerfully reflects this deep-seated military creed.

Military leaders at all levels are going to have to confront these issues — for themselves and for their troops. And though that will be a complex and difficult process, this conversation should begin with the following message: “You served honorably and did what the nation asked you to do.” For the nation to keep its promise to those it asked to

fight, this affirmation is a vital expression of gratitude and respect for all those who deployed to Afghanistan simply because the nation sent them. But it is not sufficient to sustain a strong all-volunteer force into the future. Unlike the U.S. defeat in Vietnam, the costs of this war — especially its human costs — were borne not by the nation as a whole, but by a small cohort of volunteer warriors while the vast majority of Americans remained uninvolved and largely uninterested. The failures of the war, and the policies that led to them, do not in any way diminish the fact that every single person who served in the war volunteered to fight when there was no obligation to do so. That choice, and the profound consequences it would have for those who stepped forward, shielded the rest of us from the painful experiences of war. The nation's leaders and its people have an obligation to convey their gratitude for those who volunteered to serve so that those who follow in their footsteps know that their sacrifices are both honored and appreciated.

Institutionally, the U.S. military faces three critical tasks. First, it has both a moral and a practical obligation to dissect what went wrong during the 20 years of war and to demonstrate that it has processed and learned from those hard lessons. Current and future generations of servicemembers ought to have confidence that the hard lessons from Afghanistan were not buried and that harsh critiques of wartime decisions and performance in this war's aftermath were welcomed in order to better prepare for any future irregular wars. The U.S. military utterly failed to do this after the Vietnam War, as it sought to erase counter-insurgency from its institutional memory instead of insisting on a brutal degree of self-assessment examining how military actions contributed to the defeat. As a result, a new generation of soldiers, sailors, airmen, and marines entered their own unconventional wars a quarter century later with no current doctrine or training on fighting insurgents. This should never happen again.

Second, U.S. military leaders ought to clearly identify what went wrong with the disastrous evacuation and take full responsibility for their part in the debacle. The decision to end the war was rightly made by civilian leaders. Their decision may or may not have been strategically wise. But the execution of the withdrawal was clearly a military responsibility, and it was indisputably done poorly. Congress is already scheduling hearings in an effort to establish some accountability for the war's ghastly final days and for leaving behind so many Afghans who took tremendous personal risks to help the American effort. In recent weeks, we've both seen many social media posts about the withdrawal referencing Paul Yingling's famous observation about recent conflicts — that a private who loses a rifle suffers greater consequences than a general who loses a war. Restoring confidence in the key principles of the warrior ethos requires senior leaders to launch a swift and candid assessment of the bungled conclusion to the war — perhaps by an independent and respected outside body, to ensure its credibility — and to hold themselves accountable for any military failures.

Third, senior leaders of the Department of Defense and the services should guide the force to somehow absorb the loss of the war in Afghanistan constructively. After the rancorous end of the Vietnam War in 1975, many servicemembers and veterans concluded that the war was lost primarily because civilian leaders imposed too many

restrictions on military operations, forcing the military to fight with one hand tied behind its back. For some, this led to an insidious belief that the military had been “stabbed in the back” by political leaders, the media, and anti-war protesters who ostensibly undermined the U.S. military on the battlefield and caused the U.S. capitulation. But senior U.S. military leaders, including Gens. Creighton Abrams and Frederick Weyand, sought to stamp out this dangerous interpretation by reinforcing the idea that militaries in the United States and other democratic societies *always* fight within constraints imposed by elected leaders. The generals ensured that the psychology of blame and defeat never took root within the force, which enabled it to refocus on preparing for the wars of the future.

The parallels with today are clear. We’ve both heard veterans of the war in Afghanistan argue that the past four administrations forced the U.S. military to fight with one hand tied behind its back in Afghanistan with overly restrictive rules of engagement and feckless decision-making. There is a clear risk that some leaders and troops may begin to blame the war’s stinging outcome on poor civilian leadership and support. Senior military and defense leaders should once again stop this narrative from spreading throughout the force. In fact, doing so today is even more important than it was after Vietnam, since a force that consists entirely of self-selected volunteers faces a greater risk than a conscript force of developing a belief that it is morally superior to the society it serves. It’s a short leap from that outlook to conclude that the military was failed in Afghanistan by the poor decisions of civilian policymakers who have never been in uniform. This third task of helping the force come to grips with the loss of Afghanistan could be strongly reinforced by the first task, since an open and candid assessment of the military’s performance during the 20 years of the war would clearly demonstrate that civilian leaders were not the only ones to make major mistakes.

The humiliating end to America’s longest war came suddenly, and its shocks will ripple throughout the U.S. military for years to come. But in the immediate aftermath of this painful defeat, the nation’s civilian and military leadership should recognize that they have some new obligations to the all-volunteer force that they lead. These leaders should address the individual pain and anger that many servicemembers may be feeling by affirming the fundamental value of their military service. They should reaffirm the warrior ethos that animates each of the military services and the special operations community and commit to upholding those virtues. They should both ensure that the hard lessons of the past 20 years are identified and truly learned and hold themselves accountable for the disastrously executed withdrawal that left thousands of America’s partners behind. These tasks stem partly from a moral obligation to those who sacrificed so much over the past 20 years, but they are also necessary to ensure that the all-volunteer force remains strong, capable, and motivated to fight America’s future wars. If the men and women who fought in the Afghanistan conflict are to remain fully committed to their service tomorrow, and to continue encouraging young people to consider military service, they need to hear about the end to this long war from those at the top.

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**Department of the Air Force
Planning, Programming, Budgeting and Execution System
Training Program**

REFERENCE MANUAL



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<https://www.my.af.mil>**

*Process descriptions and updates enclosed are current as of March 2023.
This Manual will be updated as additional DoD or DAF guidance is published.*

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Chapter 1: Introduction

“We are united in our commitment to modernizing the Air and Space Forces and in achieving the transformation we must have to be competitive with our pacing challenge – China, China, China.”

*Frank Kendall, Secretary of the Air Force
Department of the Air Force FY24 Budget Overview
March 2023*

The purpose of the budget of the United States government is to allocate resources and funding among all the executive agencies of the federal government as well as for social programs and interest on the nation’s debt. The U.S. budget not only focuses on dollars but other resources, such as agency manpower (military end-strength) and equipment (aircraft, vehicles, etc.) With an FY24 President’s Budget DOD request of \$842 billion, the Defense Department requires a longer-term view beyond the single-year budget request and three-year strategic plan currently required by law. The Defense Department process first implemented in 1962 to allow this longer-term planning and analysis – the Planning, Programming, Budgeting and Execution (PPBE) process – is outlined in this Reference Guide.

This Manual includes dollar amounts and illustrations to reinforce major concepts and processes. Some chapters of the Manual provide introductory material while other chapters give more detailed and greater depth on planning, programming, budgeting and execution processes. This Manual also provides information on planning, programming, and budgeting activities, functional community interactions, how programs and budgets are arrayed, and program files and data element descriptions. Commonly used acronyms and a glossary appear at the end of the Manual.

This first chapter provides environmental context surrounding the Defense Department budget. It is important for PPBE stakeholders to understand how the Defense Budget competes each year with other elements of the federal budget for limited funds. Defense budgets are cyclic, with eight to ten years of budget growth followed by ten to twelve years of more gradual decline.

The fiscal year 2024 President’s Budget proposal of March 2023 accelerates a shift in national spending from defense to non-defense accounts: the FY24 President’s Budget proposal of \$842B represents an increase of 13.4% from the FY22 base level request – nearly \$100B (although part of this increase reflects the higher cost of inflation and fuel.)

This shift is consistent with the National Security Strategy that was released in October 2022, which emphasized both defense and non-defense solutions related to the global environment and alliances. Similarly, the National Defense Strategy (NDS) also released in October 2022 and PPBE processes and products use the NSS as a strategic guidepost.

In an effort to ensure evolving Defense program portfolios – and funding – continue to support national strategic goals, the Defense Department continues to support capability-based planning and programming. The object of this effort is to identify those battlefield effects desired by Combatant Commanders, the capabilities required to produce those effects and, finally, the programs or systems providing the capabilities. As fiscal constraints remain unknown, capability-based planning and programming means the Department will continue to focus on supporting warfighter needs with little regard to which military service or defense agency provides such support.

Regardless of whether defense spending or the national budget is increasing, decreasing, or remains the same, the fact remains the Defense Department will always be operating in a fiscally constrained environment. It is crucial all PPBE stakeholders manage their programs and funding to ensure its forces are ready today and prepared for tomorrow. This Reference Manual is intended to help stakeholders identify PPBE process events, deliverables, timeframes, and strategies to support such resource management.

Chapter 2: The PPBE Process, Terms, and Key Players

Introduction

The PPBE System has served as DoD's resource management system since 1962. While most U.S. federal agencies prepare a short-term (one- to two-year) budget request as is required by law, the Defense Department's size and complexity requires the multi-year analysis PPBE provides. The PPBE process is formally required and described in Defense Department Directive (DODD) 7045.14, although the process has evolved much faster than the formal guidance that directs it (DODD 7045.14 was last updated August 2017.) PPBE is a very dynamic process with four interrelated phases designed to produce a Defense budget consistent with national security objectives, policies, and strategies. The process purpose is to identify capability requirements, *Planning*; match those capability requirements with resources, *Programming*; translate them into budget proposals, *Budgeting*; and then evaluate the *Execution* to determine how desired capabilities were achieved.

The Secretary of Defense (SECDEF) provides centralized policy direction throughout the four phases, while delegating program development, execution authority, and responsibility to the Services and DoD agencies. This chapter explains commonly used terms, defines each PPBE process phase, and identifies important leadership figures and offices involved in PPBE.

Common Terms: Future Years Defense Program (FYDP)

The purpose of the PPBE process is to allow DoD to assess strategic requirements and priorities over a span of multiple years rather than a single budgetary year. More specifically, DoD develops fiscally constrained priorities over a five-year period. This five-year period is referred to as the Future Years Defense Program (FYDP.) Formally, the FYDP is the span of years for which DoD has received monetary planning guidance (also known as "fiscal guidance") from the Office of Management and Budget (OMB.)

The assignment of funds to programs and resources must be documented in such a way as to provide an ongoing record of priorities and decisions. All DoD Components (OSD, the military services, and defense agencies) maintain databases of programs, resources, and their assigned monetary values, with all Component databases eventually merged at the OSD level. For this reason, "FYDP" can also refer to the actual database that identifies the "program of record", or official DoD program and monetary position.

Common Terms: Fiscal Guidance

"Fiscal Guidance" refers to the not-to-exceed monetary value assigned to the Defense Department by OMB and, in turn, the monetary value assigned by OSD to each DoD Component. Fiscal Guidance is provided for each year within the FYDP.

Common Terms: Total Obligational Authority (TOA)

The end result of the PPBE process is legislated (authorized and appropriated) monetary amounts for Defense Department operations. These monies will be used to purchase goods and services via legal agreements (such as contracts, task orders, and travel orders) that literally *obligate* the Defense Department to pay for goods and services provided once terms of the agreement have been met. For this reason, the monetary amount provided via Fiscal Guidance is often referred to as "Total Obligational Authority", or the *total* dollar value each DoD Component is *authorized* to use for creating legal *obligations*.

Common Terms: Process Exercises (POM, BES, PB)

The PPBE process produces three primary outputs: a Program Objective Memorandum (POM), a Budget Estimate Submission (BES), and a President's Budget (PB):

- The **POM** is a product generated by each military service and agency and reflects how given Fiscal Guidance is to be assigned to their programs and resources. This Fiscal Guidance assignment involves not only identification of service/agency requirements but also the prioritization of those requirements (because there are always more requirements than fiscal guidance.) The process used by each service or agency to create its POM is up to the service or agency and processes differ greatly from one service/agency to another. The POM is typically submitted by each military department or agency to OSD in July or early August; for the FY 24-28 exercise POMs were due to OSD on July 15 2022. The exact POM due date is identified within OSD guidance that is typically issued in the early spring of each year.
- The **BES** also is a product generated by each DoD Component (military departments and agencies – by law, a budget must be a Secretariat product.) While the POM focuses on requirements and priorities, it is not required by law. Budgets, however, remain the formal legal requirement that the Secretariat of each DoD Component must generate. The BES reflects Component POM priorities in a required budgetary format, including budget exhibits, with appropriate pricing and inflationary factors incorporated. The timing of the BES is more subject to process changes; within the last 10 years it has been submitted by Components at the same time as the POM (in the late summer of each year) or as a separate output in the late fall. The FY24 BES was submitted to OSD on August 29 2022.
- Once all DoD Components have submitted the POM and BES to OSD on their respective due dates, OSD offices (the office of Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation – CAPE – and OSD Comptroller) will review service and agency POM and BES content. These two separate reviews, known as the Program Review and Budget Review, are designed to help OSD consolidate and prioritize all DoD requirements into a single Defense Department budget request, which will become part of the larger **President's Budget** request developed by OMB and by law must be submitted to Congress no later than the first Monday in February each year or by a date mutually agreed upon by the White House and Congress. In years when a new President is inaugurated, it is common for the President's Budget to be submitted to Congress later in the spring. The FY2024 President's Budget was submitted to Congress on March 9, 2023.

The next section of this chapter applies these common terms to describe the nature of each PPBE phase in greater detail.

The Planning Phase

The PPBE planning phase begins as a DoD function designed to provide a vision of the future described via broad strategy and plans. The planning phase encompasses long-range guidance out to 20 years, long-range objectives out to 10 years, and mid-range objectives out to 5 years. Because the purpose of the planning process is to identify what is *needed* versus simply what is affordable, the planning process does not consider fiscal constraints but in recent years planning has become more “fiscally informed.”

The primary tasks in this phase include collecting intelligence about the military capabilities and political intentions of foreign nations; evaluating the threat to U.S. national security; developing strategies to meet the threat; and devising force levels to support the strategy. Long-range plans (20 years) are generated to reflect the major force

modernization and investment requirements for each DoD Component. Both long-range and mid-term defense planning are influenced by national priorities outlined in the **National Security Strategy (NSS)** and Congressional activity.

Over the last several years, DoD has moved to a more centrally-initiated and managed strategic planning process, particularly since 2010 when the confluence of changing operational requirements in Iraq and Afghanistan and fiscal constraints both created a need for significant re-evaluation of U.S. strategy and global objectives. In addition, this changing environment has increasingly emphasized the role of the Joint community in analyzing operational capabilities and identifying capability-based requirements.

OSD's evolving approach to strategic planning centers around two primary products/processes. The **Defense Planning Guidance (DPG)** is an annually issued document that provides overall defense guidance and priorities for military forces, modernization, readiness and sustainability, and supporting business processes and infrastructure for program development. The most recent DPG was released in June 2022; an updated DPG will be published in spring 2023. Additionally, the DPG aligns with the NSS and NDS; both of these documents inform the DPG.

Within the joint community for the mid-term planning period (2–8 years), strategic planning is conducted within the **Joint Strategic Planning System (JSPS).** The JSPS is the system by which the CJCS develops the information necessary to discharge his/her congressionally mandated responsibilities as the principal military advisor to the President and the SECDEF. The JSPS produces several key documents: the **Chairman's Strategic Recommendation (CSR)**, **Chairman's Program Recommendation (CPR)**, the **National Military Strategy (NMS)**, and the **Joint Planning Document (JPD)**. These documents help guide OSD and the SECDEF in outlining the department's planning priorities through the DPG.

The Programming Phase

Programming is the second PPBE phase. Programming is the first PPBE process to apply fiscal constraints to the OSD vision developed in the Planning Phase. Programming is primarily a military service or defense agency function and translates guidance into action; balances allocation of resources to plans; organizes plans into packages (programs); prioritizes programs; and determines program affordability. Note: while each military service builds its POM separately, within the Air Force and Navy Departments, the products of the two military services are integrated into a single, Department-level POM.

The **DPG** not only outlines an overarching strategy for the Defense Department but also serves as the link between planning and programming. It is the primary source document for the programming phase. Programming's output product, the **Program Objective Memorandum (POM)**, is developed within the fiscal constraints outlined within the DPG and is the primary means to request revisions to existing departmental resources as identified in the **Future Years Defense Program (FYDP)**. Each Component POM is submitted to OSD for further review, typically in the summer timeframe each year.

The Budgeting Phase

Budgeting is the third phase of the PPBE process and involves the formulation and justification of near-term resource requirements monetary allocation by appropriation, based on the results of the planning and programming efforts. The budget is developed from the Component's POM and the final budgeting product submitted by military departments and agencies to OSD is called the **Budget Estimate Submission (BES.)** Although the budgeting phase

is completed for the full five-year span of the FYDP, budget formulation concentrates on the first year of the FYDP and focuses on providing a detailed price estimate for presentation to Congress.

The OSD Program Review

POMs are reviewed for compliance with the DPG and other pertinent strategic guidance during the OSD Program Review. The OSD Program Review is led by the OSD office of Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation (CAPE.) Once Components submit a POM to OSD, the OSD CAPE Program Review evaluates Component POMs for compliance with strategic guidance and any specific programmatic guidance. Additionally, the **Chairman's Program Assessment (CPA)**, developed by the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, provides user risk assessment of POM recommendations and requests. The Program Review culminates in the issuance of **Program Decisions** by the DEPSECDEF, guidance documents that may direct monetary or other programmatic adjustments to Components' programs.

Historic Note: OSD issued "Program Decision Memoranda (PDMs)" prior to 2010. These were replaced by "Resource Management Decisions (RMDs)" from 2010-2015 but returned for the FY18 and FY19 OSD Program Reviews.

Since the FY22-26 Program Review and Budget Review (including for the FY24-28 Program Review and Budget Review), OSD has used the terms "Program Decisions (PDs)" to direct program changes and "Budget Decisions (BD)" to direct budget changes.

The OSD Budget Review

Once Components submit their BES' to OSD, the OSD Comptroller Budget Review evaluates these inputs for compliance with budget guidance, fiscal guidance and directed economic assumptions. This budget guidance includes due dates and detailed instructions for preparing estimates for the prior year (PY), current year (CY), budget years BY1 and BY2 and the out-years. The OSD Comptroller may also publish Budget *Decisions (BD)* to provide budget review feedback and redirection to Components.

Upon conclusion of the OSD Budget Review, the Defense Department budget request is coordinated with the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) to become part of the larger President's Budget (PB) request. The President's Budget is required by law to be submitted to Congress no later than the first Monday in February of each year.

The Budgeting phase of PPBE also includes all legislative activity associated with developing the annual National Defense Authorization Act and the Defense and Military Construction Appropriation Acts. Once both these Acts are signed into law, the Budgeting phase is considered complete.

The Execution Phase

The final phase of the PPBE process is program and budget execution. Execution is the process by which appropriated funds are obligated and the performance of the planning, programming and budget formulation phases are measured and validated. The Execution phase occurs once Congress enacts Authorization and Appropriations Acts. During execution, assumptions that were made about program performance and capabilities can be tested. Also, risks taken during any previous phase (such as altering funding levels for a program) are often exposed in execution. The value in tracking execution data is the guidance provided to adjust future plans, programs, and budgets based on actual events. Consider, however, that Congress enacts the budget based on its own program

and plans, so there will be differences between the original Defense budget request and funding actually received and executed.

PPBE Phases Overlap

Each PPBE phase has its own associated timeframe, but process phases run in parallel rather than consecutively. In any given year, those involved with PPBE may find themselves providing input for all of the phases, often simultaneously. Another challenge is the different phases and sequences are interconnected, resulting in participants having to provide input to four parallel PPBE sequences, each representing activities affecting a different fiscal year but taking place within the same calendar year.

The Big Picture

A full PPBE process depiction is shown in Figures 2-1 and 2-2. The steps identified in Figure 2-1 take approximately 15 to 18 months to complete the journey of developing and presenting the President's Budget. The focus on planning and programming remains the same each year: turning the Defense Planning Guidance (DPG) into a POM and BES for developing a President's Budget. The details and specific activities of this process are shown in Figure 2-2.

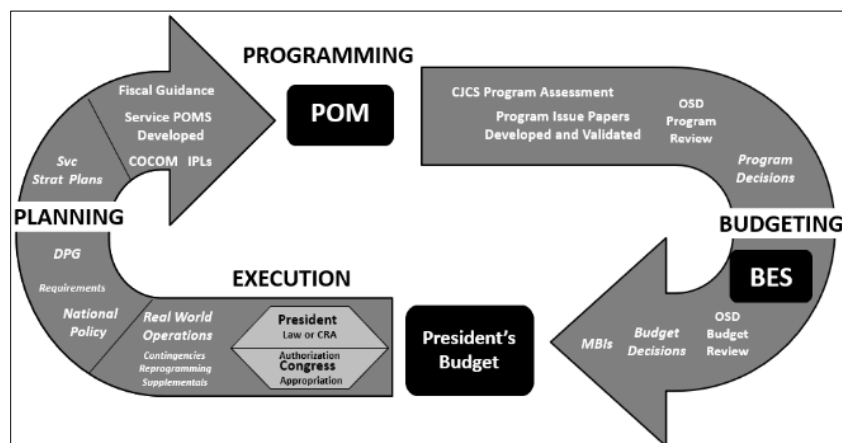


Figure 2-1. Resource Allocation Process (PPBE) Cyclic View

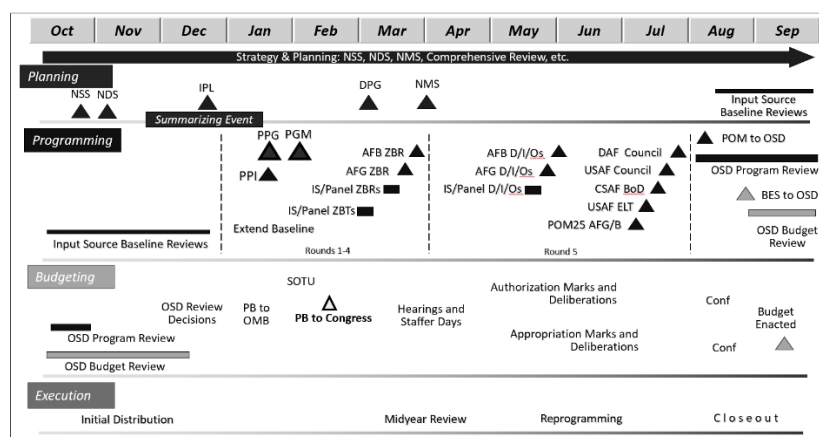


Figure 2-2. PPBE Timeline Calendar

The Unified Chain of Command

Most PPBE participants have a legislated responsibility to prepare a budget, and within the Defense Department each budget owner also develops a Program Objective Memorandum (POM.) The majority of this Reference Guide focuses on PPBE activities of these budget owners: OSD, the military services, and defense agencies. However, although the Joint Chiefs of Staff and most of the Combatant Commanders do not hold budgetary authority, their unique role within the PPBE process must be thoroughly understood. This next Reference Guide section highlights PPBE-related roles and responsibilities of the Joint Staff. First, figure 2-3 provides a high-level organizational chart that illustrates the unified command line from the President, through the Secretary of Defense and the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (CJCS), to the Combatant Commanders.

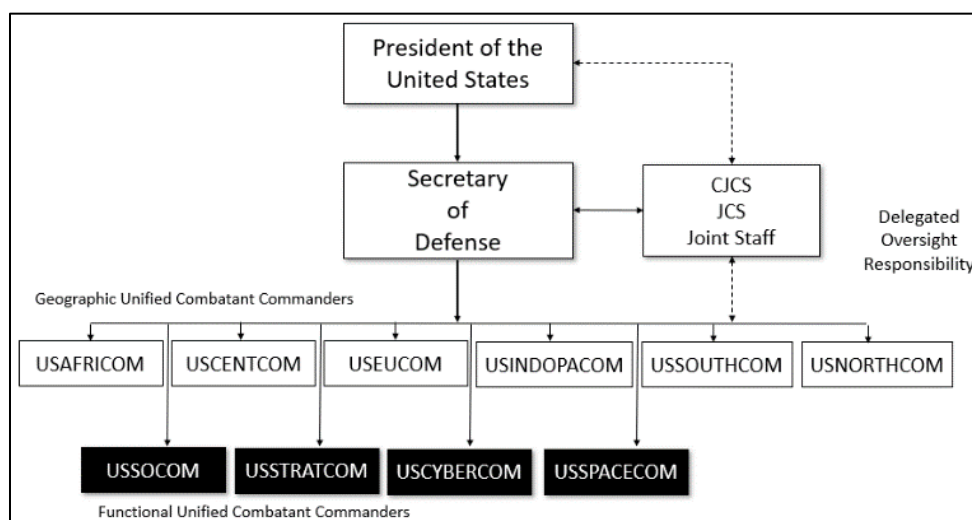


Figure 2-3. Unified Chain of Command

The Role of the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff is:

- Principal military advisor to the President, Secretary of Defense, and National Security Council
- Head of the Joint Chiefs of Staff and senior ranking member of the Armed Forces
- Communications conduit between the National Command Authority and the commanders of the combatant commands

Note: The Chairman has no statutory authority over combatant forces.

Even without formal budgetary authority, the Chairman and the Joint Staff participate in every stage of the PPBE process. This is a direct result of the Goldwater-Nichols Act identifying the Chairman as the principal military advisor to the President and allowing the joint staff and theater Commanders to participate in the PPBE Process. Table 2-2 lists key documents produced or supported by the joint community.

BES	Budget Estimate Submission —Service and DoD Agency proposal of time-phased program pricing with justification documents for President's Budget.	CPA	Chairman's Program Assessment —Chairman's personal appraisal of the Service program and budget proposals
CPG	Contingency Planning Guidance —SECDEF guidance to Chairman to reflect the NSS and DPG: principle source document for the JSCP.	CPR	Chairman's Program Recommendation —Chairman's personal recommendations to SECDEF on priorities, goals and objectives for POM as input to DPG
DPG	Defense Planning Guidance —provides overall defense policy and strategic guidance to be used in developing the defense program.	IPL	Integrated Priority List —List of Combatant Commander high priority needs for filling shortfalls in key capabilities and programs.
JSCP	Joint Strategic Capabilities Plan —Guidance to Combatant Commanders to accomplish tasks and missions	JSR	Joint Strategy Review —combined effort of Services, Combatant Commanders, Chairman and staff
NSS	National Security Strategy —developed by National Security Council	NMS	National Military Strategy —document conveys JCS and Chairman's advice on the strategic direction of the Armed Forces in implementing the guidance NSS and QDR
Plans	Plans —plans developed by Combatant Commanders to accomplish tasks and missions	POM	Program Objective Memorandum —Service and DoD Agency resource requirement to accomplish mission

Table 2-1. Joint Community Document Acronyms

IPLs, the CSR, CPR, and the CPA

Integrated Priority Lists (IPLs) are a key means by which the Combatant Commanders communicate their operational requirements to the SECDEF, CJCS and Services. The Combatant Commanders submit their IPLs annually to the SECDEF, with the CJCS and Services receiving copies. IPLs represent the Combatant Commanders' top warfighting needs and are designed to influence the services' POM submissions. In recent years, OSD has directed the CCMDs to produce capabilities-based IPL submissions, focusing on warfighting requirements rather than specific system-based solutions. This reflects the evolving mindset in OSD giving increased responsibility to the joint community in identifying capability-based requirements. The IPLs affect the Defense Planning Guidance (DPG) and the Joint Staff's Joint Planning Document (JPD), a product of the JSPS. The IPL is one document against which OSD assesses the adequacy of the services' POM submissions. CCMD IPLs are also informed by the Guidance for the Employment of the Force (GEF) produced by OUSD(Policy.)

The Chairman's Strategic Recommendation (CSR) describes the Chairman's early strategic-level advice and input to the SECDEF. It identifies joint-based capability needs and requirements. The CSR significantly influences OSD's preparation of the DPG.

The Chairman's Program Recommendation (CPR) relays the Chairman's personal recommendations directly to the SECDEF. The CPR focuses on the Chairman's high-priority programs in support of joint doctrine, readiness, and training issue areas. The SECDEF uses the CPR during the construction of the final DPG.

The Chairman's Program Assessment (CPA) is the Chairman's "report card" on the Services' programming efforts. It summarizes and communicates the Chairman's views on the balance and capabilities of the POM force and support levels required to attain our national security objectives. Whereas the JPD, CSR and CPR "transport" the planning efforts from the JSPS to the PPBE, the CPA ties PPBE back into the JSPS.

Key DoD PPBE Players

- The **Secretary of Defense (SECDEF)** is the civilian head of the DoD. The SECDEF sits on the President's Cabinet and has duties as a member of the National Security Council (NSC).
- The **Deputy Secretary of Defense (DEPSECDEF)** assists the SECDEF in the overall DoD leadership and, under some SECDEFs, manages the PPBE System.
- The **Under Secretary of Defense for Policy (USD(P))** represents the DoD on foreign relations and arms control matters and serves as a primary advisor to the DEPSECDEF for the PPBE planning phase.
- The **Director of Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation (CAPE)** directs many of the key decision-making defense groups and heads the Program Review of the Service budget inputs.
- The **Under Secretary of Defense, Comptroller (USD(C))** serves as the principal assistant to the SECDEF and DEPSECDEF for budgetary and fiscal matters, constructs the DoD input to the President's Budget, and heads the Budget Review of Service budget inputs.
- The **Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition and Sustainment (USD (A&S))** acts as the Defense Acquisition Executive and has DoD-wide responsibility for acquisition matters.
- The **Military Department Secretaries** are the civilian heads of their respective military Departments, act as key advisors to the SECDEF/ DEPSECDEF, and manage their own versions of PPBE.
- The **Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (CJCS)** acts as principal military advisor to the President, transmits communications from the President and SECDEF to the Combatant Commanders, and participates in DoD senior councils speaking for the Joint Chiefs of Staff (JCS) and the Combatant Commanders. The CJCS receives support from the JCS, Joint Staff, and the Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC).
- The **Combatant Commanders (CCDRs)** are the warfighters who execute the military strategy developed in planning. The Combatant Commanders provide PPBE-related inputs through both the Services and CJCS, particularly through the Joint Strategic Planning System (JSPS) and through submission of the Integrated Priority Lists (IPLs).

Key DoD Groups and Boards

- The **Deputy's Management Action Group (DMAG)** was created in 2011 by then-DEPSECDEF Ashton Carter as a four-star level body chartered to review management actions across the defense enterprise, including the PPBE process and the OSD Program and Budget Review. The DMAG is chaired by the DEPSECDEF and co-chaired by the Vice Chairman of the JCS. DMAG membership is topic dependent.
- The **Resource Management Group (RMG)** is the mid-level review group chaired by the Director, CAPE who develops issues for the DMAG. The RMG identifies major issues, analyzes them, and develops decision options for the DMAG.

- The **Defense Acquisition Board (DAB)** is directed by the USD (A&S) and VCJCS and oversees the defense system acquisition of major programs. The DAB reviews major defense programs at the completion of each life cycle milestone and links the acquisition process to PPBE.
- The **Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC)** is chaired by the VCJCS and links the acquisition process to PPBE. The JROC articulates military need and validates DAB program performance goals and program baselines at successive milestones.

Players Outside of DoD – The Executive Branch

- The President is authorized to submit the national budget each year under the Budget and Accounting Act of 1921 (Title 31, Subtitle II, Chapter 11, Section 1105, U.S. Code.)
- The National Security Council (NSC) prepares national security guidance, with the President's approval, establishing national security policy. Title 50 requires the President to annually submit to Congress a comprehensive report regarding the National Security Strategy (NSS) of the United States along with the President's Budget.
- The Office of Management and Budget (OMB) has the authority to assemble, correlate, revise, reduce, or increase requests for the appropriations of all federal departments. The OMB provides assistance to the President in the preparation of the budget and the formulation and administration of government fiscal programs.

Players Outside of DoD – The Legislative Branch

- As required by law, the President sends the budget to Congress not later than the first Monday in February. Congress can approve, increase, or decrease funding levels, eliminate proposals, or add programs not requested by the administration. The Congressional Budget and Impoundment Control Act of 1974 (Public Law 93-344) requires Congress must first agree on government-wide totals prior to considering individual appropriation measures before April 15th of each year.

Chapter 3: Financial and Program Structures

In order to program and manage resources effectively, all PPBE practitioners must know how resources are identified and in what databases they are kept. In addition, using consistent financial and programmatic data structures allow the Department of the Air Force to express to Congress how it intends to use the budget authority requested.

Future Years Defense Program (FYDP)

The FYDP is the official collection of DoD data summarizing resources (**Total Obligational Authority** (TOA)) and manpower associated with DoD programs approved by the Secretary or Deputy Secretary of Defense by fiscal year. The FYDP compiles total resources (forces, manpower, funding) programmed for DoD over a specific period of time. At the Defense Department level, the FYDP is maintained in databases within the OSD Comptroller and OSD CAPE offices.

The FYDP reflects the total resources programmed by DoD, covers five years in total, and generally begins two years after the current calendar year (for example, the FYDP for most of calendar year 2023 is FY2025 through FY2029.)

The FYDP is updated two or three times each year: once when Components submit a POM to OSD, a second time when Components submit a BES to OSD, and a third time in February to reflect the President's Budget (PB) as submitted to Congress (note: if the POM and BES are submitted simultaneously, as has occurred in years past, the FYDP is only updated twice.) After each update to the FYDP, the changes made become the departure point (baseline) for developing the organizations' program and the next budget event. Figure 3-1 shows the FYDP timeline.

FY25-29 FYDP

BY	+1	+2	+3	+4
FY25	FY26	FY27	FY28	FY29

Figure 3-1. FYDP Timeline with FY25-29 Example

Major Force Programs (MFPs)

Congress uses MFPs to aggregate dollars, identifying areas of spending. There are 12 MFPs. These cross service lines and each service contains a portion of those MFPs relating to its mission. Table 3-1 below shows the 12 major force programs.

1	Strategic Forces
2	General Purpose Forces
3	Command, Control Communications and Intelligence
4	Mobility Forces
5	Guard and Reserve Forces
6	Research and Development
7	Central Supply and Maintenance
8	Training, Medical and Other Personnel Activities
9	Administration and Associated Activities
10	Support of Other Nations
11	Special Operations
12	National Security Space

Table 3-1. Major Force Programs, by Number

Note that another data element called a program element is a subset of MFPs (described in more detail below.) The first two numbers within a PE corresponds to the related MFP. See Appendix C, “Program Element Number Mapping”, for a more detailed explanation of the link between program elements and MFPs.

Program Element (PE) Numbers

PEs are the basic building blocks used by DoD for the FYDP; therefore, they are fundamental to the Program Objective Memorandum (POM.) There are over 800 PEs assigned to the Department of the Air Force (DAF.) DAF programs are described by using PEs, each of which identifies the resources needed to support a specific program.

PEs were specifically designed to include multiple appropriations, if needed, so a PE can have multiple appropriation codes embedded with resources attached. PEs can also affect more than one Air or Space Force Panel; therefore, cross-panel coordination is a must. AF/A8PE is the Air Force **Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR)** for PE maintenance; SF/S8N is the OPR for the Space Force. Air Force AF/A8PE assigns PEs to Air Force corporate structure Panels according to their force structure or support function; Space Force SF/S8N performs the same function for the Space Force.

PEs can be changed, added or deleted using the guidelines of DoDI 7045.7 and AFI 16-501. All PPBE participants need to understand the elements represented with PE numbering. Figure 3-2 provides an example of how PEs are built, and additional guidance is contained within Appendix C, “Program Element Number Mapping.”

- Program Element Numbers describe the program 0101113F is an actual PE			
MFP	Special Use	Specific Program	Service Component
01	01	113	F = Air Force, S = Space Force
- The first two digits identify the Major Force Program. 01 = Strategic Forces - The next two digits are special use by MFP. 01 = Offensive Forces - The next three digits identify the specific program: 1 = Aircraft Units; 113 = B-52 Squadrons and its order assigned to a specific program – e.g. B-52 is the 113th program assigned to 0101XXX - The last digit identifies the Service component - As Space Force establishes unique data elements, typical timeline for a new PE request is roughly six months			

Figure 3-2. PE Structure and Example

Note: at the DoD level, PEs consist of 8 characters. In prior years, the Air Force dropped the first digit of the MFP and Special Use code, which resulted in a 6-digit PE. As a 6-digit PE does not allow for 2-digit MFP numbers, MFPs 10, 11 and 12 were reflected by using a lower case “a”, “b” and “c” as the first digit of the Program Element number. This adjustment was required due to limitations within the database system ABIDES (the DAF master database used until calendar year 2021.) The updated DAF database PBES (Program Budget Enterprise System) launched in 2021 and reflects a return to a full 8-digit PE.

Appropriation Codes

Appropriation codes represent the functional categories Congress uses to fund the DoD budget request. Appropriation codes can be thought of as categories of money, each with a specific intended use. Table 3-2 shows the major Department of Air Force appropriation codes and their individual life spans. Appropriation codes (APPN) are used in DAF and OSD systems. Each appropriation has a specific life span and is no longer available for obligation once the life expires. This is an important reason for programming the funds in the year of need.

APPN	Appropriation	Life
3010	Aircraft Procurement	3 Years
3020	Missile Procurement	3 Years
3021	Space Procurement	3 Years
3080	Other Procurement	3 Years
3300	MILCON	5 Years
3400	O&M	1 Year
3401	O&M	2 Years
3500	Military Personnel	1 Years
3501	Military Personnel	2 Years
3600	RDT&E	2 Years
3700	AFRES Personnel	1 Years
3701	AFRES Personnel	2 Years
3730	AFRES MILCON	5 Years
3740	AFRES O&M	1 Year
3741	AFRES O&M	2 Years

APPN	Appropriation	Life
3830	ANG MILCON	5 Years
3840	O&M ANG	1 Year
3841	O&M ANG	2 Year
3850	Military Personnel ANG	1 Years
3851	Military Personnel ANG	2 Years
7040	Family Housing Construction	5 Years
7045	Family Housing Ops Fund	1 Year
4930	Defense Working Capital Fund (DWCF)	1 Year

Table 3-2. Major DAF Appropriation Codes

Forces and Infrastructure

The concept of “tooth-to-tail” ratio is often discussed in conjunction with MFPs, program elements, and appropriation codes. Another means to consider these resources is to compare Forces (tooth) to Infrastructure (tail.) Forces are associated with mission (Flying Squadrons, Aircraft, Bombs, Security, Missiles, etc.) and infrastructure is associated with mission support (Training, Recruiting, Education, Staff, Military Construction, etc.). All PPBE practitioners must efficiently optimize resources with an appropriate investment in infrastructure. Infrastructure dollars are at high risk during budgeting exercises. Those managing resources also need to be aware of reductions by Congress based on infrastructure; caution is required prior to adding money back to these areas. Senior leaders realize the need for infrastructure spending but also want to limit this spending. Dollars allocated to force structure are perceived as being protected because reducing force allocations has a direct correlation on capability and mission accomplishment. Reducing infrastructure allocations can have a direct or an indirect correlation. The goal is to always minimize this expenditure. Congressional markups during appropriation cycles are good indicators of dollars at potential risk for other uses during program and budget reviews.

Beyond Program Elements and Appropriations

Program Codes

A Program Code is the 6-digit number through which a smaller portion of a program element program is tracked – most notably for modifications or changes within a program element. Program codes are assigned sequentially so the number has no special significance. New program codes can be requested and approved through AF/A8PE or SF/S8N. Every DAF dollar is mapped to one and only one program code.

Operating Agency Codes

Operating Agency Codes provide another level of program detail and identify funds specific to a MAJCOM (Air Force), FIELDCOM (Space Force), Field Operating Agency (FOA), or Direct Reporting Unit (DRU.)

Weapon Systems Codes (WSCs)

A WSC is a DAF-specific six-digit alphanumeric code used to identify and map procurement-funded activities to a particular weapon system across PEs and Budget Programs (BPs) or group common procured commodity categories within a BP.

Budget Program Activity Codes (BPACs)

Within RDT&E, an Air Force MAJCOM-issued six-digit alphanumeric code that serves as a program element's (PE)/R-1 primary division between subordinate funded activities.

Cost Categories (Cost Cats)

A Cost Category is a 5-digit numeric code that identifies cost type, most typically within the Operations and Maintenance and Manpower appropriations (example: Officer or Enlisted costs.) The codes are designed for use in budget preparation and accounting systems to identify the nature of services and items acquired for immediate consumption or capitalization. (Some are model driven e.g. flying hours and manpower.)

Constant and Then-Year Dollars

Then-Year Dollars

Then-Year (TY) Dollars reflect the rate of inflation rates over different fiscal years. When Congress appropriates dollars, they do so in TY Dollars. The POM, BES, PB, and appropriations are always in TY Dollars.

Why do we have then-year Dollars? Since outlays (government cuts a check or EFT funds) occur over many fiscal years for almost all appropriations, inflation affects these outlays. Think of TOA as a checkbook with enough money in it to pay for goods and services purchased over numerous fiscal years, and then draw down to a zero balance at the end.

Not all money Congress appropriates within DAF TOA is spent in the current fiscal year. For example, Operations and Maintenance (O&M) funding has a one-year legislated life for obligation, so all FY23 funds must be obligated in FY23 before the appropriation *expires*. However, every appropriation has an additional 5 years of availability to actually finish the payment cycle for the goods and services the government obligated itself to pay for before the end of FY23, 30 September 2023. After five years, the appropriation is *cancelled* and no longer available for any use.

Using FY23 as the initially legislated year, FY23 O&M obligations will be paid for (expended and then outlaid) as goods are actually received over the next five years. At the end of FY28, all available funds are cancelled, so it's important all obligations are paid in full before that time.

Other appropriations have different execution timetables. For example, most procurement appropriations are current (able to be obligated) for three years. Research, Development, Testing and Evaluation (RDT&E) funds are current for two years. Military personnel (MILPERS) funds are current for a single year.

Do not confuse *obligations* with expenditures, the second phase of dollar execution, and *outlay*, the final phase of dollar execution. Obligations represent a legal (signed) contract for payment, such as a purchase order or travel order. Expenditures occur once goods and services have been received (or travel has been completed) and the obligating command formally approves an invoice (or travel voucher) for payment. Outlays are the actual issuance of monies, such as a check or EFT. For O&M, the appropriation must be *obligated* by the end of one fiscal year, but expenditures and *outlays* to actually complete the purchase process for goods and services will occur over the next five fiscal years.

Constant Dollars

These types of dollars reflect the amount of spending as if all of the outlays occurred in one fiscal year. We use Constant Dollars to show real growth in the budget (or a real decrease as the case may be). To compute real growth, you must use Constant Dollars; never use Then-Year Dollars.

A “Base Year Dollar” and a “Constant Year Dollar” are really the same thing. A program which has a “Base Year of FY18” means the dollars for every year in the analysis are expressed in FY18 Constant Dollars. Many acquisition programs use a particular Base Year (e.g., FY18) for expressing their dollars as a means to measure cost growth.

Chapter 4: Planning

The Planning phase of PPBE incorporates many strategic guidance documents such as the National Security Strategy (NSS), National Defense Strategy (NDS), the National Military Strategy (NMS), the Defense Planning Guidance (DPG) and other documents supporting DAF core functions. The objective of the PPBE planning phase is to develop strategic guidance documents that reflect the priorities of the National Command Authority, the Joint Staff, the OSD Staff and the Department of the Air Force. This guidance enables the DAF to align its direction with that of the President, Secretary of Defense and Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff. DAF planning also establishes guidance that will inform the development of the POM by examining the impact of capability needs through the mid- and long-term planning periods.

Supporting the planning process is a series of strategic planning documents including the National Security Strategy (NSS), National Defense Strategy (NDS), the National Military Strategy (NMS) and the Defense Planning Guidance (DPG.) **The primary DAF strategic guidance document is currently the National Defense Strategy (NDS.)**

The most recent **National Security Strategy (NSS)** was released in October 2022. The NSS has three major themes:

- 1) **Invest** in the underlying sources and tools of American power and influence
- 2) **Build the strongest possible coalition** of nations to enhance our collective influence to shape the global strategic environment and to solve shared challenges
- 3) **Modernize and strengthen** our military so it is equipped for the era of strategic competition with major powers, while maintaining the capability to disrupt the terrorist threat to the homeland

The **National Defense Strategy (NDS)** is used to establish the objectives for military planning regarding force structure, force modernization, business processes, supporting infrastructure, and required resources (funding and manpower). The NDS plays a key role in identifying the capabilities required by the warfighters to support the National Security Strategy (NSS.) As the DoD's capstone document, the National Defense Strategy informs the National Military Strategy (NMS), and provides a framework for other DoD strategic guidance, including campaign and contingency planning, force development, and intelligence.

The most recent NDS was also released in October 2022 and identifies outcomes and DOD priorities and capabilities to achieve those outcomes. Figure 4-1 shows the relationship between these concepts within the NDS.

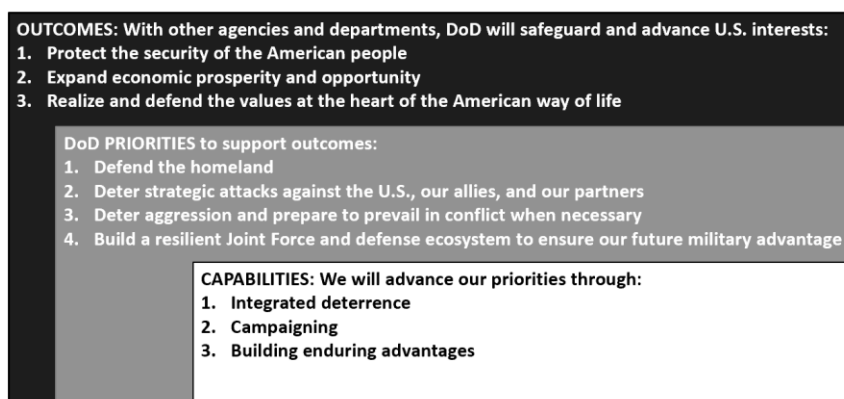


Figure 4-1. The 2022 NDS Outcomes, Priorities and Capabilities Relationship

The **National Military Strategy (NMS)** serves as DoD's overarching statement of defense strategy and business policy. It also continues to be the single link throughout DoD that integrates and influences all internal decision processes.

The **Defense Planning Guidance (DPG)** translates national and DoD guidance into specific capability-based priorities and requirements. It provides resource informed strategic guidance that begins the planning cycle and assigns long/short term issues for study. DPG decisions will also be folded into Service POMs.

JSPS Planning Input

The **Joint Planning Document** is a principal product of the Joint Strategic Planning System (JSPS) and provides the initial, timely, authoritative CJCS planning and broad programming advice to the SECDEF for initial preparation of the draft DPG. The JPD informs the DPG writers of the CJCS planning priorities as well as broad programming priorities. It reflects the CJCS' planning guidance based on the NMS, Joint Strategic Review, JSCP, Joint Vision, and strives to identify critical capability shortfalls in meeting the NMS. The JPD is prepared and submitted approximately 6 months in advance of the scheduled publication of the DPG.

The **Chairman's Program Recommendation (CPR)** provides programmatic advice to the SECDEF prior to publication of the DPG. The CPR emphasizes specific recommendations that will enhance joint readiness, promote joint doctrine and training, and better satisfy joint warfighting requirements within DoD resource constraints and within acceptable risk levels. The CPR is developed through the JROC-JWCA process, and vetted through each Combatant Command, Service Chief, and J-Director.

The **Chairman's Strategic Recommendation (CSR)** describes the Chairman's early strategic-level advice and input to the SECDEF. It identifies joint-based capability needs and requirements. The CSR significantly influences OSD's preparation of the DPG.

The **Chairman's Program Assessment (CPA)** provides the Chairman's personal assessment of the conformance of Service and agency POMs to the priorities established in the DPG, strategic plans, and combatant commander requirements. It is submitted to influence the OSD Program Budget Review (PBR), the result of which may be Program Decisions (PDs) or Budget Decisions (BDs) that direct programming and budgetary changes from the services, defense agencies and the OSD staff as required. Most CPA issues are derived from JWCA findings and recommendations vetted through the JROC.

Combatant Commander Inputs

Programmers should also review each Combatant Commander's **Integrated Priority Lists (IPL)**, which is a list of the Combatant Command's top funding priorities. IPL Items may be either specific programmatic requests or may be couched in terms of capabilities required. IPLs are usually near-term request because the focus of the CCMD's is usually immediate needs within their AOR or functional mission area.

All involved in the POM build should be cognizant of a CCMD's IPL request because failure to address these requests has the potential to result in a CCMD's sponsored "issue" (challenge) during OSD's Program Review after the MilDept POMs have been submitted.

Both Air and Space Forces use effects and capabilities-based planning and programming processes to validate potential program change requests during the POM cycle. Thus, the foundation of both Air and Space Force POMs is the programs and capabilities required to support specific Core Functions (see figure 4-2 below, noting the Core Function concept still reflect a DAF-level perspective.) These capabilities are derived through combinations of sub-capabilities provided by systems and family-of-systems. By focusing on capabilities, the Air and Space Forces shifted their emphasis from programs and platforms to battlefield effects and concept of operations that emphasize how airmen and guardians will fight in joint combat operations within a joint integrated architecture.

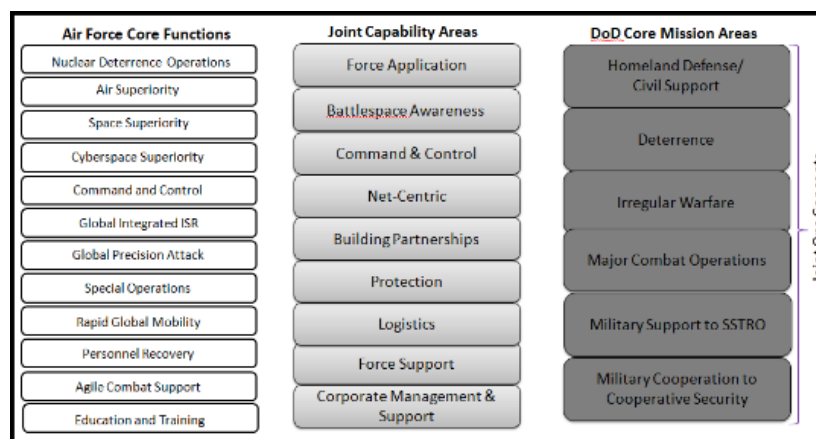


Figure 4-2. USAF Core Functions – Joint Capability Areas and DoD Core Mission Areas

Air Force Core Functions

DAF Core Functions were developed as a means of capturing and articulating the “key” DAF contributions to the joint fight. The Service Core Functions (SCF) are functional areas that delineate the appropriate and assigned core duties, missions, and tasks of the DAF as an organization. Service Core Functions express the ways the DAF is particularly and appropriately suited to contribute to national security, although the SCFs do not cover every aspect in which the Air and Space Forces contribute to national defense. The DAF Service Core Functions support OSD’s Joint Capability Areas (JCA) which in turn support the DoD Core Mission areas. See Figure 4-2 above (the “Service” core function concept remains defined at the DAF level as each of the DAF Services determine distinct areas of functional responsibility.)

Planning Guidance as Inputs to the POM

The **Plan to Program Guidance (PPG)** complements the NDS. The PPG is designed to incorporate any “initial vectors” that result from the Air Force **4-Star Summarizing Event** (formerly known as the Planning Choices meeting) held in November/December prior to the POM exercise. This allows senior Air Force leadership the ability to direct movement of funds between/amongst the Core Functions prior to upcoming POM build. NOTE: the most recent Planning Choices meeting took place in December 2022 and results in guidance that will be incorporated into the FY 25-29 POM build.

The **Program Guidance Memorandum (PGM)** is an Air Force AF/A8 document that applies a “programming spin” to the PPG. The PGM is also the companion to the **POM Preparation Instruction (PPI)** which is the “how to” unclassified document that details the process/procedures/mechanics for the Air Force POM process. The Space Force also publishes their own PPI that guides their POM process and submission.

Chapter 5: Data Processes

Introduction

Quality decisions rely on quality information. The DAF has developed databases and tools to provide quality information to form recommendations for senior decision makers. Tools alone cannot ensure quality information and decisions. All PPBE Practitioners must respond quickly and accurately in the resource environment. The adage of “you want it bad, you get it bad,” cannot exist in the resource distribution world. It is important to know what program data and tools are available to analyze, how to retrieve that data, and how to change the data files. Programming databases and tools include the Program Budget Enterprise System (PBES); Automated Budget Interactive Data Environment Systems (ABIDES – the legacy database replaced by PBES in calendar year 2021); the Force Structure Data Management (FSDM); Manpower Programming and Execution System (MPES); and the Air Force FYDP Structure Management System (Air Force FSMS.) Each of these databases and tools is discussed in this chapter.

Program and Budget Enterprise System (PBES) and Automated Budget Interactive Data Environment Systems (ABIDES)

ABIDES was the database used by the DAF for many years. PBES is its replacement and has been used since the FY23 POM process (calendar year 2021) by both the Air Force and Space Force. Both PBES and ABIDES provide a current and historical database for PPBE stakeholders to conduct research and analysis. Both systems contain all appropriations including dollars, aircraft flying hours, manpower, and end-strength number. SAF/FM is the OPR for PBES.

The PPBE process results in updates to the FYDP and supporting databases three times during each exercise year: once as the POM is completed and submitted to OSD, once as the BES is submitted to OSD, and once upon conclusion of the OSD review cycle. PBES (and ABIDES) historic files are based on those points in time.

Choosing the “current file” in the PBES database will give you the most recent FYDP updated position; prior year data is available as well. For example, ABIDES’ historical files are the files used most often when doing research and analysis. It is possible to conduct inquiries to track program changes through the POM, BES, and PB over multiple fiscal years, with data back to 1962. This information is important when defending any program and can assist in providing an interpretation of program intent. As an example, reports based on constant-year dollar inquiries will identify whether spending decreased or increased in real terms. During programming exercises (POM, BES, PB), the baseline start of an exercise is identical to the final baseline for the previous exercise. **Change files** track proposed changes during exercises.

Note: the functions within PBES and ABIDES are very similar. The primary difference between PBES and ABIDES is that the PBES system *includes* an option generation tool that has the ability to pull current program data directly from the database itself. (When using ABIDES, a separate, standalone option generation tool and current program data had to be researched separately from ABIDES and manually re-typed into option presentations by the user.)

Change Control Numbers (CCNs)

CCNs keep track of corporate decisions: approvals or denials of requests for changes to resources within a POM cycle. Every programmatic change briefed through the corporate process must have a CCN. A CCN is a ten-digit alpha-numeric code specifically designed to track changes in PBES. Table 5-1 lists the primary CCN Components.

In what year the change was made
In which cycle (POM, BES, PB)
Whether the proposed change is a disconnect, initiative, or offset
Which panel is the OPR, as well as the panel's sequential number of all actions
Whether any manpower or procurement is part of the change.

Table 5-1. Primary CCN Components

CCNs are used throughout the programming and budgeting process and remain in the database as permanent documentation of program changes. They represent the record of senior leadership decisions. Figure 5-1 identifies the elements and fields required in CCN construction for the POM.

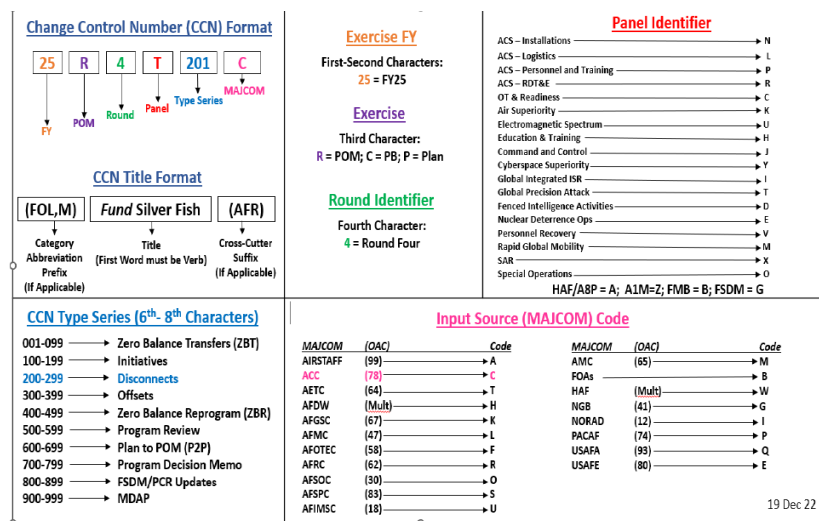


Figure 5-1. Change Control Number Structure

ASARS RAPIDS and “Option” Development

ASARS RAPIDS was a software tool used to develop proposals (“options”) to increase or decrease program funding during the POM process. It was used by the Air Staff, MAJCOMs, FOAs and DRUs. Although ASARS RAPIDS functions have largely been absorbed within PBES, the information required to present option proposals via the prescribed “Perfect Slide” (see Figure 5-2) is still a valuable guideline to use for anyone requesting program changes within the POM process. For this reason, this Reference Manual uses the ASARS RAPIDS option format to provide explanation of the information expected to be provided by anyone proposing an option.

Relevant data, background, impact, resources, and hard-hitting facts were all displayed on an ASARS RAPIDS slide, and a common format similar to RAPIDS is still generated by PBES (currently, slides presenting proposed resource changes are simply referred to more broadly as “option slides.”) Using a common option format provides uniformity

among PPBE stakeholders and displays all the information required to inform corporate decisions in a presentable format.

UNCLAS

Increase JSOW/F-22 Mod

TRAINING ONLY!

BACKGROUND:

(U) Joint Stand Off Munition (JSOW) joint program provides stand-off munition capable of line-of-sight and beyond precision attack and destruction of hard and deeply buried targets. Weapons can be carried on a variety of USAF, USN/USMC and USA systems.

ADJUSTMENT:

(U) Adds funds to the JSOW program to increase production numbers by 100 across the FYDP and mods the F-22A to enable carriage of the weapons with appropriate weapons computer upgrades.

SM: 25A1T102CB	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30
CURRENT PRG	220.8	220.9	222.0	224.0	232.0	236.0	242.0	0.0
ADJUSTMENT			108.5	115.1	120.3	125.2	133.1	0.0
REV PGM TOTAL			330.5	339.1	352.3	361.2	375.1	0.0

PROCUREMENT	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30	MPWR	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30
Current Prg:	236	248	264	286	310	344	380	0	OFF	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Adjustment:	0	0	20	20	20	20	20	0	ENL	0	0	14	18	22	22	22	0
Revised Pgm:	0	0	284	306	330	364	400	0	CIV	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

IMPACTS:

(U) Guidance: DPG - improve precision caps COCOM IPL: CE#3 - increase JSOW

(U) CONG: No

(U) RQMTS: F-22A ORD Feb 17

(U) Program enjoys significant support from COCOMs and ACC, PACAF, and USAFE

(U) Provides capability to engage a variety of stationary and mobile targets including advanced armor, bunkers, command and control vehicles, and hardened transporter/erector launchers

UNCLAS

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Manpower Programming and Execution System (MPES)

The MPES is a database that contains total force manpower for military personnel positions. MPES is updated exclusively by Manpower Programmers and it contains the end-strength appropriations. It does not contain dollars, aircraft or flying hours. Manpower changes are tied to CCNs and briefed through the corporate structure. Manpower dollars are model driven by cost factors managed by SAF/FMBOP. Every Panel has a manpower programming representative. The manpower programmer on the panel validates, programs, and defends Air Force manpower resources.

There are several rules when adjusting manpower:

- Budget rules change every year; SAF/FMB enforces the process
- All PPBE stakeholders must be sensitive to Congressionally mandated floors, minimum end-strength levels and ceilings, and maximum end strength levels
- Special consideration must be given to the officer-to-enlisted ratio
- PPBE participants must know which manpower authorizations are allowed to be adjusted, as many programs are fenced (protected by Congress)
- Plus-ups can be difficult to execute, so PPBE Practitioners must watch for major growth patterns.

Force Structure Data Management System (FSDM)

FSDM is a mainframe software system with five subsystems:

- Programmed Force Structure
- Programmed Flying Hours
- Actual Inventory and Flying Hours
- Installation/Unit Data
- Attrition Model (yearly aircraft loss model)

FSDM is used as a repository for all force (aircraft) related information. Aircraft and flying hour changes are tied to CCNs approved by the corporate structure and exported to PBES and priced by SAF/FMBOO. Forces (aircraft) and flying hours are updated in FSDM twice a year, during the POM and PB (including approved PCRs and ZBTs.) FSDM is accessible only to the Air Staff Force Programmers and Flying Hours Programmers (AF/A3OT.) The FSDM information allows option development focused on force structure. FSDM is managed by AF/A8PE, contains no dollars or manpower, produces Worksheets, and updates PBES. Resource Managers rely on FSDM for information regarding all flying related issues, force distribution, numbers of aircraft, and modeling. Panels and Force Programmers develop “what if” options for senior leadership based on FSDM as the official Air Force position.

Chapter 6: Department of Air Force Programming

Introduction

There are three things required to produce a POM: the first is a baseline, the second is fiscal guidance, and the third is program or strategic guidance. Within PPBE, a POM is never built from scratch; the last four years of the previous year's FYDP are used as a baseline. It's important to understand the baseline represents a service and DoD position that has been approved by the Service Chief and Secretary as well as the Secretary of Defense.

The second POM requirement is fiscal guidance. Fiscal guidance informs DoD of the maximum size of the DoD budget the administration will be willing to submit to Congress for their consideration. Fiscal guidance is a political document.

The third POM requirement is program or strategic guidance. Program guidance is the outcome of the strategic planning process reviewed and prioritized by DAF senior leadership. Inputs include such things as the CCMD Integrated Priority Lists (IPLs), prior year Congressional guidance, the OSD Defense Planning Guidance (DPG), and the National Defense Strategy (NDS) and the Plan to Program Guidance (PPG), just to name a few.

The Programming phase of PPBE has two equally important parts. First, programmers create and "cost" a resource allocation plan for the equipment, systems, and programs needed to achieve capabilities and execute plans and strategies. For example, let's say that guidance directed the creation of a second training location for the F-35. Programmers would translate that option into specific timelines and detailed budget numbers (what will construction requirements be, how much manpower will be required, how many flying hours must be planned for, what support equipment must the Service procure, etc.). This will become the detail that allows programmers to "cost" the option, create the documentation, and eventually develop the option itself within PBES. Second, programming provides a process through which new requirements (options) will compete for limited fiscal guidance funding. This process will vary from Service to Service. The DAF calls its process the "Corporate Structure", and there is a distinct Air Force Corporate Structure (AFCS) and Space Force Corporate Structure (SFCS) that then integrate their separate POM products into a single DAF-level POM.

Using those Corporate Structures, the two DAF Services match available resources (fiscal guidance) against requirements (NDS, IPLs, PPG, etc.), make the appropriate adjustments to the baseline, combine the two Service inputs into a single DAF POM, and submit that integrated DAF POM to OSD for review. The DAF POM is reviewed by CJCS, OSD, CCMDs, and the other Services, and alternatives are presented to address significant programmatic issues. The individual programmer's task is to make warfighting effects, and the capabilities needed to achieve them, the drivers for resource allocation efforts. In most cases, the resources required by plans exceed the resources available. Programming can be viewed as a process of prioritizing programs, assessing and attempting to minimize risk, and analyzing programs in terms of their connectivity and ability to be executed.

The Program Objective Memorandum (POM)

The Program Objective Memorandum (POM) is the primary document used to submit Military Department (and Defense Agency) programming proposals to OSD. The POM includes an analysis of missions, objectives, alternative methods to meet capability needs, and allocation of resources.

The POM is used to develop proposed programs consistent with DoD and DAF guidance and to submit proposed programming. The POM is a multiyear plan that is organized within program categories (Major Force Programs from

Chapter 3), such as General Purpose Forces or Special Operations; and by type of resource, such as procurement or manpower. It provides for one budget year and four years beyond the budget year for cost and manpower.

Once the DAF POM is submitted to OSD, it is reviewed for compliance with priorities established in strategic planning documents such as the DPG and CCMDs IPLs. This review, known as the OSD Program Review and Budget Review, is discussed in more detail in chapter 9.

Beginning the POM Build: Extending the Baseline

Both the Air Force and Space Force begin the **Program Objective Memorandum (POM)** build by extending the **Program Baseline** into the new fifth year of the FYDP.

Baseline extensions are unique to the building of the POM and are usually completed prior to actual POM deliberations. Each year at the DAF level, the existing Program Baseline is expanded to include a new year of the FYDP by literally *extending* existing program content in the last year of the prior FYDP to the newly-added year of the next FYDP. For example, the program content in FY28 within the FY 24-28 FYDP becomes the basis for FY 29 within the FY 25-29 FYDP. The baseline extension process also means that, unless fiscal guidance is increased (more funds become available), every dollar within the DAF is already committed to an existing program – there are no “free range” dollar available at the beginning of the POM build. That baseline extended position then becomes the starting point for the next POM effort.

The baseline extension process will vary from year to year. What follows explains a “typical” baseline extension but the reader should reference the most current **POM Preparation Instruction (PPI)** for guidance applicable to the present POM. Typically, the baseline extension will start with inputs from the Input Sources (MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs, FOAs, DRUs, Centrally Managed Programs) and Program Element Monitors (PEMs) as validated by the Panels. Programs are first extended based on inflation adjustment rates provided by SAF/FM and then reviewed by the respective Service Corporate Structures for appropriate program content changes.

The baseline extension begins in PBES, where the last year of the prior FYDP is inflated using approved inflation factors from OSD to create a new fiscal year that is an inflation-adjusted version of that last year. Because this inflationary process assumes nothing has changed between fiscal years, the newly created fiscal year will likely contain errors. Air Force and Space Force Panels and PEMs are responsible for identifying these errors and making recommendations to adjust the new year to account for already-approved changes in investment programs (procurement, RDT&E, and MILCON). This is the heart of the baseline extension.

While extending the baseline, the Service MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs, Panels and PEMs will also identify (but not yet fix) those programs that have not had program content (mission/function) changes but for which resources are not available to complete the mission. These programs are described as “broken.” Programs may be short resources for the following reasons:

- Poor programming
- Database errors
- Cost changes out of line with normal inflation
- Rate change
- Corporate Structure restructuring of the program with incorrect total funding.

Associated with this baseline extension is the relationship with the DoD **Fiscal Guidance (FG)** given to the DAF. FG is in terms of Total Obligational Authority (TOA) derived from Presidential decisions about future DoD funding levels as estimated by OMB. When budgets are climbing in real (inflation adjusted) terms, fiscal guidance for any given year of the FYDP is likely to be slightly higher than it was in the previous year’s guidance. This allows additional content to be inserted to the baseline. When budgets are in decline, fiscal guidance for a given year may be lower than in the previous year’s guidance and there may not be funding available for all the content already in the baseline.

PEM Parades and Baseline Reviews

PEM Parades and Baseline Reviews are conducted at all levels within PPBE, including MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs, and the Air and Space Staffs in preparation for the coming POM build. A PEM Parade allows Corporate Structure Panels (or Baseline Reviews, within MAJCOMs and FIELDCOMs) to become aware of potential issues within the assigned portfolio of PEs and to confirm the currency of funding requirements. Preparation for PEM Parades and Baseline Reviews is a demanding process, not only for PEMs but also for other program stakeholders (within functional communities, for example), because the information gathered during a PEM Parade or Review creates the basis for all subsequent Corporate Structure deliberations. The goals of each PEM Parade are to “skull” (prepare) the Panel Chair for Corporate Structure presentations; provide a thorough review all Panel programs; and identify potential end-game offsets.

As Panels progress through the PEM Parade process, background information (Parade slides, papers, supporting documents, etc.) is usually formed into a series of “Brain Books” (large binders) that are housed and maintained with the OPR for each Panel. Note this material becomes classified as SECRET once PEM Parade templates are populated.

Making It Balance: Prioritizing the Baseline

Once the baseline extension has been completed, MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs and other Input Sources are normally directed to develop “balanced” lists of Disconnects and Initiatives. Input Sources, normally, are also allowed to “internally fix” Disconnected programs with Offsets provided from their own MAJCOM/Input Source portfolio. The submitted solution must “balance” – the total dollar value of Disconnects and Initiatives must be paid for by the submitted Offsets.

NOTE: in some POM exercises, due to the resource allocation environment at the time, the Air Force or Space Force may not allow Input Sources to submit Initiatives because of the challenging environment with very limited ability to fund “new” programs. Guidelines regarding submitting Initiatives are provided within each Service’ annual POM

process document, the POM Preparation Instruction (PPI.) Note a separate PPI is issued by the Air Force and the Space Force.

MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs, and other Input Sources brief their organizations' balanced solution to each Service' Corporate Structure. This process concludes when the DAF Council (4-Star level) reviewing these proposed solutions and making adjustments.

Note these Corporate Structure deliberations actions take place after the 4-Star Summarizing Event (formerly the Planning Choices meeting) has taken place earlier in the POM build. The 4-Star Summarizing event is designed to afford senior leaders the opportunity to review, and as necessary, make decisions that realign resources to meet Air Force priorities *across and/or within Core Functions*. Also, during this meeting the senior leaders may consider cross – MAJCOM or FIELDCOM adjustments to fund those Air/Space Force programs still requiring more funding.

POM Integration

Once program Disconnects and Initiative proposals have been submitted from Input Sources, the POM focus shifts process leadership to each of the DAF Service Corporate Structures. Deliberations during the 4-Star Summarizing event are designed to make major programming decisions that impact the entire DAF enterprise, thereby simplifying (hopefully) the follow-on work of the Corporate Structures. During this integration phase, additional issues are identified and further adjustments may be required. Detailed funding requirements are determined and final fiscal balance achieved. All adjustments are to be in accordance with senior DAF leader decisions during the 4-Star Summarizing event.

Disconnects

A Disconnect is an approved program (recall that any program in the baseline has been approved by the Service Chief and Secretary and by the SECDEF), or a portion of an approved program, that has become unexecutable because of a mismatch between its resources and the content approved by the SECAF and CSAF in the previous baseline.

Fixing Disconnects

Three actions are possible with a broken program:

1. Fund (requires resources)
2. Restructure (adjust program content)
 - Note: terminating the program is a form of restructure
3. Accept Risk (do nothing)

Note that Disconnects usually have priority as a Corporate Structure begins to validate requirements and apply resources. It is essential Disconnects are validated by the Input Source and Panel who own the program.

Program Initiatives

Program Initiatives are defined as either new starts or additions to existing programs due to program content or growth. Implementing the NDS, DPG and PPG may create the need to start a new program or increase resources to an on-going program. For example, Air Force Air Education and Training Command (Air Force MAJCOM) reports that pilots coming into a major weapon system directly from UPT are taking several additional rides to upgrade to mission capable status because they are deficient in formation flying. The AETC Commander decides it would make fiscal sense to increase the number of sorties these student pilots receive in UPT. This would require added UPT

resources and would be addressed as an initiative in the POM. Generally speaking, these programmatic changes occur during the POM cycle of the FYDP; however they are not limited to the POM. We will discuss in a later chapter the procedures for making changes inside the POM timeline (e.g. for this or the next fiscal year.) Program Initiatives can be either top-driven (direction of the President, SECDEF, SECAF, CSAF, CSO) or bottom up (MAJCOM, FIELDCOM, Air/Space Staff Functional (e.g. A2), PEM, etc.). All Program Initiatives must be validated (program content and mission/function must be accepted) by the functional Deputy Chief of Staff (DCS) and the corporate structure (Panel, Air or Space Force Group (AFG/SFG), Air or Space Force Board (AFB/SFB), DAF Council.

Offsets

Staying within OSD fiscal guidance is a must during the FYDP exercises. Fully funding Disconnects and Initiatives would well exceed the available TOA even in the best year. The DAF solves this problem by taking Offsets from existing programs of lower importance or programs where changing circumstances have made it prudent to accept increased risk. A program may be wholly offset (in essence terminated) or partially offset (as might be the case if we reduced by one the number of active duty F-16 squadrons). Offsets transfer resources from the baseline of the program being offset to pay for Disconnects and Initiatives. *Said another way, they take resources from less dear programs to pay for more dear requirements.* It should be noted here that a specific Offset is seldom applied to fund a specific Initiative or Disconnect. Instead, Corporate Structures will create a pool of Disconnects it wants to fund and prioritizes them from most to least dear. They next create a pool of Offsets, similarly prioritized. They will fund the list of Initiatives and Disconnects in priority order until the resources freed by the Offsets runs out or until the relative importance of the remaining Initiatives and Disconnects is lower than the importance of the Offset being given up as a funding source.

Offsets inevitably create program changes. Unrealistic Offsets – proposing Offsets that are clearly too dear to be considered (say, a proposal to close the Air Force Academy) – are a waste of a Corporate Structure's time and call into question the Panel Chair's credibility. Focus on the doable. "Radioactive" Offsets (cuts proposed to highly political or sensitive programs) may be realistic but will be the toughest to work. These Offsets must normally be worked well in advance with the potentially impacted parties to minimize political blow-back. Junior ROTC is an example of a radioactive Offset. "Peanut Butter Spreads" or "Salami Slices" are across the board percentage reductions to level of effort programs (base operating support, for example) that do not change the expectations of the program delivery (mission), but reduce the resources available to produce the capability are affected. These are the least desirable of all Offsets proposals but are routinely used in a typical POM build.

Sometimes resourcing an Initiative or Disconnect will free up resources elsewhere that can be used as an Offset. In the previous UPT example, increasing UPT sorties might reduce the number of more expensive sorties required by pilots training to fly a major weapon system. Recall, however, that at the Corporate Structure level, Offsets are not generally linked to Disconnects and Initiatives. In this case, the Air or Space Staff Panel would need to make sure the Offset remained linked to the Initiative. We could not reduce F-16 RTU sorties without the increase in UPT formation rides.

Balanced Program

OSD requires the DAF to present a balanced and affordable program at the end of each FYDP update. By having the summation of corporate supported Disconnects and Initiatives equaling the programmatic Offsets, the DAF keeps the program balanced to the OSD fiscal guidance. Remember the formula below:

$$D + I = O$$

DISCONNECTS + INITIATIVES = OFFSETS

Changing the Baseline

Programming is all about changing the baseline to replace less dear programs with more dear programs. There are two ways we can change the baseline during the programming phase. The first is through action of a Corporate Structure (Panels, Group, Board, or Council.) In a nutshell, the Input Sources (MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs, FOAs, DRUs) bring forward their Initiatives, Disconnects, and Offsets for debate and adjudication. Those that are approved are input as changes to the baseline.

Note: For the current FY 25-29 POM exercise, the USAF has modified the POM procedures in an attempt to allow the Input Sources greater flexibility in addressing their internal programming requirements. For the FY 25-29 POM, Input Sources are allowed to use a Zero Balanced Reprogramming (ZBR) (see definition below) action to fund Disconnects and Initiatives within their own portfolios. It is hoped that this flexibility will allow Input Sources to address their own programming needs (Disconnects and Initiatives) without relying on HQ USAF. This adjustment hopefully will also reduce the workload at HQ USAF.

Zero Balanced Transfers

The second way a baseline can be changed within the programming phase is using a Zero Balance Transfer (ZBT). A ZBT is the method used to correct a program imbalance or ensure the executability problem. A ZBT is a zero-sum reallocation of resources within a single PE, and usually allowed where there has been a database error in a previous exercise. For example, a keystroke error resulted in dollars being taken from an enlisted personnel line when it should have come from the officer personnel line. The potential for such errors (the cost categories for officer and enlisted personnel are just one number different) is the reason PEMs should continue to check the database even after it is locked for changes. A ZBT is not to be used for reprogramming; a ZBT can put resources at risk because the corporate structure can disapprove the transfer and take the resources offered to be transferred. Check the PPI for specific ZBT procedures.

Zero Balanced Reprogramming

Zero-balanced transfers should not be confused with zero-balanced reprogramming, which refers to the practice of funding a Disconnect or an Initiative with a dedicated Offset *from the same portfolio*. ZBRs allow PPBE practitioners – Input Sources and/or HQ USAF Panels – the ability to “fix” their own Disconnects and address their own Initiatives by paying the bill with a specific Offset from their own portfolios.

NOTE: rules on when and how Initiatives and Disconnects are considered can change from year to year. **Recommend all PPBE practitioners review the current Air or Space Force POM Preparation Instruction (PPI) for each specific POM effort.**

Chapter 7: Department of Air Force Corporate Structures

Introduction

“Corporate structures” provide a forum for considering and deciding Department of Air Force resource allocation issues. The Air Force Corporate Structure is the corporate review process for both the U.S. Air Force and Department of the Air Force (DAF), and the Space Force Corporate Structure is the corporate review process for the Space Force.

Each Service within the DAF maintains its individual corporate review processes and upon completion, the products of each Service are merged to form the final DAF product (such as a final DAF POM or BES.) Currently, Air and Space Force corporate processes are highly similar but not identical, and there is no requirement for the two Services to maintain similar processes going forward. Because the Programming process within PPBE is not statutory (not required by law), programming processes and structures can be modified to best suit the current organization, environment, or process needs. Membership in corporate structure bodies consists of civilian and military personnel assigned to the Air Staff, Space Staff, or DAF Secretariat, MAJCOMs (USAF) and FIELDCOMs (USSF.)

The Air and Space Force Corporate Structures

Both the Air and Space Force Corporate Structures, as illustrated in Figures 7-1 and 7-2 below, are designed to enhance and facilitate the corporate decision process. This is done in a number of ways. First, the Corporate Structure increases stakeholder involvement in decision-making. Second, decision-making is enhanced across functional areas. Third, participants focus on the process rather than the organizational structure. In addition, it facilitates involvement across the entire DAF, enhancing institutional buy-in to decisions.

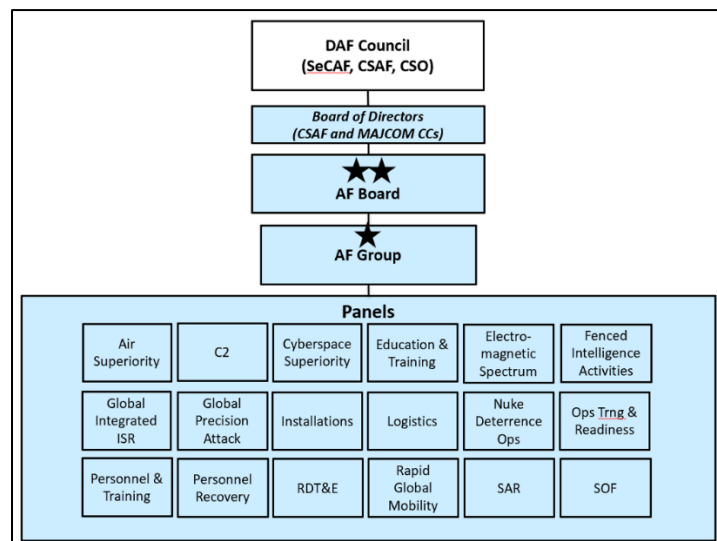


Figure 7-1. The Air Force Corporate Structure

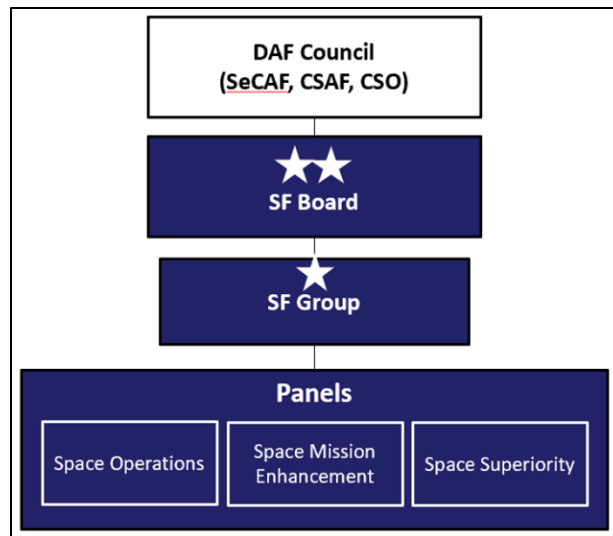


Figure 7-2. The Space Force Corporate Structure

Functional Organizations

Certain organizations within both the Air and Space Force have significant responsibility in the resource allocation process:

For *Planning processes*, AF/A5 is the Air Staff focal point for strategic planning and requirements. SF/S5/8 is the Space Staff Chief of Strategic Resources Office.

For *Programming processes*, AF/A8PE is the central point for Air Staff programming. SF/S8N is the central point for Space Staff programming.

SAF/FM is responsible for managing the budgetary process for the Department of the Air Force. SAF/FMP integrates, submits, and defends the DAF POM. SAF/FMB transitions the DAF POM into a DAF Budget Estimate Submission (BES) and oversees its execution.

Air Force Panels

The Air Force Panel system currently consists of 18 panels:

Air Superiority	Logistics
Command and Control (C2)	Nuclear Deterrence Ops
Cyber	Ops Training and Readiness
Education and Training	Personnel and Training
Electromagnetic Spectrum	Personnel Recovery
Fenced Intelligence Activities	RDT&E
Global Integrated ISR	Rapid Global Mobility
Global Precision Attack	Special Access Requirements (SAR)
Installations	Special Operations Forces (SOF)

Space Force Panels

The Air Force Panel system currently consists of 3 panels:

1. Space Operations
2. Space Mission Enhancement
3. Space Superiority

Note: because the Programming process within PPBE is not required by law, it can and often is modified from year to year, including the number of Panels or business rules used by a Corporate Structure. PPBE Practitioners should refer to the latest POM Preparation Instruction (PPI) or consult with either AF/ A8PE or SF/S8N for process updates.

Input Sources

“Input Sources” are also significant participants in resource decision-making. Input Sources are Major Commands (MAJCOMs), FOAs, DRUS and centrally managed programs within the Air Force, and Field Commands (FIELDCOMs), FOAs, and DRUs within the Space Force. Within both Services, Input Sources were created to represent a field-level, capabilities and function perspective (as opposed to the Panels, who provide real-time process expertise.)

Roles and responsibilities between the Panels and Input Sources have not always been well-defined and were frequently agreed upon between the Panels and Input Sources themselves, which did not always produce consistent inputs to higher levels of the Corporate Structure. The POM Preparation Instruction (PPI) usually clarifies expectations of each.

Creating POM Proposals: Roles and Responsibilities

All entities within PPBE (Panels, Input Sources, and other stakeholders) begin their resource allocation process by conducting baseline reviews of the programs contained in their portfolios. For a Panel, this review is often referred to as a “PEM Parade”, but similar reviews are conducted throughout the Air and Space Forces at the beginning of each POM exercise. Each sub-organization will identify initiatives, disconnects and offsets – for the MAJCOMs and FIELDCOMs, this is the focus of their “1 to N List” submission.

For recent POMs, Panels have primary responsibility for formally developing options to be presented to higher levels of the AFCS, starting with the Air Force Group (AFG) or Space Force Group (SFG.) This means Input Sources must conduct initial requirements and costing research and forward proposed resource options to the Panels. Panel Chairs are primary briefers to the AFG or SFG and prepare an initial briefing for that details the Panel portfolio. The AFG or SFG in turn issues fiscal constraints to the Panels based on DAF TOA and existing guidance.

Panels also prepare Zero Balance Transfer (ZBTs) and other minor programmatic changes. Input Sources contribute core function expertise and Panels contribute process expertise, with real-time knowledge of corporate deliberations, access to PBES data, presentation format requirements, and process “situational awareness.” Additionally, the Panels assess and provide comments to OSD guidance during OSD Program and Budget Reviews, and they analyze and assess all programs and program elements vice Integrated Priority Lists (IPLs). Both Input Sources and Panels work together to develop fiscally constrained options and present a “balanced” (within fiscal guidance) portfolio to the AFG or SFG in an effort to “get to the bottom line” (GTBL.)

The Air and Space Force Groups (AFG and SFG)

For both the Air and Space Force, the AFG and SFG are the next level of decision-making above the Panels and Input Sources. Each body provides senior-level (O-6 and equivalent) decision-making on significant issues. A Group's key function is to provide the initial corporate-level review of the integrated Air or Space Force program. In addition to this responsibility, Groups also review options in light of guidance, review and confirm cost, schedule and completeness of program options, and consider whether initiatives meet core competencies or requirements.

The Air Force and Space Force Boards (AFB and SFB)

The AFB and SFB are the next level of corporate decision-making. Members are one and two star or equivalent functional representatives. Each Board resolves issues brought to it by its corresponding Group, as well as providing input back to that Group for further review. Board issues are refined and integrated for final submission to the Department of Air Force Council (DAF Council).

The Department of Air Force (DAF) Council

The DAF Council is the top-level decision-making body. Members are Deputy Chief of Staff (DCS) and Assistant Secretary level with selected Directorate participation. The DAF Council reviews Air and Space Force plans, objectives, and policies. It provides senior leadership recommendations that reflect a *single, DAF-level* POM to the Chief of Staff of the Air Force (CSAF), Chief of Space Operations (CSO) and the Secretary of the Air Force (SECAF.)

Interaction of Corporate and Functional Processes and Operational Concepts

The headquarters functional staff is responsible for the daily activity within the Air Staff, Space Staff and Secretariat. Functional staff members become involved in the corporate structure through their involvement at one of the levels just described. Part of the role of corporate structure participants is to provide their unique perspective regarding the issues with which they are involved. This allows the cross-functional vetting of major issues and avoids a stove-piped process. Additionally, both MAJCOMs and FIELDCOMs play a significant role in deliberations.

It is important to understand the Corporate Structure's role in decision-making is an advisory one only. Decisions made in the Corporate Structure serve only as recommendations and are not binding. In addition, findings of the Corporate Structure do not usurp the authority of functional decision-makers. Only the CSAF, CSO and SECAF and their subordinates have binding decision-making authority.

The Corporate Structure is designed to maintain a process streamlined and accountable while increasing corporate participation and review. The process is designed to be open and inclusive. The Corporate Structure serves as the forum for the resolution of major issues affecting the entire DAF. Not every proposed issue goes through the Corporate Structure—only those significant enough to need an Air Force-wide decision. Ultimately, it helps the DAF develop unity of support for final decisions to strengthen and clarify positions provided to OSD.

Chapter 8: Building and Justifying the Air Force Budget

Introduction

The PPBE cycle produces *two* distinct budget requests. The final product is the President's Budget request annually submitted to Congress, but each military service and agency within the Department also produces its own budget request for consideration by OSD. This military service/agency budget is known as a BES – a budget estimate submission – and is typically submitted to OSD in the late summer or early autumn each year. Both budgets are discussed in this chapter.

The President's Budget (PB) recommendation to Congress is assembled by staff in the Office of Management and Budget (OMB). OMB initiates this process every year in time to submit the PB to Congress in early February, following the President's State of the Union address at the end of January. To generate the PB, each Federal Department or Agency prepares a budget in accordance with OMB Circular A-11 and the fiscal guidance issued annually by OMB. Fiscal guidance includes the total obligational authority (TOA) each Federal department or agency should use for future planning purposes (also known as "topline"), and any other funding constraints or allocations, such as assumptions on outlay rates.

OMB Circular A-11, Preparation, Submission, and Execution of the Budget, provides an overview of the OMB budget process under which the Defense Department operates. It discusses the basic laws that regulate the budget process and defines all budget-related terms and concepts. The circular covers development of the President's Budget, including explanations of how to prepare and submit materials required for OMB and requests for presidential review of an agency. OMB Circular A-11 also details the formulation of the budget, including development and submission of performance budgets.

The DoD Financial Management Regulation incorporates and complies with OMB Circular A-11. Upon receipt of its fiscal guidance from OMB, the Defense Department allocates this "topline" to each of the defense services and agencies through the Under Secretary of Defense, Comptroller (USD(C)). Services and agencies then develop a full plan of how funding will be used in future years and submit this plan back to USD(C) in a formal Budget Estimate Submission (BES). The USD(C) reviews each input during a formal budget review, consolidates all inputs into a single defense budget, and submits this budget to OMB.

The budget data in each BES is based on the programs and fiscal guidance contained in the Program Objective Memorandum (POM) and covers the same fiscal years. DoD departmental guidance for general preparation of a BES is provided in DoD Financial Management Regulation (DoD FMR) 7000.14-R, Vols. 2A & 2B. More specific guidance is included in DoD's annual fiscal guidance and budget call.

Although the POM and BES address the same fiscal years, the nature of each package is very different. The POM focuses on identifying how programs help achieve the mission and long-term objectives. The POM also forces resource choices on the basis of capability and programmatic need, with cost an important but not primary decision factor.

The BES, in contrast, assumes program choices made in the POM are valid and fixed, and focuses instead on applying accurate pricing factors, such as inflation, foreign currency, fuel rates, and pay raise percentages.

These key differences between the POM and the BES are summarized in table 8-1.

Programming	Budgeting
Is built primarily by <i>program element</i>	Is built primarily by <i>appropriation</i>
Is an <i>OSD</i> -developed process	Is a <i>Constitutionally</i> -developed process
The process <i>differs greatly</i> depending on Service and Agency	The process is largely <i>the same</i> regardless of Service or Agency
Requires tools <i>internal</i> to DoD (PBES, TriCharts, OSD databases)	Requires tools <i>external</i> to DoD (exhibits, J-Books, OMB databases)
Targets DoD audiences	Targets non-DoD audiences

Table 8-1. Programming and Budgeting Process Comparison

Developing the Defense Department Budget Estimate Submission (BES)

The BES is, in theory, simply a re-price of the POM. Programmatic decisions should be settled in the POM, leaving the BES as a pricing and budget exhibit development exercise. Reality can be much different. As sufficient funds are rarely fully available to satisfy all requirements identified in the POM, the POM leaves the BES with a basic problem of economics: the demand for dollars exceeds the supply of dollars. Tough decisions must be made, and that decision-making process requires constant review of programs beyond the programming window. These programmatic “revisits” have also become more frequent in recent years, when fiscal guidance issued to the Defense Department has been modified mid-process. Although program *priorities* established during the POM process may stay the same, the *price* of those priorities often shifts during budget formulation and must be recalculated.

Budget Output: Budget Exhibits

Each BES package consists of several different budget “exhibits,” organized by appropriation and each identifying different detailed financial data. For example, one exhibit may focus on training costs while another exhibit addresses staffing levels. Some exhibits will reflect a single fiscal year’s worth of data, others (particularly for more complex procurement and research programs) will reflect all FYDP years. Exhibits are referred to both by formal name (i.e. “Summary of Price and Program Growth”) and number (i.e. “OP-32”) and when integrated into a single package, include several thousand pages worth of data.

Regardless of appropriation, most budget exhibits contain similar information (Note: different budget exhibits may use different titles to describe similar information:)

1. First, each budget exhibit normally contains a written general description of the programs and operations within a given appropriation. This “force structure summary” provides a summary level tutorial of the nature of funded programs.
2. Second, each budget exhibit more specifically describes what programs and operations are funded within the *current* budget request. For example, the “description of operations financed” data within the FY24 budget identifies and discusses what programs, activities, and resources are needed within fiscal year 2024.
3. Third, and most importantly, each budget exhibit must explain any changes between the previous budget request and the current budget request. This “reconciliation of increases and decreases” acknowledges the annual nature of Congressional legislation even though the Defense Department will refine each fiscal year multiple times as it moves forward in the FYDP. This means that each budget exhibit *must* begin with exactly the same monetary

request identified in the previous budget request and then display and explain the increases and decreases that result in the updated budget request.

The DoD Financial Management Regulation identifies which exhibits are required and how to prepare them, and there are often several dozen (and thousands of pages) contained in each package. Comptroller personnel within each military service and agency are responsible for reviewing and assembling approved POM decisions into these budget exhibits (note: by law, the budget request from each agency must be a Secretariat product.)

The Secretary of each military department and agency formally prepares and submits the final BES package OSD, who in turn will review these exhibits during its Program Budget Review activities in the autumn of each year. OSD-suggested modifications to military service/agency BES' are identified in "Budget Decision" documents, then incorporated into an integrated Defense Department package submitted to OMB for inclusion in the President's Budget (see chapter 10 for more information about the OSD Program Budget Review process.)

Another Budget Output: Justification Books (J-Books)

The budget exhibits prepared by DoD for OMB are compliant with the Circular A-11 guidance issued to all federal agencies. However, this means that many DoD budget exhibits reflect only the basic information requested of all federal agencies. Given the Defense Department is seven times the fiscal size of the next largest federal agency, supplemental information about DoD programs and funding is also required.

In addition to budget exhibits, the Defense Department must prepare Justification Books, or "J-Books." J-Books provide additional background information to Congress regarding DoD budgetary actions – they are the "budget exhibits we would have designed for ourselves." The J-Books are written at the appropriation level, with J-Books for Operations and Maintenance (O-1) funding, Procurement (P-1) funding, etc. Developing J-Books is a follow-on process to the BES and PB and takes considerable effort. However, the better job the Defense Department does in preparing its J-Books, the more time can be spent discussing specific program details with Congress and less time spent providing general background and educational material.

The Budget Process: Summary

As discussed throughout this chapter, the budget formulation process is very similar throughout DoD, because the requirement to prepare a budget comes from a common source: the Office of Management and Budget. All budget submissions – internal and external to the Defense Department – must follow the same guidelines, which has a very standardizing effect on formulation process. Budget exhibits prepared by one department echelon are forwarded, reviewed and discussed by a higher echelon in a similar manner each time.

Chapter 9: OSD Program Review and Budget Review Processes

For most of PPBE history, DoD Components submitted a POM and BES in separate, sequential processes and OSD Program Reviews and Budget Reviews were also separate and sequential. From calendar years 2001 to 2014, Components were directed to combine the POM and BES products and submit them to OSD simultaneously, followed by an integrated and concurrent OSD Program and Budget Review. Both the sequential and concurrent Review models have been used since 2014. For the FY24-28 Review cycle (calendar year 2022), OSD conducted a concurrent but staggered Program Review and Budget Review, with the two reviews slightly overlapping in the September and October 2022 timeframes.

The Program Review is conducted after POMs are submitted to OSD (for the FY 24-28 POM exercise, Component POMs were due to OSD on July 15 2022.) Program Decisions (PD) are issued from OSD CAPE to Components to direct any “programmatic changes.” Components (to include the USAF and USSF) programs will then be so adjusted.

While the Program Review is ongoing, all Components will proceed with their Budget Estimate Submission (BES) exercises and OUSD Comptroller then conducts the Budget Review (for the FY 24-28 exercise, the DAF BES was due to OSD on August 29 2022.) If any budgetary changes are required, those changes will also be issued via Budget Decisions (BD) and released to the Components.

Terminology Clarification:

- “Resource Management Decisions (RMDs)” were introduced into the OSD review process in 2009.
- Effective 2016 RMDs were replaced by “Program Decision Memoranda (PDMs)”, which were generated by the OSD Program Review, and “Program Budget Decisions (PBDs)”, which were generated by the OSD Budget Review.
- For the FY 22-26 and FY 23-27 Program Reviews and Budget Reviews, the OSD directive documents were called Program Decisions (PD) for program changes and Budget Decisions (BD) for budget changes. This remains true for the FY 24-28 Program Review and Budget Review.

The outcome of the OSD Program Review and Budget Review is OSD-directed changes to Component POM and BES positions. These changes can be based on several factors, from failure to follow Joint or OSD-level strategic guidance to changes in the global environment, to changes in resource strategy. While all Program Review and Budget Review decisions are ultimately made by the SECDEF or DEPSECDEF, the process is facilitated by several OSD governance bodies. The Resource Management Group (RMG) (formerly the PRMG and before that the 3-Star Programmers Group), the OSD Comptroller, and the Deputy’s Management Action Group (DMAG) support the SECDEF in the Program Review and Budget Review processes.

The DMAG, chaired by the Deputy Secretary of Defense (DEPSECDEF), assists in making major program decisions. The Deputy Service Secretaries and the Vice Chiefs/Vice CNO are members of the DMAG. The Services’ lead programming offices (USA G8, DAF A8 and S8, DON N8) are members of the RMG. The RMG, chaired by the OSD Director of Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation (CAPE) and supported by the Comptroller, is responsible for screening and developing review issues for presentation to the DMAG. In addition to the OSD governance bodies discussed above, the SECDEF’s Secretary’s Leadership Council (SLC) may get involved in adjudication of certain POM issues.

OSD Issues and Issue Papers

The focal point of the Program Review is an “issue.” Once each Component has submitted its POM to OSD and OSD has incorporated those inputs into its database, that database – which now reflects POM issues throughout the entire DoD – are released for review to the entire Department. As a result, some organizations (including OSD) may “*take issue*” with resource choices made by other organizations. For example, a Combatant Command may take issue with the POM choices made by one of the Military Departments. Similarly, any office within OSD may feel that a Military Department or Defense Agency has not sufficiently complied with guidance or policy and may take issue with that noncompliance.

Any organization that wants to identify a potential issue (from their perspective) may write a formal *issue nomination* highlighting the perceived discrepancy, problem or alternative viewpoint. Many different stakeholders can develop topics for consideration as issues, including OSD offices (CAPE, Comptroller, and others), Combatant Commanders, other Defense Agencies, and the Military Departments. The issues are based on the OSD DPG studies, USD papers, DPG compliance issues, fiscal guidance issues, and any myriad of other reviews that may be underway (such as the National Security Strategy). OSD CAPE, after reviewing the issue “nominations” outlines and coordinating with other interested parties, will select those *programmatic* topics on which issue papers will be written and will designate lead organizations – known in the past as issue teams - to prepare the papers. The number of issue nominations permitted can vary from cycle to cycle but is generally quite limited.

Updates to the FY24-28 Program Review and Budget Review Process

For the FY24-28 Program Review and Budget Review (calendar year 2022), OSD significantly modified the PBR process. OSD retained the “bottom up” issue nomination process but significantly limited a Component’s ability to submit Issue Nominations. For the FY24-28 PBR, Combatant Commands and the “fourth estate” (other elements of the OSD Staff) were limited to three (3) Issue Nominations. The Military Departments were not limited by number of Issue Nominations but were limited to Issue Nominations explaining noncompliance to Strategic Guidance only. Another difference is that Issue Nominations from the Combatant Commands and fourth estate were discussed via the Resource Management Group for review and adjudication while those Issue Nominations from the Services were reviewed and adjudicated by the Program Review Teams (formerly Issue Teams).

Correspondingly, the DAF now uses the term “Program Review Teams (PRTs)” in lieu of “Issue Teams.” The role of the DAF PRT is essentially the same as the “legacy” Issue Teams: to interface with the OSD PRTs.

Another new feature of the FY24-28 PBR is a “top-down” element in which OSD determined what issues/programs/mission areas were to be reviewed in the Program Review and Budget Review. These actions were tied to “Focus Areas” previously identified SECDEF and DEPSECDEF. Selected actions, either programmatic or budgetary, were initially reviewed by the Resource Management Group (RNMG) and if necessary, were elevated to the Deputy’s Management Action Group (DMAG.) As in previous PBRs, programmatic and budgetary changes directed by OSD were released in either Program Decisions (PD) or Budget Decisions (BD).

This “Bottom Up and Top Down” process is depicted in figure 9-1. Table 9-1 identifies FY24-28 PBR Focus Areas.

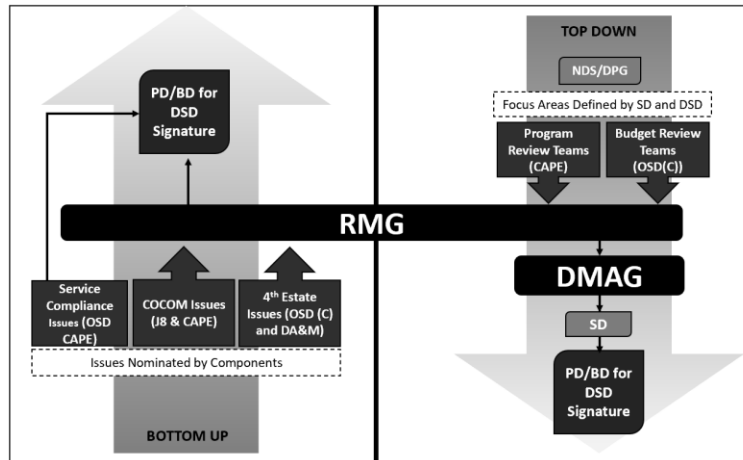


Figure 9-1: FY24-28 PBR Top Down and Bottom Up Perspectives

C2	Enduring Advantages
Budget Review	Fires
Campaigning	Homeland Defense
Climate	ISRT
Cross-Cuts	Logistics
Cybersecurity and IT	Nuclear Forces
Defense/Resiliency	Program Review
	Readiness/Training

Table 9-1: FY24-28 PBR Focus Areas

Another Issue Source: The Chairman’s Program Assessment (CPA)

Title 10 United States Code gives the CJCS a specific responsibility to advise the Secretary of Defense regarding program recommendations, and to submit alternatives. The CPA is the tool the CJCS uses to perform this duty. The CPA becomes a “report card” on the Combatant Commander’s requirements, and the Chairman’s perspective regarding program balance and adequacy. Within the CPA, risks with warfighting capability are assessed and alternatives are developed if required. The CPA is also a likely potential source for OSD PBR issues, as it is produced shortly after (and based on) Service POM submissions in the late summer timeframe.

OSD Issue Teams

Program Review Teams. Based on likely “issues” – those areas of interest and potential change to the Air or Space Force POM submission – specific OSD Offices are designated to lead the evaluation of the issues as selected by their leadership. The lead office(s) for each issue names a staff member (a GS-15 typically, in some cases an SES) to head a team that then reviews the issue and develop alternatives for decision. These Program Review Teams also draw membership from the Joint Staff and each of the Military Departments and Defense Agencies.

Issue Development. Once issues “nominations” are identified and formally approved, they are carefully vetted through the OSD-led Program Review Team. The DAF also has its own issue response process for coordinating responses and inputs to OSD issue teams, discussed later in this chapter. Frequently, Component issue teams are

formed even before their POM is submitted to OSD, based on known potential issue areas or in response to OSD identification of its planned issue teams. Component issue defense is developed by its respective Program Review Teams as the issue is being fleshed out by the OSD team. Component Program Review Teams are responsible for researching and developing both written responses and presentation materials that explain and support that organization's POM position.

Each OSD Program Review Team assesses the issues assigned to it and develops alternatives for decision. OSD Program Review Team leads work with Component Program Review Team members to formulate and present their team's position on the assigned issues and keep their senior leadership informed throughout the process. Generally, the total number of alternatives should not exceed five for any single issue. The alternatives selected should represent a balanced and affordable set of solutions; the strengths and weaknesses of each alternative should be evaluated in the Program Review Team's presentation.

Issue Briefings. Program Review Teams brief their proposed alternatives and solutions. The Resource Management Group (RMG) may ask PRTs with issues that are complex to prepare issue papers or separate briefings on discrete parts of the issue. Follow-up briefings to the RMG presents the results of the PRT's work. The RMG determines if the issue is appropriate for presentation to the DMAG for decision. Where further work is needed, the RMG will provide appropriate guidance to the issue team.

The RMG validates and resolves issues at their level when possible. Depending on the issue, the DMAG may request briefings on any issue or from any team, or may restrict briefings to only issues that remain unresolved at the RMG level. NOTE: In recent years the DMAG has been very active reviewing submitted issues.

OSD Issue Team Actions During OSD Reviews

The primary goal of each OSD PRT is to research and identify issue solution as soon as possible through coordinated input from all team members. PRTs (both OSD-led and Component-specific) will research and discuss Program Review issues informally for a short time after Military Department and Defense Agency POMs are submitted and briefed to OSD, but any issues that cannot be resolved will escalate to a higher level in the form of more formal OSD proposed changes: draft Program Decisions or draft Budget Decisions.

DAF Actions During OSD Reviews

Program Review issues are carefully vetted through throughout the DAF and issue responses are coordinated to prepare the DAF position on the major issues. DAF Program Review Teams (PRTs) may be formed even before the POM is submitted to OSD, based on known potential issue areas or in response to OSD identification of its planned issue teams. Each issue is assigned to a DAF Issue Lead, usually a colonel or civilian equivalent, who serves concurrently on the OSD issue team and the DAF Program Review Team. This issue defense is developed by the DAF team as the issue is being fleshed out by the OSD team. DAF Program Review Teams are responsible for researching and developing both written responses and presentation materials that explain and support the DAF POM position.

Program Decisions and Budget Decisions

The issuance of Program Decisions and Budget Decisions signals the final phases of programming and budgeting activities within PPBE. The number of Program Decisions (PD) and Budget Decisions (BD) can vary greatly from year to year. (For reference purposes, in past years there were typically at least two PDs issued and sometimes as

many as four, and over a dozen BDs. Program and Budget Decisions require Components to change their programs, but often do not identify sources for the resources required to do so. *That responsibility – to generate Offsets - is generally left to the impacted Component.*)

Unlike the informal issue team discussion early in the Program Review, Component response to Program Decisions and Budget Decisions is significantly more formal and allows less time for preparation. Once a draft Program Decision or Budget Decision is issued – either by OSD CAPE or OSD Comptroller, depending on the issue nature – the DAF usually has between 48 and 72 hours to provide OSD with its formal response. During this short window, the DAF must inform affected stakeholders of the draft Program Decision or Budget Decision, issue teams must develop a draft response, the AFB (or SFB, depending on the issue) must review and make a formal recommendation to SECAF, CSAF, and CSO, and a written memo must be prepared and returned to OSD. There are three possible responses to a “draft” Program Decision (PD) or Budget Decision (BD): Accept, Accept with Comment or Reclama. Success during this short timeframe depends highly on how well-prepared and postured each issue team is prior to final Program or Budget Decision issuance.

Once the DAF has responded to an OSD draft Program Decision (PD) or Budget Decision (BD), DEPSECDEF recommends and SECDEF approves a final course of action. SECDEF actions are provided to impacted Service(s) and agencies via a signed Program Decision or Budget Decision. Signed Program Decisions or Budget Decisions are digested by DAF Program Review Teams, AF/A5/8, SF/S8N and SAF/FM, briefed to the DAF Council, and entered into the DAF database (PBES), to affect the actual decision.

Figure 9-2 represents the entire flow of the OSD Program Review and Budget Review processes.

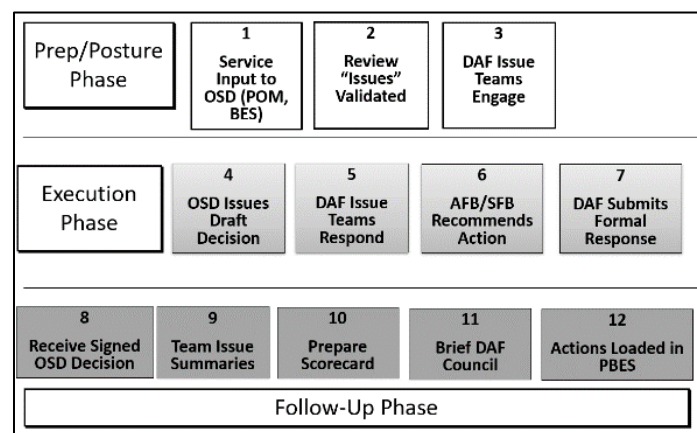


Figure 9-2. DAF Process for OSD Program and Budget Reviews

The President's Budget (PB)

After the OSD Review processes are complete, it is time to assemble the PB. The Justification Books (J-Books) now become top priority. As with DAF J-Books, OSD J-Books are written at the appropriation level (e.g., O&M, Procurement, RDT&E). Our audience is no longer OSD/OMB, but Congress. All program growth must be fully justified, and accuracy is paramount.

Once the J-Books finish a Security Review, the budget is ready for presentation to Congress the first Monday of February. This is done through Press Conferences and “Staffer Days”, when DAF leaders, subject matter experts,

and legislative support personnel visit the members of the key committees in the House and Senate for briefings and discussions on the PB.

Chapter 10: Building the Budget (Legislative Branch)

Introduction

Congress “controls the purse strings” and thus plays an important role in the success or failure of any defense program. Knowledge of Congress and Congressional policies is essential to running a successful program and building an effective budget request.

The Defense Budget Process

Congress is responsible for raising and supporting the armed forces of the United States. The main way it exercises this responsibility is by reviewing and acting on the annual defense budget. The overall U.S. resource allocation process has three principal segments: the defense budget request by the Executive branch, the Congressional defense budget process, and budget execution. The Defense Department has the greatest amount of involvement with Congress during the second segment of the process, the Congressional defense budget process.

Leading Committees in the Congressional Defense Budget Process

Congress is run by committee. The congressional defense budget process is dependent on the following key committees for the bulk of each year’s efforts as shown in Table 10-1 below.

Key Senate Committees and Products
Budget Committee — Budget Resolution
Armed Services Committee — Authorization
Appropriations Committee — Appropriations
Key House of Representatives Committees and Products
Budget Committee — Budget Resolution
Armed Services Committee — Authorization
Appropriations Committee — Appropriations

Table 10-1. Key Congressional Committees in PPBE

The Congressional Defense Budget Process

Congressional action on the Defense budget is a three-step process following a timetable established by the Congressional Budget Act of 1974, as amended by the Balanced Budget Act. The congressional defense budget process has three distinct elements: the Concurrent Budget Resolution, the Authorization process, and the Appropriations Process. Refer to Figure 10-1 for a full-page chart detailing the flow of the congressional defense budget process.

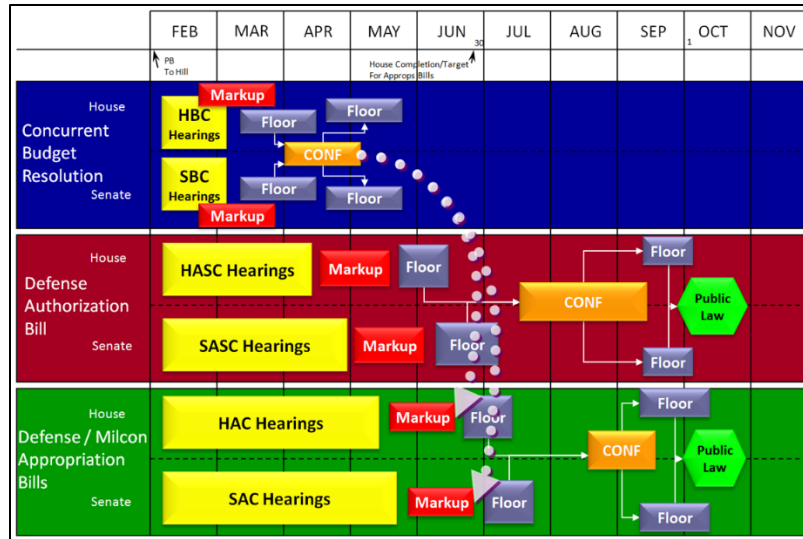


Figure 10-1. Congressional Defense Budget Process

Concurrent Budget Resolution (CBR)

The first formal action taken by Congress is establishing a ceiling on funding for national defense programs in the Concurrent Budget Resolution (CBR.) The CBR establishes revenue targets and sets ceilings on budget authority and outlays for the entire Federal budget. As a result of the CBR, spending allocations are made to the appropriations committees (and to the subcommittees.) The CBR is to be completed no later than April 15 of each year. No final decisions on spending priorities are made at this time.

Authorization Process

In formal terms, authorization acts provide the legislative authority to establish or maintain a government program or agency and to eventually appropriate funds. Authorization bills prescribe policy issues and changes to existing laws. Authorization acts define the scope of programs and authorize funding levels for programs either in terms of specific amounts or for “such funds as may be necessary” to implement the program. Authorization does not create budget authority (does not specify total funding levels.) Steps in the process include:

- Hearings
- Mark Up
- Floor Action
- Conference Committee
- Final Floor Vote
- Presidential Action

Appropriations Process

The appropriations process provides the necessary budget authority (funding) to fund defense programs. The bulk of defense funding is provided via three regular appropriations acts:

- DoD appropriation
- Military construction appropriation
- Energy and water appropriation

In each Congressional chamber, the relevant appropriations subcommittees hold hearings to review the President's defense budget request, and to mark up the defense appropriations legislation before passing it to the full appropriations committee for markup. The process then follows the same steps as the authorization process: hearings, floor action, conference committee, floor vote, presidential action. (For annual appropriations, Congress must pass new appropriations acts every year. Permanent appropriations, in contrast, are made in substantive legislation, and make funds available each year without new action by Congress.)

Types of Appropriations Acts:

There are three significant types of Appropriations acts:

Regular Appropriations Acts.

Three regular appropriations acts provide the majority of defense funding (see above).

Continuing Appropriations Resolution. If Congress fails to pass all of the regular appropriations acts by the beginning of the fiscal year (1 October), the DoD (and other affected agencies) can be left without funds to continue operations. To avoid the disruptive effects of these occurrences, Congress passes continuing appropriations legislation to provide “stop-gap” budget authority. Stop-gap authority provides funding for a specified amount of time at levels be equal to (1) the prior fiscal year, (2) the President's requested level for the coming fiscal year, or (3) the level approved by the House or Senate. This funding is restricted, notably by the fact it cannot be used to start new programs. In some years, continuing appropriations resolutions are used to provide funding for the full-year, taking the place of a regular appropriations act.

Supplemental Appropriations Act. Used by Congress to appropriate funds to cover unanticipated expenditures during the current fiscal year in response to a request by the Executive branch.

The Role of Congressional Language

Three primary types of language impact Resource Managers and their programs. “**Public Law Language**” is found within the text of a law—it is the law of the land, though it is often indefinite and lacking in detail. “**Report Language**” is contained within congressional reports describing committee intent, direction, and recommendations. “**Bill Language**” is any language found in a bill, from its inception through mark ups and amendments to conference and final votes. Of the three, Report Language is the most relevant.

Report Language often provides the details to a piece of legislation, signaling the intent of Congress. Report Language is derived from reports issued in the wake of legislative or oversight hearings and is an explanation of committee markup action. These reports often contain suggestions and recommendations on the implementation of Public Law Language. The language within records why the legislation was passed. It also illuminates committee

sensitivities, intent, and rationale. Technically, Report Language is not law but it is generally accepted as binding on the DoD.

Program stakeholders must be aware of Report Language that mention program(s) directly or indirectly. Report Language can dictate the following:

- Whether programs have changed
- How changed programs are expected to proceed
- Studies or analyses needing to be performed (and reported back to the committee).
- Whether the release of funds is contingent on the DoD completing some designated action
- Whether a program is designated as a **Congressional Interest Program (CIP)**

A Congressional Interest Program means the program has received special attention from one or more Congressional committees, a status precluding the DoD from reprogramming funds into or out of the program without prior Congressional notification and approval.

Congressional Hearing and Testimony

A hearing is a formal committee meeting scheduled and convened by the committee chair to receive testimony from government and non-government witnesses. Witnesses from the private or public sectors appear before the committee to testify. Hearings can be open or closed and can occur anywhere, though nearly all occur on Capitol Hill. Hearings are used to support the drafting of legislation, develop background or reference material, and provide direction and guidance to federal agencies.

The Defense Department typically begins interaction with the congressional hearing system during the Defense Budget process when it presents the Defense Department's **Annual Posture Statement**. Defense Department and other DoD programs are justified during authorization hearings, and the budget authority to support these programs is justified during appropriations hearings. The Defense Department Posture Statement is produced annually and serves two primary purposes:

- The development, coordination, and articulation of the Defense Department's position on current issues and key programs, and
- The management of the preparation and support of the annual congressional testimony provided by DoD senior leaders.

SECDEF and JCS present the OSD Posture Statement in testimony before the Authorization Committees (HASC and SASC) and the Defense Appropriations Subcommittees (HAC and SAC). Other key DoD officials will follow with their own testimony before subcommittees to amplify the overall OSD Posture Statement. The hearings generally follow a similar course:

- DoD Senior Leadership testifies and is questioned by the committee.
- Approximately one week after the hearing, the committee releases a draft transcript and additional questions for the record.
- A committee report on the hearing is published.

Prior to hearings, potential issues and likely congressional positions will be identified and evaluated to determine the context and tenor of upcoming hearings. Preparatory materials will be generated based on these evaluations. Resource Managers – Action Officers, Program Managers and others - will be required to assist in the preparation of these materials, which commonly include **PHIPs** and pre-hearing review sessions, sometimes known as **Skull Sessions**.

Posture Hearing Issue Papers (“One Pagers” or PHIPs)

PHIPs form the foundation of posture hearing preparation, and cover the main points of a budget issue, as well as anticipated congressional issues. Backup data is commonly provided on funding, program performance, procurement, and a bottom-line Defense Department position. Resource Managers must ensure each PHIP represents the current, coordinated Defense Department position.

Skull Sessions

Skull sessions bring together the key general officers and/or Secretariat personnel to address subjects of congressional interest. They are organized by distinct capabilities and are intended to generate discussion on important Defense Department issues dealt with before Congress. There are three types of skull sessions:

- Pre-hearing skull sessions begin in January, and address broad areas for general preparation.
- Specific hearing skull sessions occur two or three days before a hearing, and address issues pertinent to a specific committee holding the hearing.
- “Mini-skulls” or murder boards are held the morning of the hearing and cover late-breaking issues.

Resource Managers (usually Defense Department subject matter experts for the program or topic in question) will be asked to provide skull session background material in the form of questions and answers in PowerPoint format. When developing this material, Resource Managers need to be sure to:

- Place themselves in the position of the witness
- Answer questions directly (first bullet)
- Use specific examples to illustrate points
- Synchronize Skulls with PHIPs

Following each hearing, support for senior leadership requires transcript review and preparation of inserts/questions for the record. Additionally, after committee mark-ups are complete, it may be necessary to generate budget/program fact papers to counter committee action contrary to the Defense Department position. The committee will provide witnesses with a transcript of hearing testimony to make necessary editorial and factual corrections, provide additional information, and identify classified information.

Transcript Review

The committees extend this privilege as a courtesy—therefore, all deadlines for return of the corrected transcript **must** be met.

PPBE stakeholders must read the instructions (contained on the tasker cover page) carefully and follow them exactly. Be aware each committee has its own requirements. Extensive, substantive revisions or addition of new information is not permitted unless expressly authorized by the committee.

Classified information should be handled in accordance with tasker instructions. Be aware there is a congressional sensitivity to the over-classification of information. Recommendations for deleting classified information from transcripts must reflect a valid security position.

Inserts/Questions for the Record (IFRs/QFRs)

During a hearing, committee members often ask for information too detailed for immediate response. These questions are referred to as Inserts for the Record, with responses inserted at a later time into the text transcript. Questions not asked during the hearing are submitted at this time as Questions for the Record. Responses will be appended to the hearing transcript as well.

An Office of Primary Responsibility (OPRs) is tasked to respond to each IFR/QFR. A tasker with a detailed instructions and a sample response will accompany each question. Be aware the format described in the tasker must be followed exactly—each committee has its own requirements. Avoid incomplete coordination, confusing jargon or acronyms, and improper responses (too much, too little or too emotional.)

Congressional Appeals

As Congress completes its hearing and mark-up work, the Executive Branch has several venues available to request changes to draft legislative language (appeals.) There are three primary tools used to submit appeals:

1. A Statement of Administrative Policy (SAP), issued by the President
2. A “Heartburn Appeal”, issued by SECDEF on behalf of the Defense Department
3. Individual appeals from the military services and/or defense agencies, sometimes known as Budget/Program Fact Papers

Congressional Appeals: Statements of Administrative Policy

A Statement of Administrative Policy is a White House/Office of Management and Budget initiative that follows legislative markup completed by the Defense authorization and appropriation committees. SAPs identify congressional funding levels and/or legislative language that is of particular concern to the President, including Presidential veto threats. While SAPs are issued by the White House, they are developed and coordinated through relevant offices within the Defense Department (OSD and/or specific defense agencies or the military services), depending on the issue.

Congressional Appeals: OSD Heartburn Appeals

In addition to the President’s SAPs, the Defense Department has the opportunity to present to Congress its “top 10” concerns regarding draft legislative language. These “heartburn appeals” (there may also be more than 10) are developed by each military service and defense agency, then narrowed to a single Defense Department list by the OSD Office of Legislative Council (OLC.) Heartburn appeals are short and issue-oriented, and restate the preferred DoD program requirement and a rebuttal of the legislative rationale used to change a program.

Congressional Appeals: Budget/Program Fact Papers (BFPs)

BFPs are developed by individual Components within the Defense Department as a result of marks to the President’s Budget Request. They are aimed at educating the committees regarding the impact of their action prior

to the committee conference. Like Heartburn Appeals, BFPs are short, issue-oriented papers containing a concise restatement of the program requirement and a rebuttal of the rationale used to reduce or terminate a program.

The Unfunded Priority List (UPL)

The UPL is a corporately approved list of un-funded programs within a focus area chosen annually by each Component of the DoD (for example, each military service develops its own UPL.) These programs are designated to receive funding should additional money become available. Prior areas of focus have included modernization, readiness, people, and quality of life. Programs included on the list are those that are completely un-funded. Programs under-funded or otherwise impaired are not candidates for the UPL.

Summary

Defense Department involvement with Congress is more bi-lateral than most imagine. Although the President's Budget is presented to Congress in early February, the majority of the legislative budget season involves providing additional programmatic information via posture statements, hearings, program briefs, appeals, and responding to any other congressional requests for information as required. Legislative language, in both authorization and appropriation forms, will legally direct DoD program behavior, so it is critical PPBE stakeholders not only follow congressional processes closely in order to anticipate congressional requirements but also provide accurate, timely and coordinated information that supports the official DoD position whenever requested.

Chapter 11: Executing the Air Force Budget

Introduction

After the congressional authorization and appropriation bills are signed by the President and the funds are released to the Defense Department, the job of actually using appropriated funds, as authorized, begins. This chapter discusses the procedures used to spend appropriated funds from the beginning of a fiscal year through fiscal year closeout.

PPBE practitioners can learn useful information from budget execution data. For example, programs not fully executed during the year are good sources for possible bill-paying exercises during future budget cycles. Also, programs historically having difficulty during execution due to lack of funding are excellent candidates to repair during the programming cycles. Let's begin looking more closely at the Budget Execution process by defining a few terms.

Budget Authority

Budget legislation demands programs stay within their fiscal boundaries. Congress appropriates funds to OSD, who, in turn, allocates to the military services and defense agencies their shares of the appropriations, providing **Budget Authority (BA)** for each DoD Component. The sum of the resources allocated to each Component is often described as Total Obligational Authority (TOA). Note: the difference between Budget Authority and TOA is *Budget Authority* is the "new" amount of money available to spend each fiscal year. *TOA* is the combined totals of all funds available to be spent. The two totals vary because some appropriations last for more than one fiscal year.

Obligating Funds

In order to spend appropriated funds, the funds must formally be allocated to a specific requirement or task via a legally-binding document, such as a contract, task order, or travel order. This legal agreement literally obligates the Defense Department to pay for the goods or services requested by the agreement, so long as the terms of the request are also met. A program's "obligations" (also sometimes referred to as its "spend rate" or "burn rate") are expressed as the cumulative total of all obligating documents.

Expending Funds

Although a program's obligation levels are the most commonly-used metric for both planning and measuring program performance, another metric is also tracked and used to gauge program activity. Once the goods or services requested by an obligating document have been received, the formal acknowledgement of receipt to allow payment of funds is known as an expenditure. Expenditures then presented for payment by DoD to the Treasury are called outlays. At the end of the budget year, the goal is for outlays to equal the obligation authority.

Time Limits for Obligations

Each appropriation has certain time limits during which obligations, expenditures and outlays can be made. Table 11-1 explains appropriation lifespan by major functional titles as submitted to OSD. When the Defense Department receives an appropriation from Congress, the appropriation language includes the appropriation lifespan. Each appropriation has certain time limits for obligations. During the execution year(s), the goal is to be 100% obligated when the appropriation lifespan ends, and this lifespan time period varies by appropriation. For example, Operations and Maintenance appropriations are said to be "current" (available for obligation) for one fiscal year. For Procurement appropriations, there are generally three current fiscal years.

When the legislative time period for creating new obligations has passed, appropriations are said to be “expired.” During this “expired” time period, programs may continue to expend and outlay already-obligated funds but may not create any new obligations. The expiration time period for all appropriations is five years.

After this expired time period ends, the money can no longer be obligated expended, or outlaid for any reason, and the appropriations are considered “cancelled.” If a legitimate obligation is presented for payment a cancelled appropriation, it must be paid out of current year funds if the “bona fide need” cannot be established for other unexpired or expired appropriations.

One Year Appropriations
Operations and Maintenance
Military Personnel
Military Family Housing
Two Year Appropriations
Research and Development
Three Year Appropriations
Aircraft Procurement
Procurement of Ammunition
Missile Procurement
Space Procurement
Other Procurement
Five Year Appropriations
Military Construction
Military Family Housing Construction

Table 11-1. Appropriation “Life Spans” for Creating New Obligations

Funding Limitations

Each fiscal year has certain constraints on the execution of the budget. An “A” limitation has a legal basis and is usually included in an Appropriation or Authorization Act. A “B” limitation has no legal basis but is an OSD or military service policy regarding certain spending. Another kind of limitation is an “earmark” in the appropriation or authorization language from Congress. It can be specific — appropriated for the purpose of or the intent of Congress. In all cases, a spending limitation is a restriction on funds during execution. This lack of flexibility makes budgeting correctly the first time very important.

Notice in Figure 11-1 appropriations can be summarized by grouping them into major categories. For example, investment accounts include Procurement, RDT&E and MILCON. There are times when four categories are used: People (e.g., quality of life), Readiness (e.g. O&M to include flying hours), Investment, & Modernization.

Planning for Funds Execution

Because of the enduring nature of many Defense Department missions, many programs do not experience significant changes in obligation and expenditure rates from year to year beyond inflationary activity. A program’s ability to obligate and expend funds in prior years is often a valid indicator of that program’s ability to execute current year funds. However, program history may not adequately capture any changes in program requirements or program

management, so many Defense Department Components (and sub-Components) also develop month-by-month plans for funds execution, prior to the beginning of each fiscal year. These month-by-month projections of program obligation and expenditure rates are called many different names, such as Execution Plans, Spend (or Spending) Plans, Operating Budget Plans, and Financial Plans (Fin Plans), for example.

While Execution Plans (the most common term currently in use within the DAF) provide important information to headquarters-level activities, they are not developed at the headquarters level. Instead, Execution Plans are requested of field-level activities (below the military service or agency level) via a formal data call shortly after the President's Budget is submitted to Congress each February, for the coming fiscal year. (For example, an FY20-focused Execution Plan would begin its development in spring 2019.) Execution Plan inputs are then consolidated at the military service and agency level to reflect forecasted obligation and expenditure rates on a month-by-month basis for each appropriation category (Operations and Maintenance, Investments, and Research and Development.) Execution Plans also often identify known un-funded requirements for the coming fiscal year.

Combined with appropriation execution history, Execution Plans set a performance benchmark against which each appropriation can be measured once the fiscal year begins via Execution Reviews and Midyear Review.

Funds Release

The ability for OSD to release funds depends on three steps after the Appropriation becomes law. These involve *Apportionment* (Step 1) from the Office of Management and Budget. A *Warrant* (Step 2) issued by the U.S. Treasury showing the amount of cash on the account/appropriation. The issuance by OSD of a *Release Letter* (Step 3) meaning the Defense Department now has the money. The key point here is this all takes time and involves some paperwork.

New Starts and Bona Fide Need Rule

A "New Start" is any Defense Department effort not justified in the President's Budget and approved by the Congress. Congress must be kept informed, in writing, of any New Start. Conversations with congressional staff members do not constitute proper New Start notification.

The Bona Fide Need Rule applies to any appropriation. There are three things to consider in bona fide need:

1. The expense must be authorized, or "necessary and incident" to proper execution of the general purpose of the appropriation.
2. The expenditure must not be prohibited by law.
3. It must not be otherwise provided for in another appropriation.

Example: You can't buy copier paper on 30 September for the entire upcoming fiscal year. Certain purchases are allowed to maintain operations between fiscal years but in short, don't "stockpile" items for future years using obligation authority (TOA) from a prior year.

Program Execution and Execution Reviews

There are three key areas Resource Managers need to focus on during program execution. **Underexecuted** programs are programs not spending funds as quickly as they should, which then encourages these funds to migrate to other programs requiring money. **Underfunded programs** are programs spending more than was originally

estimated, and are usually the programs where funds might migrate to. Chronic, recurring funding problems are caused, for example, by contract inflation, procurement delays, or underpriced manpower. **Funding issues** are identified when programs may not have enough funding to complete the fiscal year. In other words, the consumption rate will exceed the obligation authority.

Underexecution, underfunding, and known funding issues are formally reviewed multiple times during the fiscal year. By law, the general “status of funds” (obligation and expenditure levels) must be reported each fiscal month. More substantial Execution Reviews, however, are conducted on a quarterly basis, with “investment accounts” (procurement and research and development appropriations) and “operating accounts” (operations and maintenance) often treated separately, due to the distinct nature of each account.

Investment Budget Reviews – the “Fall” and “Spring” Reviews

There are two reviews of investment appropriations – procurement and research and development – each year. These reviews often involve visiting a specific production or research site, to formally view production or testing as well as speak directly with program management personnel. Because of the large dollar values associated with major investment programs, these biannual reviews are more involved and detail oriented, in order to both anticipate any known performance issues and gather data to be able to provide ongoing program status to higher levels as required. Not all investment programs undergo a review every year. Programs known to have performance problems, large deviations from planned obligation and expenditure levels; Congressional interest; or extremely large program budgets are likely candidates for review.

The Operating Budget Review

In contrast, an Operating Review (or Operating Budget Review) is typically conducted at headquarters levels, without specific site visits. Because the Operation and Maintenance appropriation pays for readiness, operating tempo (particularly fuel usage), and civilian personnel payroll requirements, the Operating Budget Review focuses on projecting and ensuring sufficient funds will be available to fund requirements to the end of the fiscal year, without also leaving funds unused. Operating accounts are particularly vulnerable to changes in fuel costs, civilian hiring activity, and unforeseen mission requirements, so adjustments to satisfy full fiscal year requirements are often required.

Midyear Review

In addition to general quarterly execution reviews, OSD also formally reviews the status of each appropriation midway through the fiscal year, in the April and May timeframe. This Midyear Review is conducted by OSD Comptroller personnel, although because of likely programmatic impact Resource Managers can also expect to become involved. As with all execution reviews, Midyear Review compares planned obligation and expenditure rates (provided by each DoD Component via Spending Plans) with actual program performance (as recorded in DoD’s official accounting systems, reporting by the Defense Finance and Accounting Service – DFAS.) Midyear Review affords OSD the flexibility to make adjustments to program funding levels, either to increase funding to overexecuting programs if warranted or to decrease funding of underexecuting programs. Midyear Review often marks the beginning of major reprogramming activity within the Defense Department, to ensure all appropriated funds are used.

Contingency Operations & Emergency and Special Project (ESP) Codes

The Defense Department continues to be tasked around the world in support of our National Security Policies. When this occurs, costs are incurred and they need to be tracked. This tracking is often accomplished by using alpha-numeric Emergency and Special Project Codes (ESP Codes) to capture these costs.

Note that ESP Codes are used if the contingency is not already budgeted. Known contingencies are budgeted for during the normal budget process. Contingency operations by definition are not normally budgeted for, so they often drive a requirement for reprogramming activity or supplemental appropriation requests.

Reprogramming

No budget goes as planned when the fiscal year begins. Thus, during the year of execution, reprogramming actions are inevitable. Reprogramming does not create new TOA; it simply moves TOA from where it is not needed to where it is needed. There are two types of reprogramming actions: reprogramming action which requires prior written Congressional approval (“above threshold reprogramming”) and those actions which do not require congressional approval (“below threshold reprogramming”).

Reprogramming actions requiring prior approval by Congress are sent to the four congressional committees in the House and Senate who approve the budget. These are the Authorization and Appropriations Committees in the House and Senate. For reprogramming requests, there is no floor action by the Congress. Any one of these committees can influence the outcome. If we request a \$50 million reprogramming action from RDT&E (Source) to O&M (Use) and one of the committees approves \$35 million, then \$35 million is the approved action. In short, the “lowest number wins.”

Congress issues reprogramming guidelines as part of ancillary tables that accompany the Defense appropriation each year; these can vary depending on Congressional interest or desired oversight. As an example, in order to request congressional reprogramming action, a form DD1414 (Base for Reprogramming Actions) must be completed whenever the following reprogramming action is desired:

- Movement of funds between any appropriations
- Move funds between any appropriations – “crossing the streams”
- Move funds that affect a Congressional Interest Program (CIP)
- Move +/- \$20M or 20% of the appropriated Procurement or R&D line item, whichever is less (at the line item level)
- Notify of moves within O&M, MilPers, RDT&E, and Procurement: +/- \$10M

Note Congress does not need to formally approve a reprogramming request in order for the Defense Department to receive reprogramming authority; if no congressional subcommittee acts upon a reprogramming request within 30 days, the request is considered by “pocket approval” to have been approved. Completing and submitting the DD1416 simply provides Congress to opportunity to exercise reprogramming oversight if desired.

Reprogramming actions that do not require prior Congressional notification or approval (“below threshold reprogramming”, or “internal reprogramming”) vary widely, because any DoD Component that maintains fiduciary responsibility – the legal authority to manage its funds – may set its own internal reprogramming guidelines. Since reprogramming guidelines are designed to direct and control program activities, each DoD Component may determine

that different programs, commands, agencies, or tasks require different reprogramming guidelines. For example, internal reprogramming may be restricted by:

- Program, or program element
- Appropriation, beyond existing Congressional guidelines
- Command or Agency priority or policy
- Fiscal quarter or general timeframe within the fiscal year

PPBE practitioners must be aware of reprogramming restrictions and guidelines that may have been imposed at different command or agency levels that may direct specific program behavior. These reprogramming guidelines are formally provided, in writing, by one command/agency to another when appropriated funds are allocated. The allocation documents are prepared and managed by the Comptroller organization within each command or agency.

Supplemental Funding

A Supplemental Appropriation adds to TOA, which makes the process different from reprogramming. A supplemental is another appropriations act requiring full Floor Action in the Congress and is signed into law. The Budget Enforcement Act, which was designed to reduce deficit spending, exempts emergency supplemental appropriations from being “scored” as part of the normal budget processes considering receipts and expenditures in establishing the amount of funds available for the budget.

Fiscal Year Closeout

The end of any fiscal year involves substantial funds monitoring, reprogramming, and procurement activity at all levels within the Defense Department. The goal of every “successful” fiscal year is to obligate 100% of appropriated funds toward strategically supportive activities. Although each fiscal year ends September 30th, fiscal year closeout activities begin well before this date, usually throughout most of the 4th fiscal quarter (July through September) to allow sufficient time to assess program performance and make obligation adjustments as necessary.

All PPBE practitioners must work closely with both Comptroller and contract personnel to maintain close oversight of current obligation levels, potential unused funds, and any un-funded requirements that could benefit from funding that becomes unexpectedly available as a result. Because most program obligations are created well below the Defense Department headquarters level, it is also critical any manager working within OSD maintain an active and well-informed network throughout the fiscal year.

Summary

Executing legislated funds represents the end of the PPBE process. When executing funds, the overarching question must always be “does this funds execution activity support the Defense strategy as originally designed during the PPBE planning phase?” To answer this question, the Funds Execution process will require creating a plan for using funds well before a fiscal year begins; close monitoring of actual program performance via Execution Reviews; and logical and timely reprogramming of funds if and when required.

Appendix A: Acronym Index

ABIDES	Automated Budget Interactive Data Environment System
ACAT	Acquisition Category
ACTD	Advanced Concept Technology Demonstration
ADR	Annual Defense Review
AF/A8	Deputy Chief of Staff for Plans and Programs
AF/CV	Air Force Vice Chief of Staff
AFB	Air Force Board
AFC	Air Force Council
AFCAIG	Air Force Cost Analysis Improvement Group
AFCIS	Air Force Capabilities Investment Strategy
AFCS	Air Force Corporate Structure
AFEE	Air Force Element of Expense
AFEEIC	Air Force Element of Expense/Investment Code
AFF	Air Force Futures (formerly AFWIC)
AFG	Air Force Group
AFGM	Air Force Guidance Memorandum
AFI	Air Force Instruction
AFMC	Air Force Material Command
AFMSS	Air Force Mission Support System
AFPD	Air Force Policy Directive
AFPP	Air Force Program Projections
AFRAP	Air Force Resource Allocation Process
AFRC	Air Force Reserve Command
AFRES	Air Force Reserve
AFROCC	AF Requirements Operational Capabilities Council
AFSP	Air Force Strategic Plan
AFSPD	Air Force Strategic Planning Directive
AFTFP	Air Force Transformation Flight Plan
AFWCF	AF Working Capital Fund
AFWIC	Air Force Warfighting Integration Capability (legacy term)
AMC	Air Mobility Command
AMS	Acquisition Management System
ANG	Air National Guard
AO	Action Officer
AoA	Analysis of Alternatives
AP	Approved Program
APB	Amended President's Budget
APB	Acquisition Program Baseline
APOM	Amended Program Objective Memorandum
APPG	Annual Planning and Programming Guidance (legacy document)

APPN	Appropriation Codes
ASD/NII	Assistant Secretary of Defense for Networks and Information Integration
ASOC	Air Support Operations Center
AT&L	Acquisition, Technology & Logistics
ATD	Advanced Technology Demonstration
AV	ABIDES Viewer
BA	Budget Authority/Activity
BAC	Budget Activity Code
BAI	Backup Aircraft Inventory
BCP	Budget Change Proposal
BD	Budget Decision
BES	Budget Estimate Submission
BER	Budget Estimate Review
BoD	Board of Directors
BOS	Base Operating Support
BP	Budget Program
BPAC	Budget Project Activity Cod
BPFP	Budget/Program Fact Papers
BR	Budget Review
BRAC	Base Realignment and Closure
BUR	Bottom-Up Review
BY(s)	Budget Year(s)
C4ISR	Command, Control, Communication, Computers, Intelligence, Surveillance & Reconnaissance
CAF	Combat Air Force
CAPE	(OSD Director of) Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation
CBR	Concurrent Budget Resolution
CCD	Combat Capability Document
CCN	Change Control Number
CDD	Capability Development Document
CE	Cost Element
CFC	Critical Future Capability
CFL	Core Function Lead
CFSP	Core Function Support Plan
CG	Chairman's Guidance
CHAMPUS	Civilian Health and Medical Program of the Uniformed Services
CIO	Chief Information Officer
CIP	Congressional Interest Program
CJCS	Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff
CJCSM	Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Manual
CLS	Contract Logistic Support
COCOM	Combatant Commander

CONOPS	Concept of Operations
COST-CAT	Cost Category
CP	Change Proposal
CPA	Chairman's Program Assessment
CPD	Capabilities Production Document
CPF	Common Planning Framework
CPG	Contingency Planning Guidance
CPR	Chairman's Program Recommendations
CR	Continuing Resolution
CRD	Capstone Requirements Document
CRRA	Capabilities Review and Risk Assessment
CSAF	Chief of Staff of the Air Force
CY	Current Year, Calendar Year
CYD	Constant Year Dollars
DAB	Defense Acquisition Board
DAWG	Defense Advisory Working Group
DBOF	Defense Business Operation Fund
DCI	Director of Central Intelligence
DCS	Deputy Chief of Staff
DEPSECDEF	Deputy Secretary of Defense
DG	Defense Guidance
DHP	Defense Health Program
DIO	Development, Investment and Operations
DLR	Depot Level Repairable
DMAG	Deputy's Management Action Group
DMR	Defense Management Review
DMRD	Defense Management Review Decision
DoD	Department of Defense
DOTMLPF	Doctrine, Organization, Training, Materiel, Leadership & Education, Personnel, and Facilities
DP	Development Plans
DPA&E	Director for Program Analysis & Evaluation
DPAG	Defense Planning Advisory Group
DPG	Defense Planning Guidance
DPP	Defense Planning Projection
DPG	Defense Planning Guidance
DRI	Defense Reform Initiative
DRR	Design Readiness Review
DRU	Direct Reporting Unit
DSG	Defense Strategic Guidance
DT	Decision Tracker
DWCF	Defense Working Capital Fund

EBO	Effects-Based Operations
EEIC	Elements of Expense & Investment Code
EPP	Enhanced Planning Process
ERA	Executive Review Account
ESP	Emergency and Special Project
EY	Execution Year
F&FP	Force & Financial Plan
FAA	Functional Area Analysis
FAR	Federal Acquisition Regulation
FCB	Functional Capabilities Board
FERS	Federal Employee Retirement System
FFG	Fiscal Forecasts and Guidance
FG	Fiscal Guidance
FIELDCOM	Field Command (Space Force Input Source)
FIN PLAN	Financial Plan
FNA	Functional Needs Analysis
FOA	Field Operating Agency
FoS	Family of Systems
FSA	Functional Solution Analysis
FSDM	Force Structure Data Management
FW	Fighter Wing
FY	Fiscal Year
FYDP	Future Years Defense Program
GDF	Guidance for the Development of the Force
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GEF	Guidance for the Employment of the Force
GTBL	Get to the Bottom Line
GPA	Guide to Program Analysis
HAC	House (of Representatives) Appropriations Committee
HAF	Headquarters Air Force
HASC	House (of Representatives) Armed Service Committee
HBC	House (of Representatives) Budget Committee
HNSC	House (of Representatives) National Security Committee
IAW	In accordance with
IB	Issue Book
IBR	Investment Budget Review
IBRC	Investment Budget Review Committee
IBRP	Investment Budget Review Process
ICD	Initial Capabilities Document
ILR	Intermediate Level Review (preceded the Air Force Group)
IOC	Initial Operational Capability
IOT&E	Initial Operational Test & Evaluation

IPL	Integrated Priority List
IPT	Integrated Process Team
IRSS	Information & Resource Support System
JADC2	Joint All-Domain Command and Control
JCB	Joint Capabilities Board
JCIDS	Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System
JCS	Joint Chiefs of Staff
JFC	Joint Functional Concept
JLRSA	Joint Long Range Strategic Appraisal
JMA/SA	Joint Mission Assessment/Support Assessment
JMNA	Joint Military Net Assessment
JMRR	Joint Monthly Readiness Review
JNA	Joint Net Assessment
JOC	Joint Operating Concept
JOpsC	Joint Operations Concept
JOPEs	Joint Operational Planning and Execution System
JPD	Joint Planning Document
JPD	Joint Potential Designator
JPG	Joint Programming Guidance
JRO	Joint Requirements Office
JROC	Joint Requirements Oversight Council
JSCP	Joint Strategic Capabilities Plan
JSPS	Joint Strategic Planning System
JSR	Joint Strategic Review
JV20XX	Joint Vision 2020 (or subsequent updates)
JWCA	Joint Warfighting Capabilities Assessment
KPP	Key Performance Parameter
LCC	Life Costing Cycle
LRIP	Low-Rate Initial Production
LRP	The Air Force Long Range Plan
M&S	Modeling and Simulation
MAIS	Major Automated Information System
MAISRC	Major Automated Information System Review Council
MAJCOM	Major Command (Air Force Input Source entity)
MBI	Major Budget Issue
MCP	Major Change Proposal
MDA	Milestone Decision Authority
MDAP	Major Defense Acquisition Program
MEIS	Mission Essential Information System
MFP	Major Force Programs
MID 913	Management Initiative Decision 913
MILCON	Military Construction

MILPERS	Military Personnel
MLA	Military Legislative Assistant
MP	Major Program
MPES	Manpower Programming and Execution System
MRC	Major Regional Conflict
MS&A	Modeling, Simulation & Analysis
MS	Milestone
MSP	Mission Support Plan
MTW	Major Theater War
NCA	National Command Authority
NDI	Non-Developmental Items
NDP	National Defense Panel
NDS	National Defense Strategy
NFIP	National Foreign Intelligence Program
NGB	National Guard Bureau
NMS	National Military Strategy
NSA	National Security Agency
NSC	National Security Council
NSDD	National Security Decision Directives
NSS	National Security Strategy
O&M	Operations & Maintenance
O&S	Operations & Support
OA	Obligating Authority
OAC	Operating Agency Code
OBRC	Operation Budget Review Committee
OBRG	Operation Budget Review Group
OBRP	Operation Budget Review Process
OCO	Overseas Contingency Operations
OCR	Office of Corollary Responsibility
OIPT	Overarching Integrated Product Team
OJCS	Office of the Joint Chiefs of Staff
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
OPLAN	Operations Plan (in complete format)
OPR	Office of Primary Responsibility
OPTEMPO	Operations Tempo
ORD	Operational Requirements Document
OSC	Operating Agency Code
OSD	Office of the Secretary of Defense
OY	Out Year
PA&E	Program Analysis and Evaluation
PAA	Primary Aircraft Authorized
PB	President's Budget

PBD	Program Budget Decision – legacy document as of 13 Sep 2019
PBES	Program Budget Environment System
PBR	Program and Budget Review
PCP	Program Change Proposal
PCR	Program Change Request
PD	Program Decision
PDD	Presidential Decision Directive
PDM	Program Decision Memoranda – legacy document as of 13 Sep 2019
PDS	Program Data System
PE	Program Element
PEG	Program Evaluation Group
PEM	Program Element Monitor
PEO	Program Executive Officer
PGM	Program Guidance Memorandum
PHIP	Posture Hearing Issue Paper
PM	Program Manager
PMD	Program Management Directive
POC	Point of Contact
POM	Program Objective Memorandum
POM/BES	See also <i>PBR</i> – Combined POM and BES submission
PPBE	Planning and Programming, Budgeting & Execution System
PPI	POM Preparation Instructions
PPG	Plan to Program Guidance
P&R	Personnel and Readiness
PR	Program Review
PRD	Presidential Review Directives
PRM	Presidential Review Memorandum
PRMG	Program Resource Managers Group (replaced the 3-Star Programmers)
PY	Prior Year
QDR	Quadrennial Defense Review
QFR	Question for the Record
RAP	Resource Allocation Plan
RAPIDS	Resource Allocation Program Information Decision System (legacy system)
RDT&E	Research, Development, Test & Evaluation
RIC	Resource Identity Code
RMD	Resource Management Decision (as of 2018 – a legacy document)
RMG	Resource Management Group
RMS	Resource Management System
RPA	Retired Pay Accrual
RPM	Real Property Maintenance
RRP	Rapid Response Process
SA	Situational Awareness

SAC	Senate Appropriations Committee
SAF/AQ	Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Acquisition)
SAF/FM	Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Financial Management)
SAF/FMB	Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (FM-Budget)
SAG	Sub-Activity Group
SAP	Special Access Program
SAR POC	Special Access Required Programs Oversight Committee
SAR	Special Access Required
SASC	Senate Armed Services Committee
SBC	Senate Budget Committee
SBIR	Small Business Innovative Research
SBR	Summer Budget Review
SCF	Service Core Function
SECAF	Secretary of the Air Force
SECDEF	Secretary of Defense
SLRG	Senior Leader Review Group
SFG	Space Force Group
SFB	Space Force Board
SMP	Strategic Master Plan
SOF	Special Operations Forces
SPG	Strategic Planning Guidance
SPO	System Program Office
SPWG	Special Projects Working Group
SS	Service Secretaries
TDS	Technology Development Strategy
TEMP	Test and Evaluation Master Plan
TEP	Theater Engagement Plan
T&E	Technology and Evaluation
TOA	Total Obligational Authority
TPG	Transformation Planning Guidance
TSPR	Total System Performance Requirement
TY	Then-Year Dollars
UPL	Un-funded Priority List
USC	United States Code
USD	Under Secretary of Defense
USD(A&S)	Under Secretary of Defense (Acquisition & Sustainment)
USD(C)	Under Secretary of Defense (Comptroller)
USD(I)	Under Secretary of Defense (Intelligence)
USD(P)	Under Secretary of Defense (Policy)
USD(P&R)	Under Secretary of Defense (Personnel & Readiness)
WCF	Working Capital Fund
WIPT	Working-Level Integrated Product Team

WMD	Weapons of Mass Destruction
WRAP	Warfighter Rapid Acquisition Process
WSC	Weapons System Code
ZBR	Zero-Based Reprogramming
ZBT	Zero-Balanced Transfer

Appendix B: Resource Allocation Glossary

The purpose of this glossary is to help the reader understand the terms listed as used in this reference guide. It is not intended to encompass all terms. Joint Publication 1-02, and Department of Defense Dictionary of Military and Associated Terms, amended 9 May 2005, contain standardized terms and definitions for Department of Defense and Air Force use. The primary source for definitions included here are the governing regulations' glossaries. Some slang terms are defined based on experience.

ABIDES: Automatic Budget Interactive Data Environment: The *legacy* HQ Air Force Budget database and its menu-driven database manipulation tool. ABIDES hosts the Force and Financial Plan (F&FP) the official source of programs and funding for the Air Force. ABIDES database is classified SECRET and was replaced by the Program Budget Enterprise System (PBES) for the FY23 PPBE cycle.

Above the Line: Starting with top-ranked program and proceeding down a prioritized list, a Corporate Structure reaches the program before it reaches the cumulative total funding line representing DAF TOA. i.e., the program is funded.

Acquisition Executive: The individual within the Department and Components charged with overall acquisition management responsibilities within his or her respective organization. The Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition, Technology, and Logistics is the Defense Acquisition Executive (DAE) responsible for all acquisition matters within the Department or Defense. The Component Acquisition Executives (CAEs) for each of the Components are the Secretary of the Military Departments or the Heads of Agencies with power of re-delegation. The CAEs are responsible for all acquisition matters within their respective Component.

Acquisition Program: A directed, funded effort designed to provide a new, improved, or continuing system or automated information system (AIS) capability in response to an approved operational need. (See ACAT, AMS)

ACAT I, II, III: Acquisition Categories I, II and III: Category groupings of weapon system acquisition programs based on dollar value or DoD interest. ACAT I programs are MDAPS. Some programs which would be ACAT II based on dollar value might be declared ACAT I based on Administration interest. DoD 5000.2 Categories established to facilitate decentralized decision-making and execution, and compliance with statutorily imposed requirements. The categories determine the level of review, decision authority, and applicable procedures. DoD 5000.2, Enclosure 2, provides the specific definition for each acquisition category (ACAT I through III).

ACAT I. A major defense acquisition program (MDAP) subject to Defense Acquisition Board oversight and estimated by the USD (AT&L) to require an eventual total expenditure of more than \$365 million in RDT&E funds, or \$2.190 billion in procurement funds measured in FY00 constant dollars.

ACAT ID. A major defense acquisition program (MDAP) for which the MDA is USD (AT&L). The "D" refers to the Defense Acquisition Broad (DAB), who advises the USD (AT&L) at major decision points.

ACAT IC. A major defense acquisition program subject for which the MDA is the DoD Component Head or, if delegated, the DoD Component Acquisition Executive (CAE). The "C" refers to Component.

ACAT IA. A major automated information system (MAIS) acquisition program estimated to require program costs in any single year in excess of \$32 million, total program costs in excess of \$126 million, or total life cycle costs in excess of \$378 million (FY00 constant dollars).

ACAT IAM. A major automated information system (MAIS) acquisition program for which the MDA is the Chief Information Officer (CIO) of the Department of Defense (DoD), the ASD (C3I).

ACAT IAC. A major automated information system acquisition program for which the DoD CIO delegated milestone decision authority to the CAE or Component CIO. The “C” (in ACAT IAC) refers to Component.

ACAT II programs are those programs not meeting the criteria for an ACAT I program, but are Major Systems or are designated as ACAT II by the MDA as a result of the MDA’s special interest. Because of the dollar values of MAISs, no AIS programs are ACAT II. The MDA is the CAE or the individual designated by the CAE.

ACAT III programs are defined as those acquisition programs not meeting the criteria for an ACAT I, an ACAT IA, or an ACAT II. The MDA is designated by the CAE, and shall be at the lowest appropriate level. This category includes less-than-major AISs.

ACTD: Advanced Concept Technology Demonstration: Used to determine military utility of proven technology, and to develop the concept of operations optimize effectiveness. A joint effort by the acquisition and operational (warfighter) communities within the DoD, the primary object of which is to provide the decision makers an opportunity to fully understand the operational potential offered by a given advanced concept and or technology/system to meet an urgent military operational need prior to an acquisition decision. (An ACTD is the application of a mature technology to address a critical military need. Mature technology implies it is not 6.1 or 6.2 research and a critical military need is an approved requirement by the JROC.)

Additional Topline: Money over and above the current DAF TOA.

ADM: Acquisition Decision Memorandum: A memorandum signed by the milestone decision authority (MDA) documenting the decisions made and the exit criteria established as the result of a milestone decision review or in-process review.

Advance Procurement: Early funding for parts taking a long time to make or will result in a more economical buy. See Full Funding Policy.

AFAE: Air Force Acquisition Executive: The Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Acquisition). Also called Service Acquisition Executive (SAE) or Component Acquisition Executive (CAE).

AFCAIG: Air Force Cost Analysis Improvement Group: Chaired by Deputy Assistant Secretary (Cost and Economics) (SAF/FMC) with members from Budget, Programming, Plans, Logistics, Acquisition and Communications plus others as needed depending on the program. Establishes Service Cost Position for major defense acquisition programs (MDAPS) as part of the milestone review process in the Acquisition Management System. AFCAIG publishes Air Force Cost and Planning Factors and establishes the flying hour cost factors used in ABIDES to price out Fuel, DLRs (depot-level repairables) and consumables based on a cost per flying hour for each MDS by major command.

AFCIS: Air Force Capabilities Investment Strategy: The Air Force projection through three FYDPs of the investment profiles to achieve the critical capabilities identified in the Air Force Strategic Planning Directive. By forecasting a funding profile of current and future systems in a constrained financial environment, the AFCIS highlight “fork in the road” issues for critical capabilities and AF CONOPS.

AFCS: Air Force Corporate Structure: Embodies the corporate review process for the Air Force; there is also a Space Force Corporate Structure. The primary bodies of the Air Force Corporate Structure are the Air Force Group, the Air Force Board, and Panels (note: the highest-ranking body, the Council, is convened at the DAF level.) This Structure increases management effectiveness and improves cross-functional decision-making by providing a forum in where senior Air Force leadership can apply their collective judgment and experience to major programs,

objectives, and issues. This process balances programs among mission areas, between force structure and support, and between readiness and modernization.

AFB: Air Force Board: Advises and provides recommendations to the DAF Council regarding major programming and other staffing issues. In addition, the AFB conducts corporate reviews of the resource allocation process, enhances the corporate decision process, and works to shape and refine proposals prior to presentation to the DAF Council. The AFB has decision authority for issues submitted by the Air Force Group (AFG). The Director of Programs chairs the AFB, except for purposes of budget formulation and execution to include the Budget Estimate Submission (BES), Budget Review Cycle, and President's Budget (PB), when the Deputy Assistant Secretary (Budget) (SAF/FMB) chairs it. Membership is at the General officer/Senior Executive Service level.

AFG: Air Force Group: Advises and provides recommendations to the Air Force Board (AFB) regarding major programming and other staffing issues. Conducts corporate reviews of the resource allocation process, enhances the corporate decision process, and works to shape and refine proposals prior to presentation to the AFB and the DAF Council. The Deputy Director of Programs chairs the AFG. Membership is at the Colonel/civilian equivalent level.

AF Futures: New title effective in 2021 for the organization previously known as AFWIC (Air Force Warfighting Integration Capability.)

AF Panel: Advises and provides recommendations to the Air Force Group (AFG) regarding major programming and other issues. Conducts corporate reviews of the resource allocation process, enhances the corporate decision process, and works to shape and refine proposals prior to the AFG. Serves as initial point of entry for Input Sources and issues requiring corporate review. Chairs are designated by appropriate Deputy Chief of Staff/Assistant Secretary.

AF Warfighting Integration Capability: (*legacy title*) the Air Force organization whose objective it was to integrate capabilities across the entire Air Force enterprise. As of 2021 known as Air Force Futures.

AIS: Automated Information System: A combination of computer hardware and software, data, or telecommunications performing functions such as collecting, processing, transmitting, and displaying information. Excluded are computer resources, both hardware and software, physically part of, dedicated to, or essential in real time to the mission performance of systems. See MAIS

AoA: Analysis of Alternatives: The evaluation of the performance, operational effectiveness, operational suitability and estimated costs of alternative systems to meet a mission capability. The AoA assesses the advantages and disadvantages of alternatives being considered to satisfy capabilities, including the sensitivity of each alternative to possible changes in key assumptions or variables. The AoA is one of the key inputs to defining the system capabilities in the capability development document (CDD).

AFSARC: Air Force Systems Acquisition Review Council: The Air Force corporate body advises the Air Force Acquisition Executive regarding matters concerning the initiation, continuation of, or substantial changes to major defense acquisition programs.

AFSPD: Air Force Strategic Planning Directive: Provides the key planning priorities of the Secretary of the Air Force and Chief of Staff, outlines the Air Force shift to a capabilities-based planning process. It assigns planning initiatives that will provide the foundation for future capability decisions. The Directive establishes guidance that will affect development of future Program Objective Memorandums (POMs) by examining the impact of capability needs

through the mid- and long-term planning period. It replaces the multiple Strategic Planning Volumes published previously by AF/A8.

APB: Acquisition Program Baseline: Each program's APB is developed and updated by the program manager and will govern the activity by prescribing the cost, schedule and performance constraints in the phase succeeding the milestone for which it was developed. The APB captures the user capability needs, including key performance parameters, which are copied verbatim from the capability development document (CDD).

APPG: Annual Planning and Programming Guidance: (*legacy document*) Air Force document developed by AF/A8P to instruct MAJCOMS in the development of their POM submissions. Incorporates known elements of the Defense Planning Guidance (DPG.) Replaced by the Planning Guidance Memorandum (PGM) and Planning and Program Updated Guidance (PPUG) in 2013.

Appropriation: Act of Congress authorizing funds to be drawn from the Treasury for specific uses. Government operations are funded through 13 different appropriation acts. Three affect the DAF: Defense, Energy, and Military Construction. The remaining appropriations are: Agriculture, Commerce, District of Columbia, Foreign Operations, Interior, Labor/HHS/Education, Legislative Branch, Transportation, Treasury, and VA/HUD.

Appropriation Code: Used to describe the purpose and availability (life) for obligation of an appropriation. Each Service has unique codes. The 4-digit code from OSD maps to a 2-digit Fund Code in ABIDES. There are 22 separate DAF codes with available life varying from one year for 3400 operations and maintenance to five years for 3300 military construction. (See Obligation Rate, Appropriation, and Fund Code)

Approved Program: The technical and operational, schedule, and quantity requirements reflected in the latest approved Under Secretary of Defense (Acquisition, Technology, and Logistics) (USD(AT&L)) Acquisition Decision Memorandum (ADM), or other document reflecting a more current decision of the USD(AT&L) or other appropriate approval authority (such as the President's Budget (PB), the Future Years Defense Program (FYDP), and supporting documentation).

Architecture: The structure of Components, their relationship, and the principles and guidelines governing their design and evolution over time.

"At Risk" Programs: Programs subject to funding cuts due to cost, schedule, or performance (technical) difficulties. Cuts could be taken by AFCS or OSD.

ATD: Advanced Technology Demonstration: Used to demonstrate the maturity and potential of advanced technologies for enhanced military operational capability or cost effectiveness, and reduce technical risks and uncertainties at the relatively low costs of informal processes. ATDs are funded with Advanced Technology Development (ATD) funds.

BA: Budget Authority: Authority provided by law to enter into obligations that will result in immediate or future outlays involving Federal Government funds. The basic forms of budget authority are appropriations, authority to borrow, and contract authority. Budget authority relates to direct programs. (See also Obligation Authority)

Base Year Dollars: A base-year dollar reflects the dollar's value at the time of a specified base-year as if all the dollars were expended in that year. See Constant Dollar.

Below the Line: Starting with top ranked program and proceeding down a prioritized list, the AFCS reaches the cumulative total funding line representing DAF TOA before it reaches the program below the line i.e., the program is not funded

BES: Budget Estimate Submission: The DoD Component's budget submissions to the Office of the Secretary of Defense (OSD) showing budget requirements for inclusion in the DoD budget during the Planning, Programming, Budget, and Execution (PPBE). The BES is annually submitted with the POM as part of the concurrent Program Budget Review (PBR) process by OSD and the Joint Staff.

Bill: 1) Funding shortfall resulting when new program content is added without additional funds, or when funds are taken without reducing program content or pricing. A bill can be caused by a disconnected, existing program or an initiative or an OSD reduction to DAF funding levels.

Bill Payer: A program source of money for the AFCS i.e., an Offset

Bogey: Dollar figure given to each Panel to assess their "fair share" of the Corporate Bill

BOS: Base Operating Support: Program funds transportation, security forces, comptroller, staff judge advocate, claims, and personnel organizations; and dining facilities, lodging, contracting services, chaplain, administration, mess attendant and equipment maintenance contracts, postal services, data processing, airfield and air operations, furnishings management, and other authorized Service activities. It is a cross-cutter issue normally funded in PEs ending in XXX96. It consists of the money for the normal operation of a base. A difficult number to quantify, it is historically funded as a "level of effort" program by the Installations Panel who monitors it. (See Level of Effort)

BPAC: Budget Program Activity Code: A six-position alphanumeric code established for a classification below appropriation level to identify major budget programs and activities. It is applicable to *Air Force* procurement and RDT&E appropriations.

Broken Glass: Programs whose funding was reduced during AFCS deliberations to the extent they may be disconnected or require adjustments to schedule and cost.

Bubblemaster: Individual who controls all changes to any particular document or briefing used during the programming process--normally an A8/PE senior action officer.

Budget Decision: for the FY22-26 PPBE cycle, a Budget Decision (BD) is the OSD directive document that records OSD-directed changes to a Components' budget in the wake of the Budget Review.

Budget Review Cycle: Run concurrently with the OSD Program Review, the OSD Budget Review examines Service BES' and is conducted jointly by the OSD Comptroller and the OMB to build the Defense Department input to the President's Budget. The Program and Budget Review begins when the Services submit their BES in late summer and ends in the President's Budget in January.

Buy-In: Consensus from all players concerned with a particular course of action within the DAF.

Capability: The ability to execute a specified course of action. It is designed by an operational user and expressed in broad operational terms in the format of an initial capability document or a DOTMLPF change recommendation.

CAIV: Cost As an Independent Variable: The process of using better business practices, allowing trade space for industry to meet user requirements, and considering operation and maintenance costs early in requirements definition to procure systems smarter and more efficiently. Procurement strategy treating cost objectives as a program

requirement. Programs may trade performance or schedule to meet cost objectives. Normally associated with new acquisition, but it can be applied to any program.

CAO: Contract Administration Office also means a contract management office of the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA), formerly Defense Contract Management Command or DCMC.

CCD: Combat Capability Document: It is used to document deficiencies arising during combat or crisis operations. It is used in the Rapid Response Process to accelerate the fielding of critical systems to meet theater-specific wartime needs. The CCD replaced the Combat Mission Needs Statement or C-MNS and is described in Rapid Response Process (AFI 63-114).

CCN: Change Control Number: Unique, formatted number assigned to each change of the Force and Financial Plan in PBES (and ABIDES.) Permanent documentation of funding changes plus rationale for change remaining in database files. Format provides information on source and time of change. Rationale for change can come with option slides or be expanded on by budget analyst. It is a key document for understanding budget history.

Change Control Sheet: Form used to document and coordinate CCNs. Automatically identifies minimum required coordination based on appropriations, but the analyst must consider all other required coordination manually.

CDD: Capability Development Document: captures the information necessary to develop a proposed program(s), and outlines the affordability increment of capability for an evolutionary (spiral) acquisition strategy. A capability increment is a militarily useful and supportable operational capability with its own set of attributes and associated performance values with thresholds and objectives established by the sponsor and user. The CDD provides the operational performance attributes, including supportability and Key Performance Parameters (KPPs). The CDD is updated for each increment so the values only apply to the increment considered. To capture the overall objective capability, you must refer back to the ICD.

CaNDI: Commercial and non-developmental items: Term applied when referencing both commercial and Non-developmental items. See Commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS) and Non-development Item (NDI).

CLS: Contractor Logistics Support: Weapons system support manually entered into the program compared to organic/blue-suit flying hour cost factors automatically priced out in ABIDES. This becomes an issue for Resource Managers when the source of repair changes from organic to contract since, because of the automatic method of calculations, flying hour funds are not available for Zero Balance Transfer (ZBT). When the source of repair changes from contract to organic, an offset is created to apply against the flying hour bill.

Compatibility: The capability of two or more items or Components of equipment or material to exist or operate near or with other systems, and not be affected by those systems or affect those systems.

CONOPS: Concept of Operations: A verbal or graphic statement, in broad outline, of a commander's assumptions or intent in regard to an operation or series of operations.

Concurrent Budget Resolution: A resolution passed by both Houses of Congress, but not requiring the signature of the President, setting forth, reaffirming, or revising the congressional budget for the United States Government for a fiscal year. A concurrent budget resolution, due by April 15, must be adopted before legislation providing new budget authority, new spending authority, new credit authority or changes in revenues, or the public debt limit is considered. Other concurrent resolutions for a fiscal year may be adopted at any time following the first required concurrent resolution for that fiscal year.

Constant Dollars: A dollar value adjusted for changes in prices. Constant dollar series are derived by dividing current dollar estimates by appropriate price indices, a process generally known as deflating. The result is a time series as it would presumably exist if prices remained the same over the years—in other words, as if the dollar had constant purchasing power. Any changes in such a series would reflect only changes in the real (physical) volume of output. Constant dollar figures are commonly used for gross national product and its Components.

Contingency Supplemental: A supplemental appropriation to support unforeseen (not programmed or budgeted), un-funded military combat, peacekeeping, or humanitarian operations. Does not count against the budget appropriation and outlay targets constraining Congress in developing the annual budget. (See Supplemental Appropriation and concurrent resolution)

Continuing Resolution: Legislation enacted by the Congress to provide budget authority for specific ongoing activities where the regular fiscal year appropriation for such activities was not enacted by the beginning of the fiscal year. The continuing resolution usually specifies a maximum rate the agency may incur obligations, based on the rate of the prior year, the President's budget request, or an appropriation bill passed by either or both Houses of the Congress.

Contracting Officer: A person with the authority to enter into, administer, and or terminate contracts and make related determinations and findings. The term includes certain authorized representatives of the contracting officer acting within the limits of his or her authority as delegated by the contracting officer. “**Administrative contracting officer (ACO)**” refers to a contracting officer who is administering contracts. “**Termination contracting officer (TCO)**” refers to a contracting officer who is settling terminated contracts. A single contracting officer may be responsible for duties in any or all of these areas. Also called PCO for program contracting officer for large SPOs.

Corporate Bill: Any bill the AFCS must source (pay). The sources are either from the panels or additional Topline.

Core Functions: The Service Core Functions (SCF) are functional areas that delineate the appropriate and assigned core duties, missions, and tasks of the Air Force as an organization. Service Core Functions express the ways the Air Force is particularly and appropriately suited to contribute to national security.

Core Function Lead: principal integrators for their assigned SCFs and the corresponding **Core Function Support Plans (CFSP)**. CFLs are the MAJCOM Commanders. NOTE: as of the FY 20-24 POM effort, the CFL construct is no longer used.

CFSP: Core Function Support Plans contain the strategic vision, operational view, programmed force, programmed force extended, planning force proposals, operations and maintenance challenges, science and technology, efficiencies, total force enterprise manpower, metrics and a decision space section for that particular SCF. The CFMPs will contain risk analysis for that particular Core Function. CFMPs will be developed by the appropriate CFL. CFL's are directed to coordinate their assigned CFMPs with other appropriate stakeholders across the Air Force.

Cost estimate: A product of an estimating procedure specifying the expected dollar cost to perform a stipulated task or to acquire an item. It may be stated as a single value or a range of values. Cost estimates are required for milestone reviews. For Major defense acquisition program (MDAPs), the AFCAIG leads a cost Integrated Product Team (IPT) to develop a Service cost position.

COTS: Commercial-off-the-shelf: Commercial items requiring little or no unique government modifications or maintenance over the life- cycle of the product to meet the needs of the using command. Any item, other than real

property, customarily used by the general public or by non-governmental entities for purposes other than governmental. (See FAR Part 201 for a complete definition)

CPs: Change Proposals: Introduced by USD(Comptroller) in the FY 2007-2011 Integrated Program Budget Review. It was the mechanism used by the Services and defense agencies to introduce change to the baseline (previous PB) during an off-year cycle. Change Proposals were discontinued for the FY11 OSD Program Budget Review., when instead OSD required a full POM submission.

CPD: Capability Production Document: address the quantities and production attributes specific to a single increment (spiral) of a program, and provides linkages back to the ICD and CDD. It narrows the generalized performance and cost parameters from the CDD. It is started after the Design Readiness Review (critical design review), and addresses the Key performance parameter (KPPs), threshold and objective performance values in the CDD to ensure they are met. If threshold KPPs are reduced, an assessment of military utility must be completed and, possibly, a reexamination of the entire program. The CPD must be approved prior to Milestone C or IOT&E.

CRD: Capstone Requirements Document: A document that contains capabilities based requirements that facilitates the development of CDDs and CPDs by providing a common framework and operational concept to guide their development.

Cross-Cutters: Programs funded across different Panels and within separate program elements, but viewed as a single “rolled-up amount” at appropriate times to provide better funding visibility. e.g., technical orders, sustaining engineering, or contractor logistics support (CLS).

CSMI: Cost Savings Modernization Initiative: A program office or command initiative under the Reduction in Total Ownership Cost (RTOC) program to fund a modification to pay for itself in a relatively short period through reduced operating costs.

Cut Drill: Process of identifying least dear programs as potential offsets.

DAB: Defense Acquisition Board: The Department of Defense corporate body for system acquisition providing advice and assistance to the Secretary of Defense normally chaired by the Under Secretary of Defense (Acquisition, Technology, and Logistics) and the VCJCS. DAB reviews MDAPs at each milestone.

DAC: Designated Acquisition Commander: The individual who performs the same functions as the program executive officer (PEO) regarding programs not assigned to a PEO, primarily the commanders of product centers'. Logistic centers commanders may be identified as DACs under the Integrated Weapon System Management concept. for acquisition program activities, DACs, like PEOs, are accountable to the Air Force acquisition executive.

DAF Council: Advises and makes recommendations to the Chief of Staff and Secretary regarding major matters, including the responsiveness of DAF plans and programs to national, Office of the Secretary of Defense, Joint Chiefs of Staff, and DAF objectives. The Vice Chief of Staff chairs the AFC. Membership is at the Deputy Chief of Staff (three-star) level, corresponding Secretariat level, and selected Directorate (two-star) level.

DAS: Defense Acquisition System: Management process by which the Department of Defense provides effective, affordable, and timely systems to the users.

DAWG: Defense Advisory Working Group (legacy term – replaced by the DMAG in 2011): came into being for the 2005 Quadrennial Defense Review, and former Secretary Rumsfeld institutionalized it to help with budget review. Under DEPSECDEF Carter, the DAWG has been replaced by the DMAG effective October 2011. The DAWG was a

four-star level body, with Services represented by the Vice Chiefs of Staff (VCNO for the Navy) and the Service Under Secretaries.

DAWIA Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act: Law directing the professional development and assignment criteria for the DoD workforce. Requires identification of acquisition billets and criteria for staffing them.

Decision Tracker: Interactive software program used during programming deliberations; list all programs and program elements considered for funding; also lists priorities AFCS and MAJCOMs assign, and the cumulative total of funding regarding the TOA baseline. (see Above and Below the line)

De-funded (formerly Offsets – legacy term) - Resources offered to “pay” for a Program Change Request action, un-funded, or initiative; funds in an existing approved program removed from the program to fund higher priority requirements. Funds should be excess to need in the approved program or they will create a Un-funded.

Development Plans: Development Plans (DP) identify potential materiel solutions to the MAJCOM identified needs, and potential revolutionary approaches to solve long-term needs. The DP documents the potential contribution of each concept to the MAJCOM needs, along with available technical risk, costs, and schedule information associated with the concepts.

Directed program: A program mandated by higher authority.

Discretionary Spending: Those programs for which Congress, its discretion, authorizes funds each year; for example, the Department of Defense represents approximately half of all government discretionary spending. Congress must take positive steps to appropriate funds or the funds are not available.

Disconnect: An approved program unexecutable because of a shortfall of resources to accomplish the given objectives or mission. Specific DAF or Office of the Secretary of Defense program budget decisions (PBDs) changing the program content or pace in the Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution System cycle are not candidates for disconnects in the following year’s cycle.

DMAG: Deputy’s Management Action Group: The Deputy’s Management Action Group (DMAG) was created in 2011 by DEPSECDEF Ashton Carter as a four-star level body chartered to review management actions across the defense enterprise, including the PPBE process and the OSD Program and Budget Review. The DMAG is chaired by the DEPSECDEF and co-chaired by the Vice Chairman of the JCS. DMAG membership is topic-dependent. DMAG replaced the DAWG.

DoD Components: The Office of the Secretary of Defense; the Military Departments; the Chairman, Joint Chiefs of Staff and Joint Staff; the Unified and Specified Commands; the Defense Agencies; and DoD Field Activities.

DPG: Defense Planning Guidance: this is a single, fiscally informed document replacing the policy/strategy sections of the Guidance for the Development of the Force (GDF) and the fiscally-informed guidelines formerly contained in the Joint Programming Guidance (JPG). It is a statement from the Secretary of Defense on policy, strategy, and force planning. The DPG may include programmatic guidance regarding a few issues of paramount importance. The DPG first establishes a framework for and gives direction to the Enhanced Planning Process (EPP).

DSM: Digital System Model: Software representation of a system used to dynamically characterize the expected effects of changes regarding assumptions, design, tactics, or doctrine. May be used when considering AoAs during the as part of the RGS.

EA: Economic Analysis: Also called cost-benefit analysis, a method for systematically comparing competing project alternatives to recommend the best course of action. EA offers a means of assessing both monetary and non-monetary costs and benefits across alternatives. The Clinger-Cohen Act requires an EA for MAISs. The RTOC program uses a modified EA for CSMIs.

EEIC: Element of Expense/Investment Code: (*legacy data element, replace by Cost Categories*) A five-place alphanumeric code consisting of two parts: a three-place account code followed by a two-place sub-account code to provide a further breakdown. The codes are designed for budget preparations and accounting systems to identify the nature of services and item acquired for immediate consumption (expense) or capitalization (investment). EEICs are used regarding Air Force accounting only, but they are related to Office of Management and Budget (OMB) element of resource codes.

Effects-Based Operations (EBO): Military actions and operations designed to produce distinctive and desired effects through the application of appropriate movement, supply, attack, defense, and maneuvers. Effects-based operations focus on functional, systemic, and psychological effects well beyond the immediate physical result of a tactical or operational event.

Enhanced Planning Process (EPP): Designed to examine major issues and provide capability-based analyses of programmatic alternatives to the Secretary of Defense.

ESP: Emergency and Special Program Code: A two-place alphanumeric code used to provide separate accounting and reporting for costs incurred during an emergency or support of a special program. ESP codes may be assigned by HQ USAF, Major Commands (MAJCOMs), or bases. The first position is assigned by the user and may be either an alpha or numeric character. The second position is always an alpha character, and is assigned as follows: (A-G) HQ USAF; (H-W) MAJCOM; or (X-Z) base.

EV: Earned Value: EVM Earned Value Management. Acquisition Process tool linking a program's schedule and funding profiles as a management tool. Using EVM, program managers can track the estimated cost of their program at completion based estimated cost of their program based on the actual cost to date vice the budgeted cost.

Exit criteria: Program specific accomplishments to satisfactorily demonstrate before an effort or program can progress further in the current acquisition phase or transition to the next acquisition phase. The exit criteria serve as gates, when successfully passed or exited, demonstrate the program is on track to achieve its final program goals, and should be allowed to continue with additional activities within an acquisition phase or be considered for continuation into the next acquisition phase. Exit criteria may include such factors as critical test issues, the attainment of projected growth curves and baseline parameters, and the results of risk reduction efforts deemed critical to the decision to proceed further. Exit criteria supplement minimum required accomplishments, and are specific to each acquisition phase. The MDA approves the exit criteria.

Expenditure: Authorization for funds from Treasury resulting from presentation of a voucher or claim (should be as a result of a legal obligation).

Expense versus Investment Costs: The criteria for cost definitions consider the intrinsic or innate qualities of the item such as durability of an investment cost or consumability of an operating cost and an item is used or the way it is managed. In all cases, where the definitions appear to conflict, the conditional circumstances prevail. The following guidance determines whether a cost is either an expense or an investment. All costs are classified as either an expense or an investment.

1. Expenses are the costs incurred to operate and maintain the organization, such as personal services, supplies, and utilities. Operations & Maintenance (normally O&M)
2. Investments are costs resulting in the acquisition of, or an addition to, end items. These costs benefit future periods, and generally are of a long-term character such as real property and personal property (normally Procurement).

F&FP: Force and Financial Plan: The database describing the Future Years Defense Plan. The DAF portion of the DoD FYDP, consisting of a series of classified volumes, showing (by program element code), a projection of the forces, manpower, and dollar resources approved for the DAF. It is kept in PBES.

FAA: Functional Area Analysis: An FAA identifies the operational tasks, conditions and standards needed to achieve military objectives. It uses the national strategies, joint operational concepts, joint functional concepts, integrated architectures, and DAF CONOPS as inputs. The output is tasks to be reviewed in the follow-on functional needs analysis.

FCB: Functional Capability Board: A permanently established body that is responsible for the organization, analysis, and prioritization of joint warfighting capabilities within an assigned functional area.

Facing Slide or Facer Page: Slide facing the principal slide in a briefing providing further insight regarding the program funding or program content. It is normally used to prepare DAF senior leaders for an OSD briefing during program reviews at the OSD PMRG or DMAG.

Fenced: Programs or program elements designated to remain above the line at the start of any programming exercise i.e., excluded from being bill payers. Exclusion can be a DAF, OSD, or Congressional input.

Fin Plan: Financial Plan: Plan for executing the annual DAF O&M budget. At one time, Fin Plans were submitted by major commands and integrated by SAF/FMBO into an Air Force plan highlighting execution risks and funding priorities. The Fin Plan was presented to the AFCS prior to approval by the CSAF and SECAF. Fin Plans were replaced by more informal "Spend Plans" in the 2006 timeframe.

Fiscal Guidance: Annual guidance issued by the Secretary of Defense providing the fiscal constraints the Joint Chiefs of Staff, the military departments, and Defense agencies must observe to formulating force structures and Future Years Defense Programs, and by the Secretary of Defense staff when reviewing proposed programs.

Fiscal Year: Any yearly accounting period without regard to its relationship to a calendar year. The fiscal year for the Federal Government begins on October 1 and ends on September 30. The fiscal year is designated by the calendar year in which it ends. Fiscal years are further designated as follows:

Past Year-1: Also referred to as Prior Year-1, the fiscal year immediately preceding the past year.

Past Year (PY): Also referred to as Prior Year, the fiscal year immediately preceding the current year; the last completed fiscal year.

Current Year (CY): The fiscal year in progress. Immediately precedes the budget year. [Also known as execution year]

Budget Year (BY): The next fiscal year for which estimates are submitted.

Budget Year 1 (BY1): In a biennial budget submission, the first fiscal year of a 2-year period for which the budget is considered.

Budget Year 2 (BY2): In a biennial budget submission, the second fiscal year of a 2-year period for which the budget is being considered

Budget Year(s)+1 (BY(s)+1): The fiscal year immediately following the budget year(s). This format continues through Budget Year +5 (BY+5), the fifth fiscal year following the budget year(s).

FITR: Fork in the Road: Decision Point. The starting year where a program for a future or replacement capability must begin receiving funding if the capability is to be available at the desired time, assumes a normal acquisition profile. The FITR can be a decision between a service life extension to an existing program versus the start of a replacement program.

Fix in Execution: An intentional decision by the AFCS to risk under- funding a program or crosscutter in the POM, BES, or PB for a wide range of reasons, such as: additional funds would be at risk with OSD or Congress, the cost estimate is perceived as overly pessimistic, the program is linked with another program and the two will move funds between them, or it is a traditional recipient of additional funds during the execution year.

FOA/DRU: Field Operating Agency/Direct Reporting Unit: FOAs are a subordinate, supporting unit to a major command or Air or Space Force headquarters. DRUs report directly to the CSAF/SECAF; examples include the Air Force Academy, AF Studies and Analysis Agency, and the 11th Wing (where funds for numerous FOAs are programmed and executed).

FOC: Full operational capability: The full attainment of the capability to effectively employ a weapon system, item of equipment, or system-of-approved specific characteristics, manned and operated by a trained, equipped, and supported military unit or force. FOC is not necessarily a date, but is the criteria necessary to declared full operational capability.

FSDM – Force Structure Data Management: The system that replaced Program Data System (PDS) and tracks programmed and actual aircraft inventories as well as programmed and actual flying hours. FSDM – like PDS – also contains all aircraft basing information.

FOS: Family of Systems: A set or arrangement of independent systems that can be arranged or interconnected in various ways to provide different capabilities. The mix of systems can be tailored to provide desired capabilities, dependent on the situation.

Full-Funding Policy: The practice of funding the total cost of major procurement and construction projects in the fiscal year they will be initiated. It is Department of Defense policy to fully fund procurements covered within the procurement title of the annual DoD Appropriations Act. There are two basic policies concerning full funding. The first is to provide funds at the outset for the total estimated cost of a given program so Congress and the public can be fully aware of the dimensions and cost when the program is first presented in the budget. The second is to provide funding each fiscal year to procure a complete, usable end item. In other words, an end item budgeted in a fiscal year cannot depend upon a future year's funding to complete the procurement. However, efficient production of major defense systems necessitated two general exceptions to this policy - advance procurement for long lead-time items, and advance economic order quantity (EOQ) procurement. EOQ is normally associated with multi-year procurements but can be requested for annualized procurements on an exception basis for unusual circumstances (such as combined parts buys for a block of satellites). Both efforts must be identified in an Exhibit P-10, Advance

Procurement, when the Budget Estimate Submission is submitted to OSD, and when the President's budget request is submitted to the Congress

Full Operational Capability (FOC)—The full attainment of the capability to effectively employ a weapon system, item of equipment, or system of approved specific characteristics, which is manned and operated by a trained, equipped, and supported military unit or force. FOC is not necessarily a date; it defines the criteria necessary to declare full operational capability.

Full-rate production: Production of economic quantities following stabilization of the system design, and prove-out of the production process.

Functional Needs Analysis (FNA)—It assesses the ability of the current and programmed joint capabilities to accomplish the tasks that the FAA identified, under the full range of operating conditions and to the designated standards. Using the tasks identified in the FAA as primary input, the FNA produces as output a list of capability gaps/shortfalls that require solutions, and indicates the time frame in which those solutions are needed. The sponsor leads the FNA.

Functional Solution Analysis (FSA)—It is an operationally based assessment of all potential DOTMLPF approaches to solving (or mitigating) one or more of the capability gaps (needs) previously identified. On the basis of the capability needs, potential solutions are identified, including (in order of priority) integrated DOTMLPF changes that leverage existing materiel capabilities; product improvements to existing materiel or facilities; adoption of interagency or foreign materiel solutions; and finally, initiation of new materiel programs. Identified capability gaps/shortfalls or redundancies (excess to the gap/shortfall) establish the basis for developing materiel approaches in ICD and/or DOTMLPF approaches through CJCSI 3180.01.

Fund Code: Two-digit number used in ABIDES to identify OSD's four-digit appropriation code. For example, appropriation 3400, AF O&M, is fund code 30 in ABIDES.

FYDP: Future Years Defense Program: A massive DoD database and internal accounting system that summarizes forces and resources associated with programs approved by the Secretary of Defense (SECDEF). Its three parts are the organizations affected, appropriations accounts (Research, Development, Test and Evaluation (RDT&E), Operation and Maintenance (O&M), etc.), and the 11 major programs (strategic forces, mobility forces, R&D, etc.). The FYDP allows a crosswalk between DoD's internal system of accounting via 11 major programs and congressional appropriations. The primary data element in the FYDP is the Program Element (PE). The FYDP is updated three times during a single Planning, Programming, Budgeting and Execution (PPBE) Process cycle: submission of the combined Program Objectives Memorandum (POM)/Budget Estimate Submission (BES) (usually August/September), and submission of the President's Budget (PB) (early February the year following).

GDF: Guidance for the Development of the Force: (*Legacy Term as of 2010*). This GDF was a single, fiscally informed document replacing the policy/strategy sections of the Strategic Planning Guidance (SPG). It, in turn, has been replaced by the Defense Planning and Programming Guidance. (see DPG.)

GEF: Guidance for the Employment of the Force: Strategic guidance from OSD that serves as the basis for the COCOM IPLs.

GDP: Gross Domestic Product: value of the total amount of goods and services produced by a nation.

GTBL: Getting to the Bottom Line: An AFB exercise to get all of the priority programs above the funding line with the rest of the DAF program reasonably balanced. In the end, their accepted disconnects and initiatives will equal the offsets or $D+I=O$.

Group: Second-level indenture within the ABIDES Viewer breaking a roll-up into identifiable Components. For example Flight Training, Initial, 18a, captures the costs associated with undergraduate flight training, and Flight Training Operational, 18b, captures weapon system qualification training. (See Roll-up and Program code)

Harmonization: The process and results of adjusting differences or inconsistencies to bring significant features into agreement (Joint Publication 1-02). It implies especially that comparatively minor differences in requirements should not be permitted to serve as a basis for the support of slightly different duplicative programs and projects.

Headroom: A year in the FYDP where there is more TOA than program. Years with headroom are the recipients of programs that slip or accelerate from years with more program than funding. Normally this is an out year.

Highly sensitive classified program: An acquisition special access program established in accordance with DoD 5200.1-R, Information Security Program Regulation, and managed in accordance with DoD Directive 5205.7, Special Access Program Policy.

HSI: Human systems integration: A disciplined, unified, and interactive approach to integrate human considerations into system design to improve total system performance and reduce cost of ownership. The major elements of HSI are manpower, personnel, training, human factors safety, health hazards, and personnel survivability.

IBRC: Investment Budget Review Committee: Chaired by the Director of Budget Investment, SAF/FMBI. It reviews the execution of investment programs, and recommends program adjustments to the AFCS.

ICD: Initial Capabilities Document: makes a case for capability to resolve gap identified by Joint Capabilities Integration & Development System (JCIDS) analysis. Defines gap in terms of functional areas, relevant range of military operations, time, obstacles to overcome, and key attributes with appropriate measures of effectiveness as well as proposes a recommended solution serving as the beginning for analysis of alternatives. Once approved, it is not normally updated.

Implementing command: The command or agency designated by the Air Force Acquisition Executive to manage an acquisition program.

Incremental Funding: The phasing of total funding of programs or projects over two or more fiscal years based upon levels and timing of obligational requirements for the funds. Differs from full funding concept where total funds for an end item, program, or project are provided in the fiscal year of program or project initiation, regardless of the obligational requirement for the funds.

Information security: The result of any system-of-policies and procedures for identifying, controlling, and protecting information from unauthorized disclosure, whose protection is authorized by executive order or statute.

Initiative: A new program not yet approved or approved and not previously funded in the FYDP or a change in an approved program's content requiring funds.

Innovation: Taking advanced technologies and putting them into the hands of the warfighter faster. Referred to as an "emerging concept" matched of an operational need a compelling military capability to an operational need. Current vehicles of innovation include Advanced Technology Demonstrations (ATDs), Advanced Concept Technology Demonstrations (ACTDs), Battlelab Initiatives (from the six AF Battlelabs), and Spiral Development.

In-production system: System for which the Air or Space Force is still accepting deliveries. (For example, the Air Force is still accepting Block 50 F-16 aircraft; they are in-production. This is not true for Block 30 F-16; this system is out of production, even though they are both F-16 aircraft. A modification on the Block 50 could be done at the factory, requiring an assembly line change. There is no opportunity to change the assembly line of the block 30.)

Input Sources: term used to describe those organizations (MAJCOMs, FIELDCOMs, FOAs, DRUs) in both the Air Force and Space Force who make inputs to each Service's respective POM build.

Intermediate Level Review (ILR): *(legacy term) Replaced by the Air Force Group in 2015.* Advised and provided recommendations to the Air Force Board (AFB) regarding major programming and other staffing issues. Conducted corporate reviews of the resource allocation process, enhanced the corporate decision process, and worked to shape and refine proposals prior to presentation to the AFB and the Air Force Council (AFC). Membership was at the Colonel/civilian equivalent level.

Interoperability: The ability of systems, units, or forces, to work in conjunction with other systems and provide services to or accept services from other systems, units, or forces and to use the services so exchanged to operate effectively together.

IOC: Initial operational capability: That first attainment of the capability to effectively employ a weapon, item of equipment, or system of approved specific characteristics with the appropriate number, type, and mix of trained and equipped personnel necessary to operate, maintain, and support the system. It is normally defined in the Capability Development Document (CDD) and the Capability Production Document (CPD).

IPL: Integrated Priority List: A list of combatant commanders highest priority requirements, prioritized across Service and functional lines. They define shortfalls in key programs that may adversely affect the combatant commander's mission. During the Program Review, OSD and JCS evaluate how well Service POMs support the Combatant Commander IPLs.

ISP: Intelligence Support Plan: The authoritative reference document for identifying, planning, and monitoring implementation of intelligence infrastructure requirements for a system from need definition through system retirement.

Issue Books: The compilation of issue papers by OSD that require 3-star Group and SLRG deliberations. The issue papers come from analysis of the Service POMs, inputs from Combatant Commanders, OSD, and OMB. Everyone has an opportunity to comment regarding the issues. Service staffs prepare Facing Slides for issues in the book to prepare their representatives for the 3-star Group and SLRG.

IWSM: Integrated Weapon System Management: A management concept created to consolidate responsibility for managing all facets of the development, production, modification, support, and retirement of a weapons system under a single manager.

J-Books: Budget Justification Documentation: Supporting documentation provided to OSD with the BES and to Congress with the PB showing how and why the DAF intends to use the funds requested in the budget. Justification is by appropriation and program. For O&M, accounts justification is by Sub-Activities such as base support within four Activity-Groups, Combat Forces, Mobility Forces, Training/Recruiting, and Admin/Service-wide support. See Omnibus Reprogramming for importance.

Joint Capabilities Board (JCB)—The JCB functions to assist the JROC in carrying out its duties and responsibilities. The JCB reviews and, if appropriate, endorses all JCIDS and DOTMLPF proposals prior to their submission to the

JROC. The JCB is chaired by the Joint Staff, J-8, Director of Force Structure, Resources, and Assessment. It is comprised of Flag Officer/General Officer representatives of the Services.

JCIDS: Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System: CJCS system for identifying, assessing, and prioritizing joint military capability needs through the Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC). It implements a capabilities-based approach to better leverage the expertise in all government agencies, industry, and academia to identify improvements to existing capabilities, and to develop new warfighting capabilities. JCIDS products are the ICD, CDD, and CPD in support of major systems acquisition.

JDP: Joint Potential Designator: The JPD establishes the body responsible for final validation and approval of the Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System (JCIDS) document, any certifications that may be required (e.g., National Security System (NSS) and Information Technology System (ITS) interoperability and supportability certifications, or intelligence or munitions insensitivity certifications), and the staffing distribution for the document. According to CJCSI 3170.01C, there are four Joint Potential Designators as shown below:

JROC (Joint Requirements Oversight Council) Interest: Applicable to all Acquisition Category (ACAT) I/IA programs and programs designated as JROC Interest. All Capstone Requirements Documents (CRDs) will be designated as JROC Interest. The JROC validates and approves the Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System (JCIDS) documents of JROC Interest programs.

Joint Impact: Applicable to all Acquisition Category (ACAT) II and below programs where the concepts and/or systems associated with the document affect the joint force such that an expanded review is appropriate in order to ensure the most appropriate and effective solution is developed for the joint warfighter. The Functional Capabilities Board (FCB) validates and the DoD Component approves the Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System (JCIDS) documents of Joint Impact programs.

Joint Integration: Applicable to Acquisition Category (ACAT) II and below programs where the concepts and/or systems associated with the document do not significantly affect the joint force and an expanded review is not required, but interoperability, intelligence, or munitions certification is required. The DoD Component validates and approves the Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System (JCIDS) documents of Joint Integration programs.

Independent: Applicable to Acquisition Category (ACAT) II and below programs where the concepts and/or systems associated with the document do not significantly affect the joint force, an expanded review is not required, and no certifications are required. The DoD Component validates and approves the Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System (JCIDS) documents of Independent programs.

Joint: A potential for joint program management, joint funding, and joint development or procurement exists. (CJCSI 3170.01)

Joint Functional Concept (JFC)—An articulation of how a future Joint Force Commander will integrate a set of related military tasks to attain capabilities required across the range of military operations. Although broadly described within the Joint Operations Concepts, they derive specific context from the Joint Operating Concepts and promote common attributes in sufficient detail to conduct experimentation and measure effectiveness.

Joint Operating Concept (JOC)—An articulation of how a future Joint Force Commander will plan, prepare, deploy, employ, and sustain a joint force against potential adversaries' capabilities or crisis situations specified within the range of military operations. Joint Operating Concepts guide the development and integration of Joint Function

Concepts (JFCs) to provide joint capabilities. They articulate the measurable detail needed to conduct experimentation and allow decision makers to compare alternatives.

Joint Operations Concepts (JOpsC)—A concept that describes how the Joint Force intends to operate in 15 to 20 years from now. It provides the operational context for the transformation of the Armed Forces of the United States by linking strategic guidance with the integrated application of Joint Force capabilities.

Joint program—Any Defense acquisition system, subsystem, Component, or technology program involving formal management or funding by more than one DoD Component during any phase of a system's life-cycle.

Joint Programming Guidance (JPG): *Legacy term as of 2010.* This document, issued by the Secretary of Defense, provided firm guidance in the form of goals, priorities, and objectives, including fiscal constraints, for the development of the Military Departments, Defense agency, and USSOCOM POMs. It has been replaced by the Defense Planning and Programming Guidance (see DPPG.)

JROC: Joint Requirements Oversight Council: The Joint Requirements Oversight Council is responsible to the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff for assessing military requirements supporting of the system acquisition process. The Vice Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff chairs the Council and decides all matters before the Council. The permanent members include the Vice Chiefs of the Army and Air Force, the Vice Chief of Naval Operations, the Vice Chief of Space Operations, and the Assistant Commandant of the Marine Corps. The Council directly supports the Defense Acquisition Board through the review, validation, and approval of military requirements at the start of the acquisition process, prior to each milestone review, or as requested by the Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition.

Kick the Can: Delay a decision on a program or move program content to the out years (move it to the right), or take the risk of fixing it in execution.

KPP: Key performance parameter: Those minimum attributes or characteristics considered most essential for an effective military capability. KPPs are validated by the Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC) for JROC Interest documents, by the Functional Capabilities Board (FCB) for Joint Impact documents, and by the DoD Component for Joint Integration or Independent documents. The Capability Development Document (CDD) and the Capability Production Document (CPD) KPPs are included verbatim in the Acquisition Program Baseline (APB). (CJCSI 3170.01C)

Large Group: One of a number of SECDEF advisory groups that may provide recommendations to SECDEF in development of the OSD POM. Service participation in the Large Group is usually invited.

Lead command: The command who serves as operators interface with the Single Manager for a weapon system, but not to be confused with that MAJCOM designate by HQ AF/A5R as OPR for authoring a requirements document. Although, in most cases, the MAJCOM designated by HQ AF/A5R to sponsor a requirement will become the "lead command" for a weapon system.

Least Dear: Those programs or initiatives with the lowest priority for funding

Level of effort programs: Programs with generally identifiable content, but no clear metric for meeting "full funding" criteria. Examples are BOS and RPM.

Limit: The limitation or subhead is a four-digit suffix to the U.S. Treasury account number (basic symbol). The limitation is used to identify a subdivision of funds restricting the amount or use of funds for a certain purpose, or identifies sub-elements within the account for management purposes. On accounting documents, the limitation is preceded by a decimal point. If there is no limitation, leave these positions blank.

Logistics Support Analysis: The selective application of scientific and engineering efforts undertaken during the acquisition process. As part of the systems engineering process, logistics support analysis assists: causing support considerations to influence design; defining support requirements related optimally to design and to each other; acquiring the required support; and providing the required support during the operational phase at minimum cost.

LRIP: Low-rate initial production: The production of a system in limited quantity to provide articles for operational test and evaluation, to establish an initial production base, and to permit an orderly increase in the production rate sufficient to lead to full-rate production on successful completion of operational testing.

MAIS: Major Automated Information System: An acquisition program that is: 1) designated by the ASD(NII) as an MAIS; or 2) estimated to require program costs in any single year in excess of \$32 million (FY 2000 constant dollars), total program in excess of \$126 million (FY 2000 constant dollars), or total Life Cycle Costs (LCCs) in excess of \$378 million (FY 2000 constant dollars). MAISs do not include Information Technology (IT) that involves equipment that is an integral part of a weapon system or is an acquisition of services program.

Major System: A combination of elements that shall function together to produce the capabilities required to fulfill a mission need, including hardware, equipment, software, or any combination thereof, but excluding construction or other improvements to real property. A system shall be considered a major system if it is estimated by the DoD Component Head to require an eventual total expenditure for Research, Development, Test and Evaluation (RDT&E) of more than 140 million in FY 2000 constant dollars, or for procurement of more than 660 million in FY 2000 constant dollars, or is designated as major by the DoD Component Head.

Manpower and Personnel—The identification and acquisition of military and civilian personnel with the skills and grades required to operate and support a materiel system over its lifetime at peacetime and wartime rates.

Materiel Management: Direction and control of those aspects of logistics which deal with materiel, including the functions of identification, cataloging, standardization, requirements determination, procurement, inspection, Quality Control (QC), packaging, storage, distribution, disposal, maintenance, mobilization planning, industrial readiness planning, and item management classification; encompasses materiel control, inventory control, inventory management, and supply management.

MBI: Major Budget Issue: Those few, most significant issues the Services have with adjustments made by OSD PBDs during the Budget Review Cycle. They are tentatively identified when the corporate structure builds the reclama to the PBD. They are either a policy or a funding issue of great concern to the DAF. The first effort to resolve MBIs is between the Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Financial Management and Comptroller (SAF/FM) and the Under Secretary of Defense (Comptroller) (USD(C)) in an “Out of Court” Session. Those issues not resolved in that meeting are discussed between the SECAF, CSAF, CSO, and SECDEF.

MCP: Major Change Proposal: For the FY 22-26 programming exercise, OSD directed Components to submit Major Change Proposals instead of POMs. MCPs were programming submissions with some limitations. This approach in limiting the Component programming activities and in turn their programming deliverables, was in response to the COVID crisis.

MDA: Milestone Decision Authority: Designated individual with overall responsibility for a program. The MDA shall have the authority to approve entry of an acquisition program into the next phase of the acquisition process and shall be accountable for cost, schedule, and performance reporting to higher authority, including congressional reporting. (DoDD 5000.1)

MDAP: Major defense acquisition program: An acquisition program that is designated by the Under Secretary of Defense (Acquisition, Technology, and Logistics) (USD(AT&L)) as an MDAP, or estimated by the USD(AT&L) to require an eventual total expenditure for Research, Development, Test and Evaluation (RDT&E) of more than 365 million in Fiscal Year (FY) 2000 constant dollars or, for procurement, of more than 2.19 billion in FY 2000 constant dollars.

MDS: Mission Design Series: System by which military aircraft are identified. Mission is fighter (F), Bomber (B), Cargo (C), etc., design is its design number during development, and series represents any major changes: for example F-15A, B, C, D, E or the C-5A and C-5B. Some aircraft haven't changed enough structurally to get an entire series identification, so they may have a block identification associated with their production run. The F-16C and D represent the single seat and two seat series upgrades from the F-16 A/B, but they have several different blocks based on avionics or other minor configuration enhancements. The B-2A went from block 10 to block 20, and then block 30 as the final production configuration was achieved. Early B-2s were sent back through the production line to become block 20s and sent through again to become block 30s. The last few B-2s were produced as block 30s. In the case of the F-16, the variances came because of the very long production run of the F-16C, and the continuing improvements in technology. For the B-2, it was because of the overlap of test and production.

MFP: Major Force Program: MFPs are directed by Congress to identify funds in areas of activity or capability regardless of the Service. MFP code is the first 2 numbers of each 8-digit PE. The PE for B-52s and SSBNs both start with 01 for strategic forces, while Air to Ground fighters, destroyers and Apache Helicopters all start with 02 for general purpose forces

MID: Management Initiative Decision: A decision document similar to a Program Budget Decision, but designed to institutionalize management reform decisions. A MID may be issued at any time during the year. The OSD Comptroller incorporate any funding adjustments into the next President's Budget. No MIDs have been issued since FY2007.

MID 913: Management Initiative Decision 913: An OSD directive issued in 2003 implementing a 2-Year Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution Process. This directive stated OSD would evolve from an annual POM/BES cycle to a biennial (2-year) cycle. The Department would formulate 2-year budgets and use the off year to focus on budget execution and program performance. MID 913 has been overcome by events of the OSD FY10.5 and FY11 Review processes, and the biennial cycle it mandated was superseded by OSD Guidance in spring 2010 directing the DoD to return to an annual POM/BES cycle.

Milestones: The point at which a recommendation is made and approval sought regarding starting or continuing an acquisition program, i.e., proceeding to the next phase. Milestones established by DoDI 5000.2 are: MS A that approves entry into the Technology Development (TD) phase; MS B that approves entry into the System Development and Demonstration (SDD) phase; and MS C that approves entry into the Production and Deployment (P&D) phase. Also of note are the Concept Decision (CD) that approves entry into the Concept Refinement (CR) phase; the Design Readiness Review (DRR) that ends the System Integration (SI) effort and continues the SDD phase into the System Demonstration (SD) effort; and the Full Rate Production Decision Review (FRPDR) at the end of the Low Rate Initial Production (LRIP) effort of the P&D phase that authorizes Full Rate Production (FRP) and approves deployment of the system to the field or fleet.

Mini-Skulls: last-minute preparation of senior DAF leaders, such as the CSAF, CSO or SECAF, to defend the DAF program or budget, usually the morning of the event, and usually focused on the most critical issues.

Mission Area: Obsolete, see Functional Area

Mission deficiency: The inability to accomplish an operational or support task required to achieve a military objective.

Modification: An alteration to a produced material item applicable to aircraft, missiles, support equipment, trainers, etc. As a minimum, the alteration changes the fit or function of the item.

MOE: Measure of Effectiveness: A qualitative or quantitative measure of a system's performance or a characteristic indicating the degree it performs the task or meets a requirement under specified conditions. MOEs should be established to measure the system's capability to produce or accomplish the desired result.

MOP: Measure of Performance: A quantitative measurement of the system's capability to accomplish a task. Typically, it is in the area of physical performance (e.g., range, velocity, throughput, payload.).

Most Dear: Those programs or initiatives with the CSAF's and SECAF's highest priority for funding

NDI: Non-developmental Item: NDIs are: Any item commercially available in the market place; any previously developed item in use by a department or agency of the United States, a state or local government, or a foreign government with which the United States has a mutual defense cooperation agreement; any of the above items requiring only minor modifications to meet the requirements of the procuring agency; any of the above items of supply currently produced but is not yet in use or is not yet available in the commercial marketplace, or any commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS) item.

NSC: National Security Council: The National Security Council is chaired by the President. Its statutory members, in addition to the President, are the Vice President and the Secretaries of State and Defense. The Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff is the statutory military advisor to the Council, and the Director of Central Intelligence is the intelligence advisor. The Secretary of the Treasury, the U.S. Representative to the United Nations, the Assistant to the President for National Security Affairs, the Assistant to the President for Economic policy, and the Chief of Staff to the President are invited to all meetings of the Council. The Attorney General and the Director of the Office of National Drug Control Policy attend meetings pertaining to their jurisdiction; other officials are invited, as appropriate.

NSS: National Security Strategy: Broad document published by the NSC outlining the defense, economic, internal, and international security objectives of the United States. Specific recommendations or directives are written as Presidential Decision Directives (PDDs) or Presidential Review Directives (PRDs).

Need: The identification of a mission deficiency satisfied by a materiel or non-materiel solution.

Negative Wedge: Taking anticipated savings from a program prior to implementing the initiative, and understanding the actual savings, e.g., Competitive Sourcing and Privatization.

New Start: An item or effort appearing in the President's Budget (PB) for the first time; an item or effort that was previously funded in basic or applied research and is transitioned to Advanced Technology Development (ATD) or engineering development; or an item or effort transitioning into procurement appearing in the PB for the first time in the investment area. Often confused with program initiation, an acquisition term that describes the milestone decision that initiates an acquisition program.

Non-discretionary Spending: Those expenses or entitlements Congress defines and Treasury must outlay funds against when presented. For example, payment of unemployment compensation or interest on the national debt. Funds are available until Congress takes a positive step to stop the entitlement or program such as repealing legislation or enacting a sundown clause.

Normalized: (1) Database – To render constant or to adjust for known differences. (2) Dollars – Various fiscal year costs are inflated/deflated to a common year basis for comparison.

O&M, Operations and Maintenance: Annual appropriation for operating expenses, such as fuel, utilities, real property maintenance. O&M is programmed in each individual program, but the Operating Budget Review Committee (OBRC) reviews it as part of the AFCS, and SAF/FMBO executes it through the field commands.

OBAN: Operating Budget Account Number: A two-digit number assigned by the operating agencies (e.g., MAJCOMs) to identify a specific operating budget. This term is comparable to “allotment serial number.”

OBAD: Operating Budget Authority Document: Documents issued from a higher headquarters containing operating budget authorities for a given fiscal year. The OBAD will grant obligation authority for only the Operations and Maintenance Appropriation. The OBAD identifies both annual programs and cumulative programs.

Obligation(s): The legal reservation of a specific amount of funds associated with a firm contract or other obligating document. An obligation represents a legal and binding promise to purchase a service or supply item from a vendor. Amounts of orders placed, contracts awarded, services received, and similar transactions during an accounting period requiring payment during the same or future period. Such amounts include payments, for which obligations previously were not recorded, and adjustments for differences between obligations previously recorded and actual payments to liquidate those obligations. There are three types of obligations: Undelivered Orders Outstanding (UOO), Accrued Expenditures Unpaid (AEU), and Accrued Expenditures Paid (AEP).

Obligation Authority: The sum of (1) budget authority provided for a given fiscal year, (2) balances of amounts brought forward from prior years remaining available for obligation, and (3) amounts authorized to be credited to a specific fund or account during that year, including transfers between funds or accounts. (See “Budget Authority.”)

Obligation Rate: The percentage of funds obligated over time. Used by OSD to evaluate program financial execution; metric forecasts expenses. OSD sets obligation rate goals varying by appropriation code. For example, programs should obligate 90% of 3600 RDT&E funds in their first year of availability, while most procurement, 3010, 3020, 3011, is 80%, and 3400 O&M is 80% in the first 9 months of a year, with 100% by the end of a year.

Objective: The objective is that value desired by the user, which could potentially have a measurable increase in performance over the threshold. An objective value may be the same as the threshold when an operationally significant increment above the threshold is not significant or useful. (CJCSI 3170.01C)

Offset: Resources offered to “pay” for a Program Change Request action, disconnect, or initiative; funds in an existing approved program removed from the program to fund higher priority requirements. Funds should be excess to need in the approved program or they will create a disconnect.

OMB: Office of Management and Budget: An element of the President’s Executive Staff responsible for developing and presenting the President’s Budget to Congress between the 1st Monday in January and the 1st Monday in February each year. OMB reviews and integrates each department’s budget into a unified federal budget submission. Because the Defense Department represents such a large part of the discretionary budget, and the review effort is so time-consuming, OMB analysts participate in the OSD review rather than conducting a separate review of their own.

Omnibus Reprogramming: Single, all-encompassing request from OSD submitted through OMB to Congress each year requesting realignment of appropriated funds to improve financial execution. Provides line-item justification for transfer from a losing program appropriation (source) to a gaining program appropriation (requirement).

Operating Command: The command primarily operating a system, subsystem, or item of equipment; generally applies to those operational commands or organizations designated by Headquarters, U.S. Air Force to conduct or participate in operations or operational testing. Interchangeable with the term “Using Command” or “user.”

Operational Assessment: An analysis of potential operational effectiveness and operational suitability made by an independent operational test activity, with user support as required, on other than production systems. The focus of an operational assessment is significant trends noted in development efforts, programmatic voids, areas of risk, adequacy of requirements, and the ability of the program to support adequate operational testing. Operational assessments may be made at any time using technology demonstrators, prototypes, mock-ups, engineering development models, or simulations, but will not substitute for the independent operational test and evaluation necessary to support full production decisions.

Operational Effectiveness: The overall degree of mission accomplishment of a system used by representative personnel in the environment, planned or expected (e.g., natural, electronic, threat, etc.), for operational employment of the system; considers organization, doctrine, tactics, survivability, vulnerability, and threat (including countermeasures, initial nuclear weapons effects, nuclear, biological, and chemical contamination [NBCC] threats).

Operational Reliability and Maintainability Value: Any measure of reliability or maintainability that includes the combined effects of item design, quality, installation, environment, operation, maintenance, and repair.

Operational Suitability: The degree to a system can be placed in field use satisfactorily with consideration given to availability, compatibility, transportability, interoperability, reliability, wartime usage rates, maintainability, safety, human factors, manpower and, logistics supportability, natural environmental effects and impacts documentation, and training requirements.

Originating Command: The Air Staff office, major command, or field operating agency who prepares a document in compliance with this instruction. Includes civilian pay, installation repair and maintenance and minor construction, flying hour costs, travel pay, service and support contract costs, transportation costs, purchase of supplies and non-capital equipment, and depot maintenance as examples. The account for the Active Air Force is appropriation 3400; the account for the Air Force Reserve is appropriation 3740 and the account for the ANG is appropriation 3840. Funds are available one year for obligation.

Outlay: The amount of checks issued or other payments made (including advances to others), net of refunds, and reimbursements. Outlays are net of adjustments to obligational authority. The terms “expenditure” and “net disbursement” are frequently used inter-changeably with the term “outlay.” Gross out-lays are disbursements, and net outlays are disbursements (net of refunds) minus reimbursements collected.

Out Years: Normally the years of the FYDP not included in the execution or budget years, but can be years beyond the FYDP. From the time a fiscal year enters the programming years until it becomes the execution year, there are 18 opportunities to adjust funding and content within it and, therefore, change it significantly. Hence the saying, “the out years never get here.”

Overseas Contingency Operations: A separate funding account created in 2012 (previously known as “Global War on Terror” funding from 2003-2011.) OCO funds originally supported operations primarily in Iraq and Afghanistan in the early 2000s and became a separate, concurrent budget request with the President’s Budget submission from 2012 to 2020. As southwest Asia operations lessened, the OCO account was integrated back into the general President’s Budget submission in calendar year 2020.

Participating Command: A command or agency designated by the Air Force Acquisition Executive to advise the program manager and to take an active part in developing a new system. The supporting command is also a participating command.

PB: President's Budget: The budget for a particular fiscal year transmitted to the Congress by the President in accordance with the Budget and Accounting Act of 1921, as amended. Some elements of the budget, such as the estimates for the legislative branch and the judiciary, are required to be included without review by the Office of Management and Budget or approval by the President. The PB is assembled by Office of Management and Budget and presented to Congress no earlier than the 1st Monday in January, and no later than the 1st Monday in February each year.

PBES: Program Budget Enterprise System: The current DAF Budget database and the official source of program and funding for data the DAF. Replaced the ABIDES database for the FY23 PPBE cycle (calendar year 2021.)

PBD: Program Budget Decision: A budget decision document issued during the joint review of Service budget submissions by analysts of the Office of the Secretary of Defense (OSD) and the Office of Management and Budget (OMB). PBDs reflect the decisions of the Secretary of Defense appropriate program and funding adjustments to a Service BES that, in turn, is included in the President's Budget.

PBR: Program Budget Review: (Legacy Term) Until the FY17-21 PPBE cycle, the POM and BES were submitted and concurrently reviewed at the OSD level. As of 2015, the two Reviews (Program Review and Budget Review) are now separate.

PCP: Program Change Proposals: *While revised to "change proposals" in the FY 2007-2011 Program and Budget review process, it is included here to provide a more complete description of the terms used in the DoD Financial Management Regulation.* The instrument by which the Services were allowed to make limited adjustments to their Programs in the "off-year." in lieu of a Program Objectives Memorandum (POM). Projected program increases must be accompanied by specific program decreases of equal value. PCPs were resolved through Program Decision Memorandums (PDMs) or PBDs, but have not been used since FY2007.

PCR: Program Change Request: Document used to request an out-of-cycle change to the FYDP program structure (during the execution and budget years). Can be initiated by Headquarters Air Force, the MAJCOMs, or other programming agencies. Changes to the Air Force Program beginning beyond the execution and budget years should be part of the Program Agency initiatives or disconnects during the next programming phase.

PD: Program Decision: For the FY22-26 Program Review, the OSD directive document containing program adjustments to the impacted Components.

PDM: Program Decision Memoranda: A document containing the decisions by the Secretary of Defense regarding the program and resource levels identified in the Service Program Objective Memorandum.

Peanut Butter Spread: Percentage cut spread among all eligible programs to create an offset when a single bill payer isn't readily discernable or forthcoming. Normally this is used to pay a corporate bill or to spread TOA reductions not applied to exempted programs.

PEC: Program Element Code/Program Element: A description of a mission by the identification of the organizational entities and resources needed to perform the assigned mission. Resources consist of forces, manpower, materiel quantities, and costs, as applicable. The program element is the basic building block of the Future Years Defense Program. Used by the OSD to group funds by major force program and specific programs,

the code is structured to show the major force program (01 to 11), any special categories such as a budget activity (2 digits), a unique, specific program such as undergraduate flying training (3 digits), and the Service (single letter, F = Air Force, S = Space Force.) The program element is 8 digits for OSD. In ABIDES, the program element codes were 6 digits, the first 0 was dropped (for MFP 10, 11, and 12 DAF used a, b, and c respectively.) Within the current DAF database PBES, PEs are reflected as 8 digits. PEC and PE are often used interchangeably. Changes to PEs must be coordinated through AF/A8PE, SF/S8N, and OSD CAPE for approval.

PEM: Program Element Monitor: Individual charged with monitoring all aspects of a programs' programming, budgeting, and execution to advise the Corporate Structures or Using Command regarding issues.

PEO: Program Executive Officer: A military or civilian official who has primary responsibility for oversight of several ACAT I programs, and for assigned ACAT II and III programs. A PEO has no other command or staff responsibilities within the Component, and only reports to and receives guidance and direction from the DoD Component Acquisition Executive.

Program Guidance Memorandum (PGM): Document developed by the "Engine Room", AF/A8PE, that applies a "programming spin" on the PPG. The PGM is also a companion document to the POM Preparation Instruction (PPI) that also is developed by AF/A8PE for the Air Force. A separate PPI is issued by SF/A8N for the Space Force.

Performance: Those operational and support characteristics of the system allowing it to perform its assigned mission over time effectively and efficiently. The support characteristics of the system include both supportability aspects of the design and the support elements necessary for system operation.

Personnel: Those individuals required in either a military or civilian capacity to accomplish the assigned mission. Also, Manpower and Personnel

Plus Up: Increase in Topline

PM/PD Program Manager/Program Director: The individual designated in accordance with criteria established by the appropriate Component (DAF) Acquisition Executive to manage an acquisition program, and appropriately certified under the provisions of the DAWIA. PM is responsible for the execution of a program within the approved Acquisition Program Baseline. This individual is accountable to the AFAE through the Program Executive Officer (PEO) if the program is a PEO Program, or through the Designated Acquisition Commander (DAC) if the program is a DAC Program. A PM has no other command or staff responsibilities within the Component. Also, System Program Director (SPD) or System Manager (SM).

PMD: Program Management Directive: The official DAF document used to direct acquisition or modification responsibilities to appropriate DAF MAJCOMs or FIELDCOMs for the development, acquisition, modification, or sustainment of a specific weapon system, subsystem, or piece of equipment. It is used throughout the acquisition cycle to terminate, initiate, or direct research for development, production, or modifications for which sufficient resources are identified. States program unique requirements, goals, and objectives, especially those to meet at each acquisition milestone or program review. (See HOI 800-2, Policy and Guidance for Preparing Program Management Directive.)

PMO: Program Management Office: Office led by a program director charged with the life-cycle responsibility for a program under the IWSM process. Can be part of a System Program Office (SPO), led by a System Program Director, but more often the term is used interchangeably with SPO.

POM: Program Objective Memorandum: The final product of the programming process within the Department of Defense, the Components' POM displays the resource allocation decisions of the Military Departments in responding to and in accordance with Defense Guidance.

PPBE: Planning, Programming, Budgeting and Execution System: The primary Resource Allocation Process (RAP) of DoD. It is one of three major decision support systems for defense acquisition along with Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System (JCIDS) and the Defense Acquisition System. It is a formal, systematic structure for making decisions on policy, strategy, and the development of forces and capabilities to accomplish anticipated missions. PPBE is annual process which produces a Defense Planning and Programming Guidance, an approved Program Objectives Memorandum (POM) for the Military Departments and Defense Agencies covering five years, and the DoD portion of the President's Budget (PB) covering one year.

PPI: POM Preparation Instruction: Each year, prior to the kick off of the POM (usually in the December time frame), AF/A8PE (Air Force) and SF/A8N (Space Force) publishes process guidance in a document called the POM Preparation Instruction. Contents of that document typically include detailed instructions on the content and construction of options and supporting documentation, a list of Panels active in that year's POM, rules governing the Baseline Extension and Zero Balance transfers, policy on the treatment of manpower changes, and the like.

Procurement Accounts: Appropriations for the purchase of DAF capital equipment and weapons. Appropriation 3010 is for aircraft, aircraft modifications, and initial spares; 3011 is for munitions; 3020 is for missiles; 3080 is for other procurement of equipment.

Product Group Manager: The single manager who is charged with all cost, schedule, and performance aspects of a **product group**: a compilation of several specific products in all life cycle phases that are characterized by an ongoing development requirement as well as a much larger cumulative sustainment effort, and is in direct support of one or more weapon system or military system program director.

Program: An organized set of activities directed toward a common purpose, objective, or goal undertaken or proposed by an agency to carry out responsibilities/mission assigned to it.

Program Code: Program codes identify funding for programs at the lowest system level and reside in PBES. Examples would be F-16 crew upgrade training operations, or T-6 acquisition costs.

Program Content: What a Corporate Structure expects the program to deliver in any given year based on planning documents such as the PGM, PPGM or acquisition plan, guidance from the CSAF, CSO and SECAF, direction from OSD via a PDM or PBD, or the will of Congress as expressed in law or report language. Also, approved program.

Program Cost: The total of all expenditures, in any appropriation or fund, directly related to the AIS definition, design, development, and deployment, and incurred from the beginning of the "Concept Exploration" phase through deployment at each separate site. For incremental and evolutionary program strategies, program cost includes all increments. Program cost does not include operations and support costs incurred at an individual site after operational cut over of any increment at that site, even though other sites may exist and are not yet completed deployment.

Program Decision: for the FY22-26 PPBE cycle, a Program Decision (PD) is the OSD directive document that records OSD-directed changes to a Component's program in the wake of the Program Review.

Program and Budget Review Cycle: Formal review conducted by the Program and Budget Review Meeting (formally 3-star Programmers' Group) and the DMAG of Service POM submissions for compliance with the Defense Planning and Programming Guidance (DPG), Combatant Commander IPLs, and other strategic guidance.

Conducted sequentially prior to the OSD Budget Review, which examines Service budget submissions for fiscal compliance and executability. Significant activity begins with submission of the Service Program/Budget Review submission in summer and ends with final adjudication of OSD Resource Management Decisions (RMDs) in the late autumn.

Program and Budget Review Meeting: New, (as of 13 Sep 2019) review body that replaces the 3-Star Programmers meeting. Program and Budget Review Meeting will continue to support the DMAG as did the legacy 3-Star meeting.

Program to Plan Guidance (PPG): Related to the SMP, the PPG can be used to provide updated planning and programming guidance to the DAF as a result of senior leader discussions/decisions that take place during the 4-Star Summarizing Event meeting.

Program Resource Managers Group (PRMG): (legacy term) Replaced by the Resource Management Group in the FY 24-28 PBR. OSD review body that was formerly known as the 3-Star Programmers meeting. PRMG is very active during OSD's Program Review.

QDR: Quadrennial Defense Review: Congressionally directed review of defense vision, force structure, and objectives. DoD and JCS conduct the review with the input of the Services, and provide a report to a National Defense Panel (NDP), appointed by Congress. The NDP then provides Congress their assessment of the QDR. *Legacy process; the QDR is no longer required and was last published in 2016.*

QFR: Question for the Record: Questions asked during Congressional Testimony deferred at the time, but requiring a formal response, are entered into the Congressional Record. Focal point is SAF/FML appropriation committee questions and SAF/LL for all other committees

RAA DATE Required Assets Available date: A date agreed to by Headquarters, Air Force Material Command and the using command where sufficient equipment, personnel, and logistics elements are available to the operational command to begin a trial period for equipment operation and support capability before initial operational capability declaration. Logistics elements include approved operational support equipment, critical spares, verified technical manuals, and training programs and courses.

Ramp Down: The reduction in annual funding levels over time as a program is reduced or eliminated in the FYDP.

Ramp Up: The increase in annual funding levels over time as a program is introduced or increased in the FYDP

RAPIDS: Resource Allocation Programming Information Decision System: *legacy tool, no longer used.* This AF/A8PE software application served two primary purposes: developing the "perfect slide" to brief program options to the AFCS, and creating funding change documents passed to ABIDES.

RCT: Requirements Correlation Table: A three-part table, specific to Air Force-generated CDDs and CPDs, which provides an audit trail of the performance attributes and desired capabilities identified in the text of these documents. The RCT lists operator-identified performance attributes and capabilities with accompanying thresholds and objectives; identifies operator recommended key performance parameters; provides supporting rationale justifying each threshold obtained from the AoA or concept studies; and provides a concise summary to ensure decision makers have the necessary data to make informed decisions.

Read Aheads: Briefing or facer material provided in advance of the meeting or briefing to prepare participants to discuss the issues in the briefing. Usually transmitted electronically to Group, Board, or Council members.

Reclama: A formal response to an Issue Paper during OSD PBR that provides additional justification or clarification of a Service programming or budgetary issue to OSD and OMB reviewing authorities with the objective of sustaining the MilDept (DAF) position. Reclamas are vetted at the AFB or SFB.

Reprogramming: Realignment of budget authority from where Congress appropriated it to finance another (usually emergent, un-funded) requirement in a different appropriation. Below-threshold reprogramming is accomplished within the Services. Congress authorizes the threshold amounts for realignment in advance. Reprogramming actions above the approved threshold must be sent back to Congress for approval. Approval is a two-step process. Congressional staff consents to the sources to use and the requirements to be funded. It only takes one person to disapprove a source or a requirement. If a source is disapproved, then the Service must spend the money for what it was appropriated.

Requirement: A recommended solution to a mission deficiency, when validated and approved, justifies the timely allocation of resources to achieve a capability to accomplish military objectives, missions, or tasks.

Resource Allocation Plan (RAP): 30-year projection of Air Force force structure that is developed and reviewed during the 4-Star Planning Choices meeting typically held in Nov. The RAP consists of a database with an accompanying narrative.

Resource Management Decision (RMD): *(as of 2016 a legacy document. Replaced by the Program Decision Memoranda (PDM) for Program Issues and Program Budget Decisions (PBD) for Budget Issues.)* The RMD is an OSD document that directs changes to the Services' programs. RMDs were first issued to the Services in April 2009 to reflect budget changes directed by the Obama Administration. RMDs have replaced PDMs and PBDs as the OSD-issued directive guidance resulting from the Integrated Program Budget Review.

Resource Management Group (RMG): starting with the FY 24-28 Program Review and Budget Review (PBR), the Resource Management Group (RMG) replaces the Program Resource Managers Group (PRMG) as the initial corporate body in the OSD Corporate Structure. The RMG is convened to review and adjudicate actions and/or issues elevated during OSD's program Review and Budget Review.

Revisit: Programs requiring further discussion than cannot be accomplished in the current session of the AFCS due to insufficient information or the introduction of additional information.

Risk: Fact of life in planning and programming for forces and resources in a fiscally constrained environment. The Services measure the risks they take at every step of the PPBE. See Fix it in Execution and At Risk Program.

RRR: Rapid Response Process: An expedited process for documenting and staffing materiel solutions to urgent, time-sensitive requirements. The process is fully described in AFI 63-114.

Roll-up: 1) Informal term to describe the process of considering several similar but small issues requiring a single policy decision. For example, disconnects for C-130, F-15, and AWACS technical orders could be a roll-up issue.

RPM: Real Property Maintenance: Maintenance and repair of facilities and the accomplishment of minor construction financed by O&M funds instead of the MILCON appropriation. Requirement usually expressed in terms of percentage of "plant replacement value," the total value of all DAF buildings, roads, utilities, runways, etc.

RPS: Real Property Services: Account for services such as fire protection or crash rescue, utility plant operations, purchased utilities, annual service contracts (e.g., refuse, custodial, elevator maintenance and inspection, overhead door repairs, etc.) snow removal, etc.

SAMP: Single Acquisition Management Plan: A SAMP is required by SAF/AQ for all ACAT I and II programs, and is optional for ACAT III programs. The SAMP is a comprehensive, integrated document discussing all relevant aspects of a program supporting of a MS decision. As a program management strategy document, it consolidates required documentation, and is tailored for the specific needs of the program. The SAMP is structured to streamline the oversight and statutory requirements contained in all other management plans for all levels above the PEO or DAC.

SE: SEEK EAGLE: The Air Force certification program for determining safe carriage, employment and jettison limits, safe escape, and ballistics accuracy, when applicable, for all stores in specified loading configurations on United States Air Force and Foreign Military Sales (FMS) aircraft. SE includes compatibility analyses for fit, function, electromagnetic interface, flutter, loads, stability and control, and separation; stores loading procedures; ground and wind tunnel tests; and flight tests. The end product is source data for flight, delivery, loading manuals, and the weapon ballistics portion of the aircraft operational flight program.

Selected Programs: Those programs, normally acquisition category II, selected by the Air Force acquisition executive for special oversight and assigned to the management portfolio of a program executive officer.

Senior Level Review Group (SLRG): The SLRG replaced the Defense Resources Board. It oversees the PPBE process and assists the Secretary of Defense and Deputy SECDEF make decisions.

Senior Information Resources Management (IRM) Official: The senior Air Force official responsible for the IRM Program. The Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Acquisition) is the Senior Air Force IRM official.

Skulls: Time spent preparing senior DAF leaders such as the CSAF, CSO or SECAF to defend the DAF program or budget before OSD or Congress.

SM: Single Manager: General term used to describe System Program Directors (SPDs), Product Group Managers (PGMs), Materiel Group Managers (MGMs), and Technology Directors who are the individuals responsible for a system, product group, or materiel group or major research area and report directly to a Program Executive Officer (PEO) or Designated Acquisition Commander (DAC).

Small Group: One of a number of SECDEF advisory groups that may provide recommendations to SECDEF in development of the OSD POM. Services are usually not invited to participate in the Small Group.

Snake Chart: The Snake Chart is a timeline published by AF/A8PE and kept current as the exercise progresses. The Snake Chart will depict each step of the process with specific dates. For example, it will show the dates the Group will meet to consider Panel and MAJCOM inputs to the POM. Because it is kept current, it may be updated two to three dozen times over the course of the exercise. It is critical that participants have a source for the current version of the Snake Chart.

SPD: System Program Director; see PM.

SPE: Senior Procurement Executive: The senior official responsible for management direction of the Air Force procurement system, including implementation of unique procurement policies, regulations, and standards. The Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Acquisition) is the SPE. See also Air Force Acquisition Executive (AFAE).

STA: System Threat Assessment: The basic authoritative threat assessment tailored for and focused on ACAT II and III program. The STA describes the threat to counter and the projected threat environment. The STA may be a stand-alone document or the threat assessment contained in the Operational Requirements Document. The threat information is based on Defense Intelligence Agency validated documents.

STAR: System Threat Assessment Report: A DIA intelligence document serving as the single authoritative reference for threat data regarding weapon system acquisition program. The STAR contains the lethal and non-lethal threats against the proposed U.S. system and the threat environment in which the system will operate.

Strategic Master Plan (SMP): The primary DAF strategic guidance document that is reviewed every other year. It is an unclassified document with 4 Annexes (Human Capital, Strategic Posture, Capabilities, and Science and Technology). This guidance is updated annually by the SPG.

Strategic Planning Guidance (SPG): DAF document to instruct Input Sources and the Air and Space Staffs in the development of their POM submissions. Incorporates known elements of the Defense Planning Guidance (DPG). Signed by the Vice Chief of Staff and the Undersecretary. It is the primary strategic planning document in the DAF and links Strategic Planning to Programming. It should be released prior to the start of the internal Air and Space Force POM efforts in the January/February timeframe.

Supplemental Appropriation: An act appropriating funds in addition to those in an annual appropriation act. Supplemental appropriations provide additional budget authority beyond original estimates for programs or activities (including new programs authorized after the date of the original appropriation act) for which the need for funds is too urgent to be postponed until enactment of the next regular appropriation act.

Supporting command: The command responsible for providing logistics support for a system, and assuming program management responsibility from the implementing command.

Survivability: The capability of a system to avoid or withstand man-made hostile environments without suffering an abortive impairment of its ability to accomplish its designated mission. Survivability may be achieved by avoidance, hardness, proliferation, or reconstitution (or a combination). Its Components are susceptibility and vulnerability.

SVR: System Verification Review: Conducted to ensure that performance requirements of the system specification have been met. Demonstrates that the system satisfies the requirements in the functional and allocated baselines, confirms the completion of all incremental accomplishments for system verification (e.g. Functional Configuration Audits (FCAs) for Configuration Items (CIs)), and confirms readiness for production. Normally conducted during the Low Rate Initial Production (LRIP) effort of the Production and Deployment (P&D) phase.

System Acquisition Process: A sequence of specified decision events and phases directed to achieve program objectives and acquire systems. It extends from validating a requirement through deploying the system, or terminating the program.

System Capabilities: Measures of performance (such as range, lethality, maneuverability, etc.) for a system to accomplish approved military objectives, missions, or tasks.

Technical Data: Scientific or technical information recorded in any form or medium (such as manuals and drawings). Computer programs and related software are not technical data; documentation of computer programs and related software are. Also excluded are financial data or other information related to contract administration.

TEMP: Test and Evaluation Master Plan: Documents the overall structure and objectives of the Test and Evaluation (T&E) program. It provides a framework within which to generate detailed T&E plans and it documents schedule and resource implications associated with the T&E program. The TEMP identifies the necessary Developmental Test and Evaluation (DT&E), Operational Test and Evaluation (OT&E), and Live Fire Test and Evaluation (LFT&E) activities. It relates program schedule, test management strategy and structure, and required resources to: Critical Operational Issues (COIs), Critical Technical Parameters (CTPs), objectives and thresholds documented in the Capability Development Document (CDD), evaluation criteria, and milestone decision points. For

multiservice or joint programs, a single integrated TEMP is required. Component-unique content requirements, particularly evaluation criteria associated with COIs, can be addressed in a Component-prepared annex to the basic TEMP.

Then-Year Dollars: A constant or base-year dollar inflated or deflated to show the amount needed when expenditures are actually made. In other words, the amount spent in any given year expressed in that year's dollars.

Three-Star Programmers Group (3-Star Group): *legacy term: replaced by the Program Resource Managers Group (PRMG).* The 3-Star Group addressed major issues and presents decision options to the SLRG and SECDEF for resolution.

Threshold [Requirement]: A minimum acceptable operational value below which the utility of the system becomes questionable. (CJCSI 3170.01C) If the threshold values are not otherwise specified, the threshold value for performance will be the same as the objective value, the threshold value for schedule will be the objective value plus six months for Acquisition Category (ACAT) I programs and three months for ACAT IA programs, and the threshold value for cost will be the objective value plus 10 percent.

TIWG/TPWG: Test Integration Working Group/Test Planning Working Group: A cross functional group that facilitates the integration of test requirements through close coordination between material developer, combat developer, logistician, and developmental and operational testers in order to minimize development time and cost and preclude duplication between Developmental Testing (DT) and Operational Testing (OT). This team produces the Test and Evaluation Master Plan (TEMP) for the Program Manager (PM).

TOA: Total Obligational Authority (TOA) [Availability]: The sum of (1) all budget authority granted (or requested) from the Congress in a given year, (2) amounts authorized credited to a specific fund, (3) budget authority transferred from another appropriation, and (4) unobligated balances of budget authority from previous years which remain available for obligation. In practice, this term is used primarily when discussing the Department of Defense budget, and most often refers to TOA as "program" equating to only (1) and (2) above. **BLUE TOA:** DAF Topline after funds accounted for in the DAF Budget for the DAF portion of the Defense Health Program (DHP), Special Operations Forces funding (SOF), and National Foreign Intelligence Program (NFIP) are excluded

Topline: Department total funding level in each year of the FYDP authorized by Office of Management and Budget (OMB), e.g., Service TOA.

Tradespace: Selection among alternatives with the intent of obtaining the optimal, achievable system configuration. Often a decision is made to opt for less of one parameter in order to achieve a more favorable overall system result.

Two-Liner: Succinct explanation of a program or program adjustment within an options slide used to brief a Corporate Structure.

ULB: Unified Legislation for Budgeting: Process of getting agreement between the Services regarding to which personnel initiatives for entitlements will be included in the budget for funding along with a request for authorization. All Services must agree to fund in the BES, and the requested legislation is sent to Congress as part of the PB. If Congress does not authorize the entitlement, the dollars are lost.

Unexecutable: Programs unable to meet projected milestones, or deliver contracted capability due to cost, schedule, or performance (technical) problems. If the program is a weapon system, it will also be a disconnect. If the program is a level of effort, then it means the planned, programmed, and budgeted effort for a given year cannot be achieved with the funding available--could be due to cost increases or materialization of the risks taken in the PPBE.

Un-funded: (also Disconnects – legacy term) - An approved program unexecutable because of a shortfall of resources to fulfill the program's objectives or mission. Specific DAF or Office of the Secretary of Defense program budget decisions (PBDs) changing the program content or pace in the Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution System cycle are not candidates for disconnects in the following year's cycle.

UPL: Un-funded Priority List: List of the highest priority un-funded items maintained at every level of the Air or Space Force—squadron to wing/base, base to Major Command, Major Command to HQ Air Force, DAF to OSD in the POM and in the last administration OSD to Congress with submission of the budget. Target for the next available dollar.

Upward Adjustment: An increase to an obligation due to a change in the cost of goods or services purchased. Normally used in the context of expired appropriation accounts, but it can occur at any time. The important thing is that is not for new work.

Using Command: Also known as the operating command, operator, or user: typically, the ultimate operator of a system. There are some exceptions. For example, Headquarters, Air Combat Command can be the using command for a reconnaissance satellite for which Air Force Space Command is the operating command.

Validation: 1. A process normally associated with the collection of intelligence providing official status to an identified requirement and confirming the requirement is appropriate for a given collector and was not previously satisfied. 2. In computer modeling and simulation, the process of determining the degree a model or simulation is an accurate representation of the real world from the perspective of the intended uses of the model or simulation.

Validation Authority: Someone or agency, other than the user, who gives official confirmation the system will produce the desired result.

Vector Checks: Meetings held between the AF/A8, SF/S8 and SECAF, CSAF and CSO during Corporate Structure POM deliberations where the SECAF/CSAF/CSO provides guidance regarding the priorities and direction of the Corporate Structure decisions made to date. Typically occurs at least three times in any programming session.

Vet/Vetted: To subject to thorough examination or evaluation (American Heritage College Dictionary.) To brief or discuss programming issues through the Corporate Structure to establish a program's priority for funding.

VV&A: Verification, Validation, and Accreditation: The means by which a decision maker's confidence is established and maintained regarding digital modeling and simulation results by investigation, documentation, and accreditation of databases, software, hardware, and analysts. a. Verification is the process of determining a model implementation accurately represents the developer's conceptual description and specifications. b. Validation is the process of determining (a) the manner and degree to which a model is an accurate representation of the real-world from the perspective of the intended uses of the model, and (b) the confidence placed on this assessment. c. Accreditation is the official certification a model or simulation is acceptable for use for a specific purpose.

Weapon(s) System: A combination of one or more weapons with all related equipment, materials, services personnel and means of delivery, and deployment (if applicable) required for self-sufficiency. Items used directly by the armed forces to carry out combat missions.

Wedge: Funding laid into the POM or Budget in anticipation of defined program content; an easy target during any budget scrub. Wiser Resource Managers can confirm you "cannot sell a wedge in the Pentagon." See its opposite: negative wedge.

Workarounds: Options to recover from a cost, schedule, or technical problem to prevent or mitigate the risk to the program without adding or reducing the program funding. Normally done to avoid being a bill payer in the near term or to fix a disconnect.

ZBR: Zero Based Reprogramming: A programming action in which a portfolio owner – Input put Source and/or HQ USAF Panel - can address one of their own Disconnects and/or Initiatives with a specific Offset form their own portfolio. Specific rules may vary from year to year.

ZBT: Zero Balance Transfer: An exact reallocation of resources, normally within a single program element. A ZBT is a non-programmatic action accomplished to “clean up” a data base error or realign resources to allow for better management. This is accomplished during the programming phase under the guidance of the Associate Deputy Director of Plans and Programs.

Appendix C: Program Element Number Mapping

The US Department of Defense uses 8-character program element numbers in the budget process to identify each program (sometimes also referred to as PENs – Program Element Numbers – or PECs – Program Element Codes.)

The following listing explains the meaning of the codes within a Program Element.

First Two Characters: DoD Major Force Program

01	Strategic Forces
02	General Purpose Forces
03	Command, Control Communications and Intelligence
04	Mobility Forces
05	Guard and Reserve Forces
06	Research and Development
07	Central Supply and Maintenance
08	Training, Medical and Other Personnel Activities
09	Administration and Associated Activities
10	Support of Other Nations
11	Special Operations
12	National Security Space

Third Character: Category (MFPs 1-4 and 6 only)

1	Strategic Forces	1 Offensive 2 Defensive
2	General Purpose Forces	1 Unified Commands 2 Army Forces 3 Army Operational Systems Development 4 Navy Forces 5 Navy Operational Systems Development 6 Fleet Marine Forces And Systems Development 7 Air Force Forces And Systems 8 Other
3	Intelligence and Communications	1 General Intelligence And Cryptological Activities 2 National Military Command System 3 Communications 4 Special Activities 5 Other Activities
4	Airlift/Sealift	1 Airlift 2 Sealift 3 Traffic Management And Water Terminals 4 Special Operations And Combat Rescue Forces
5	Guard and Reserve	
6	Research and Development	1 Research 2 Exploratory Development 3 Advanced Development 4 Engineering Development 5 Management And Support 6 Operational Systems Development
7	General Supply and Maintenance	
8	Training, Medical and Other	
9	Administration and Associated Activities	
10	Support of Other Nations	
11	Special Operations	
12	Space	

Fourth Character: R&D Budget Activity (MFP 6)

1	Military Sciences
2	Aircraft and Related
3	Missile and Related
4	Astronautics and Related
5	Ships and Related
6	Ordnance, Combat Vehicles and Related
7	Other
8	Program-Wide Support

Fifth Character: Sponsor's Element Identifier
Sixth Character: DoD Component

A	Army
C	OSD
E	Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA)
F	Air Force
G	National Security Agency
H	Defense Nuclear Agency
I	Defense Reconnaissance Support Activities
J	Joint Chiefs of Staff
K	Defense Information Systems Agency
L	Defense Intelligence Agency
M	Marine Corps
N	Navy
R	Defense Contract Audit Agency
S	Space Force
U	Undistributed Resources
V	Defense Investigative Service
BB	Special Operations Command